TAINTED GRAIL

LAST KNIGHT

EXPLORATION JOURNAL

AWAKEN REALMS

DISCORD

https://discord.me/taintedgrailtts

Component List

Models

1 Dagan model

1 Fyul model

1 Sloan model

1 Mabd model

Paper Components

30 save sheets

Last Knight Exploration Journal

5 starting letters

Tiles

4 Character Tiles

Cards

Standard cards (260):

18 green Encounters

17 gray Encounters

18 purple Encounters

18 blue Encounters

30 Dagan cards

30 Fyul cards

30 Sloan cards

30 Mabd cards

69 Story Event cards

Oversized cards (69):

67 Location cards

2 Help cards

Small cards (35):

35 Secret cards

Four-hundred years have passed since
the One True King disappeared.

Before the menhirs burned out entirely,
forcing people to shelter in scarce, habitable areas,
some places flourished in a moment of glory.
There were heroes. There were kings and queens.
All now faded in the memory of the living as the long-
lasting autumn shifted into never-ending winter.

Now, snow and ice cover all. Even the wyrdness
is a pale shade of itself, weaker than before,
as if the cold stifled this force of pure change.
Though the Fore-dwellers failed to reconquer
their land, the millennium-long story of humans
on Avalon comes to a close as something interferes
with the fragile balance of the island.

Introduction

Last Knight is an additional campaign for Tainted Grail, designed to be played with a dedicated set of Characters. It takes players to the future Avalon and lets them see the final effects of their decisions from other campaigns.

The three main Tainted Grail campaigns can be played in any order, but for the best experience, we suggest players should tackle the **Last Knight** second, after the **Fall of Avalon** and before the **Age of Legends** campaigns.

Please keep in mind that the **Last Knight** and **Age of Legends** expansion campaigns build upon the core Tainted Grail rules and change some of them. If you have no previous experience of Tainted Grail, we recommend that you start with the core box campaign: **Fall of Avalon**.

Special Rules

Compared to the base game, Last Knight introduces the following new rules:

Sanctuary

There is now a fourth, additional Location Seal – **SANCTUARY** ( ). At the Start of the Day, if your Character is in a Location with this Seal, they don't gain (or lose – if you're using the Last Knight Challenge Mode) due to being out of range of an Active Menhir.

Please note that Sanctuary rules are slightly different in the Last Knight and Age of Legends campaigns.

Out of Range Locations

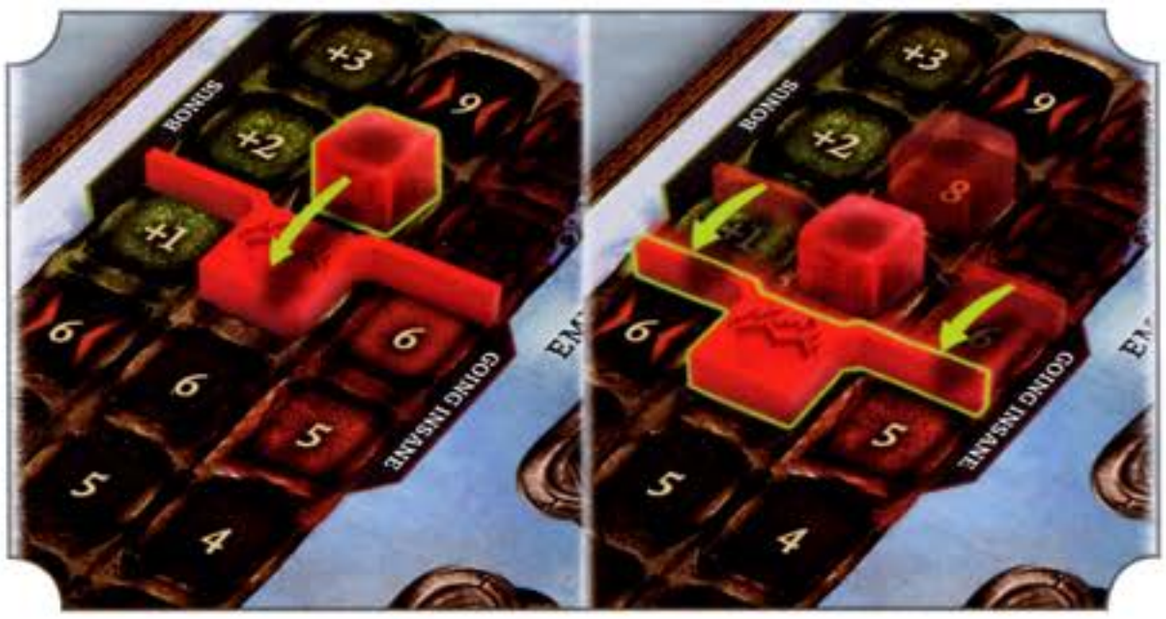
In Last Knight, you will often have no Active Menhirs anywhere on the map. There are new rules concerning Locations out of Active Menhir range:

- Locations are not discarded if there are Fore-dweller or Character models on them, or if the Locations are adjacent (including diagonally) to any Character.
- At the Start of the Day, each Character out of Active Menhir range gains 1 instead of the standard penalties outlined in the rulebook.

Exposure

Exposure represents the effects of extreme cold and harsh weather. It lowers your max .

- When you gain Exposure and you don't have an Exposure Marker, place an Exposure Marker (a red universal marker) in the topmost slot of your Health track. If you have a marker, move it one slot down. If there was a marker there, lose 1 to make space for the Exposure Marker.
- When you are told to lose Exposure, move the marker up. It can't reach 0, and you can't move it up above the topmost slot of the Health track. In these cases, the Exposure Marker doesn't move.
- You can remove the Exposure Marker only when you are told to discard it.
- When you have an Exposure Marker and Travel to a Location without the Seal, gain 1 Exposure. If you don't have an Exposure Marker, nothing happens.
- Your marker can never be in the same slot or higher than an Exposure Marker. When you can't restore during Rest because of an Exposure Marker, lose 1 Exposure instead.



When you gain Exposure in this situation, you must move the Exposure Marker from slot 6 to slot 5. Because there's a marker here, you have to move the marker down to slot 4 first.

Unavoidable Damage

A new type of damage icon appears on some of the **Last Knight** cards: . It is just a shorter, more convenient way to represent what the core box cards referred to as **"Unavoidable Damage"**. The cannot be prevented! Please note that effects that completely cancel the Attack or Response may still cancel .

Triple Attribute Keys

New, triple Attribute Keys appear on some of the **Last Knight** cards: , , , , , . They are similar to double Keys, but connecting them requires at least 3 of a given Attribute.

Double Magic Keys

A new, double Magic Key appears on some of the **Last Knight** cards: . It is similar to a standard Magic Key, but connecting it requires paying 2 Magic.

Connected Bonus Keys

Some of the **Last Knight** cards bear this symbol: . It's similar to the connected Attribute Keys, and means the number of connected Bonus Keys of the specific type in the entire Sequence.

Please note: effects that count all connected Keys of a certain type (for example:) also count connected triple and double Attribute Keys.

Expansion Icon

All Last Knight cards contain a special expansion icon ( ) to make sorting them easier. The only exceptions are the Secret cards. For ease of use, Secrets from all Tainted Grail campaigns can be kept in a single deck.

New "Global" Keyword

If a Secret card has this Keyword, its rules apply to each Character.

New Traits

Last Knight introduces the following new Encounter Traits:

Counter – Every time you gain or more when playing a single card (including all bonuses from Items and Skills), immediately resolve the Opportunity attack.

Fear – You Panic whenever you have more than 0 .

Frenzy – If you're not using any Weapon, resolve the Opportunity attack at the start of your Activation step.

Frostbite – Immediately after taking any , gain 1 Exposure.

Hunger – If you **have** the **"Red Sign"** Secret card (**66**), the Enemy has the *Rage* and *Feint* traits during your Character Activation step.

Multiattack – In the Enemy Attack phase, every Party member receives and gains from the Attack. Cards in the Sequence modify the Attack for every Party member. Items modify the Attack only for Characters who use them.

Retaliation – Add 1 to the Enemy Attack for every 2 cards in your hand.

Setting up the Last Knight

Please follow the steps below to start your Tainted Grail: Last Knight campaign.

Please note: if you found the Fall of Avalon campaign difficult to complete, consider using the Story Mode in this campaign (see the **"Last Knight Story Mode"** section below).

I) Importing your game

If you haven't played the Fall of Avalon and Age of Legends campaigns, or if you don't have Save Sheets from these campaigns, skip this step and go directly to the Character Setup section (II).

Otherwise, prepare a fresh Last Knight Save Sheet and find your Fall of Avalon and / or Age of Legends Save Sheet. Then, read on to import your choices from the first two campaigns.

WARNING!

MINOR SPOILERS AHEAD – IF YOU HAVE NO SAVE SHEET TO IMPORT, DO NOT READ THE REST OF THIS SECTION.

Fall of Avalon Save Sheet

- If you **have** the **"End of the Road"** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **1** status. *The story of the heroes lives on.*
- If you **have** the **"Fall of Chivalry"** part **8** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **2** status. *The Order of the Round Table has disappeared.*
- If you **have** the **"Final Confrontations"** part **4** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **3** status. *People from Cuanacht lived under Mordred's reign.*
- If you **have** the **"Fortunate Meetings"** part **5** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **4** status. *The dwarf still roams the island.*
- If you **have** the **"Remnants"** part **5** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **5** status. *People inhabited the Serene Visage and live under its protection.*
- If you **have** the **"Lost and Fallen"** part **1** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **6** status. *Lancelot and his entourage charged into Tuathan.*
- If you **have** the **"Matricide"** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **7** status. *Avalon lost one of its greatest allies.*
- If you **have** the **"People's Champion"** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **8** status. *The Order has fallen, and common people took over Kamelot.*
- If you **have** the **"Restoring the Order"** part **8** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **9** status. *The Order prevailed. Knights hid in Kamelot.*
- If you **have** the **"Restoring the Order"** part **6** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **10** status. *The recently knighted woman decided to leave Kamelot and help those in need.*
- If you **have** the **"Remedy"** part **1** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **11** status. *Whitening flourished after its people recovered.*

- If you **have** the **"Lost and Fallen"** part **7** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **12** status. *The girl from Farshire lived a long life.*
- If you **have** the **"Final Confrontations"** part **1** status, remove Location **205** from the game and replace it with Location **285**. *Morgaine achieved her dream.*
- If you **have** the **"Left Behind"** part **8** status, remove Location **210** from the game and replace it with Location **280**. *Cuanacht is no more.*
- If you **have** the **"Helping Hand"** part **2** status and don't have the **"Helping Hand"** part **4** status, remove Location **208** from the game and replace it with Location **288**. *Compassion has its consequences.*
- If you **have** the **"Last Haven"** part **2** status, remove Location **202** from the game and replace it with Location **282**. *Round Farmhold is lively again.*
- If you don't have the **"Reclamation"** status, remove Location **209** from the game and replace it with Location **289**. *Heroes from the past stopped the Fore-dweller uprising.*
- If you **have** the **"Remnants"** part **1** status, remove Location **206** from the game and replace it with Location **286**. *Farpoint Refuge grew into a great city.*
- If you **have** the **"Shrine Secure"** status, remove Loca tion 203 from the game and replace it with Location **283**. *The Allmother's shrine was saved from the fire.*
- If you **have** replaced Location **136** with Location **149**, remove Location **204** from the game and replace it with Location **284**. *The great power was released from its prison.*

Age of Legends Save Sheet

- If you **have** the **"Victories"** part **6** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **13** status. *A millennium ago, your ancestors bested a thing from beyond the stars.*
- If you **have** the **"Borderlands"** part **5** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **14** status. *The gratitude of people could last for a thousand years. Even if they are all dead now, they still try to repay you for giving them hope and a place to live.*
- If you **have** the **"Victories"** part **3** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **15** status. *The horned god is long dead, but his thirst for vengeance lives on.*
- If you **have** the **"Arbiter"** part **8** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **16** status. *The king of legends died in exile and disrepute.*
- If you **have** the **"Undercastle"** part **1** status, gain the **"Legacy"** part **17** status. *The builders of Kamelot decided to listen to military advice in the past.*

The Ultimate Secret

If you gained Secret card **90** in the **Fall of Avalon** campaign, gain it now as well. You start the Last Knight with this card in your possession.

If you gained Secret card **92** in the **Age of Legends** campaign, gain it now as well. You start the Last Knight with this card in your possession.

II) Character Setup

To set up Characters for the Last Knight campaign, use the Character Setup from the rulebook with the following changes:

I) Choose a Character Tile representing one of Last Knight Heroes (**Dagan**, **Fyul**, **Mabd**, **Sloan**) or **Niamh**.

II-XI) No Changes.

III) World Setup

Use the World Setup procedure from the rulebook with the following changes:

I) Place Location **201** in the middle of your play space and place all the Character models you are starting the campaign with there.

II) Do not place a Menhir there!

III) Attach Locations **"Jagged Cemetery"** (**211**) to its right edge and **"Glimmering Forest"** (**213**) to its bottom edge. Then, attach **"Black Sands"** (**212**) to the bottom edge of the **"Jagged Cemetery"** (**211**).

IV) Take all Encounter cards with the Last Knight symbol ( ). Add the following Encounter cards from the base game:

Gray Core Box Encounters:

Difficulty 1:

- 2x Band of Highwaymen
- 1x Clansman
- 2x Wyrd-Claimed

Difficulty 2:

- 2x Grave Robber
- 2x Seasoned Warrior

Difficulty 3:

- 1x Beastslayer
- 2x Fanatics
- 1x Fetch
- 1x Knight Errant

Difficulty 4:

- 1x Angry Mob

Green Core Box Encounters:

Difficulty 1:

- 2x Frenzied Boar
- 2x Pack of Strays
- 1x Wyrdbear

Difficulty 2:

- 1x Flock of Puffins
- 1x Wyrdbear

Difficulty 3:

- 1x Alder Tree
- 2x Bog Maiden
- 1x Fae
- 1x Giant Runtling
- 1x Selkie
- 2x Wyrdhog

Purple Core Box Encounters:

Difficulty 1:

- 3x Whispering Wisp
- 2x Wyrd-Claimed

Difficulty 2:

- 2x Dreadcrawler
- 1x Wyrdchild

Difficulty 3:

- 1x Abhartach
- 1x Fore-dweller Spirit
- 1x Hammerbeak
- 2x Yr Hen Wräch

Difficulty 4:

- 1x Puca
- 1x Slaugh

Blue Core Box Encounters:

Difficulty 1:

- 1x Breath of Wyrdness
- 3x Calm Before the Storm
- 1x Curfew
- 1x Mourners
- 1x Plague

Difficulty 2:

- 2x Calm Before the Storm
- 1x Hallucinations
- 1x Weeping Orphans

Difficulty 3:

- 1x False Accusation
- 1x Framed
- 1x Omen

Difficulty 4:

- 1x A Feast to Die for

Additionally, if you use the optional **Monsters of Avalon: Past and Future** or **Past and Future Alternative Encounters Card Pack expansion**, add the following modified Encounter cards to the Encounter decks and remove any Last Knight cards with the same names:

- Mad Warrior
- Torch Bearer
- Fachan
- Hooded Crow
- Glastig
- Gigelorum
- Fuathan
- Orphaned Heart
- Ailén Trechend
- Allfather's Inquisition

Some of the above are Diplomatic Encounters. If you draw a Diplomatic Encounter with this icon next to its name, it will act as any other Guardian if you fail or avoid it. Note that you can find Diplomatic Encounters not only in the blue Encounter deck (treat their Value as 0 for the purpose of any rules that check card's Value).

V) Add all Last Knight Secret cards to the Secret cards from the base game.

VI) Prepare a Last Knight Save Sheet.

VII) Use both additional Last Knight Help Cards from this campaign.

VIII-X) No changes.

(Optional) Last Knight Story Mode

The default difficulty of Tainted Grail puts emphasis on survival and resource management, and the constant pressure it puts on players may be overwhelming for groups who simply want to travel and enjoy the story. If you felt too hard pressed in the Fall of Avalon campaign, the Story Mode will offer you a more laid-back experience, focused on story and exploration.

Use the basic Story Mode rules, found on page 22 of the rulebook.

Additionally, remove the plastic Health limiter piece from the game and mark with a regular marker instead. Your does not limit your and you won't Panic in Combat or Diplomacy.

Please note this does not disable the Exposure rules! The red marker used for tracking in the Story Mode may still be pushed down by the Exposure Marker.

(Optional) Last Knight Challenge Mode

In addition to using the Challenge Mode options from the rulebook, you may use any of the following:

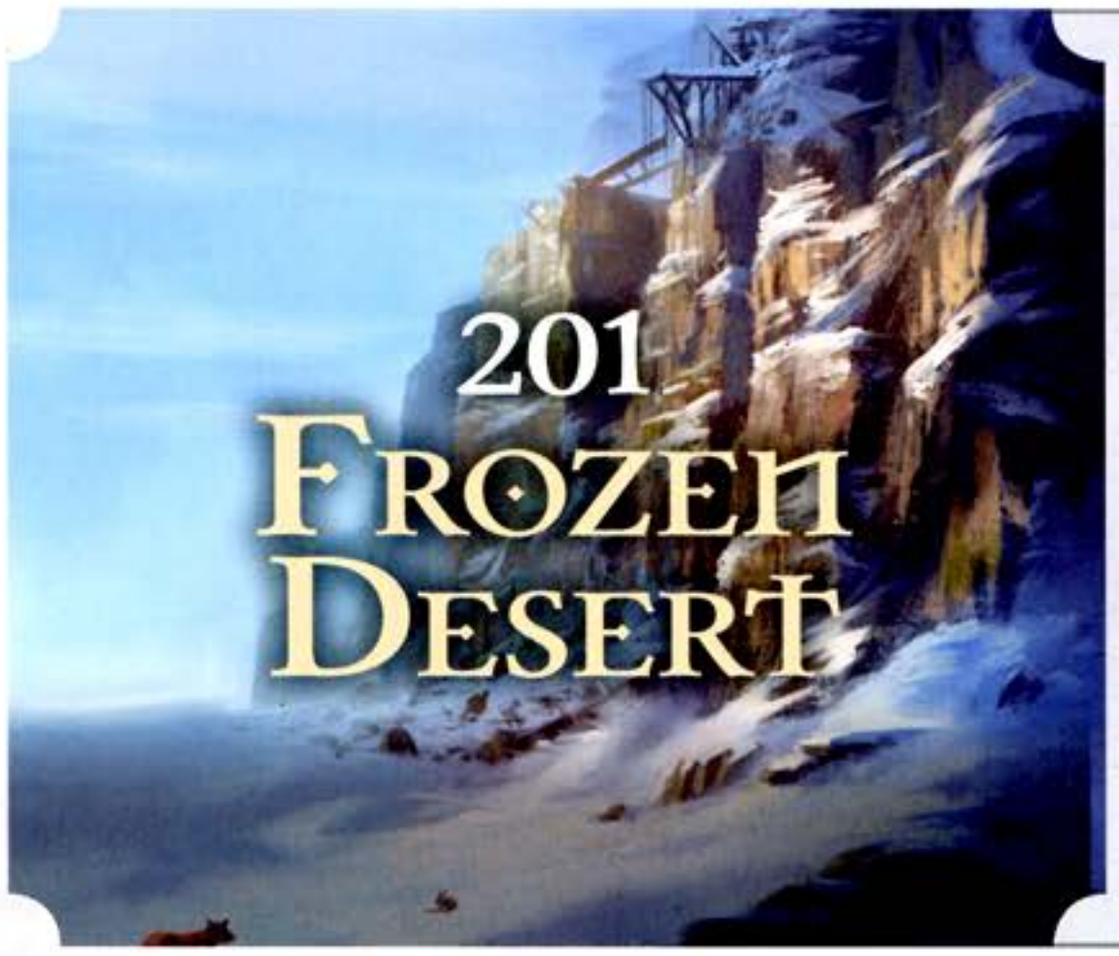
Too human

At the Start of the Day, each Character out of Menhir range loses 1 and gains 1 instead of the standard penalties outlined in the rulebook. Characters in Locations with a Sanctuary don't. lose or gain due to being out of range of an Active Menhir.

Permafrost

When you can't restore during Rest because of an Exposure Marker, nothing happens – you can't lose Exposure this way.

Locations



201 Frozen Desert

A field of white nestles under a high cliff, its top adorned with broken bridges, chains, and ropes. Everything around you is discolored, washed-out in the same way – vast snowdrifts, wisps of wyrdness creeping between them, animal tracks. The wind, blowing from the east, brings eerie melodies, stirring nostalgia and fear in your heart. A dim glow in the south reminds you of the frozen forest abundant in game.

- **Visit the cliff's icy overhang** – go to Verse 4.
- **Scout the desert** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 6.
- **Hunt snow foxes** (only if there is no Time Token on this Location; pay 2) – go to Verse 1.
- **Follow the clues** (requires the **"Mysteries and Visions"** part **2** status) – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

Place a Time Token on this Location. Resolve the **"Snow Fox"** green Encounter (Difficulty 1). Exploration ends.

3

Go to:

4

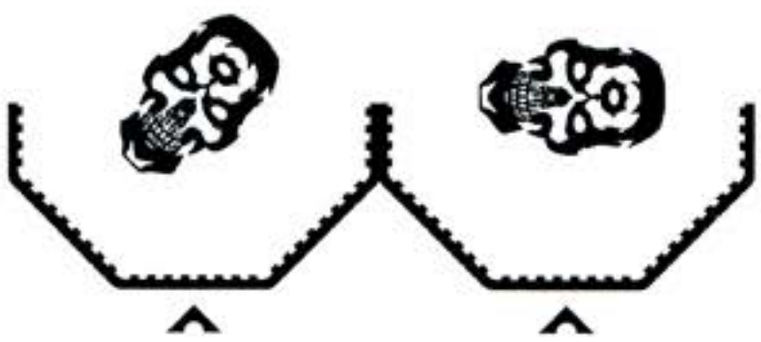
Snow partially covers the corpses of poor folks who tried to climb the cliff. Broken equipment has frozen to their stiff bodies.

If you **don't have** the **"Lost Treasures"** part **3** status, gain 1 non-Companion Item and the **"Lost Treasures"** part **3** status.

Exploration ends.

6

Go to:



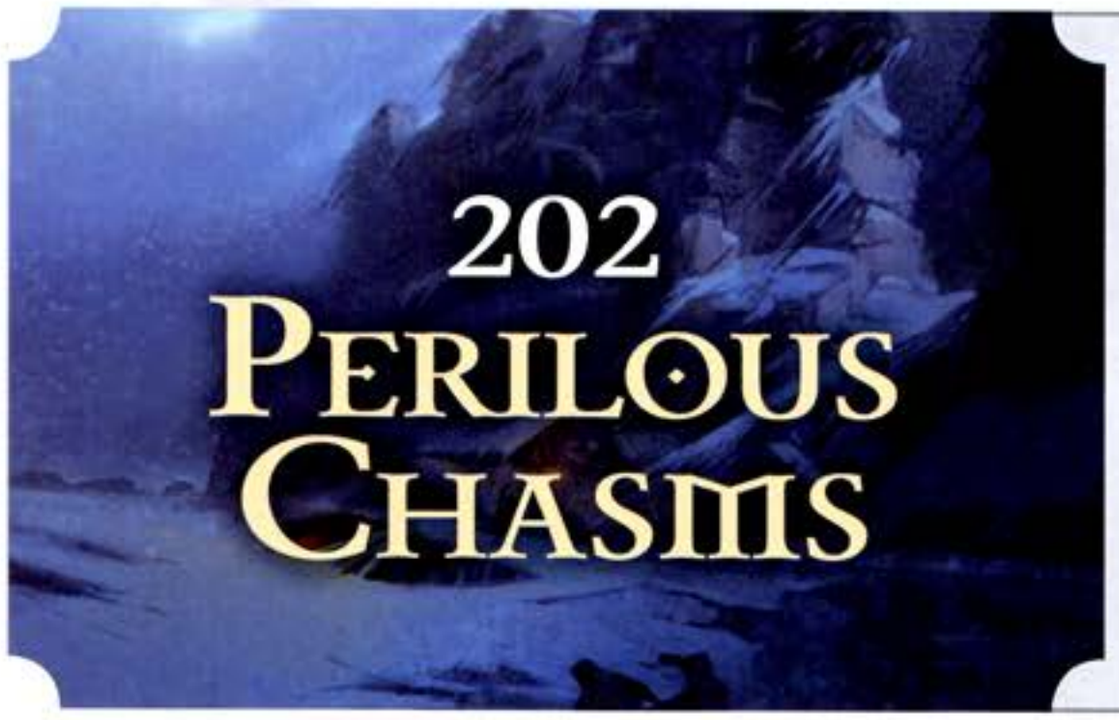
Dream

You stand amidst a vast, white field. Snow falls, but it's black and greasy. You want to hide, but find no shelter here. Then, a skeletal hand touches your shoulder and whistles an unsettling melody. At first you feel terror, but then realize the intentions of this person are good.

Nightmare

Frost bites you relentlessly while the wyrdness slowly warps your body. Wherever you go, you can't escape. What's worse, your head echoes with an ominous, maddening tune.

Each Character who has this Nightmare loses 1 .



202 Perilous Chasms

A meager encampment sits at the edge of a plain broken up with broad chasms. People wearing dirty furs fill the camp, shiver in the cold and thin wyrdness. They stare from a distance, tightening their grips on the handles of their makeshift weapons. You know them – outlaws from Mangrove Huddle, exiled because of their sins. You look upon the plain's chasms. The air from underground must be warm, as the snow melted around them.

- **Enter the underground** – go to Verse 1.
- **Visit the cluster of tents** – go to Verse 4.
- **Leave this unwelcoming place** – Exploration ends.

1

The tunnel is dark and cold. The torchlight casts unsettling shadows on the curved walls. It's hard to discern any details of your surroundings.

- **Emerge from the tunnel** – Exploration ends.
- **Go deeper** (requires 2) – go to Verse 7.

2

Everything shakes as the walls close in. You run toward the exit, hoping to escape before the walls crush you.

Each Party member gains 2 and loses 4 reduced by their . Then, Exploration ends.

3

You explore the grotto, finding more old blood on the floor and walls. A strange sound emanates from behind the wall – a faint gurgling, like water flowing between rocks.

Go back to Verse 7.

4

Smoke veils a cluster of tents. As you approach, people gather, scarves covering their faces. They keep their frostbitten hands on weapons. You've heard this is a camp of people exiled from Mangrove Huddle for their crimes.

If there is a Time Token on this Location, or if any of your Attributes are equal to 3 or more, no one dares approach you – go to Verse 5.

Otherwise, place a Time Token on this Location and resolve a blue Encounter. If you win (or you draw a **"Calm Before the Storm"**), go to Verse 5. Otherwise, each Party member loses all **Food** and Exploration ends.

5

Outcasts are protected from wyrdness by the aura of this strange area. But they still suffer from cold and starvation.

You may pay 1 **Food** to gain 2 **Wealth** (any number of times). Then, Exploration ends.

7

A massacred body lies at the center of the small grotto. You approach, peering around carefully. It looks as though a giant hand crushed this person in its deadly grasp.

If you **don't have** the **"Dismay"** part **9** status, gain 1 non-Companion Item and the **"Dismay"** part **9** status.

- **Scout the surroundings** (requires 2) – go to Verse 3.
- **Go on** – go to Verse 10.
- **Retreat from the underground** – Exploration ends.

10

Roll a die. If the result was 1, go to Verse 2. Otherwise, read on:

You wander the branching corridors, unsure of your destination. The air grows warmer, there's more dried blood, and the stones on the ground bears signs of something heavy dragged through the tunnel.

- **Retreat** – Exploration ends.
- **Go toward the heart of darkness** (requires 3) – go to:

203 Forgotten Lookout

A scenic vista unfolds – woods, glimmering snow, and oceans at your feet. You stand at the edge of a cliff too dangerous to traverse, and you wonder where is the path that once led down toward Twisted Pathways. You turn and see a cottage perched on the cliff's edge. It appears inhabited – but who would live on this windswept rise?

- **Go into the caves** – *There is an entrance near the cottage.* Go to Verse 1.
- **Observe the lands to the west** – go to Verse 6.
- **Visit the cottage** (only if you don't have the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **7** status) – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

The entrance to the caverns is covered in slippery ice. After a few steps, the area widens into a deserted shelter – dirty rags and straw mattresses huddle against a wall covered in illegible runes. An Allmother's symbol is skillfully carved between them, just above a message renewed countless times with charcoal: "'Tis a silly place."

If you **don't have** the **"Hidden Caches"** part **2** status, gain the **"Adventurer's Kit"** Item. Gain the **"Hidden Caches"** part **2** status and choose one:

- **Pray to Allmother** – go to Verse 7.
- **Pray to Allfather** – *You feel his powerful presence.* Go to Verse 5.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

3

Go to:

5

In a sudden outburst of anger, you spit on the Allmother's relief, and start praying to Allfather.

If you **have** the **"Saved by the Goddess"** status, you can't remember any prayers, and you feel overwhelming drowsiness – each Party member loses 1 and Exploration ends.

Otherwise, you feel an omnipotent presence – if you **don't have** the **"Allfather Blessing"** status, each Character gains 4 Exp; then, gain this status. Exploration ends.

6

A lonely spire rises from the bottom of the basin to the west. You can't see anything beyond – a perpetual storm rages there. An ancient forest dominates the eastern edge of the valley. Amid massive, twisted roots, you see a meadow with a ruined village and a menhir in its center.

If you're playing **Fyul**, **have** the **"Fallen Wyrdhunters"** part **1** status, and **don't have** the **"Fallen Wyrdhunters"** part **2** status, go to:

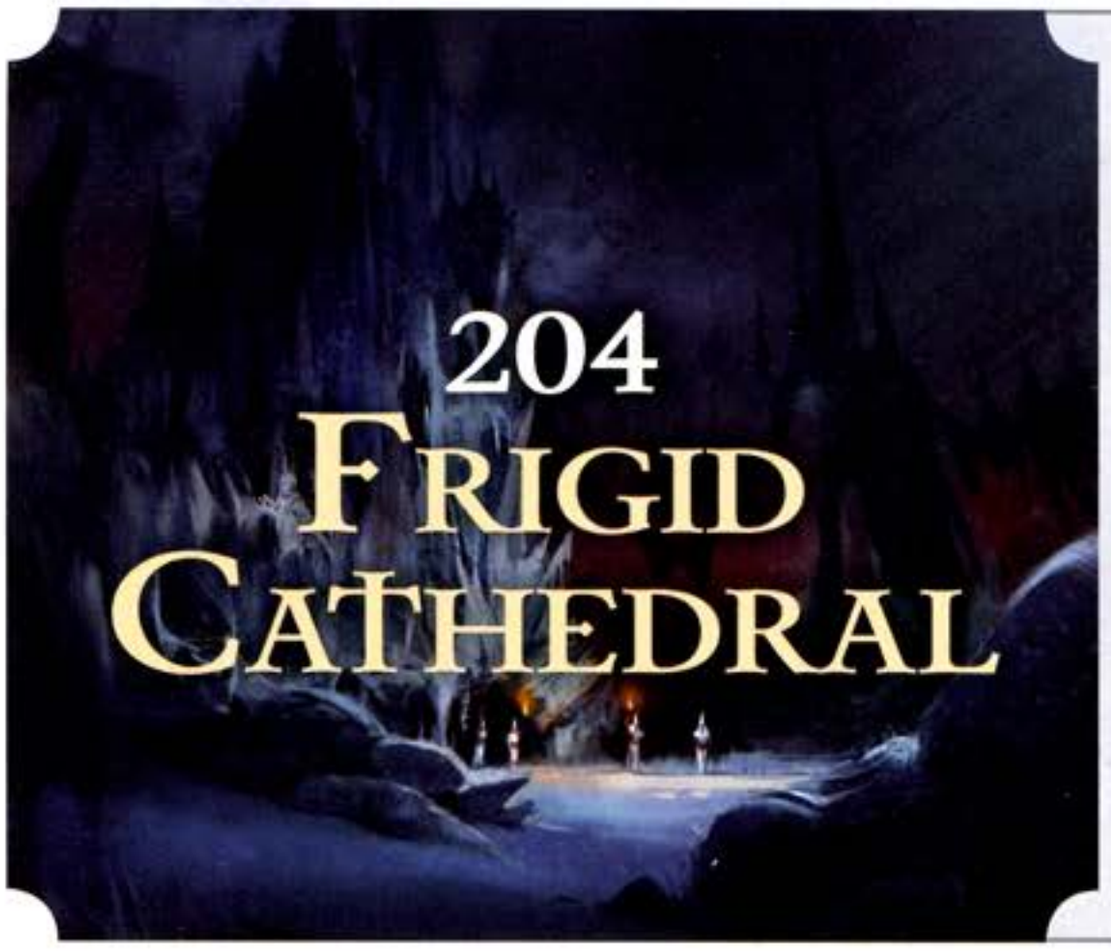
Otherwise, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

7

You sit before the carving and close your eyes. Praying to the old goddess always feels right, despite the hate she gets from Allfather's priests.

If you **have** the **"Allfather's Blessing"** status, your head sears with pain – each Party member gains 1 and Exploration ends.

Otherwise, the prayer soothes your nerves – each Party member loses 1 and Exploration ends.



204 Frigid Cathedral

If you are playing **Chapters 1-5**, go to Verse 1. Otherwise, read on:

Jagged edifices reach skyward, blocking sunlight and casting dark, cold shadows on the white-clad people wandering between them. A thick layer of ice covers everything, and some people appear completely frozen. The place unsettles you – a shiver runs down your spine, but you're unsure if it's the chill, these ominous people, or the strange lack of wyrdness. Is this one a sanctuary untouched by the wyrdness?

- **Approach one of the initiates** (only if you don't have the Secret card **48**) – go to Verse 4.
- **Visit the Cathedral** (requires the Secret card **48**) – go to Verse 6.
- **Retreat before they spot you** – Exploration ends.

1

Go to:

2

The woman tells you the cold is the only power that can fight wyrdness. The colder things are, the more resistant they are to change. Water is the best example – when warm, it flows continuously, but becomes still when frozen. Cultists here believe that if you cool the world enough, even time will stop, and humanity will finally live in a paradise.

- **Ask how to join the cult** – go to Verse 7.
- **Thank her and leave** – Exploration ends.

4

You are spotted by the cultists, and one approaches you. She asks why a faithless would come here. Do you seek truth in the cold? If not, she asks you to leave, and not taint this place with your warm flesh.

If you **have** the **"Initiation"** part **5** status, go to Verse 8.

- **Listen to the "truth"** – go to Verse 2.
- **Speak about the initiation** (requires all Characters and four parts of the **"Initiation"** status) – go to Verse 5.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

5

Go to:

6

You enter the imposing building and look upon the strange saints, their bodies emerging from altars. They don't mind the frostbite and offer you their blessing with smiles on their pale faces.

Each Party member may decide to gain 2 **Exposure**, 2 **Magic**, and 1 . Then, Exploration ends.

7

The cultist leads you into the cathedral. High arches, clear windowpanes, straight rows of benches, and a resplendent altar of ice make you feel small and insignificant. You notice two torsos, one a man and one a woman, partially frozen to the altar. Your guide bows and tells you that these are their saints. The saints speak, moving slowly in their frigid prison:

"We see you, and we acknowledge you want to hear us. But if you wish to join us, you must prove yourself. Each of our brothers and sisters has meditated in sacred places of deepest cold. Frozen Desert. Icicle Forest. White Fog. When you finish this pilgrimage, come back to us. Then, you may ask to join us."

Gain the **"Initiation"** part **1** status. Exploration ends.

New Task: Explore Frozen Desert, Icicle Forest, and White Fog and meditate there. Then, return to Frigid Cathedral to join the cult.

8

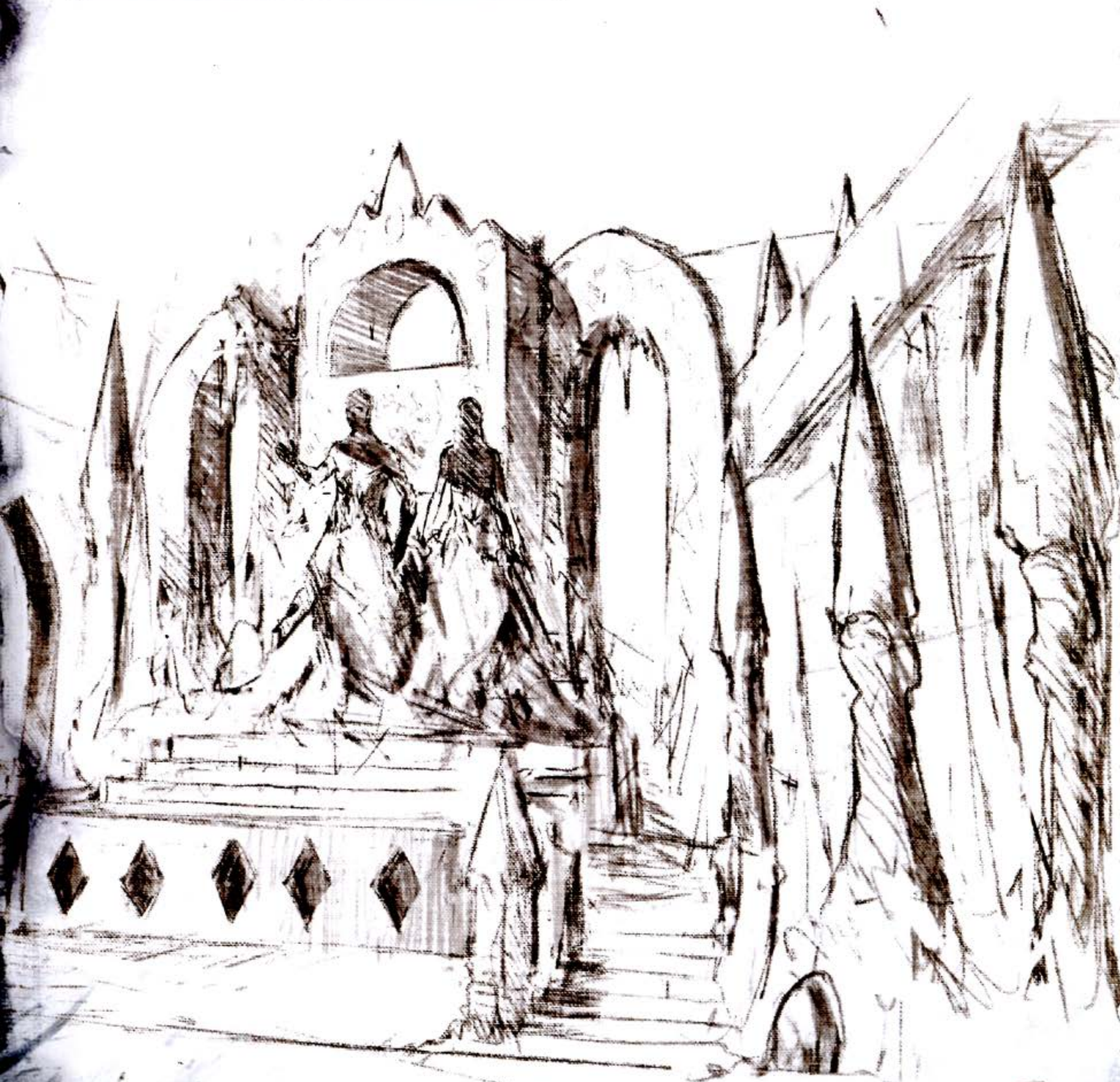
As those who rejected the greatest blessing, you are hated here. Angry cultists approach and force you to leave.

Resolve the **"Initiate"** gray Encounter (Difficulty 2). Then, Exploration ends.

Dream & Nightmare

You are chained to the curved, stone wall. You observe disgusting men, eating meat near their campfire as the cold wind and rain lashes at you.

Each Character who has this Dream or Nightmare gains 1 **Exposure**.



205
Kamelot Ruins

If you **have** the **"Time"** status, go to Verse 9. Otherwise, read on:

Ruins of a legendary Kamelot lie before you. Most of the castle fell into the sea along with the crumbling cliff. An enormous statue, broken in half, still guards the gaping entrance, glowering from beneath its stone hood. When you tear your eyes away from the ruins, you notice a forest of misshapen trees surrounding them – perhaps a good place to replenish your supplies.

If the **Chapter 6**: **Part 1** or **Part 2** Quest Card is revealed, go to Verse 3.

If the **Chapter 8**: **Part 1** Quest Card is revealed, go to Verse 8. Otherwise, choose one:

- **Step into the courtyard** – go to Verse 1.
- **Hunt in the forest** (pay 1) – go to Verse 4.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

The ruined courtyard is deserted, but you feel like something watches you.

If there is a Time Token on this Location, go to Verse 2. Otherwise, place a Time Token on this Location and toss a Dial:

- **Grail** – go to Verse 2.
- **Skull** – resolve a purple Encounter. If you win (or Enemy Run Away), go to Verse 2. Otherwise, Exploration ends.

2

It must have been your imagination. Dilapidated sheds stand beneath the wall, hiding unknown mysteries and dangers under their collapsing roofs. A dark hole gapes near the devastated keep – likely an entrance to cellars or maybe a dungeon. The keep itself also doesn't look welcoming.

- **Explore the sheds** – go to Verse 15.
- **Descend to the cellars** – go to Verse 6.
- **Enter the castle** – go to Verse 13.
- **Use the tunnels under the island** (requires **Chapters 10-15** and all Characters; pay 3 per Party member) – go to Verse 18.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

3

Go to:

4

You cross the tree line and look for tracks in the fresh snow.

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-4 – gain 1 Food.

5-7 – gain 2 Food.

8+ – gain 3 Food.

Then, resolve a green Encounter. Exploration ends.

5

You climb the stairs and enter decrepit corridors...

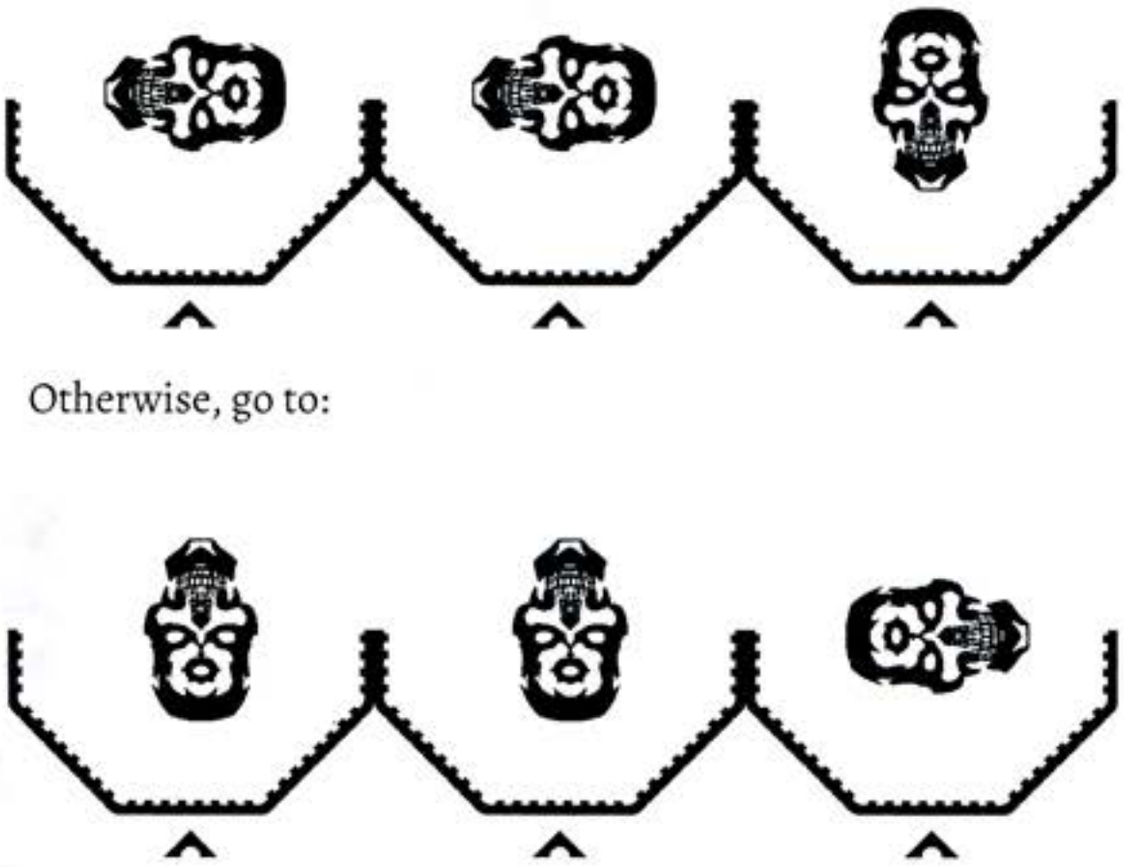
Roll a die and add your or (whichever is higher). You may pay 1 , to add 1 (any number of times). Check your final result:

1-5 – *You step on a treacherous stone. You fall, along with a section of the floor!* Each Party member loses 1 . Exploration ends.

6+ – *Navigating these stairs isn't easy, but you slowly progress.* Go to Verse 7.

6

If you are playing **Chapter 6**, go to:



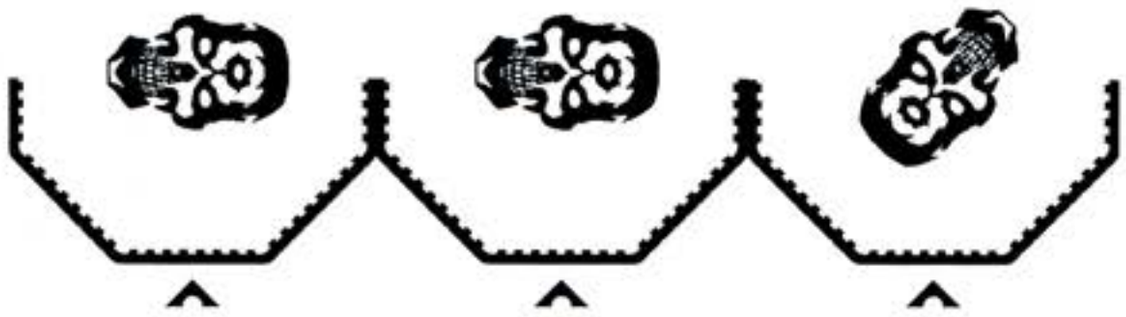
Otherwise, go to:

7

You find yourself in a room full of moldy books. You see nothing noteworthy, save some unintelligible diagrams written with charcoal. Perhaps you can still learn something from them.

Each Party member who has less than 3 **Magic** gains 1 **Magic**.

If you **have** 3 or more , you may go to:

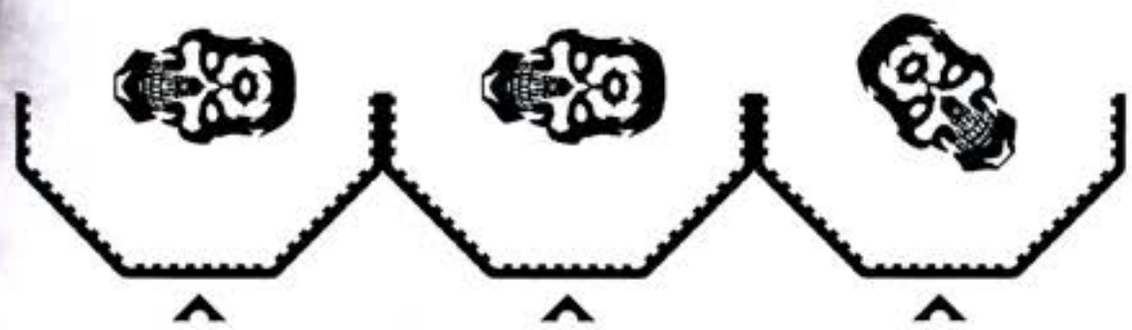


Otherwise, choose one:

- **Go back down** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 11.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

8

Go to:



9

Remove Location **205** from the game and replace it with Location **295**. Then, Explore this new Location for free.

11

The ground floor is gloomy, but from inside it appears in a good condition. Unlike the upper levels – staircases lie shattered, with the roof caved in.

- **Search the upper levels** – go to Verse 5.
- **Scout the ground floor** – go to Verse 17.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

13

The castle is in horrible condition – you hesitate to lean against anything, fearing collapse. You also hear unsettling hisses, whispers, and muffled cries from within.

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-4 – *Something stabs you from behind! When you turn, you find nothing.* Each Party member loses 1 and gains 1.

5+ – *You notice a strange tendril hanging from the ceiling and avoid it.*

Go to Verse 11.

15

Piles of decayed wood lie around the shack entrances.

If you **don't have** the **"Hidden Caches"** part **4** status, go to:

- **Otherwise, there is nothing interesting in here** – go back to Verse 2 and make another choice.

17

You wander dark corridors, unsure if the whole structure won't collapse on top of you.

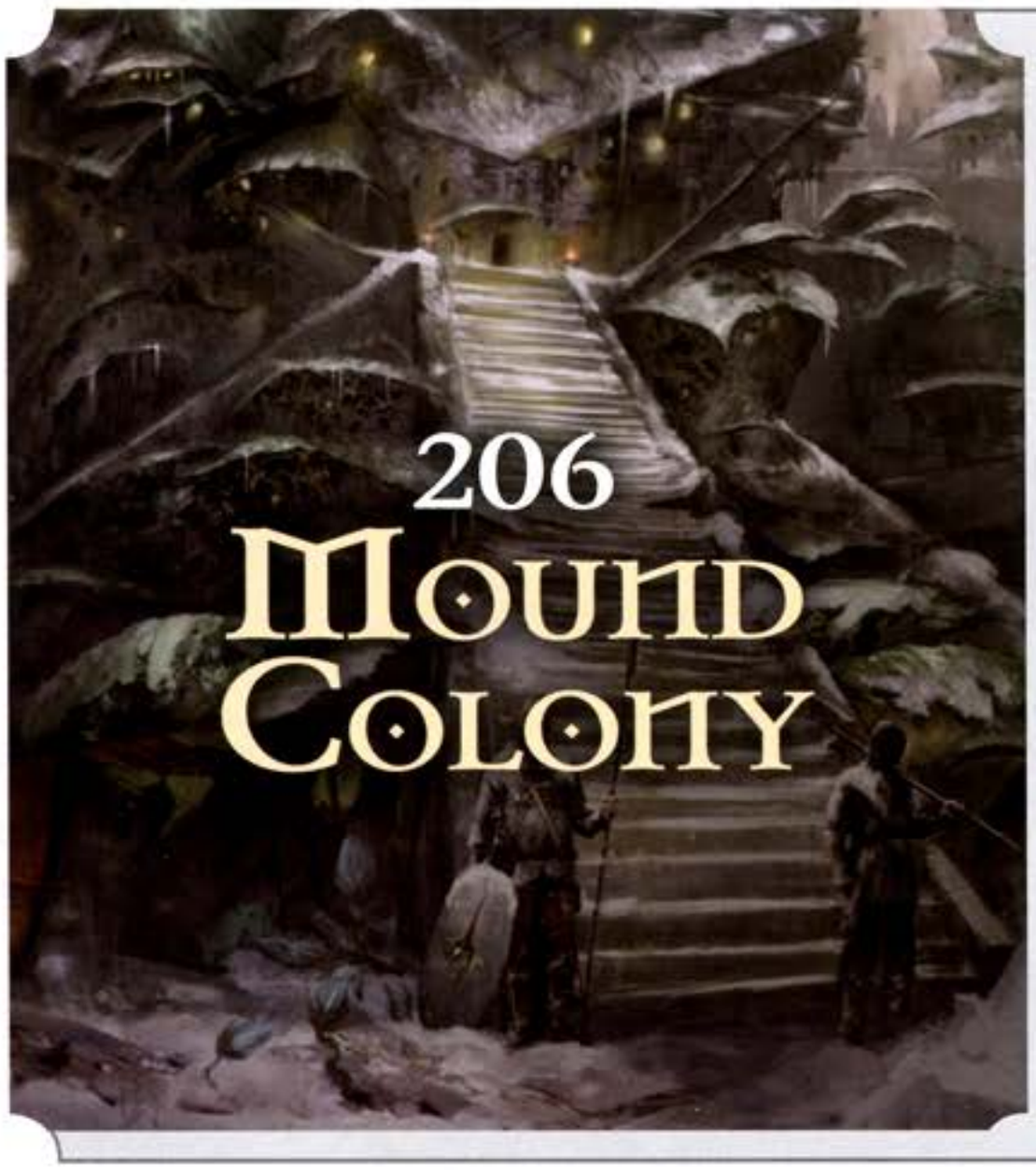
If you **don't have** the **"Horrors"** part **5** status, go to:

Otherwise, choose one:

- **Go back toward the stairs** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 11.
- **Leave** –Exploration ends.

18

Go to:



206 Mound Colony

If you're playing **Chapter 3**, go to Verse 10.

If you're playing **Chapter 5** or have the Secret card **81**, go to Verse 3.

Otherwise, read on:

Dusky-faced guards allow you into the dark mound – you can't help but think you're entering the den of a beast. The gate closes behind at your back, preventing warm air (and you, as a nagging thought reminds you) from escaping. Even though many rush down the corridors, no one stops to greet you, like a stone amidst a stream. You wonder why their skin is so pale, compared to the guards outside.

- **Explore the Colony** – go to Verse 8.
- **Look for vendors** – go to Verse 4.
- **Ask about the plants** (only if you are **Dagan** and you don't have the **"Needed Supplies"** part **2** status) – go to Verse 2.
- **Prepare to free the knight** (requires **Chapter 4**) – go to Verse 5.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

2

Go to:

3

If you **have** the **"Liberation"** part **7** status, you rest for a while in abandoned corridors discovered in your vision in the White Fog – gain 1 and Exploration ends.

Otherwise, go to:

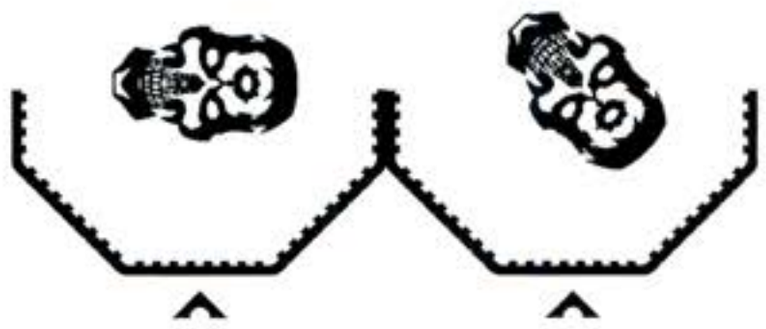
4

There is no market in this place, but rather several quartermasters. And instead of taverns, there are places to rest in warm rooms.

- **Buy food** – pay 2 Wealth to gain 1 Food (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy equipment** – draw 2 Craftable Items. You can buy any number of them for 3 Wealth each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sleep in a heated cell** (pay 3 Wealth per Party member; this will end your day) – go to Verse 6.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

5

Go to:



6

You lie in a cramped, dark cell, feeling an increasing need to escape. The Allfather gazes from every wall with his judging eyes. But the air is warm and smells pleasant. You force yourself to close your eyes and try to relax.

Each party member discards the Exposure Marker, gains 2 and 1, and Passes for the rest of the day. Exploration ends.

8

Wide pipes span almost every corridor, hot steam leaking from seams. They look dangerous, on the cusp of bursting, but it's warm inside this strange city. You see few people, and they rush about. There is nothing interesting to visit or anyone of note with whom to speak.

Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

10

Three guards order you to stop before the entrance to the city. Despite rime covering their beards, they stand motionless. Their faces are darker than people from other parts of the island. The guards tell you the city is closed to strangers, and unless you are Colony's friend, you won't be allowed in.

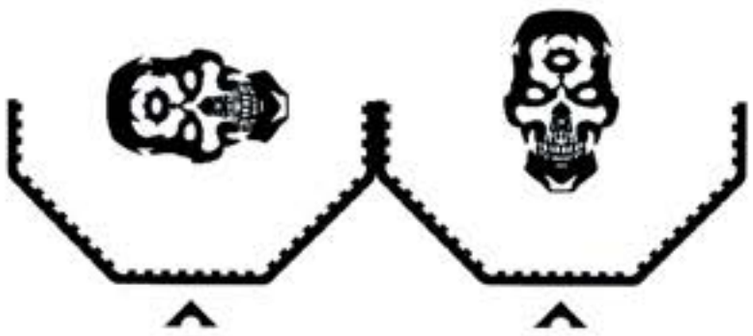
- **Ask for help** (only if you don't have the **"Means of Survival"** part **8** status) – You have traveled a long way from home. Go to Verse 11.
- **Ask what you can do to become the Colony's friend** – go to Verse 12.
- **Tell them about your deeds** (requires all Characters AND the **"Cracked Sanctuary"** part **1** status; this will end your Chapter) – go to Verse 13.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

11

Go to:

12

Go to:



13

Go to:

Dream

You know what to do. You dig, as you should. You dig as well as you can. Other pale-skinned people give you food while you work. You hear strange cries, but you are calm – when you see tall warriors with dark faces, you know you're safe. You get back to work.

Each Character who has this Dream gains 1.

Nightmare

You enter a shallow sleep you can't wake up from, even though you want to – you dream about wyrdness changing your body and mind, slowly adjusting to your new life in the cramped underground colony, packed tight with other people you can't help but hate, though they suffer as much as you.

Each Character who has this Nightmare loses 1.

208 Valley of Guardians

If you are playing **Chapter 8**, go to Verse 1. Otherwise, read on:

You enter a strange valley full of broken statues, stone remains strewing the ground. The wind quickens in this tunnel of wyrdstone, chilling you to the bone. You remember stories of this place – that as soon as you enter, you sense something watching you, and feel unfathomable horrors lurking just beyond your field of vision. But right now, you feel only emptiness and sadness.

Each Party member gains 1 Exposure.

- **Explore the crevices in the walls** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 2.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

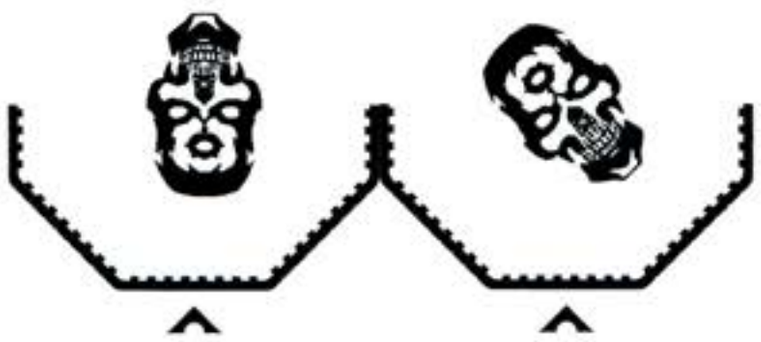
You prepare to enter the valley, a narrow corridor leading through the high wyrdstone wall. Legends say Tuathan lies beyond, the realm of the Fore-dwellers. A year ago, you might have claimed both this ancient race and their lost city were just fables – now you're not sure. What else is true? As much as you'd like, you won't learn that today. You must go back. One of the Fore-dwellers, the Pale Lady, waits for you under the Fractured Tower.

Move all Party member to Location **243**. Exploration ends.

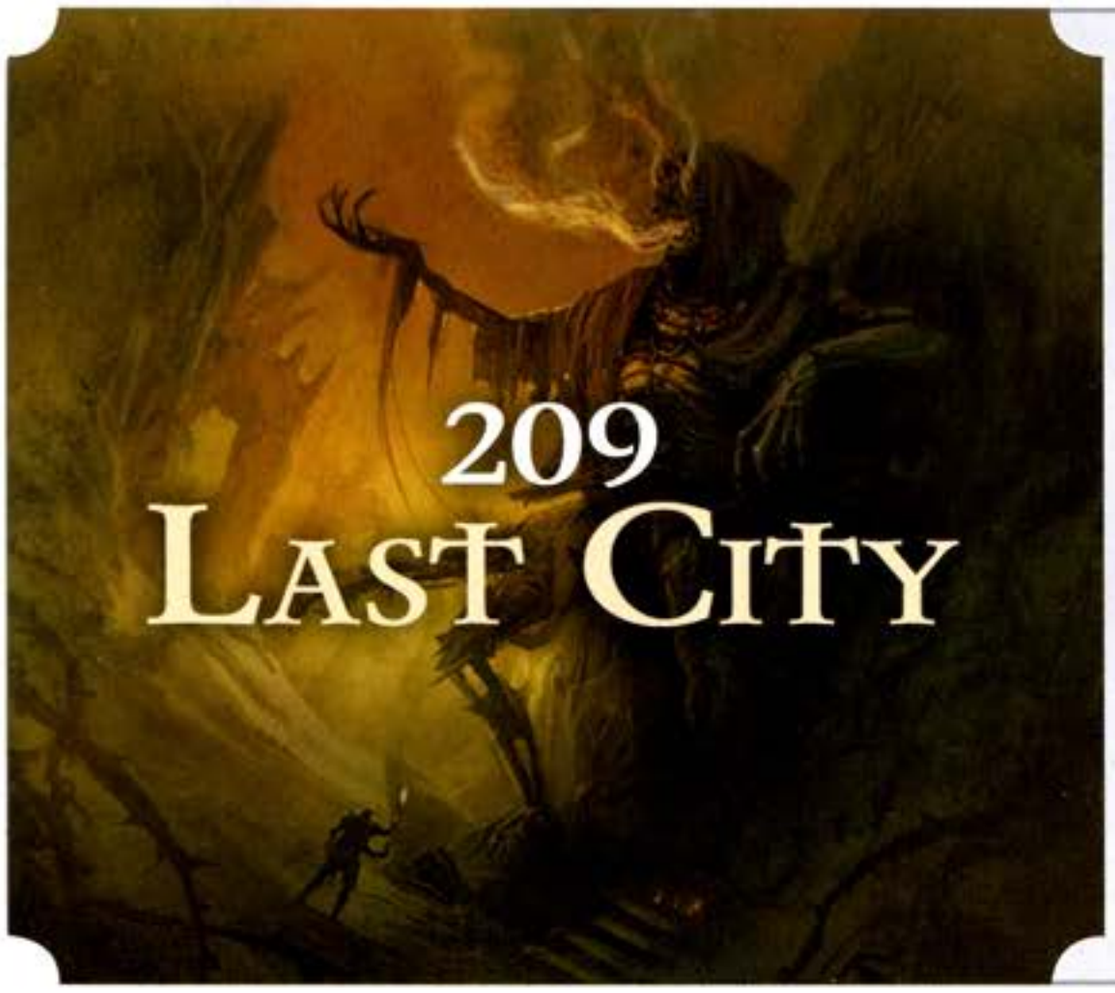
2

You explore narrow crevices of the walls, finding a greasy substance and snow-covered bones.

If you **don't have** the **"Lost Treasures"** part **9** status, go to:



Otherwise; Exploration ends.



209
Last City

If there's no Fore-dweller model on this Location, go to Verse 12.

Pale Lady leads you through the breach, and you emerge in a city surrounded by the high walls of Tuathan. Wyrdness swirls between tall buildings and gathers around a shifting statue in the central plaza. The sculpture roughly resembles a menhir, save for countless eyes forming and disappearing around its head, and a variable number of constantly growing and fading arms. Its body glimmers, changes. For the Fore-dwellers, it must be something like a Fore-dweller is to humans. Then, you notice several four-armed figures huddled around this statue. "The last city of my people," Pale Lady says with a sigh.

- **Approach Fore-dwellers** – go to Verse 4.
- **Investigate the statue** – go to Verse 1.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

If there is an Active Menhir on the **"Weeping Watcher"** Location (**246**), go to Verse 15.

Otherwise, read on:

Wyrdness is so thick around the statue that you can't get closer than a few steps.

- **Study the statue** – go to Verse 7.
- **Back out** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

2

The Pale Lady tries to translate: "A slow, cold demise. As the wyrdness seeped out to fill the void left by the fading of the menhirs, it became too diluted to support us. Then, came the cold, stifling the pure change upon which our bodies depend. In our final struggle, we managed to make this: the un-menhir. The essence of the ever-changing life. But it was too late, most of us were gone, and no could be born anew."

Go back to Verse 4.

3

"Wyrdness is all lives possible, all ideas condensed, it is the change that this world – and we – need," Pale Lady echoes. "It makes us, and we make everything from it."

Go back to Verse 4.

4

If there is an Active Menhir on the **"Weeping Watcher"** Location (**246**), go to Verse 15.

Otherwise, read on:

Fore-dwellers ready their primitive weapons – you're almost sure that this defensive behavior relates to Pale Lady's presence, not yours. They exchange words that unfurl in your mind like a tightly packed cloth tossed free on the wind. You can't understand any of them. Pale Lady turns to you and asks if you want to speak with her kind.

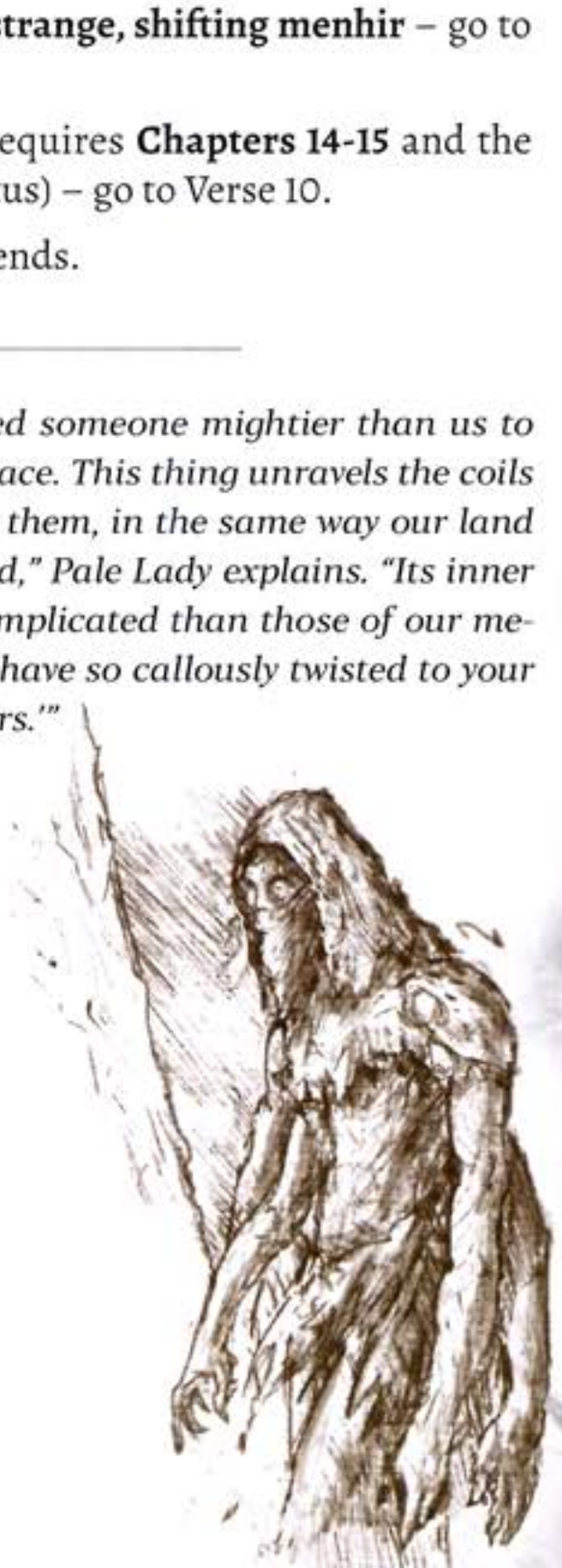
"It's impossible to accurately translate this," she warns. "Each word would take tomes of human speech to transcribe. But I can give you a faint approximation."

- **Ask them what happened to the rest of the Fore-dwellers** – go to Verse 2.
- **Ask them about wyrdness** – go to Verse 3.
- **Ask them about Avalon** – go to Verse 6.
- **Ask them about the strange, shifting menhir** – go to Verse 5.
- **Ask them for help** (requires **Chapters 14-15** and the **"Decision"** part **3** status) – go to Verse 10.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

5

"In a final struggle, we asked someone mightier than us to rescue what was left of our race. This thing unravels the coils of wyrdness and reproduces them, in the same way our land did before humans interfered," Pale Lady explains. "Its inner workings are much more complicated than those of our memorial shrines you humans have so callously twisted to your own ends and called 'menhirs.'"

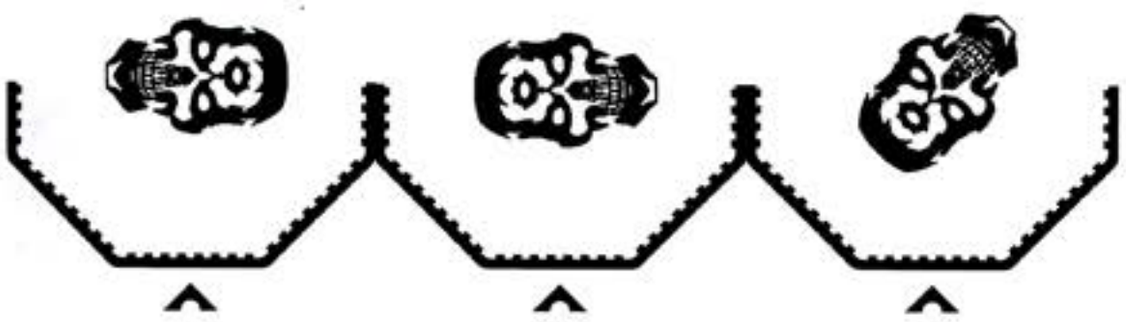
Go back to Verse 4.



6

After hearing the answer of the Fore-dwellers, Pale Lady says: "The island is lost to us, its ancient glories faded, its purpose lost. The middle bough has wilted. The spaces beyond the stars and the human world beyond the mists drift farther apart, with nothing to connect them. We are no longer needed. The best that can happen is death that will cause us to ascend or descend."

If you **have** 4 or more or , go to:



Otherwise, go back to Verse 4 and make another choice.

7

Go to:

8

A tall, four-armed monster blocks your way. It stares at you silently, then sits again. You don't know what it means, but it seems that you're safe for a while. The statue, covered in a thick veil of mist, compels you to look at its ever-changing presence.

Each Party member gains 1 .

- **Try to communicate with these monsters** – go to Verse 14.
- **Study the statue** – go to Verse 7.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

10

If you **have** the Secret card **89**, one of them is already with you – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice. Otherwise, read on:

The Pale Lady explains your wishes to the Fore-dwellers. They don't believe her words, and demand access to your mind to see for themselves.

- **Agree** – choose a Party member whose mind will be probed. Place a Quest Token on their Character Tray and go to Verse 13.
- **Disagree** – Exploration ends.

12

You enter the alien city – high buildings with seemingly impossible geometries flank the lone plaza. A strange, shifting statue stands in the middle of it, surrounded by hunched figures with too many arms and hands. Some point as you approach.

Each Party member gains 1 .

- **Approach the statue** – go to Verse 8.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

13

A four-armed monster leans over you and touches your head, pressing sensitive points of your temples. Agonizing pain flares in your skull, a piercing gaze looks through your soul, and an alien mind shares its incomprehensible thoughts with you. After a while, the sensation dissipates, and the Fore-dweller agrees to join you in your quest.

The Character with a Quest Token on their Character Tray gains 2 and 1 **Exp**. Then, they discard the Quest token. Gain Secret card **89**. Exploration ends.

14

Your attempts at speaking with them are fruitless, and only bring you one step closer to madness.

Each Party member gains 1 . Go back to Verse 8.

15

Several Fore-dwellers curl in the thick cloud of wyrdness surrounding the shifting statue in the center of this city. They snarl as you try to approach them, and the Pale Lady stops you, saying you should leave them until the menhir in Weeping Watcher goes dark.

Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

Dream & Nightmare

You can't express the pain and sadness of lacking the vital medium that can be turned into anything. You feel like someone who lost command of their own limbs. The hard, cold reality hurts you. Simple particles of air and the foam of fine elements that create them can't maintain your manyfold existence. You can't change yourself to adapt to this frozen world, and even death, the ultimate change, is now beyond your grasp. The only thing you can do is languish in misery.

Each Character who has this Dream or Nightmare loses 1 and gains 1 .

210 CUANACHT

The enormous swords dwarf even the mountains – one lies on its side, its blade reaching the Bleeding Land, its pommel obscured by the mists in the east. A ruined building nestles under its edge. You notice a village hanging high above between the remaining two swords – an enormous hammock stretched under the gray sky.

- **Gain access to the village** – go to Verse 1.
- **Visit the ruin under the lying sword** – go to Verse 7.
- **Go on a hunt** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

If you **have** at least 3 or 7 Rep, go to Verse 6.

Otherwise, choose one:

- **Pay for an entry** (pay 2 Wealth or 1 Food per Party member) – go to Verse 6.
- **Leave** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

2

You are lifted on a shaky platform, and as soon as you reach the suspended village, you are greeted by tips of spears pointed at your chest. They belong to a group of people wearing heavy furs. A woman, speaking in an unfamiliar accent, asks what you are doing here, and how you found this place. You tell them about your travels, avoiding the story about your four-armed ally and remodeled menhirs. People relax, and the woman explains their behavior – they suspected you might be wyrdspawn or worse, a tainted monster from the east – but these creatures can't speak as well as you. As she guides you into the village, you notice your first impression was wrong. They don't wear furs – thick hair simply covers their skin.

Gain the **"Friends"** part **6** status. Go to Verse 14.

3

Mountains should abound with wild game.

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-3 – *You catch a small fox, but its desperate yelps attract something much larger that attacks you.* Gain 1 Food. Draw 2 green Encounters and resolve one with the higher value.

4-7 – *You find a nest filled with delicious eggs. As you prepare to pilfer them, a mountain predator finds you.* Gain 2 Food. Resolve a green Encounter.

8+ – *On a cliff you find a family of puffins. You kill some of them before they can react.* Gain 2 Food. Resolve the **"Glacial Puffin"** green Encounter (Difficulty 1).

Then, Exploration ends.

4

You wander around, doing your best not to fall to your death. Many of the Cuanacht's residents seem interested in talking to you.

- **Ask about town's origins** – go to Verse 9.
- **Ask about the town's unusual construction** – go to Verse 11.
- **Ask about the warm air** – go to Verse 13.
- **Ask about their fur** – go to Verse 15.
- **Leave** – go back to Verse 6.

5

There is no regular market here, but many people are willing to exchange goods with you.

- **Get some equipment** – draw top 2 Item cards. You can buy any number of them for 1 Food and 4 Rep each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Hire a companion** – draw 2 Companion Items. You can buy one of them for 2 Wealth and 4 Rep. Shuffle the other one back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

6

If you **don't have** the **"Friends"** part **6** status, go to Verse 2.

You try to avoid looking down – the planks making up the walkways are narrow, and the whole town sways in the wind, making you dizzy. What is surprising, the air here is rather warm, even if the creaking and groaning around you makes you shiver.

- **Barter with people** – go to Verse 5.
- **Visit local healer** – go to Verse 10.
- **Learn about this town** – *Until recently, you didn't know it existed!* Go to Verse 4.
- **Rappel down** – Exploration ends.

7

The ruins remind you of a smithy, probably three times larger than the one in Mangrove Huddle. It's ransacked, which shouldn't be a surprise – a village hangs far above it

Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

8

You rest in a room with wooden walls covered in an intricate netting of metal ropes. The air is warm, dry, and has a strange smell. The healer tells you not to touch the hot ropes. You obey – the wood is charred around them.

Each Party member discards the Exposure Marker. Go back to Verse 6.

9

This underslung village was founded by refugees who previously lived north of here, where the vast chasm now lies. According to legends, the calamity was caused by the forgotten Cuanacht's heroes – they were supposed to save their farmhold, but instead they brought doom upon it.

Go back to Verse 4.

10

Local healers are also Allmother's priests – you're surprised they don't know about the existence of Allfather's faith. They tell you that they can help cure your exposure or "mind pain."

- **Get the warming therapy** (pay 2 Wealth per Party member) – go to Verse 8.
- **Let him release your painful thoughts** (pay 1 Wealth per Party member) – go to Verse 12.

11

There are several engineers whose only job is to maintain the village's construction and to teach this craft to the new generation. They hesitate to tell you anything, but eventually you manage to coax some information out of them. The village is safe thanks to lighter ropes made of hair that hold the buildings together, while sparser steel ropes bear the brunt of the weight. The art of making these peculiar steel cables is the greatest secret of Cuanacht, one that requires many years of difficult and skilled work.

Go back to Verse 4.

12

The healer sits you down in a chair and asks you to press your head against a wooden backrest. A low buzz fills your head, calming you. After a time that certainly feels too short, the healer helps you stand and bids you farewell. You feel much better, though you don't know why.

Each Party member loses 2 . Go back to Verse 6.

13

It's strange, but almost no one knows how exactly the village is heated – they just point toward the metal ropes and tell you they emit heat, and that you can't touch them or you'll die. One woman says you could poke a rope, but only with a wooden stick. Otherwise, the heat will enter your body and kill you. Maybe the local master engineer would know more, but he only speaks to enlightened people.

If you **have** 3 or more , go to Verse 16. Otherwise, go back to Verse 4.

14

The people are busy with a funeral, and no one has time to talk with you any longer. Two men close shut a tight, wooden coffin – you glance at the interior and see a woman with a slit throat. Men wearing heavy leather clothes climb the ropes leading toward the giant sword, hauling the coffin to the weapon's edge. Soon, the coffin hangs from the blade, along with countless others.

You ask how the woman died – it appears some beast climbed up to the village, killed the smith, and stole her tools, including a hammer used by her to shape metal shards from the swords. The murderer must have escaped east – the blood trail leads there, toward the tainted necropolis.

Gain the **"Clues"** part **7** status. Go back to Verse 6.

Hint: You should go east to find the missing tools.

15

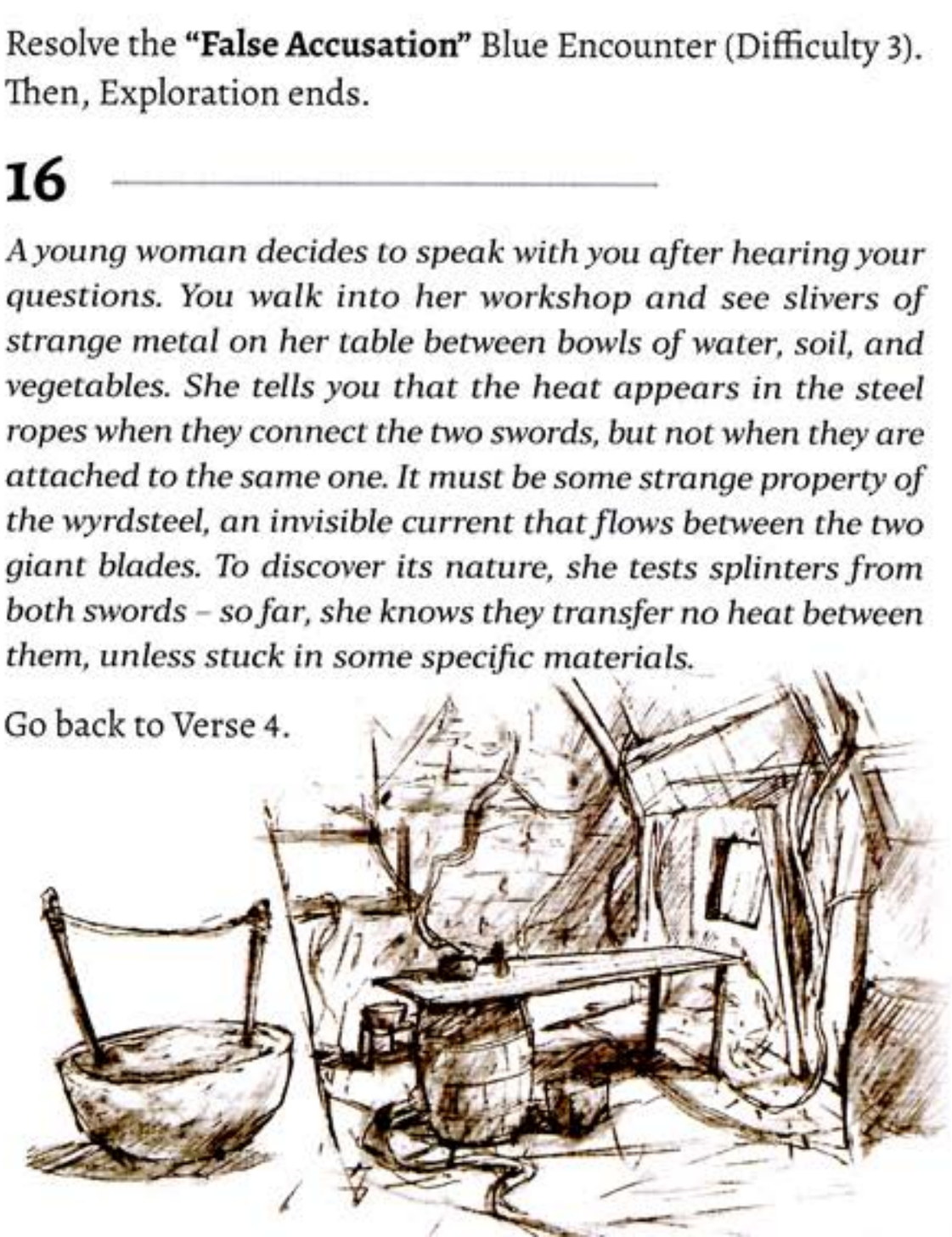
They don't answer and instead inspect you carefully. Then, they ask you why you have so little hair. They are suspicious and accuse you of being a wyrdspawn.

Resolve the **"False Accusation"** Blue Encounter (Difficulty 3). Then, Exploration ends.

16

A young woman decides to speak with you after hearing your questions. You walk into her workshop and see slivers of strange metal on her table between bowls of water, soil, and vegetables. She tells you that the heat appears in the steel ropes when they connect the two swords, but not when they are attached to the same one. It must be some strange property of the wyrdsteel, an invisible current that flows between the two giant blades. To discover its nature, she tests splinters from both swords – so far, she knows they transfer no heat between them, unless stuck in some specific materials.

Go back to Verse 4.



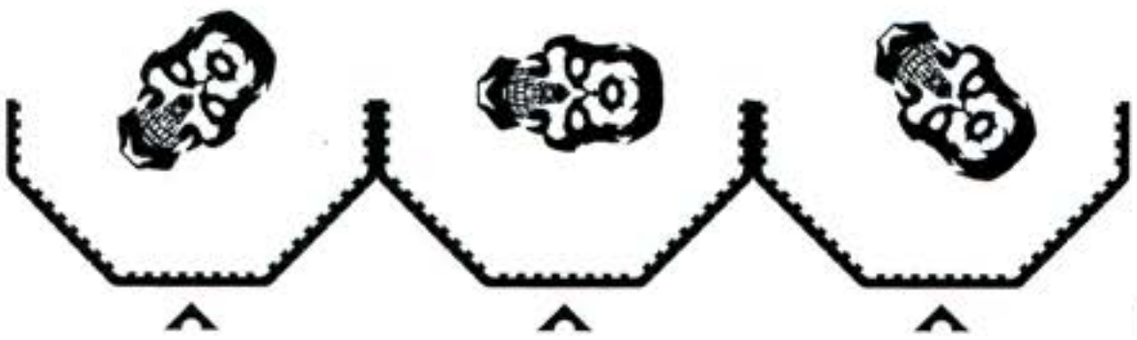
211 Jagged Cemetery

Long bones and elongated skulls protrude from frozen waters, many broken or warped by the wyrdness, some several feet tall. As the wind blows from the sea, the cemetery reverberates with eerie tunes, compelling you to listen.

- **Listen to the ghoulish melody** – go to Verse 5.
- **Search Jagged Cemetery** – go to Verse 2.
- **Visit the sacred site (requires the "Mysteries and Visions" part 2 status)** – go to Verse 1.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

Go to:



2

Fractured bones and three-eyed skulls make for solid footholds on the slippery ice, but it's easy to get lost in the labyrinth.

Roll a die and add your . Add 3 if you **have** the **"Mysteries and Visions"** part **1** status. Each Party member may pay 1 – if all Party members do, add 1 to the result.

Now, check your final result in Verse 8.

3

Suddenly, you are between clouds. Freezing wind slashes your face and wings. The land below is dotted with gleaming spots – places full of pulsating magic. You dive toward one of them, willing to kill everything on your way just to get to this tantalizing glow.

You wake from the slumber, lying on ice between bones and worthless trinkets.

If you **don't have** the **"Lost Treasures"** part **2** status, you find a tiny golden mask between rubbish; gain 2 Wealth and the **"Lost Treasures"** part **2** status.

Then, each Party member gains 1 . Exploration ends.

5

Discordant, sharp notes hurt your mind. But they also bring a vision to your eyes – three spectral silhouettes traversing this cemetery.

Each Party member gains 1 . Then, choose one:

- **Immerse in the visions** – go to Verse 9.
- **Cover your ears and escape from the bone forest** – Exploration ends.

8

Check your final result:

1-6 – *No more than ice and bones.* Exploration ends.

7+ – If you don't have the **"Mysteries and Visions"** part **2** status, go to:

Otherwise, each Party member gains 1 Magic. Exploration ends.

9

The air in your vision grows eerie. Three people make a grave from bones and stone. Behind them looms a ghastly, four-armed hulk. Who are they? Why are they not alarmed by this towering creature? Part of you wants the vision to stop, but it is too enthralling.

Each Party member gains 1 . Gain the **"Mysteries and Visions"** part **1** status. Then, choose one:

- **Keep listening** – go to Verse 3.
- **Break out of the stupor** (pay 1 per party Member) – Exploration ends.

Dream & Nightmare

The sea is calm. Waves comb shallow grooves in the shimmering sand. The cool breeze smells of salt and adventure. When you blink, the scenery changes – water swirls, hail falls from the sky, and gales howl.

Each Character who has this Dream or Nightmare tosses a Dial.

Grail – the Character gains 1 Magic.

Skull – the Character gains 1 Exposure.

212 Black Sands

Soaring dunes of black sand shimmer in the sun. Harmless yet disgusting worms bask on sunlit slopes warm and free of snow. The air tastes of salt as a mild breeze blows from the ocean. If not for the wyrdness lurking in the shadows, this would be a perfect place to rest.

- **Collect worms** (pay 1) – gain 1 **Food**. Then, go to Verse 6.
- **Lie down on the warm sand** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 3.
- **Traverse black dunes and rest by the sea** (each Party member loses 2) – go to Verse 5.
- **Follow the fresh trail in the sand** (only if the **"Saved!"** Quest Card, **Chapter 1: Part 4**, is revealed; pay 2 per Party member) – go to Verse 1.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

Go to:

2

The ground shakes as something emerges from the sand.

Go to:

3

You bask on the warm sand, letting yourself forget about everything. The cold leaves your body, and worries escape your mind.

Each Party member discards the Exposure Marker and loses 1 .

Go to Verse 6.

5

Getting to the sea was tiring, but worth the effort. Sun glimmers on ice and distant water. Sand radiates with heat that comforts your chilled body.

Each Party member loses 2 and gains 1 .

Go to Verse 6.

6

If you **have** the **"Means of Survival"** part **1**, Exploration ends.

If there are 2 Time Tokens on this Location, go to Verse 2.

Otherwise, place a Time Token on this Location. Exploration ends.

213 GLIMMERING FOREST

The hunters from Mangrove Huddle often visit Glimmering Forest – it's full of game, and its leafless trees provide ample light and shelter. Roots emerge from earth and ice, making it difficult to navigate. If you follow animal tracks, you'll always find an easy path.

- **Follow the trail** – go to Verse 6.
- **Climb a glimmering tree** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 2.
- **Delve into the forest** (only if you don't have the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **1** status) – *You think you saw a glimpse of a human there.* Go to Verse 4.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

You find a hidden glade with a massive block of salt at its center. Beneath the block, there's a puddle of water.

If you are **Mabd** and you **don't have** the **"Lost Apprentice"** part **1** status, go to Verse 3.

- **Prepare an ambush for animals** (pay 3) – go to Verse 10.
- **Drink from the puddle** – go to Verse 7.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

2

When you try to climb the tree crown, an invisible barrier glimmering with runes stops you.

- **Force through the barrier** (pay 1 Magic per Party member) – go to Verse 5.
- **Examine the runes** – go to Verse 8.
- **Climb back down** – Exploration ends.

3

You notice a trail of bare feet dotted with drops of blood leading toward a tree. Anxiety grips your heart. You climb the tree and find several parchments tucked between the branches, with more blood staining the bark. It looks like someone rested here for a while. You grab the parchments and study carefully. They are your apprentice's notes and map sketches, showing areas near Forest Sanctuary, Sleeping Rocks, and Stone of Memories. You hope you will find her there.

Mabd gains 1 Exp. Gain the **"Lost Apprentice"** part **1** status. Go back to Verse 1.

4

A man leans on a steel shovel deep in the woods. A pickaxe with a bent point lies nearby. He must have buried something valuable. You thought you were quiet enough to avoid being spotted, but the man raises his head and looks at you. "What do you want?" he asks.

Gain the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **1** status. Then, choose:

- **Calm him down** – go to Verse 11.
- **Strike him down** – go to Verse 9.
- **Say you're sorry and leave** – Exploration ends.

5

A slight gust of the arcane is sufficient to pass through the obstacle. Once on the other side, you immediately feel blissful and safe. You now understand the crowns of these trees are in fact bubbles of some ancient, protective force.

Each Party member gains 2 .

Exploration ends.

6

The track is clearly visible in the snow. But soon, it fades on hard ice.

Roll a die, add your . Check your final result:

1-4 – *You can't find anything at first, but then you notice a trail.* Each Party member loses 1 . Go to Verse 1.

5+ – *There is a barely visible trail leading deeper into the forest.* Go to Verse 1.

7

The water is bitter and makes you nauseous. You fall to your knees and vomit, cursing yourself for this idea. Once you can stand, you feel a strange tingling in the tips of your fingers.

Each Party member loses 1 , gains 1 and 1 Magic. Exploration ends.

8

The branches aren't comfortable, but the runes on them are undoubtedly interesting. Though roughly similar to other old sigils, many of them have grown wild, expanding the familiar forms with additional hairline strokes, like young sprouts. Still, those with adequate knowledge of the arcane could benefit from them.

If there is a Dial with a Time Token on this Location, Exploration ends.

Otherwise, you may place a Dial with a Time Token on this Location and set it to 4 – if you do, each Party member who has less than 4 Magic gains 2 Magic for each point of their .

9

After receiving the first strike, the man goes berserk. Muscles bulge under his skin, and his eyes roll back in his head. He's entering a wyrd spasm!

Resolve the **"Mad Warrior"** gray Encounter (Difficulty 1).

If you Escape, Exploration ends.

If you win or Enemy Runs Away, go to:

10

You hide and wait...

Roll a die. Check your final result:

1 – *Nothing comes for many hours, and you must leave.* Exploration ends.

2+ – *Finally, a tasty boar comes. It should be an easy prey.* Resolve the **"Frenzied Boar"** green Encounter (Difficulty 1). It does not have the *Runs* Trait in this Encounter. Exploration ends.

11

The man is suspicious and at least slightly mad. You try to convince him to get away from here.

Resolve the **"Suspicious Guard"** blue Encounter (Difficulty 0).

If you lose, choose one:

- **Leave the man alone** – Exploration ends.
- **Attack him** (each Party member loses 1) – *He was waiting to strike you!* Go to Verse 9.

If you win, he asks you to wait for a while, and he goes away. It is your chance to steal his treasure! Go to:

DREAM

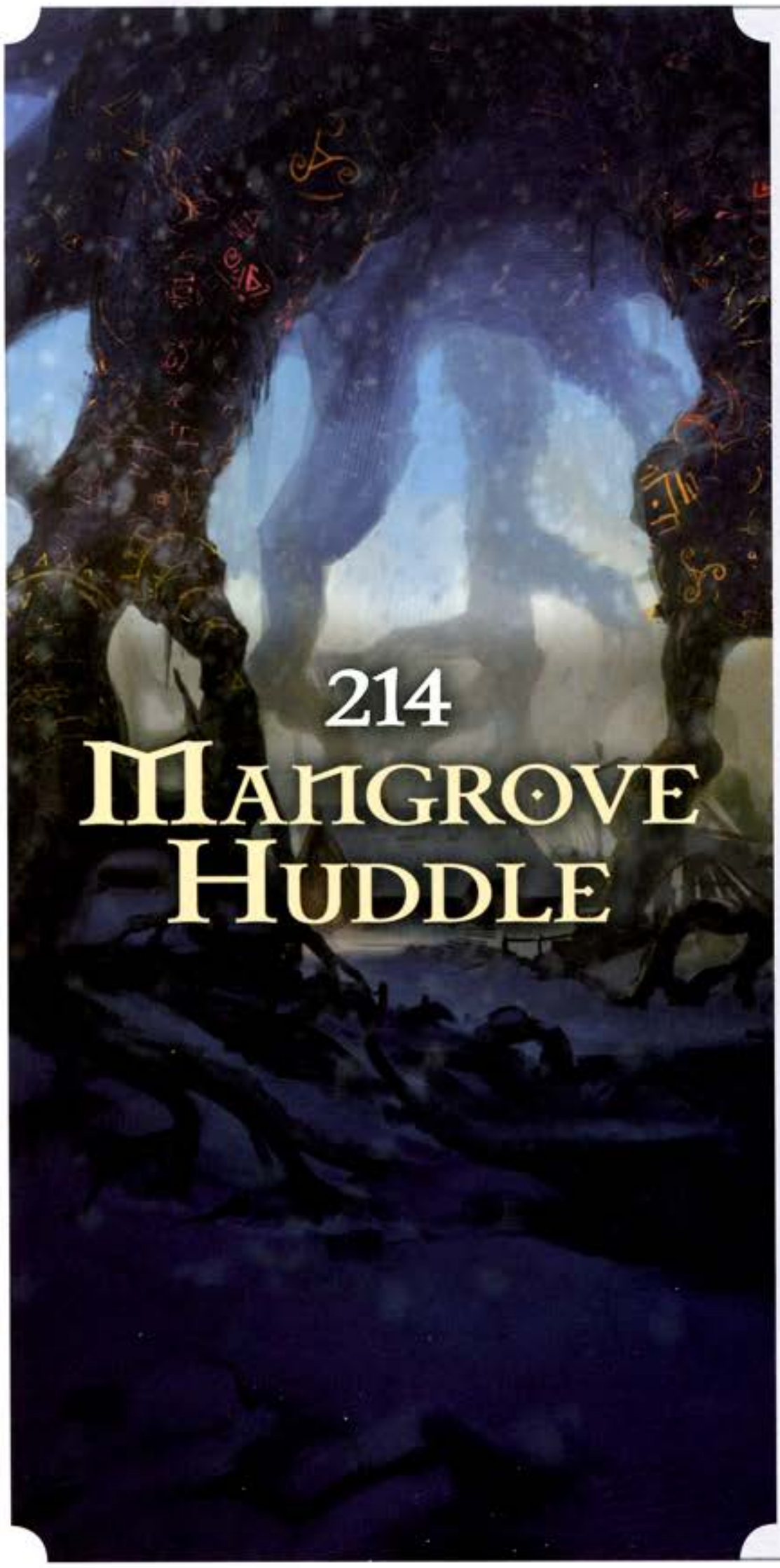
A large tree stretches its roots to the sea, as if testing its delightful warmth. The tree's crown blooms with golden flowers and gleaming runes. West wind sweeps some of them away toward their new, fertile cradle.

Each Character who has this Dream and has less than 3 Magic gains 1 Magic.

NIGHTMARE

A mighty tree is dying. In desperation, it sheds its fading magic and throws it eastward. Seeds try to grow on barren land, but most fail, and the rest are merely a fragile shadow of their parent.

Each Character who has this Nightmare gains 1 . Each Character who has this Nightmare and has less than 3 Magic gains 1 Magic.



If you **have** the **"Time"** status, go to Verse 13. Otherwise, read on:

A small settlement huddles between the roots of a giant, nameless tree – one of the few havens left on this island. Wyrdness avoids this region – they say because of legendary Merlin's blessing. Shining runes on black bark also repel the cold. Still, you're not sure if the town can prevail – its people peer with hunger in their eyes. The wyrdness thickened recently, preventing hunters from making longer excursions and destroying the crops. Some whisper the runes dim, but such rumors are suppressed by the vigilant Allfather's priests and caretakers who tend the tree.

If you are playing **Chapter 1**, go to Verse 16.

If you **have** the **"Horrors"** part **3** status and **don't have** the **"Horrors"** part **4** status, go to Verse 14.

If you **have** Secret card **2**, go to Verse 3.

Otherwise, choose one:

- **Visit the meager market** – go to Verse 6.
- **Go to the warmth healer** – go to Verse 9.
- **Inquire about surroundings** – go to Verse 2.
- **Ask townsfolk to help you prepare** (only if you don't have the **"Means of Survival"** part **3** status) – go to Verse 4.
- **Speak with the village elder** (only if you are playing **Chapter 2** or **3**, and **don't have** the **"Missions"** part **1** status) – go to Verse 1.
- **Deliver prisoner** (requires **Chapter 2** and the Secret card **12**) – go to Verse 17.
- **Finish your food quest** (requires **Dagan** and exactly 3 parts of the **"Needed Supplies"** status) – go to Verse 15.
- **Find the singer** (only if you **have** part **7** and **don't have** part **8** of the **"Missions"** status) – go to Verse 18.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

"We had to send out hunters soon after you departed. They were to find food in the Icicle Forest to the north-west. It turned out to be a bad idea – they went missing," says the village elder. "Only you have any experience in traveling through the wyrdness, so please rescue them. We need our hunters back."

If you're playing **Chapter 3**, go to Verse 8.

New Task: Go to Icicle Forest and find the missing hunters.

Otherwise, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

2

You decided to speak with one of the trackers, an experienced woman who once tried to go past the Twisted Pathways. She tells you that to the east is the Glimmering Forest, a magical place that was also the main food supply of the Huddle. Some game can also be found in the Twisted Pathways and Icicle Forest, but it's hard to reach them. To the west is the Forbidden Cage, a haunted, terrible place. To the south, there's a secluded island – legends say it is inhabited by monsters and plague. The tracker also mentions a weird tower and a ruined village with distinct ices statues near the Twisted Pathways.

If you **have** replaced Location **202** with Location **282**, go to Verse 7. Otherwise, go to Verse 5.

3

You enter the town, dragging the bodies of the hunters on a makeshift sled. Soon, their grief-stricken families approach. Despite their mourning, they take time to thank you, invite you to the funeral and offer you a small gift for your effort. They must have expected this outcome.

Discard the Secret card **2**. Each Character gains 1 Exp. Each Party member gains 2 Rep and 1 Food. Choose one:

- Each Party member discards the Exposure Marker.
- Gain the **"Oiled Tent"** Item.

Then, Exploration ends.

4

Gain the **"Means of Survival"** part **3** status.

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **11** status, go to Verse 10. Otherwise, read on.

The people of Mangrove Huddle are not content. As they collect equipment for you, they grumble it is you who should have helped them, instead of robbing them of their last supplies.

Gain 2 Items. Each Party member gains 2 Food and loses 2 Rep.

Exploration ends.

5

You thank the huntress, but she stops you. "One more thing. Beware of the Perilous Chasms north of here. Should you enter, you'll find only injury and death."

Exploration ends.

6

This town doesn't have a big market. People sell some necessities to other townsfolk, and nothing more. But if you have excess food, everyone will buy it. Also, everyone is interested in goods from other cities, since storytellers, who often brought trinkets from afar, cased their travels between the settlements.

- **Haggle for better prices** (pay 5 Rep, reduced by 1 for each point of your) – go to Verse 11.
- **Sell food** – pay 2 Food to gain 1 Wealth (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy equipment** – draw top 2 Craftable Item cards. You can buy any number of them for 4 Wealth each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sell equipment** – discard any number of Item cards and gain 1 Wealth for each of them. Then, make another choice.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

7

You thank the huntress, but she stops you. "There's also a Round Farmhold north from here. People there aren't fond of visitors, but if you want to trade, it's a good place to go."

Exploration ends.

8

"Many days have passed since they headed out. I'm afraid they might be dead," says the village elder. "But we are a tough people. I myself once lived through a month-long blizzard in the wilderness. There's a chance at least some of them are still hanging on. Please, hurry!"

Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

9

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **11** status, go to Verse 12. Otherwise, read on.

The warmth healer offers herbal sauna therapy to banish the chill. He also recommends warming mixtures for long travels.

Each Party member may pay 2 Wealth to discard the Exposure Marker.

Each Party member may pay 3 Wealth to gain the **"Fiery Brew"** Secret card (**54**).

Then, Exploration ends.

10

There is a legend in Mangrove Huddle of heroes who saved the entire village from certain death. The survivors were ancestors of current residents of the town – and to honor these heroes, people here are known to help all in need.

Gain 2 Items. Each Party member gains 3 Food.

Exploration ends.

11

Short negotiations were enough to secure better prices.

- **Sell food** – pay 1 Food to gain 1 Wealth (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy equipment** – draw top 3 Craftable Item cards. You can buy any number of them for 2 Wealth each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sell equipment** – discard any number of Item cards and gain 1 Wealth for each of them. Then, make another choice.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

12

The "warmth healer," with a large Allmother's pendant visible under the shirt, offers you sauna therapy to banish the chill. He also advises you to buy mixtures to warm yourself during long travels.

Each Party member may pay 1 Wealth to discard the Exposure Marker.

Each Party member may pay 3 Wealth to gain **"Fiery Brew"** Secret card (**54**).

Then, Exploration ends.

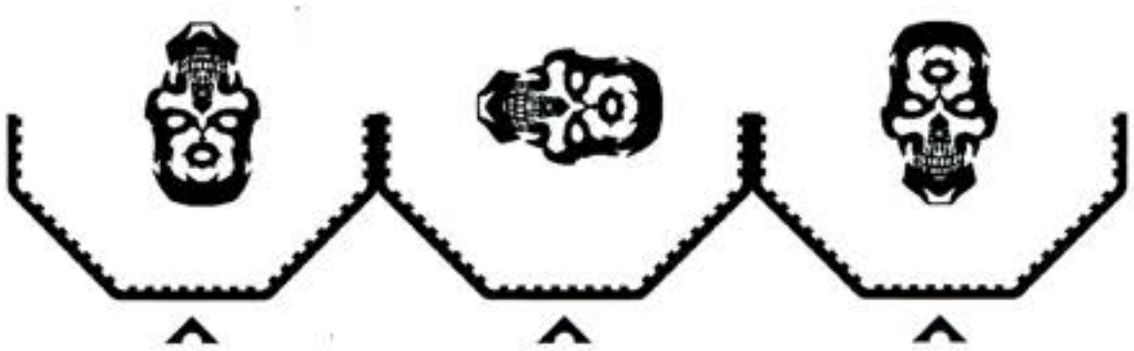
13

If you **have** the **"Means of Survival"** part **9** status, remove Location **214** from the game and replace it with Location **294**. Then, Explore this new Location for free.

Otherwise, remove Location **214** from the game and replace it with Location **293**. Then, Explore this new Location for free.

14

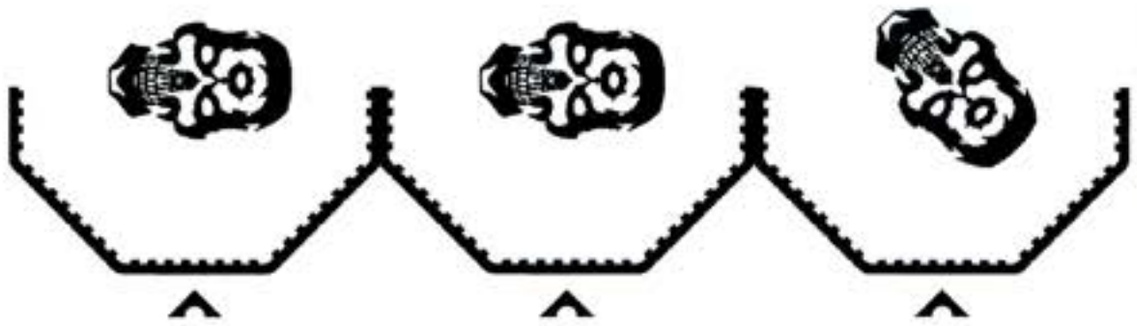
Go to:



15

If you **have** the **"Needed Supplies"** part **4** status, you've already finished your quest – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

Otherwise, go to:



16

If all Characters are in the Party, go to:

Otherwise, you must gather your party before venturing forth – Exploration ends.

17

Go to:

18

Go to:

Dream

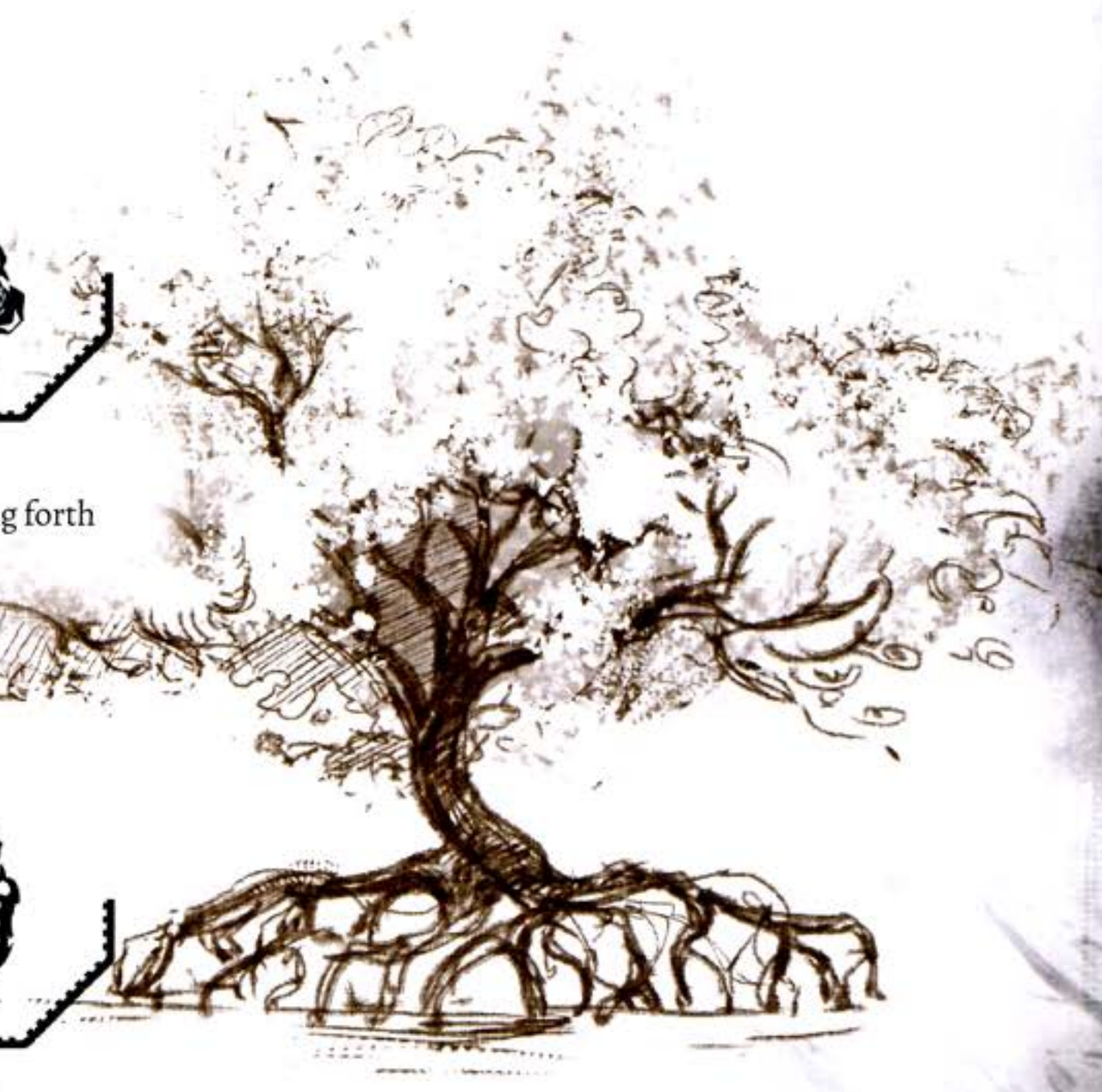
You see the court wizard raising a magical barrier around a giant tree growing out of the calm waters of the bay. The barrier covers the ships, anchored at the foot of the tree. While the wizard works, you and other knights distribute supplies to settlers gathered on the shore while a healer tends to their wounds.

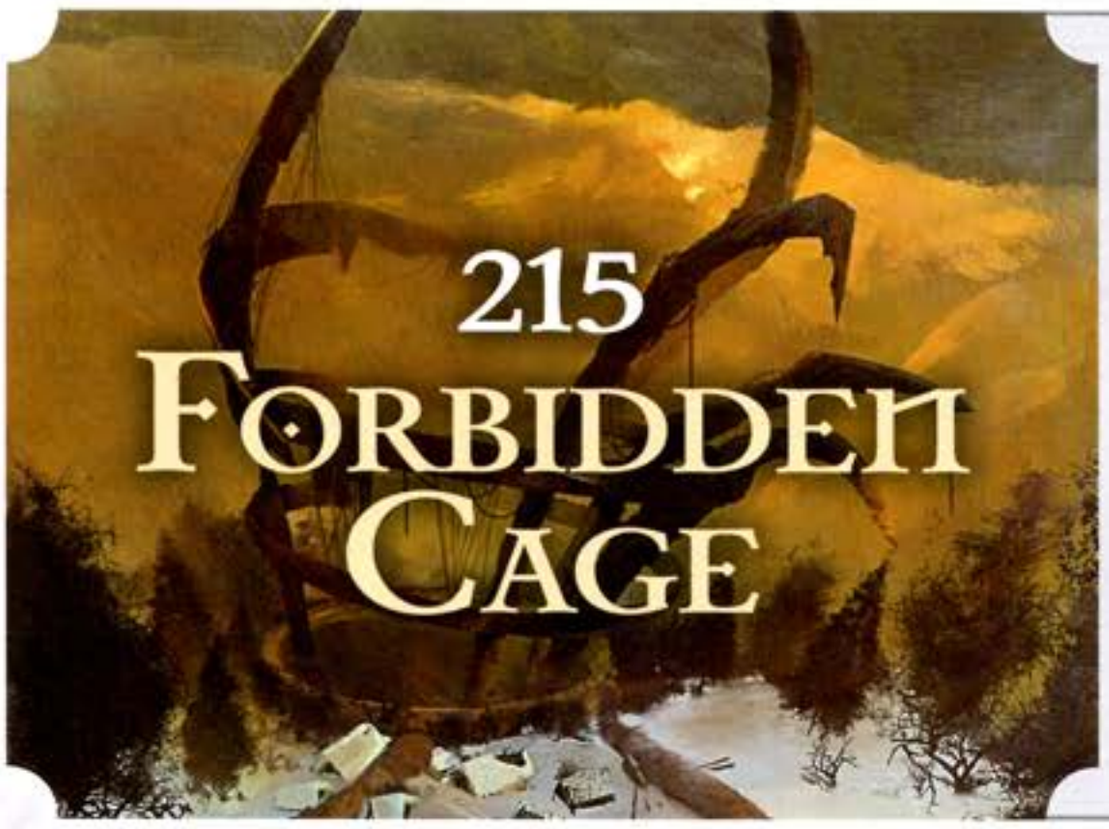
Each Character who has this Dream and has more than 4 Food loses 1 Food and gains 1 Rep. Then, each Character who has this Dream gains 1 ♥.

Nightmare

Your runes flicker desperately. Pathetic leeches drink your magic, but you can't do anything about them – you're just a tree. To make matters worse, they keep feeding you with their carrion. Oh, how you despise these maggots!

Each Character who has this Nightmare loses 1 ♥.





215 Forbidden Cage

A broken iron cage stands in the middle of an otherwise empty plain. The surrounding lands look much more interesting – to the south lies a cursed island, unreachable across a sea of perilous ice floats; a vast chasm blocks the west, representing the gaping wound in the hearts of people failed by their heroes, according to legends.

- **Approach the cage** – go to Verse 4.
- **Look into the vast chasm** – go to Verse 5.
- **Follow the safe path to the south** (requires the **"Clues"** part **8** status) – go to Verse 3.
- **Follow the blood trail** (requires the **"Clues"** part **8** status) – go to Verse 7.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

2

You stand in front of the bent bars. The snow-covered iron interior doesn't look appealing, but the awful smell of burned flesh has somehow faded. Or did you simply grow accustomed to it?

- **Go into the cage** – go to Verse 6.
- **Pay your respects to the deceased** – go to Verse 9.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

3

The ice is treacherous, but you've memorized the safe path well.

If Location **269** is not attached to this card, you may pay 1 **Magic** (1 Character), 2 **Magic** (2-3 Characters), or 3 **Magic** (4 Characters) to attach Location **269** to the bottom of Location **215**.

If Location **269** is attached to this card, you may pay 1 per Party member to move all Party members to Location **269**. Then, Exploration ends.

If you didn't do the above, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

4

When you walk toward the cage, an unpleasant feeling overflows you, as if something terrible is going to happen.

If you **have** 1 or more , go to Verse 8. Otherwise, go to:

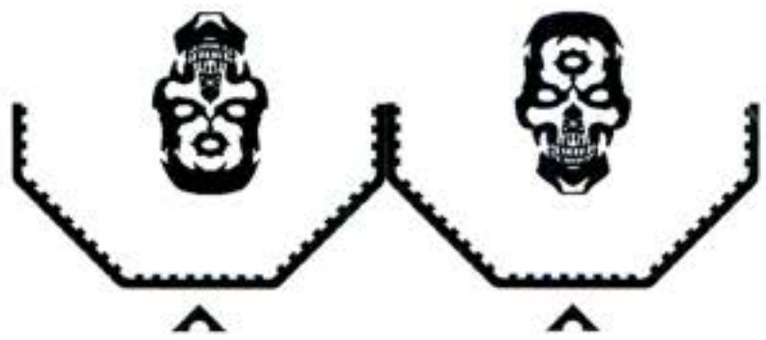
5

You approach the chasm. You see fragments of ruined buildings on the walls of the fissure. On one of the many ledges, you notice broken stone hands holding a cup.

Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

6

Go to:



7

The bloody trail leads north from here, toward Menhir Meadow.

Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

8

The disgusting, greasy smell of burnt hair and flesh fills your nostrils. You turn instinctively, looking for any source of flame, but the highland is cold and dead.

If you **have** 2 or more or , go to Verse 2. Otherwise, go to:

9

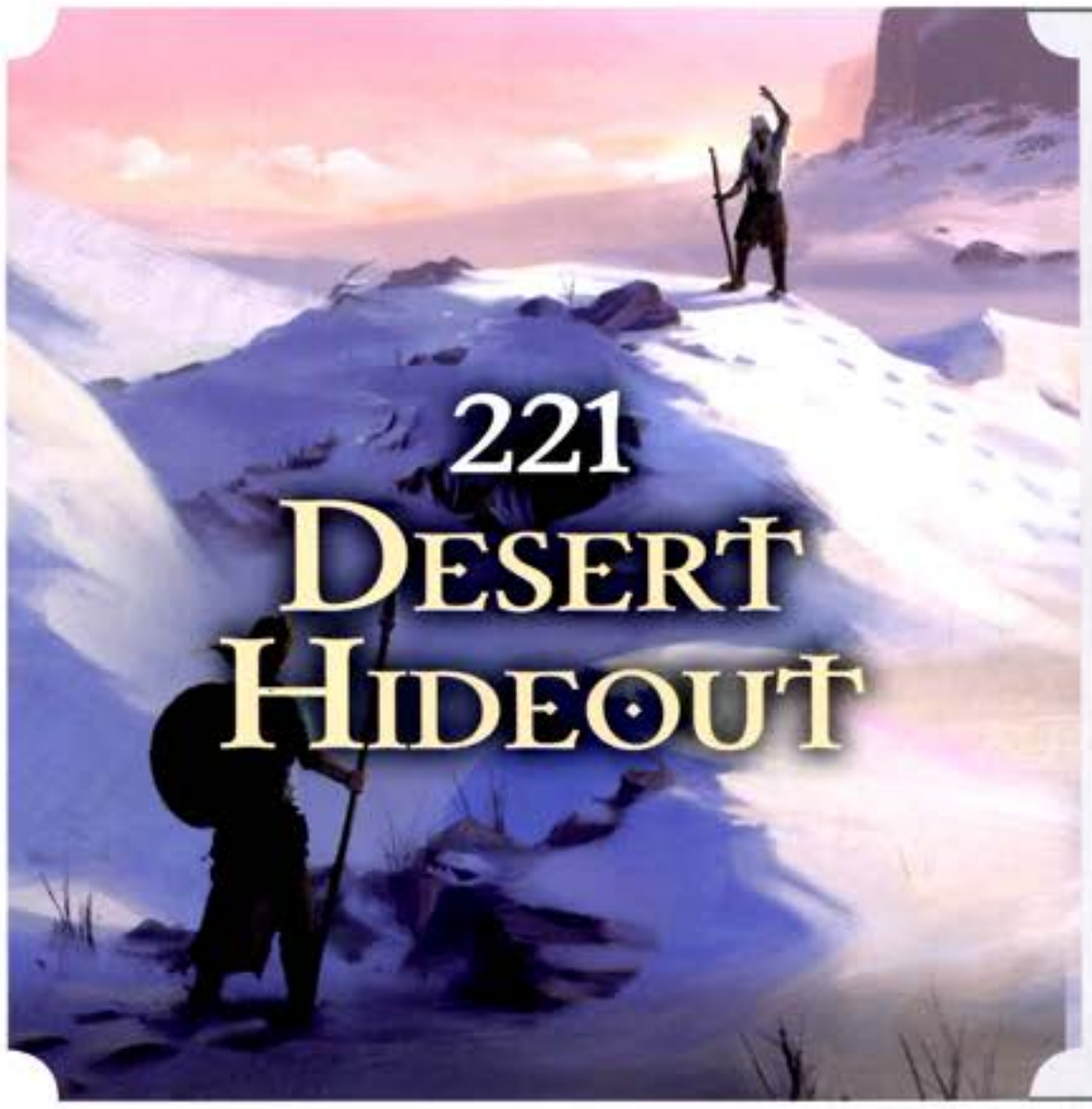
Suddenly, deep sadness and pain strike you, as if you lost something unique that's impossible to replace. The feeling is brief, and quickly makes way for bittersweet catharsis. Life will go on. As the memories fade, so will your loss.

Each Party member loses 1 . Exploration ends.

Dream & Nightmare

Everything around you burns. Your filthy clothes catch flame and sear your skin. Your brothers and sisters trample you in their futile attempt to escape. You know you're going to die, and you want it to be over with, but there is no end to your suffering.

Each Character who has this Dream or Nightmare gains 1 and loses 1 .



221
Desert Hideout

The hideout is cold but protected from wyrdness, allowing you to rest for a moment and gather your thoughts. Not so far from here, to the north, you see ruined machinery leading up the cliff. On your way here, you came across many sets of fox tracks. You wonder if this snow desert hides other secrets..

- **Scout the desert** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 6.
- **Hunt snow foxes** (only if there is no Time Token on this Location; pay 2) – go to Verse 3.
- **Climb up the cliff** (requires the **"Means of Survival"** part **4** status) – go to Verse 1.
- **Activate protective amulets** (requires all Characters, **Chapter 1**, and Secret card **44**) – go to Verse 2.
- **Meditate** (requires all Characters and the **"Initiation"** part **1** status) – go to Verse 5.
- **Rest in the hideout** – each Party member loses 1 . Exploration ends.

1

Old ropes and ladders lead up the cliff. They look like they may fall apart at any moment, but if you want to go up, this is the only way.

If Location **227** is not attached to this card, you may pay 1 Magic (1 Character), 2 Magic (2-3 Characters) or 3 Magic (4 Characters) to attach Location **227** to the top of Location **221**.

If Location **227** is attached to this card, you may pay 1 per Party member to move all Party members to Location **227**. Then, Exploration ends.

If you didn't do the above, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

2

Go to:

3

Place a Time Token on this Location. Resolve the **"Snow Fox"** green Encounter (Difficulty 1). Exploration ends.

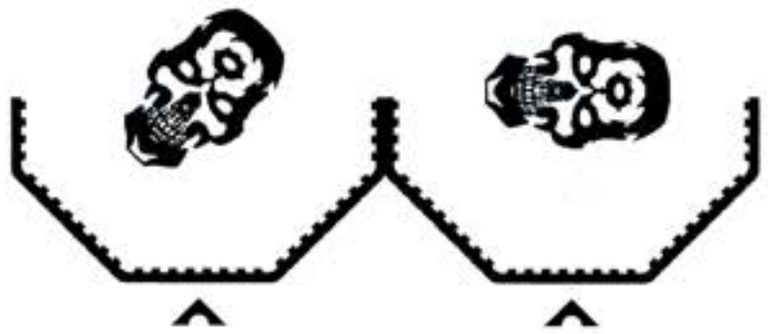
5

You kneel on the snow and think on the priest's words – about how the cold protects the world from wyrdness. About thoughts growing clearer when the body is freezing. A strange calmness and comfort envelop you.

Each Party member gains 1 Exposure. Gain the **"Initiation"** part **3** status. Exploration ends.

6

Go to:



Dream

You are in a small tavern, where the only other visitor is the wind that brings the smell of dampness and rot. You like it – it's the scent of the familiar bog. Almost every time you come here, you end up taking part in a great feast.

Each Character who has this Dream loses 1 .

Nightmare

You are old. Too old for changes. But now, the snow fell from the sky and covered everything you knew – yellow leaves, soft moss, glades bathed in sunlight. All that's left is the cold, and your never-ending hunger.

Each Character who has this Nightmare loses 1 Food.

223
Menhir Meadow

If you **don't have** the **"Dismay"** part **8** and **have** the **"Clues"** part **8** status, go to Verse 3. Otherwise, read on:

The first thing that catches your attention is a circle of statues carved in ice, surrounding a menhir in the middle of a ruined settlement. People say that menhirs once protected the island from wyrdness, but even so, they don't work now. You notice a gaping hole, tall as an upright human, in the building's wall, framed with tiny blue crystals. Nothing lies beyond except pitch-black void. A pang of primal fear stabs at your heart as you investigate.

If you **don't have** the **"Mysteries and Visions"** part **4** status, go to Verse 2.

If there is a Fore-dweller model or Time Token on this Location, go to Verse 1.

Otherwise, go to Verse 5.

1

Choose one:

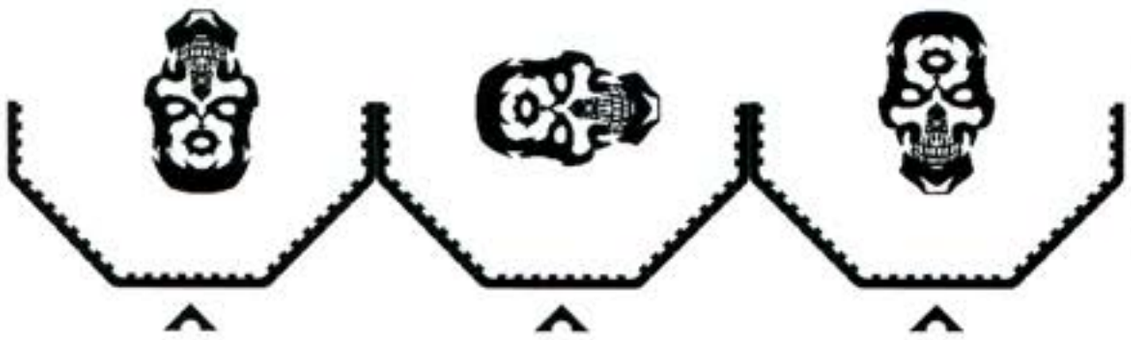
- **Examine the ice statues** – go to Verse 6.
- **Search through the ruins** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 7.
- **Absorb the menhir's magic** (requires the **"Leaking Magic"** Secret card (**24**)) – go to Verse 4.
- **Leave the deserted village** – Exploration ends.

2

Go to:

3

Go to:



4

Discard all markers from the Menhir's base. Gain Magic equal to the number of discarded markers. You may discard the **"Ritual Chalk"** or **"Wyrdstone Heart"** Item to gain additional 3 Magic for each of these discarded Items.

Exploration ends.

5

Roll a die. If you **have** the **"Leaking Magic"** Secret card (**24**), add the number of markers on the Menhir's base to the result. If there's an Active Menhir in this Location, add +3 to the result. Subtract your and check your final result:

1-5 – go to Verse 1.

6+ – place a Time Token on this Location and go to Verse 9.

6

There is a menhir in the center of the meadow, surrounded by ice statues carved in its image. The sculptures are crude and half-melted. Inside some of them, there are barely visible white crystals. Deep holes carved in the statues seem to indicate someone tried to pluck these crystals out.

Go back to Verse 1 and choose another option.

7

The ruins are damaged. Barely touching a wall is enough to make it collapse. What is worse, slippery ice covers almost all surfaces.

If you **have** 2 or more , go to Verse 11.

Otherwise, you search the ruins. Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-3 – *You nudge one of the bars, only to be buried under the falling roof.* Each Party member loses 2 and gains 1 **Wealth**. Exploration ends.

4-6 – *There is still something of value here.* Each Party member gains 2 **Wealth**. Exploration ends.

7+ – *You think there's a basement over there.* If you **have** the **"Lost Treasures"** part **4** status, each Party member gains 1 **Wealth**. Otherwise, go to:

9

Black silhouette in the sky quickly approaches the Menhir Meadow. Folks from these parts were always advising travelers to avoid these cursed ruins – perhaps for a reason!

Go to:

11

You try to move carefully, but it's cold here, and you start trembling. Frustration boils inside you, and you hit one of the walls with your fist. Stones and wooden bars fall on you.

Each Party member gains 1 **Wealth** and loses 1 . Exploration ends.

Menhir

Requires **all Characters** and the **Menhir Rites** Secret card (**11**).

Pay 2 , 2 **Magic** (per Character): put a new Menhir model on this Location and set its Dial to **8** (-1 per Character). If there aren't enough models left, take one from another Location of your choice. If you are playing **Dagan**, and you **don't have** the **"Needed Supplies"** part **3** status, go to:

224 Icicle Forest

The wind, originating in chasms to the west and south, rages between gnarled branches, heavy from ice and snow. Its gusts chill you to the bone. In the middle of the forest, a mound stands in the shape of an animal skull with horns made of icicles. You get the feeling you've seen it before.

- **Explore the forest** – go to Verse 4.
- **Approach the mound** – go to Verse 2.
- **Meditate** (requires the **"Initiation"** part **1** status) – go to Verse 9.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

As you enter the forest, you spot an old trail of blood leading into the woods. You proceed cautiously, until you find a place where a battle took place. Tracks of several people mingle with the ones of a medium-sized wyrm, all splattered in blood. There are no corpses, only shattered fragments of hunting equipment and clothes. You don't think that there are any bodies left.

Gain the **"Missions"** part **1** status. Go back to Verse 4.

2

The entrance to the barrow is open and dark. You place your torch in a sconce and enter the stone skull. There is almost nothing inside – only a thin layer of ice on the ground and an abandoned altar topped with cracked human and animal skulls. It seems a good place to rest, sheltered from the freezing wind.

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **15** status, go to Verse 6. Otherwise, read on:

- **Rest** (this will end your day) – each Party member Passes and loses 2 Exposure. Exploration ends.
- **Exit** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

3

You grow tired of the walking, and when you stop to catch your breath, you notice many animal tracks in the snow. Most of them look normal. Not like the ones reshaped by the wyrdness. It's probably an excellent place to gather provisions for Mangrove Huddle. If only it wasn't so hard to get here through the wyrdness...

Dagan gains 1 Exp. Gain the **"Needed Supplies"** part **1** status. Go to Verse 8.

4

If you're playing **Chapters 2-3** and **don't have** the **"Missions"** part **1** status, go to Verse 7.

If you're playing **Chapters 4-15** and **don't have** the **"Missions"** part **1** status, go to Verse 1.

Everything in the forest is encased in a thin layer of ice. It's beautiful, but you see it causes the plants to suffer – a tremendous burden bends them to the ground. You're also suffering, but from a bitter cold.

Each Party member gains 1 Exposure, unless this Party member has an **"Adventurer's Kit"** Item.

- **Admire nature** – go to Verse 8.
- **Locate the nest** (requires **Fyul** and the **"Fallen Wyrdhunters"** part **2** status) – go to Verse 5.
- **Emerge from the forest** – Exploration ends.

5

You march toward the hill you saw from the cliff. The forest grows denser as you progress, as if the trees stand in your way. Finally, you hack your way through and emerge in a small glade. Something resembling a nest lies before you – branches, twigs, frozen animal and human corpses all woven together. It looks abandoned, as if Black Drifter moved somewhere else. You don't mind the sight, but you are terrified of the raw menhir magic this nest radiates. The aura of this place twists your insides painfully.

- **Leave the forest** – Exploration ends.
- **Go claim your revenge** (only if you don't have the **"Fallen Wyrdhunters"** part **3** status) – go to:

6

You feel a presence behind your back. You quickly turn around and see an eerie creature – a deer skull with broad antlers, cold, dead lanterns in both hands, dark veins pulsating slowly under the bare skin. Cold mist surrounds the figure, turning into rime on its antlers and the mound walls.

You feel the creature's hatred and helplessness – as it would like to tear you to shreds for your sins, but it can't because it lost all of its power. "Leave." Strange words reverberate in your mind. "You've destroyed so much already. Don't taint this sacred place, this last memorial of our father anymore."

You don't know what this monster wants, but there's clearly nothing here for you. You leave, with questions floating around in your heads.

Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

7

You see a wyrm slowly devouring a human body – more corpses lie scattered around. The beast spits out its meal when it spots you and moves to attack. In its beady eyes, you're only another snack.

Gain the **"Missions"** part **1** status.

Resolve the **"Ice Wyrm"** green Encounter (Difficulty 2). If you win (or the Enemy Runs Away), you recover the bodies – gain Secret card **2** and go back to Verse 4.

Otherwise, you leave corpses behind to save your skin – Exploration ends.

New Task: If you reclaimed the hunters' bodies, take them to their families in Mangrove Huddle.

8

You know how cruel this frost is, but you can't stop thinking how fascinating it looks. You can see red fruits, lush-green leaves, and even small insects encased under the ice. As if they were frozen in time, not in the water.

If you are **Dagan** and you **don't have** the **"Needed Supplies"** part **1** status, go to Verse 3.

Each Party member loses 1 . Exploration ends.

9

You sit under a tree and press your back to the cold bark. Your body shudders immediately, but you close eyes and try to meditate. You feel life under the ice, hidden deep inside the tree. A life that will last forever.

Each Party member gains 1 Exposure. Gain the **"Initiation"** part **2** status. Exploration ends.

Dream

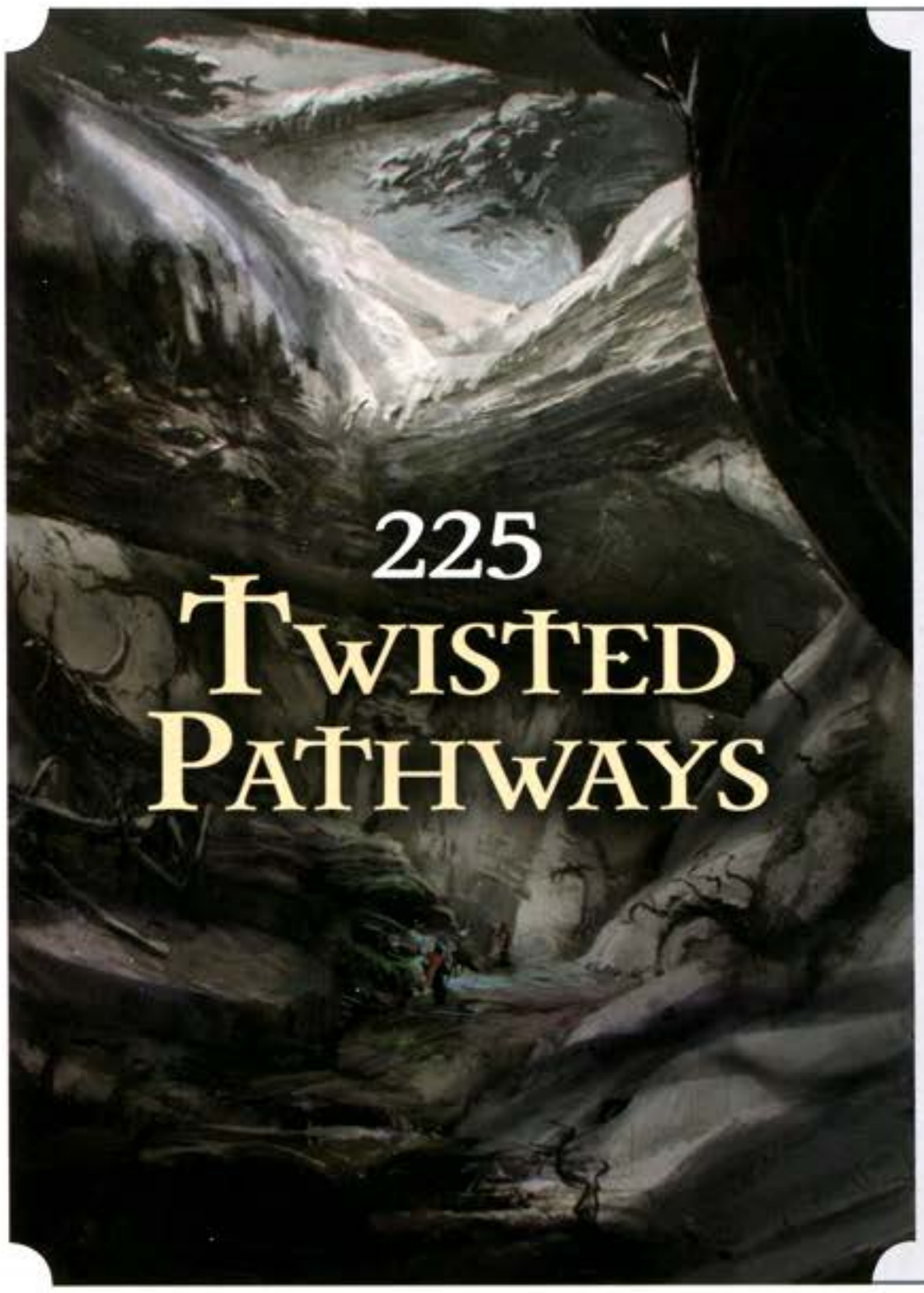
You feel a pleasant chill as you fly between branches in search of prey. You love the moment when your claws sink into a fox's neck.

Each Character who has this Dream gains 1 and 1 Exposure.

Nightmare

You can't stand it anymore. Your fallen body was always tainted by humans, but what happened now in your grove... It's too much! With the last of your power, you send torrential rains down on this place, then freeze it with the chill wind to purge from it all the filth!

Each Character who has this Nightmare gains 1 and 1 Exposure



225 Twisted Pathways

If you **have** the **"Time"** status and the **"Decision"** part **1** or **5** status, go to Verse 14. Otherwise, read on:

Freezing wind flows from the north, winding its way through the labyrinth of tangled roots, fallen trees, and snowdrifts. Remains of rope bridges and lanterns dangle from the trunks, and ancient marks cut into their bark point toward places lost to time. This maze-forest is the only known way to the north – but during the last few months, as the wyrdness grew thicker, the paths have changed. Entering without a guide might be your doom.

To the west, you see a more tranquil place – a basin with a lone tower in the center. Maybe you should go there instead?

If you are playing **Chapter 2** and have the **"Missions"** part **2** status, you may go to Verse 10 (this will end your Chapter).

If you're playing **Chapter 5**, go to Verse 11.

Otherwise, choose one:

- **Delve into the gorge** – go to Verse 1.
- **Go through the Twisted Pathways to the north** (requires **Chapters 3-15**) – go to Verse 3.
- **Visit the marvelous site** (requires the **"Means of Survival"** part **5** status; pay 2 per Party member) – go to Verse 12.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

You stand at the entrance to the gorge. Formidable roots form an enormous canopy over its shaded, cold paths.

Each Party member gains 1 Exposure.

- **Visit a ruined lodge on the gorge bank** – go to Verse 7.
- **Cross a damaged bridge** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 4.
- **Go down the main gorge** – go to Verse 6.

2

Check your final result:

1-5 – *The twisted paths are unnavigable. After hours of wandering around, you give up.* Exploration ends.

6+ – *You think you know, where to go.* Go to:

3

If the **Chapter 6: Part 2** Quest Card is revealed, go to:

Now that you know the way, the travel is almost pleasant. You feel the ancient forest enveloping you in its stillness. If only it wasn't so cold...

If Location **235** (or **275**) is not attached to this card, you may pay 1 Magic (1 Character), 2 Magic (2-3 Characters) or 3 Magic (4 Characters) to attach Location **235** (or **275**) to the top of Location **225**.

If Location **235** (or **275**) is attached to this card, you may pay 1 per Party member to move all Party members to Location **235** (or **275**). Then, Exploration ends.

If you didn't do the above, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

4

Crossing the bridge takes some time – you must avoid cracked and unstable areas. But you make it to the other side unharmed. You enter a dense grove and find a majestic, tall tree growing in a small clearing. A grave rests at its feet, a spear made of strange, opalizing metal impaled into it – you try to move the weapon, but it doesn't budge. Plenty of white and purple flowers grow around the grave, ignoring ice and snow. You shift your focus to the tree and see that it has leaves despite the cold, and something golden glimmers inside its crown.

- **Rest by the grave** – go to Verse 13.
- **Climb the tree** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to:

5

You follow the cries and find a weeping knight kneeling on the icebound ground. Thick roots have him by his armor. He raises his head – behind the visor a pair of red eyes look at you with pure hate. The knight rises and rushes at you. These things you took for roots are growing out of the knight's body!

Gain the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **3** status. Resolve the **"Lost Knight"** gray Encounter (Difficulty 2).

Then, Exploration ends.

6

You're no longer sure where you are. There trail branched off so many times, and the roots above cover the sun, making it impossible to find your direction.

- **Try to find a way to the north, regardless** (only if you don't have the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **4** status, pay 1 per Party member) – roll a die and add your . If you **have** the **"Clues"** part **1** status, add 3. Now, check your final result in Verse 2.
- **Go in a random direction** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 9.
- **Retrace your steps to the exit** – Exploration ends.

7

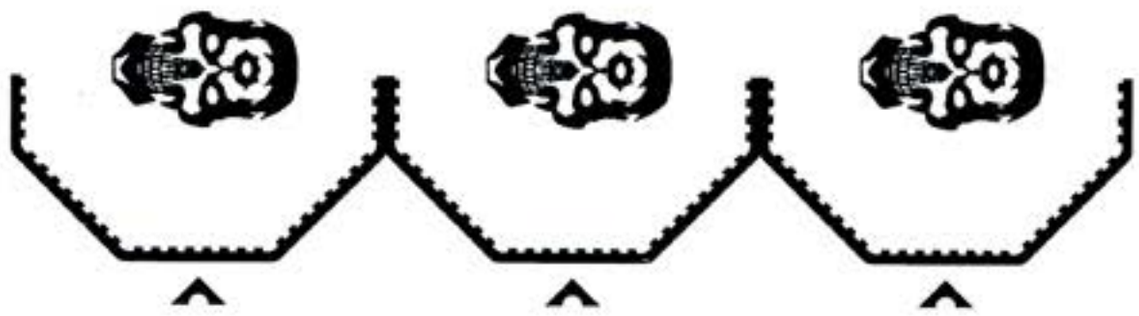
The lodge is abandoned, but its former inhabitants have left something for the visitors. Walls are covered in roughly sketched, charcoal maps of this area.

Gain the **"Clues"** part **1** status. Exploration ends.

8

This aimless walking makes you tired...

If you are playing **Chapter 2** and **don't have** the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **4** status, go to:



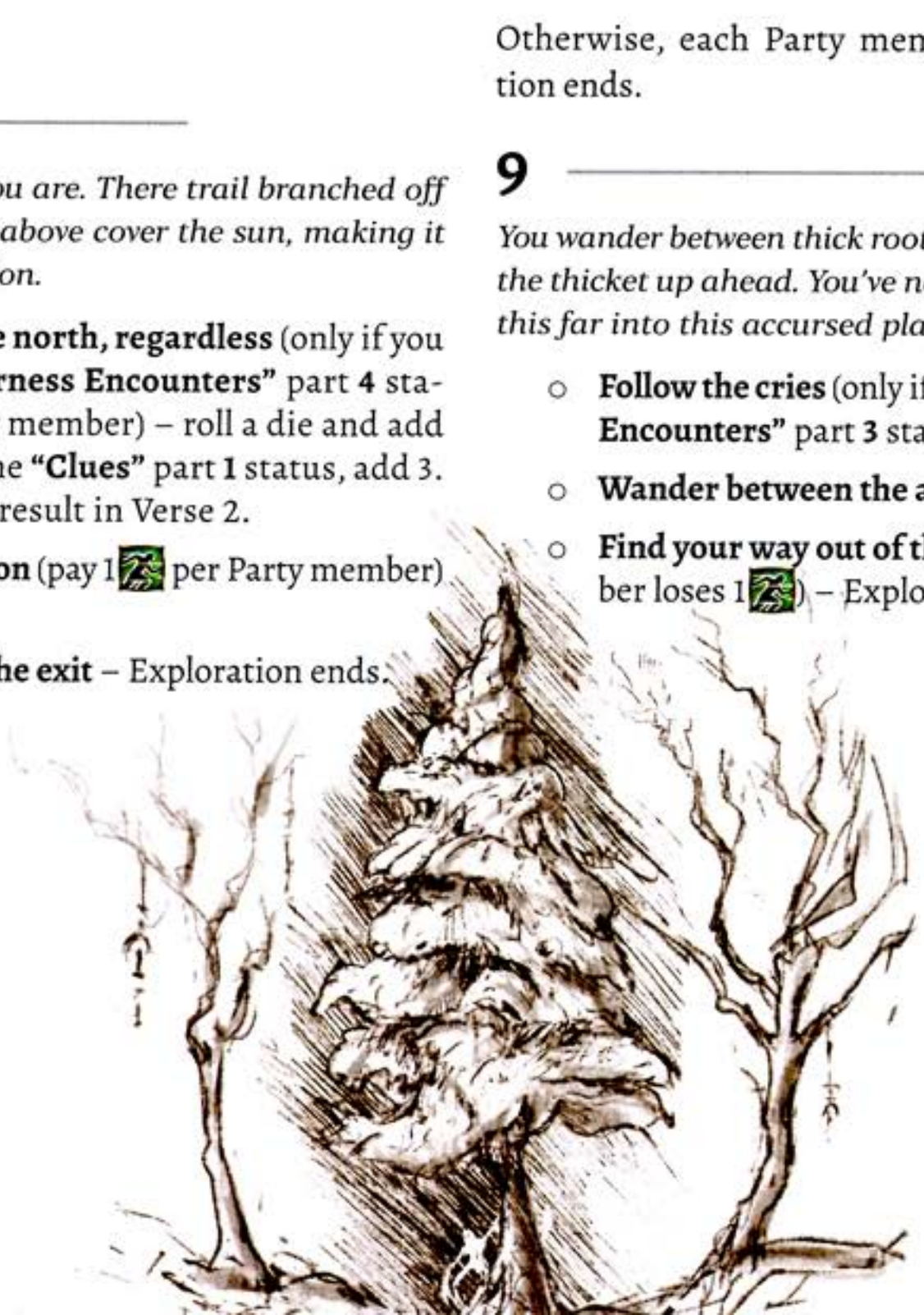
If you **have** the **"Mysteries and Visions"** part **5** and **don't have** the **"Means of Survival"** part **5** status, go to:

Otherwise, each Party member loses 2 and Exploration ends.

9

You wander between thick roots. Faint cries seem to come from the thicket up ahead. You've never heard of the travelers going this far into this accursed place.

- **Follow the cries** (only if you don't have the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **3** status) – go to Verse 5.
- **Wander between the ancient roots** – go to Verse 8.
- **Find your way out of this labyrinth** (each Party member loses 1) – Exploration ends.

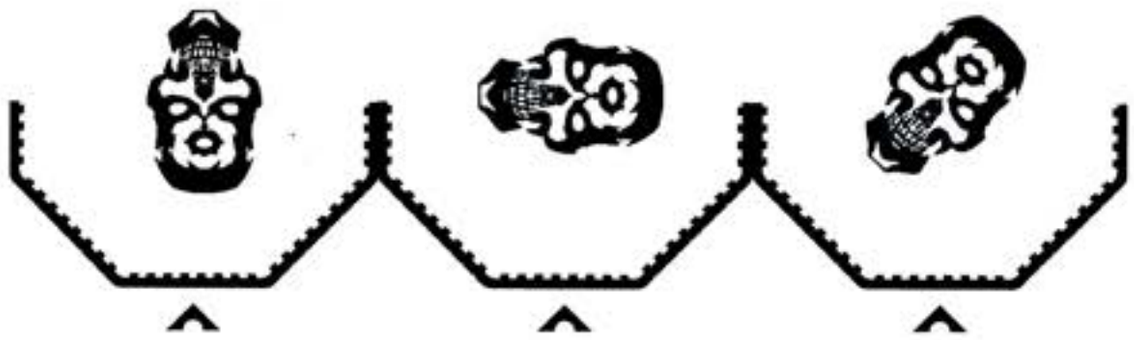


10

If all Characters are not in this Location, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

Otherwise:

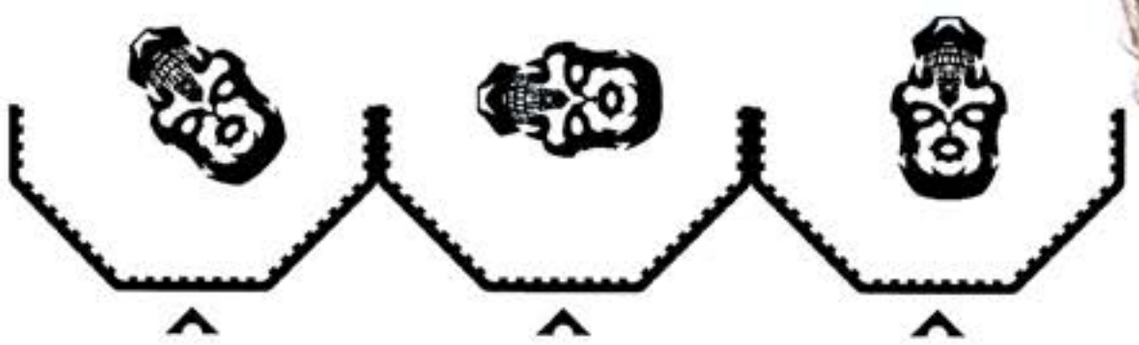
If the **"Reward Awaits"** Quest Card, **Chapter 2: Part 4**, is revealed, go to:



If the **"Unsuccessful Quest"** Quest Card, **Chapter 2: Part 5**, is revealed, go to:

11

If all Characters are in Location **225**, go to:



Otherwise, you must wait for everyone to gather – Exploration ends.

12

Go to:

13

You rest by the grave, wrapped in flowery scent. The atmosphere is calm, letting you drift off for a while.

Each Party member loses 3 . Exploration ends.

14

If you **have** the **"Decision"** part **1** status, remove Location **225** from the game and replace it with Location **276**. Then, Explore this new Location for free.

Otherwise, remove Location **225** from the game and replace it with Location **277**. Then, Explore this new Location for free.

226
Lonely Spire

If the **Chapter 13**: **Part 6** Quest Card is revealed, go to Verse 5. Otherwise, read on:

A lone tower, its walls marked with soot, rises from the bottom of a basin, surrounded by frozen mud and adorned with fish skeletons. The remains of an encampment lie scattered around the base of the tower: traces of campfires, decayed ropes, tent pegs. You wonder who dwelled here, as the area is frigid, and the wyrdness seems to somehow stick to the tower.

- **Check the spire's outskirts** – go to Verse 7.
- **Enter the tower** – go to Verse 3.
- **Speak with the resident** (only if you don't have the **"Decision"** part **1** or **5** status and you're playing **Chapters 13-15**) – go to Verse 11.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

You were expecting something spectacular, but the sight from the spire's top is rather dull. The platform is at the same level as the forests surrounding the basin, so you can't see much farther. What's more, the top of the spire is uneven and slippery. You must take care not to fall.

If you **don't have** the **"Mysteries and Visions"** part **5** status, go to:

Otherwise, Exploration ends.

2

The way up the slope is horrible – full of unstable rocks and frozen mud that crumbles under your feet. When you finally reach the top, you're drenched in sweat. Gasping for air, you notice an ethereal creature in the shape of a pig. It immediately vanishes into thin air, leaving you dumbfounded. As you look for the creature, you realize you are in the middle of berry shrubs full of small, edible fruit.

Each Party member gains 1 Food and loses 2 . Gain the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **2** status.

Exploration ends.

3

Someone tried to make camp inside this tower. You also notice traces of soot at the base of the walls, as if they were purposely set on fire.

- **Climb the flat platform at the top of the spire** (pay 2 per Party member) – go to Verse 1.
- **Search through the middle part of the tower** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 6.
- **Investigate the spire's base filled with ice** – go to Verse 4.
- **Descend to the tunnels under the island** (requires **Chapters 10-15** and all Characters; pay 3 per Party member) – go to Verse 10.
- **Go out** – Exploration ends.

4

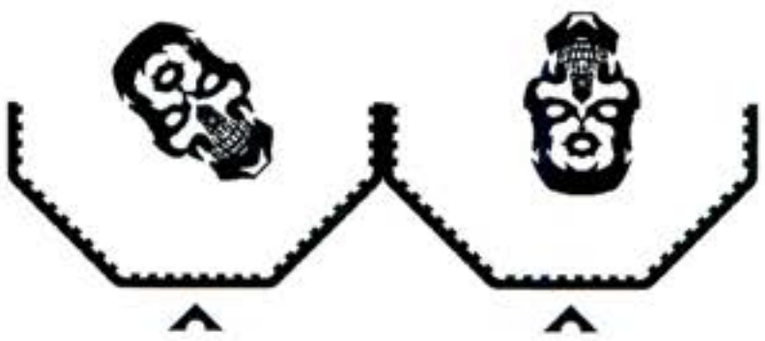
A thick layer of dirty ice covers everything. Reclaiming any objects from under its surface would require a great effort.

You may pay 1 per Party member, to gain 1 Wealth per Party member or 1 Magic per Party member.

Then, Exploration ends.

5

Go to:



6

You climb the stairs, or at least you think these are the stairs. The freezing wind howls as it squeezes through many openings in the walls. It's hard to understand why anyone would raise such a hole-ridden structure. You shiver with cold, but your mind is still – the atmosphere of this place is peaceful and mysterious. Unfortunately, all the rooms were already ransacked, and there is nothing here.

Each Party member gains 1 Magic.

- **Go farther up** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 1.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

7

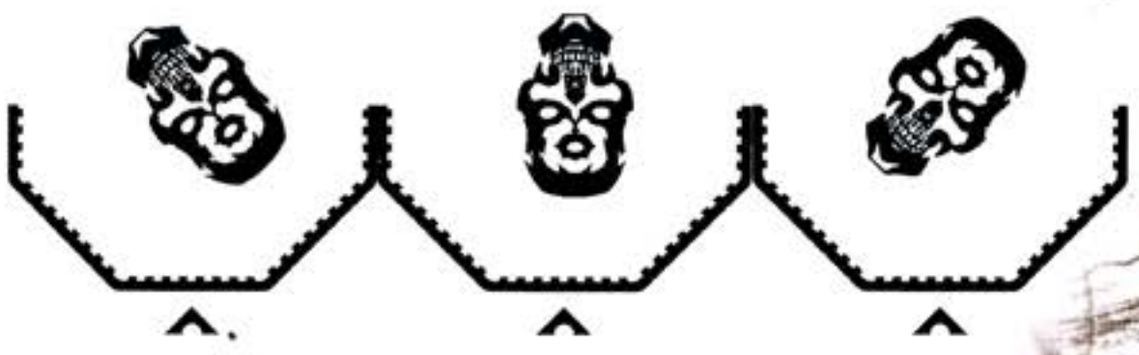
Snow mixed with mud surrounds the tower, making it difficult to move on. You feel how it saps your heat, leaving you shivering. You also notice something intriguing – wyrdness sticks to the spire's walls, leaving a small area outside almost free of its influence. As you ponder this, you catch a glimpse of something bright running up to slope of the basin.

- **Follow the light, leaving the tower behind** (only if you don't have the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **2** status; pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 2.
- **Forget it** – go to the start of this Location and make another choice.

10

The wind howls in empty tunnels under the spire. Going in there requires outstanding bravery.

Go to:



11

If you **have** Secret card **30**, there is nobody here. Exploration ends.

Otherwise, go to:

Dream

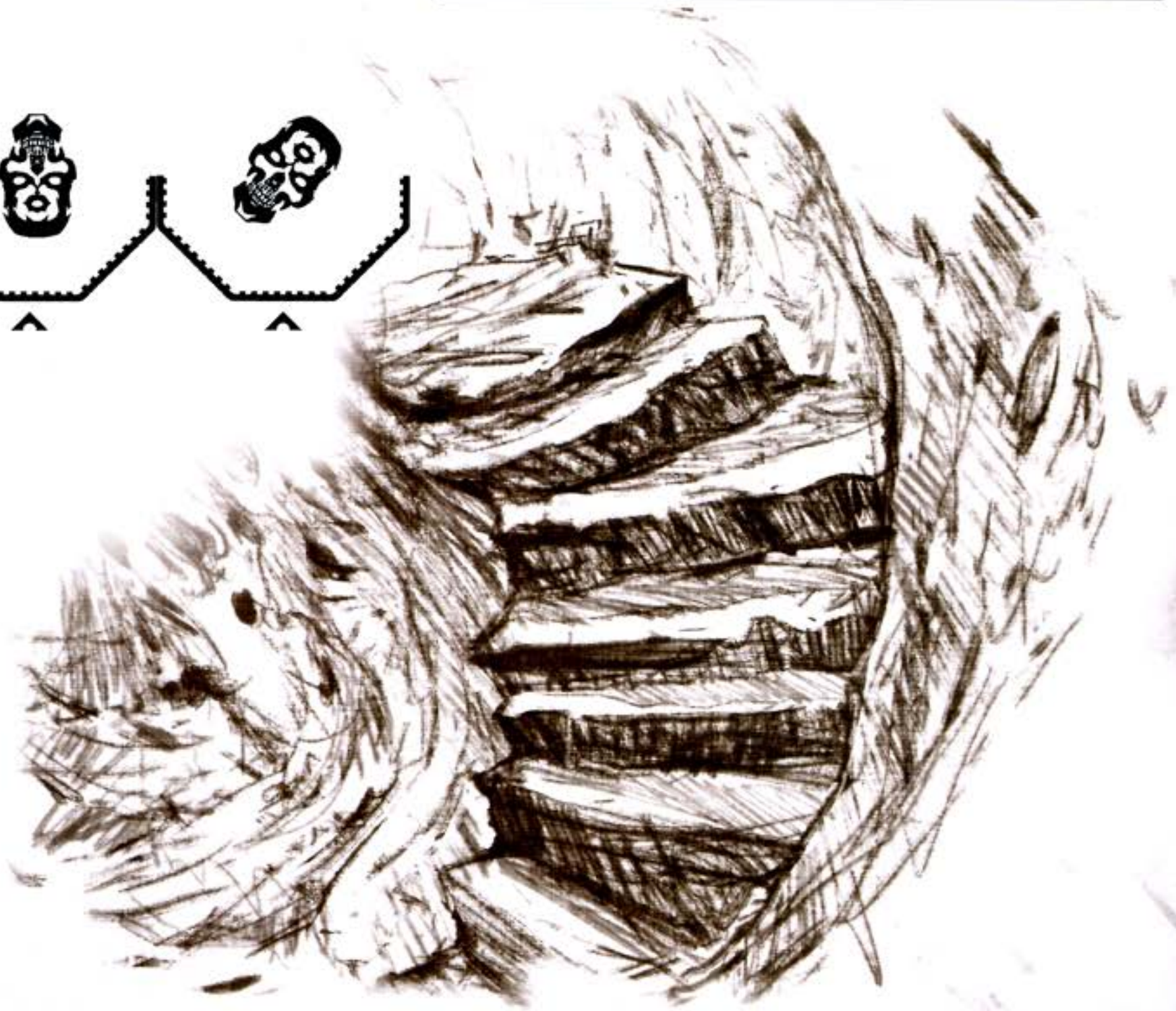
You swim with schools of colorful fish. Vast corridors glimmer with jewels, and curious artifacts lie in rows on sturdy shelves. You feel almost at home, but instead of wyrdness, you are surrounded by delightful water. When you're here, you almost forget about your worries.

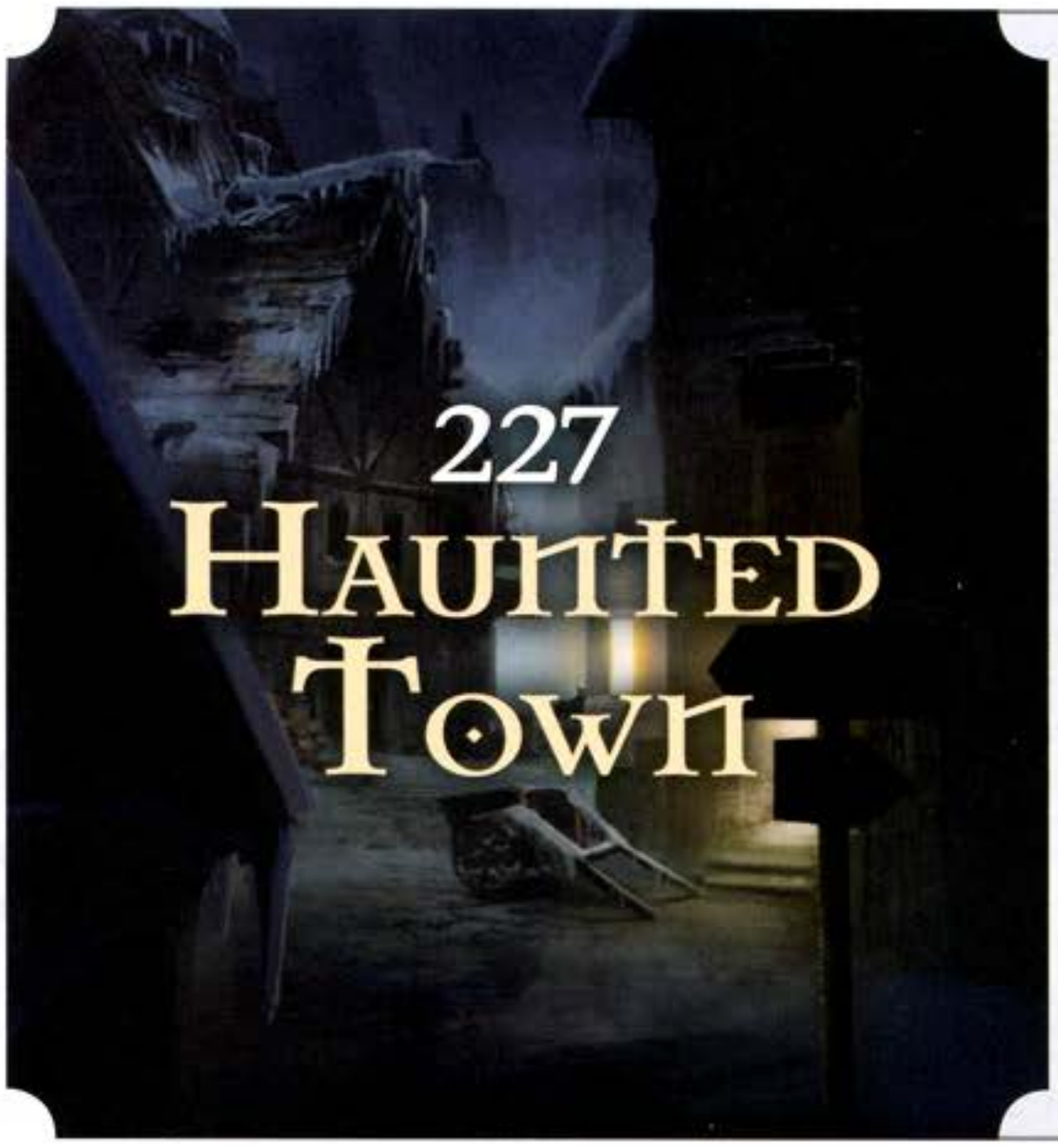
Each Character who has this Dream gains 1 Magic.

Nightmare

The forlorn tower stands at the bottom of a drained lake. People come here drawn by its thick walls, make their home inside, and die of terrible mutations, making place for others who seek their salvation in the shadow of the tower's walls – only to freeze to death. The tower is abandoned again, but not for long.

Each Character who has this Nightmare loses 1.





227
Haunted Town

This was once a great town – you imagine towers rising up, the uplifting presence of Kamelot on the eastern horizon, narrow streets filled with bargaining people, and the splendor of plentiful mansions. But now, wyrdness creeps the alleys, the spires crumbled years ago, dilapidated buildings appear empty and soulless, and the castle on the horizon lies in ruins. The southern part of this borough, built on planks and bridges hanging over the cliff, offers impressive views of the Black Sands and the Glimmering Forest.

- **Go into the town** – go to Verse 5.
- **Inspect the machinery hanging from the cliff** (only if you don't have the **"Means of Survival"** part **4** status) – go to Verse 4.
- **Descend into the desert** (requires the **"Means of Survival"** part **4** status) – go to Verse 7.
- **Visit your strange friend** (requires the **"Friends"** part **1** status; pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 10.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

Gathering resources and loose parts from the district by the cliff takes some time, but it is the actual repair work that consumes half your day. Recreating the cranes, rebuilding the intricate systems of cogs and crafting secure platforms is a daunting task. But, in the end, you make something that allows you to go up and down the southern cliff at will, opening a new path to the Frozen Desert.

Gain the **"Means of Survival"** part **4** status. Exploration ends.

2

Most buildings have at least two floors, and many stand taller. You've never seen anything like that! Almost all are made of stone, often carved in beautiful floral patterns.

- **Wander between the buildings** – go to Verse 8
- **Visit a deserted mansion** – go to Verse 9.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

3

The battered door yields under your touch, letting you onto a creaking floor. Gilded stairs used to go up to the next floor, but now they lie on the side, folded in half by wyrdness. You feel uneasy in this dark, cramped space.

- **Search the mansion** (only if you don't have the **"Hidden Caches"** part **1** status) – go to:

- **Escape from the residence** – Exploration ends.

4

You approach the ancient machinery at the edge of the cliff. You're sure that it was used to rappel up goods and maybe even livestock or people. You think you can make it work again, but it will require some effort.

- **Repair it** (pay 3) – go to Verse 1.
- **Leave it be** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

5

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **2** status, go to Verse 2. Otherwise, go to Verse 6.

6

The town is full of plundered mansions and dark districts packed tight with decrepit houses.

- **Wander between the buildings** – go to Verse 8
- **Visit a ruined mansion** – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

7

The way down, full of creaking pulleys, thin ropes, and unstable ladders, doesn't look appealing.

If Location **221** is not attached to this card, you may pay 1 Magic (1 Character), 2 Magic (2-3 Characters) or 3 Magic (4 Characters) to attach Location **221** to the bottom of Location **227**.

If Location **221** is attached to this card, you may pay 1 per Party member to move all Party members to Location **221**. Then, Exploration ends.

If you didn't do the above, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

8

If you **don't have** the **"Horrors"** part **2** status, go to:

If you **don't have** the **"Hidden Caches"** part status **6**, go to:

Otherwise, you can't find anything worth mention. Go back to Verse 5.

9

You enter once-magnificent residence – the tapestries are moth-eaten, and the paintings have faded, but they were undoubtedly splendid in their good days. One of the paintings depicts a monumental castle standing watch above a city of many ports and countless gardened villas. It takes you a moment to understand it's not Avalon. This is the first depiction of the Homelands you have seen in your entire life, and it is magnificent.

- **Search this place** (only if you don't have the **"Hidden Caches"** part **1** status) – go to:

- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

10

You visit the crumbling house and its strange host. The visit is, to put it lightly, unsettling, but you manage to rest there for a while.

Each Party member gains 2 and 1, and loses 1 **Exposure**. Exploration ends.

Dream & Nightmare

You find a nice looking inn and settle inside, making the best use of the archaic beds and furniture, which still are in quite good shape. Sheltered from cold and barricaded from other dangers, you fall asleep.

You are woke by knocking at the door. You look out dumbfounded and see...

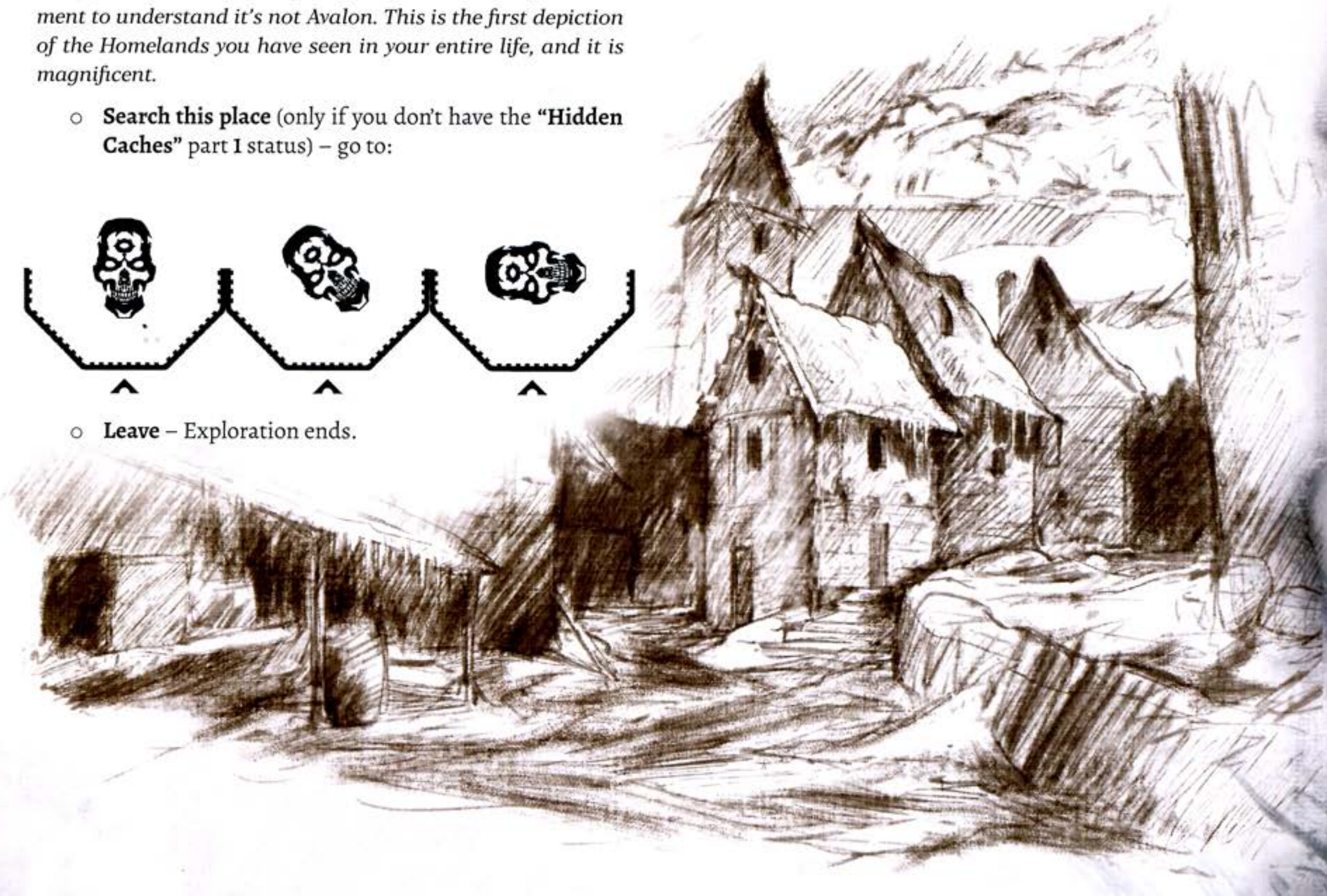
Each Character who has this Dream resolves the following effect as a Party. Roll a die and check your result:

1 – resolve the **"Silent Pilgrims"** blue Encounter (Difficulty 4).

2 – resolve the **"Unfathomable Envoy"** blue Encounter (Difficulty 3).

3-4 – resolve the **"Glastig"** blue Encounter (Difficulty 3).

5-6 – *It must have been your imagination.* Nothing happens.



235
Still River

If you **have** the **"Time"** status, go to Verse 17. Otherwise, read on:

Fat white maggots crawl on the edges of this icebound river, leaving slimy trails behind them – what keeps them from freezing to the surface? The ice shows deep scratches, as if a great bird landed here many times, perhaps hitting the dilapidated cottage sitting half-collapsed on the riverbank. You feel trapped, surrounded by Twisted Pathways, the veil of wyrdness to the west, mists to the east, and a shattered land to the north.

If there is a Fore-dweller model or Time Token in this Location, go to Verse 1.

Otherwise, go to Verse 5.

1

- **Visit a ruined house** – go to Verse 8.
- **Check the deep scratches on the river surface** – go to Verse 3.
- **Use a passage to the south** – go to Verse 15.
- **Come closer to the strange ice structure** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 2.
- **Pass through the mist and the wyrdness to the west** (only if there is an Active Menhir in this Location; pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 11.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

2

Tiny ice spirals entwine with one another, forming a larger shape. Your eyes mindlessly turn to the center of the structure. It's difficult to look away. When you manage to shake the drowsiness overwhelming you, you notice the statue has changed – the spirals now twist in the other direction.

If you **don't have** the **"Mysteries and Visions"** part **6** status, each Party member gains 1 Exp; gain the **"Mysteries and Visions"** part **6** status.

Each Party member gains 1 Magic and 1 . Exploration ends.

3

The scratches are about four inches deep. Many of them look fresh, but some are packed with old snow. Something massive must visit this place regularly. As you inspect the damage, you notice a vague silhouette of a menhir under the ice. You wonder how did the statue end up at the bottom of a river...

If you are **Fyul** and you **don't have** the **"Fallen Wyrdhunters"** part **1** status, go to Verse 13.

Otherwise, choose one:

- **Absorb the menhir's magic** (requires the **"Leaking Magic"** Secret card (**24**)) – go to Verse 12.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

4

The pile budges as you enter the house. What you took for a stack of old furs must be a beast of some kind. Maybe a great white bear?

- **Scare the beast away** (requires 3) – go to Verse 7.
- **Retreat** – Exploration ends.
- **Attack it now** – when this Encounter begins, add 3 markers to the Combat Pool. Go to:

5

Roll a die. If there is an Active Menhir in this Location, add +3 or the number of markers on the Menhir's base (if you have the **"Leaking Magic"** Secret card (**24**)). Subtract the value of your . Check your final result:

1-5 – go to Verse 1.

6+ – place a Time Token on this Location and go to Verse 10.

6

A frozen human corpse lies with its back against a tree. The spear in its blackened hands points at the house. The weapon seems fragile, as if it would break if touched.

If you are **Niamh** and you **don't have** the **"Past"** part **1** status, go to Verse 14.

Go back to Verse 8.

7

You throw a torch at the beast and scream loudly. You run into the house, making as much noise as possible. The startled bear wakes and flees in a panic.

Go to:

8

Human and animal tracks litter the area around the house. The building lies in ruins, its thatched roof collapsed beneath the weight of the snow. Behind the broken door, you see a pile of furs near a dead campfire.

- **Enter the house** (only if you don't have the **"Lost Treasures"** part **5**) – go to Verse 9.
- **Rest in the house** (requires the **"Lost Treasures"** part **5**) – go to Verse 16.
- **Check the surroundings** – go to Verse 6.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

9

You enter the house – it reeks of death and pestilence.

If you **have** 3 or more , go to Verse 4.

Otherwise, go to:

10

Legends of the Black Drifter say it is a curse from the past.

Go to:

11

The menhir dispersed the mist. You pass through and eventually reach a forest of short trees and small animals.

Attach Location **241** to the left edge of Location **235**. Move all Party members to Location **241**. Then, Exploration ends.

12

You focus on the statue under the surface – you feel a faint trace of magic emanating from it. Siphoning magic through the thick ice is difficult, but possible.

Discard all markers from the Menhir's base. Gain Magic in the number of discarded markers. You may discard the **"Ritual Chalk"** or **"Wyrdstone Heart"** Items to gain an additional 3 Magic for each.

Exploration ends.

13

On the bodies of your companions you saw markings similar to these scratches. The monster that killed them must have been the same beast that visits this river. You should climb the cliff to the east – the ruins of a castle visible there offer a great vantage point. You must discover the nest of the Black Drifter to study it further.

Fyul gains 1 Exp. Gain the **"Fallen Wyrdhunters"** part **1** status. Go back to Verse 3.

Hint: You should explore the locations along the cliff southeast from here, but they might be currently unreachable.

14

The sight of the lonely corpse reminds you of the woman whose life you destroyed. New memories emerge from the oblivion of your mind – the last time you saw the woman was near the Stone of Memories, northwest of here. It may be difficult to reach, but you must do what you can to get there. Or maybe you shouldn't? You always seem to harm people, even when you want to help.

Niamh gains 1 Exp. Gain the **"Past"** part **1** status. Go back to Verse 8.

15

You delve into a seemingly impassable forest. However, finding the passages shown to you by the ironclad warrior is an easy task, and soon you are on the other side of the ancient root maze.

If Location **225** is not attached to this card, you may pay 1 Magic (1 Character), 2 Magic (2-3 Characters) or 3 Magic (4 Characters) to attach Location **225** to the bottom of Location **235**.

If Location **225** is attached to this card, you may pay 1 per Party member to move all Party members to Location **225**. Then, Exploration ends.

If you didn't do any of the above, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

16

The house is in terrible condition, but it still provides some shelter from the freezing wind. If you close your eyes and ignore the smell, it almost feels like home.

If you **don't have** the **"Hidden Caches"** part **3**, you can light the fire with the resources gathered by the previous owner – if you do, each Party member loses 2 **Exposure**; gain the **"Hidden Caches"** part **3**.

Then, each Party member gains 1 . Exploration ends.

17

Remove Location **235** from the game and replace it with Location **275**. Then, Explore this new Location for free.

Dream & Nightmare

You hate this place. You despise it so much it makes you sick. You hate the twin towns, full of goats, hypocrites, and callous schemes. You hate their founders. You hate this stone trough splitting the plateau in half. You hate the cold. When you wake, hatred still consumes you. And it feels... right.

Each Character who has this Dream or Nightmare and has 3 or more loses 1 .

Menhir

Requires **all Characters** and the **Menhir Rites** Secret card (**11**).

Pay 2 , 2 **Magic**, and 2 **Wealth** (per Character): put a new Menhir model on this Location and set its Dial to **7** (-1 per Character).

If there aren't enough models left, take one from another Location of your choice.

236
White Fog

A wet, frigid fog creeps from the north and gathers in this area, floating around cave entrances and above the frozen river. You hear muffled sounds, not unlike chatter, from below the icy surface – you wonder if your mind plays tricks on you, or if something lurks here.

If you are playing **Chapter 5**, go to Verse 13.

Otherwise, choose one:

- **Find the source of the strange sounds** – go to Verse 3.
- **Enter the cavern** – go to Verse 6.
- **Meditate** (requires the **"Initiation"** part **1** status) – go to Verse 11.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

You find corpses in a recess of the corridor; a frozen woman hugging a child. Both show horrific signs of wyrdness.

Each Party member gains 1 Exposure. If you **don't have** the **"Means of Survival"** part **6** status, gain 1 non-Companion Item and the **"Means of Survival"** part **6** status.

- **Move on** (only if you don't have the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **5** status; pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 7.
- **Retreat** – *You don't want to end up like them.* Exploration ends.

2

You sweat despite the freezing wind. The recent battle was like a nightmare from which you couldn't wake. You notice a body in the darkness. You approach it carefully and recognize the pregnant woman who disappeared from Mangrove Huddle a month ago. There is a smile on her frozen face.

Each Party member gains 1 Exposure. Gain 1 Craftable Item, 2 Wealth, and the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **6** status.

- **Bury the woman's body** (pay 2) – each Party member loses 1 . Exploration ends.
- **Leave this place** – Exploration ends.

3

You follow the sounds, slowly advancing on the river's slippery surface. Soon, you notice faint lights – they move deep under the ice. When they gather, the sounds get louder, and you almost recognize some words.

If you are playing **Chapter 4** and **have** the **"Clues"** part **2** status, go to Verse 12.

Otherwise, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

4

The torchlight seems to dim. It's strange, since the flame is still the same size. The tunnel splits in two.

- **Pick the left corridor** (only if you don't have the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **6** status; pay 1 per Party member) – *You feel chilling, moist air coming from this direction.* Go to Verse 5.
- **Delve into the right one** (only if you don't have the **"Means of Survival"** part **7** status; pay 1 per Party member) – *Your torch can't light it properly.* Go to Verse 8.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

5

Resolve the **"Wyrdchild"** purple Encounter (Difficulty 2).

If you win (or Enemy Run Away), go to Verse 2. Otherwise, Exploration ends.

6

A freezing yet wet wind blows through the entrance to the caverns, chilling you to the bone. Despite the cold, you are amazed – walls of ice reflect torchlight in a beautiful, mesmerizing way. Corridors lead in several different directions.

Each Party member gains 1 Exposure. Choose one:

- **Take the windy tunnel** – go to Verse 1.
- **Pick the darkest tunnel** – go to Verse 4.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

7

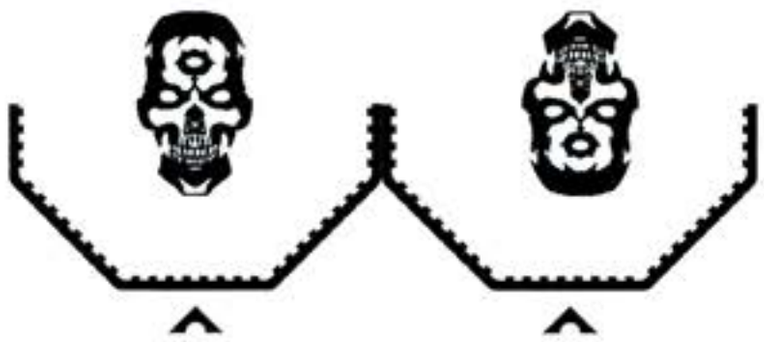
You didn't think it would be possible, but it's getting colder still. You shiver, and your mind slowly drifts away. You regain your focus just in time to spot a vicious beast lying in ambush.

Each Party member gains 1 Exposure. Resolve a purple Encounter.

If you win (or the Enemy Runs Away), go to Verse 9. Otherwise, Exploration ends.

8

If you **have** 3 or more , go to:



Otherwise, you're too scared to go on – Exploration ends.

9

Go to:

11

You sit down in the snow with your eyes closed and breathe deeply. Your teeth chatter from cold, but your mind remains clear and calm. A revelation comes eventually. The frost is the best thing that can happen to this world.

Each Party member gains 1 Exposure. Gain the **"Initiation"** part **4** status. Exploration ends.

12

The whispers get louder and clearer. Listening to them mesmerizes you. They promise knowledge, but you're not sure if you want it.

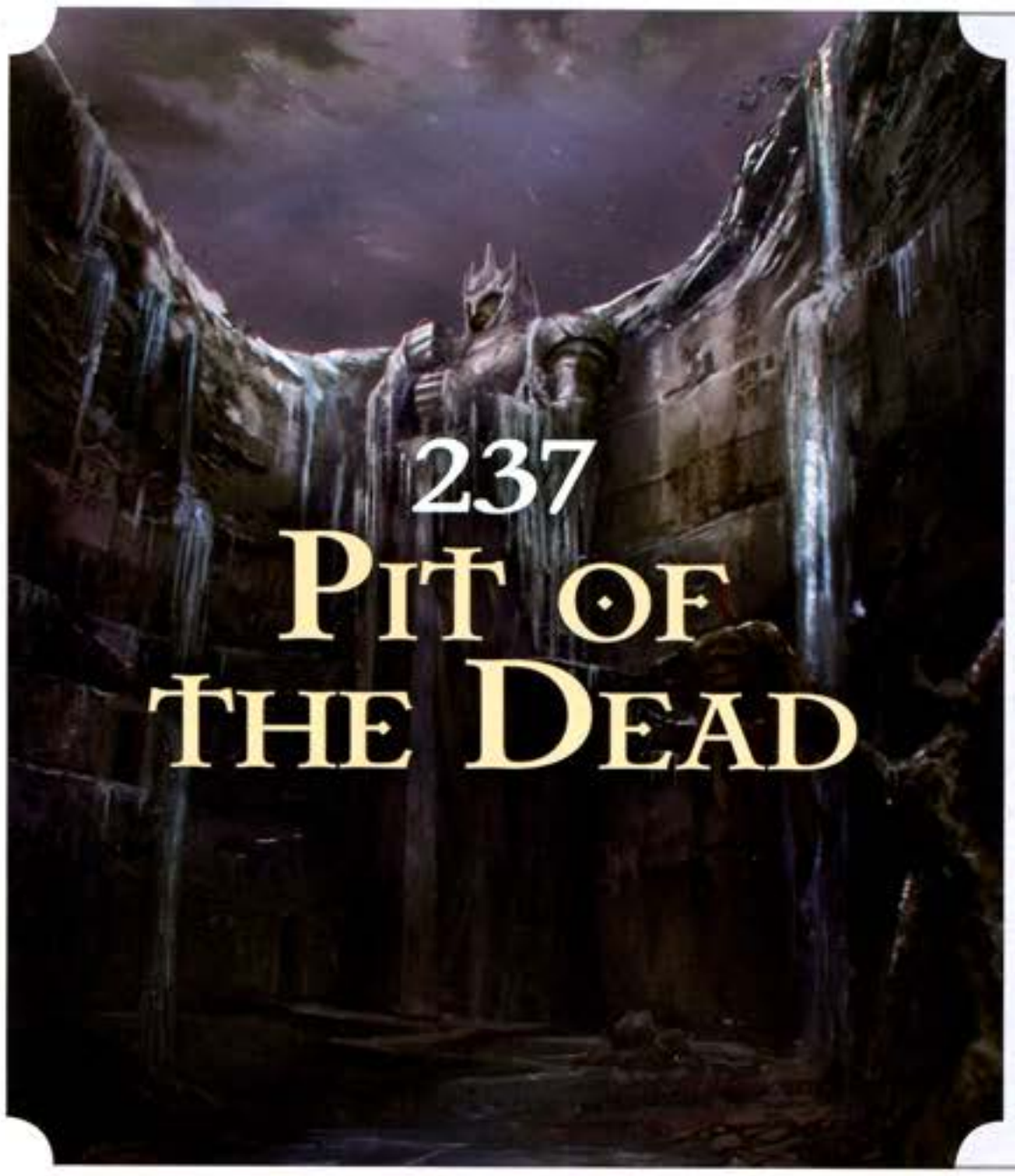
You may pay 1 Exp (1 Character) or 2 Exp (2-4 Characters) to obtain their knowledge – go to Verse:

If you can't or don't want to, Exploration ends.

13

You're exhausted from constant running. And now, the freezing mist makes you shiver.

Each Party member gains 1 Exposure. Then, Exploration ends.



237
Pit of the Dead

A dense fog, creeping from hot springs full of chattering people, gathers over a vast hole in the ground. This pit was once a resting place for the legendary knights of the Round Table. Now, it's abandoned and inaccessible – you can't descend, as the stairs crumbled. Even if you did, you couldn't climb back up – ice covers the high walls of this enormous well.

If you're playing **Chapter 5**, go to Verse 16.

Otherwise, choose one:

- **Approach the Pit** – go to Verse 1.
- **Visit the steaming lakes** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 6.
- **Catch small animals near the water** (only if there is no Time Token on this Location; pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 2.
- **Find the humpback** (requires **Chapter 4** and the **"Clues"** part **2** status) – go to Verse 15.
- **Descend into the underground tunnels** (requires **Chapters 10-15** and all Characters; pay 3 per Party member) – go to Verse 18.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

The head of a tall statue rises above the edge of a deep pit – it has a crown on its head, maybe representing the legendary king, Arthur. A long time ago, a path must have led down into pit, but now it's shattered – its remains lie on the bottom along with several dead bodies. A man covered in heavy fur sits at the edge of the abyss and scribbles something on a parchment.

- **Climb down** – roll a die and add your . If you **have** the **"Adventurer's Kit"** Item, add 2. Then, check your final result in Verse 4.
- **Back off and approach the steaming lakes** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 6.
- **Speak with the man** – go to Verse 17.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

2

You catch some desperately violent lemmings. They will make a good meal.

Place a Time Token on this Location. Gain 1 **Food** per Party member. Then, toss a Dial:

Grail – Exploration ends.

Skull – resolve a green Encounter. Then, Exploration ends.

3

As you approach the hot springs, a group of arguing people shift their attention to you. Outlanders are always great scapegoats.

Toss a Dial.

Grail – resolve a blue Encounter.

Skull – resolve a gray Encounter.

If you win (or the Enemy Runs Away), place a Time Token on this Location and go to Verse 5. Otherwise, Exploration ends.

4

Check your final result:

1-3 – *Your foot slips and your hands can't grip the ice-covered wall.* Go to Verse 9.

4-5 – *It was a hellish climb.* Each Party member loses 1. Go to Verse 7.

6+ – Go to Verse 7.

5

The water smells odd, but it's so warm and pleasant you don't mind. Other people also enjoy their time here, but some tinker with strange machinery with large pipes submerged in the hot spring.

Each Party member discards the Exposure Marker. Exploration ends.

6

If there is a Time Token on this Location, or any of your Attributes are 3 or higher, go to Verse 5. Otherwise, go to Verse 3.

7

You stand on a stone ledge halfway down the pit. The way down would be easier – there are remains of the ramp, but, then again, they're covered in ice. Closer to you is a dark entrance to something resembling a tomb.

- **Go down** (each Party member pays 3, reduced by 1 for each point of their) – go to Verse 11.
- **Climb back up** (pay 1 per Party member) – roll a die and add your . If you **have** the **"Adventurer's Kit"** Item, add 2. Then, check your final result in Verse 8.
- **Enter the tombs** – go to Verse 10.

8

Check your final result:

1-3 – *The handhold is too small and slippery...* Go to Verse 9.

4+ – Exploration ends.

9

The fall is short, but the crash is painful. Sharp stones and frozen bodies do little to break your fall.

Each Party member loses 4 and 2 and gains 3.

If any Party member has 0, you make your way up with the last desperate burst of strength – Exploration ends.

Otherwise, go to Verse 11.

10

The wyrdness gathers within these dark corridors. Weathered ornaments decorate the walls, but in the torchlight, and with the reality-warping mist crawling across them, they look ominous.

Roll a die.

1-2 – *You are lost, and the cold saps your strength.* Each Party member loses 2.

3-4 – *Wyrdness bends the stones and covers them with hair-thin needles.* Each Party member rolls a die and adds their . If their result was lower than 5, they lose 2.

5 – *You hear rustling behind you.* Resolve a purple Encounter

6 – *Someone left valuables – maybe a votive offering to whomever is buried here?* Gain 1 **Magic** and 1 **Wealth**.

Go to Verse 12.

11

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **9** status, go to:

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **8** status, go to:

Otherwise, go to:

12

If you **don't have** the **"Lost Treasures"** part **6** status, go to Verse 13.

If you **don't have** the **"Lost Treasures"** part **7** status, go to Verse 14.

Otherwise, Exploration ends.

13

You enter a room with a stone sarcophagus at its center. Carved into the lid is a depiction of a coat with stains of red paint resembling blood. The sarcophagus looks untouched.

- **Rob the grave** – go to Verse 19.
- **Seal the entrance** – *Whoever lies here, they shan't be disturbed.* Pay 1 **Magic** and go to Verse 20.
- **Do nothing** – gain the **"Lost Treasures"** part **6** status. Exploration ends.

14

A stone coffin lies in the recess of the wall. On its lid, a red lion among blue stars is painted. The coffin looks strangely pristine among the cobwebs and wyrdness-warped corridors.

- **Rob the grave** – go to Verse 21.
- **Seal the coffin** – *Let the dead rest in peace.* Pay 1 **Magic** and go to Verse 22.
- **Do nothing** – gain the **"Lost Treasures"** part **7** status. Exploration ends.

15

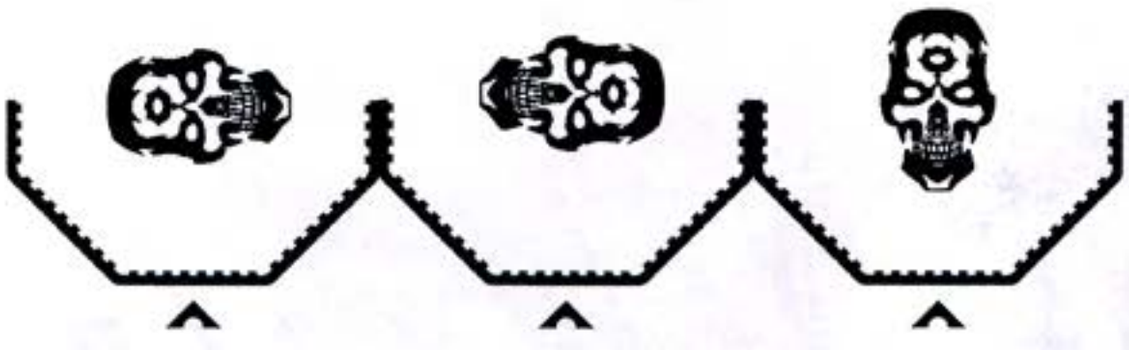
The hunchback lives in a small cave behind the hot springs. He is reluctant but makes the sleeping charm if you pay adequately.

You may pay 5 **Magic**. If you do, gain the **"Liberation"** part **5** status; each Party member gains 2.

Exploration ends.

16

Go to:



17

"Are you here to study the life and deeds of great Arthur too?" the man asks when you approach.

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **16** status, go to Verse 23. Otherwise, read on:

"I'm trying to figure out why there are so many contradictions to his story. He is the One and True King who ruled for centuries. He led our people to Avalon, and since then, rose from his slumber in times of need to protect humanity. There were always many witnesses to his deeds. But why hasn't he appeared even once in the last four-hundred years?" The man sighs and continues, "Don't mind me. I'm curious and old, so I can waste my time on futile studies. Don't waste yours – move on."

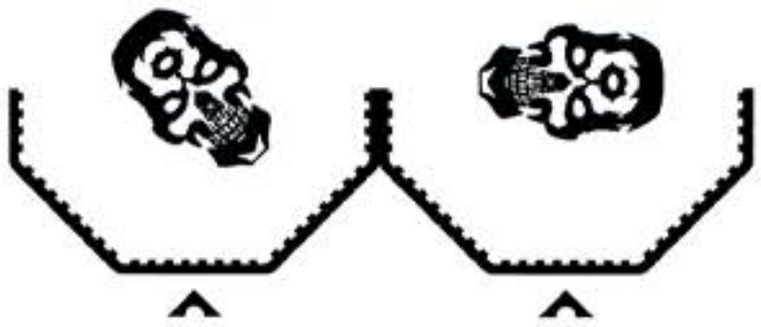
Go back to Verse 1.

18

Go to:

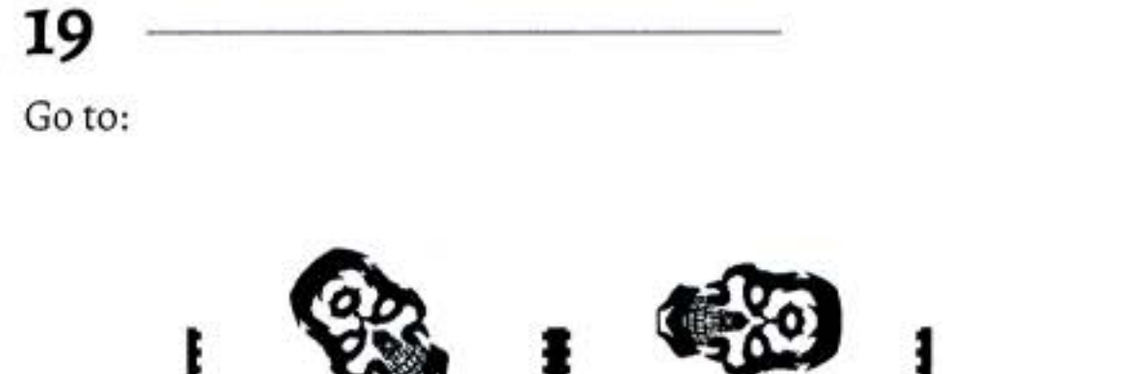
19

Go to:



20

Go to:

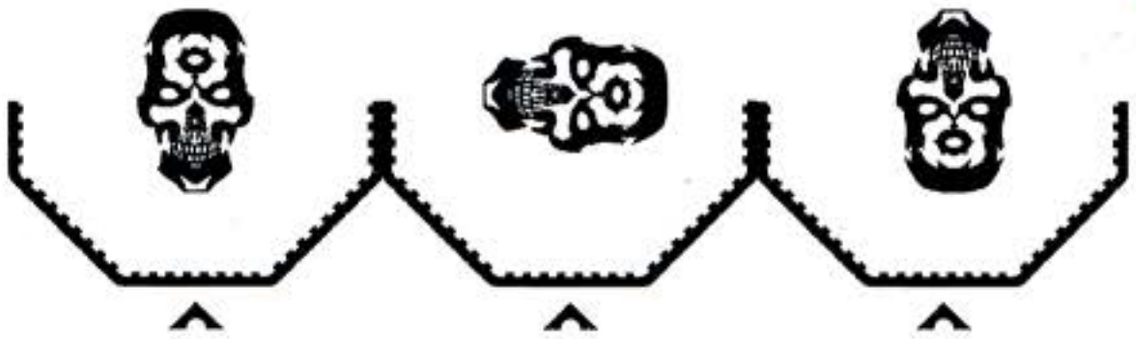


21

Go to:

22

Go to:



23

"I'm trying to figure out why there are so many contradictions to his story. Today, those who still remember Arthur believe him to be the greatest ruler ever. His monuments scattered throughout Avalon only reinforce this notion. But I found a chronicle written a decade after the conquest that indicates Arthur wasn't even the ruler back then. Apparently, there was a rebellion, and after his disastrous foray into Tuathan, the king was stripped of all powers and exiled, while a council of noble families ruled in his stead from a place called 'Tintagel'."

"Can you believe it? Mighty Arthur died in exile and disrepute, and only decades after his death, folk tales, legends, and dissident historians began to elevate him as a central figure of the golden age of Avalon."

You want to interrupt the man, but he doesn't give you a chance, consumed with his speculations.

"And here's where the thing gets really interesting. In the centuries to follow, the Round Table found a way to raise the king from the dead, whenever the land was in peril. Did they know they we're going to great lengths to bring back a ruler who never accomplished any of the grand things that were attributed to him?

The man sighs and continues, "Oh, I'm boring you to death. Don't mind me. I'm curious and old, so I can waste my time on futile studies. Don't waste yours – move on."

You nod your head and leave, but the words of the scholar stick with you. Could it be that many mighty heroes of the past were in reality just as fallible as you? Perhaps what you did so far will only grow in future retellings, placing you among great champions of this land?

It is a strange, but reassuring thought.

If you **don't have** the **"Lessons of the Past"** status, each Character gains 1 Exp and loses 1 . Gain the **"Lessons of the Past"** status and go back to Verse 1.

Dream

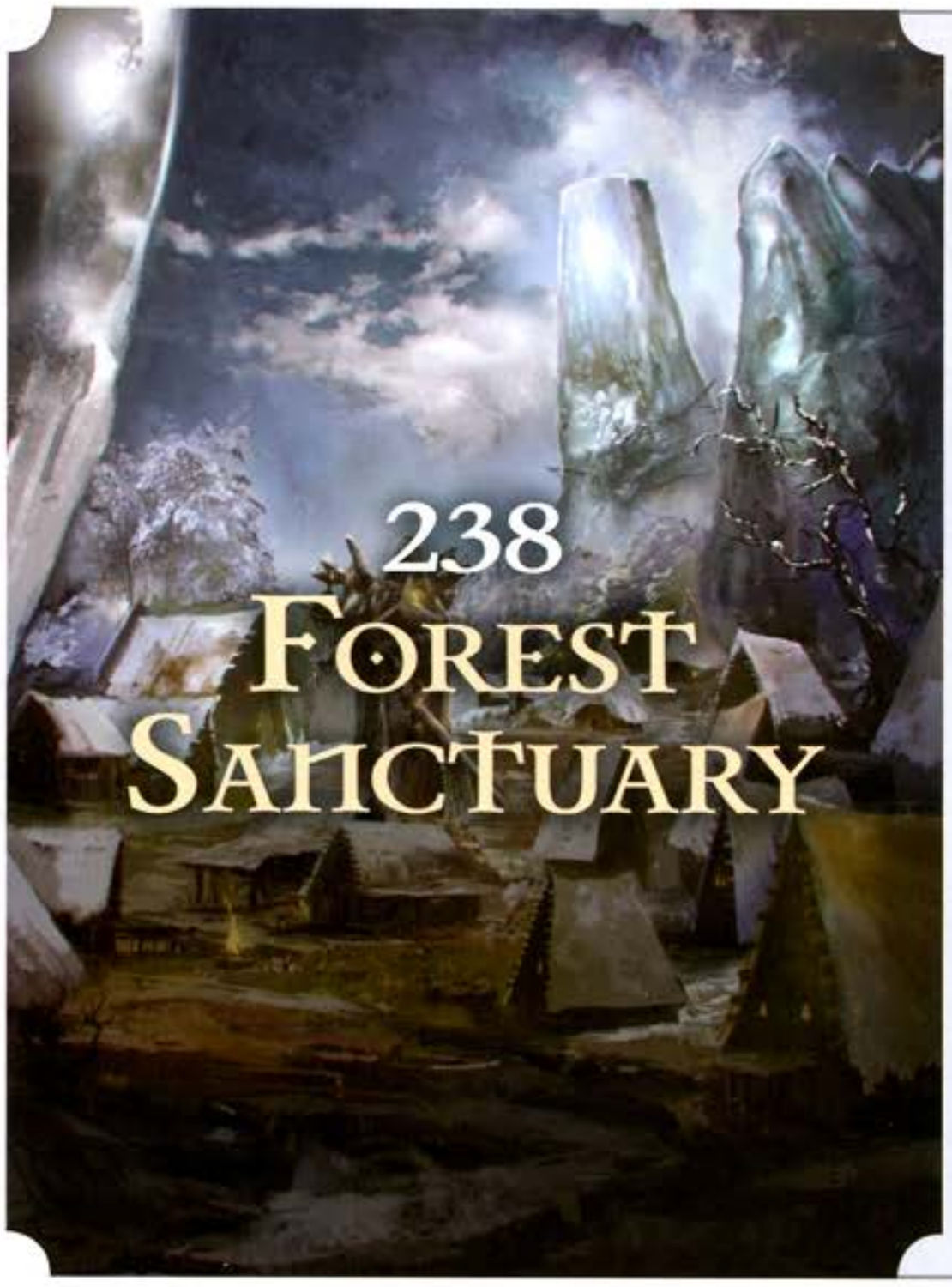
Priests and priestesses in snow-white robes light fragrant candles. Two men and two women, clad in steel, carry a body down the ramp into the Tombs of the Order. The deeds of this man will never be forgotten.

Each Character who has this Dream loses 1 .

Nightmare

The Order is dying. You see the last knights-errant wander the land, slowly succumbing to madness, wyrdness, and the cold. Soon, there will be no one left to protect Avalon from evil.

Each Character who has this Nightmare gains 1 .



Many years ago, a stray druid raised ice pillars around a dying village. They focus sunlight around the menhir, warming the area, allowing the settlement to flourish. People of this place advise you to avoid the deep woods, where the lost encounter strange, eerie creatures.

If you're playing **Chapter 5**, go to Verse 18.

If you're playing **Chapters 9-15** and you **don't have** the **"Cracked Sanctuary"** part **6** or **7** status, go to Verse 20.

If you **don't have** the **"Means of Survival"** part **8** status, go to Verse 17.

Otherwise, choose one:

- **Barter with people** – go to Verse 4.
- **Approach the menhir** – go to Verse 2.
- **Take a walk in the peaceful forest** (pay 2 per Party member) – go to Verse 5.
- **Talk with people about their problems** (requires at least 7 Rep) – go to Verse 3.
- **Look for a way to free the knight** (requires **Chapter 4**) – go to Verse 12.
- **Ask folks for help** (requires **Chapters 14-15**) – go to Verse 21.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

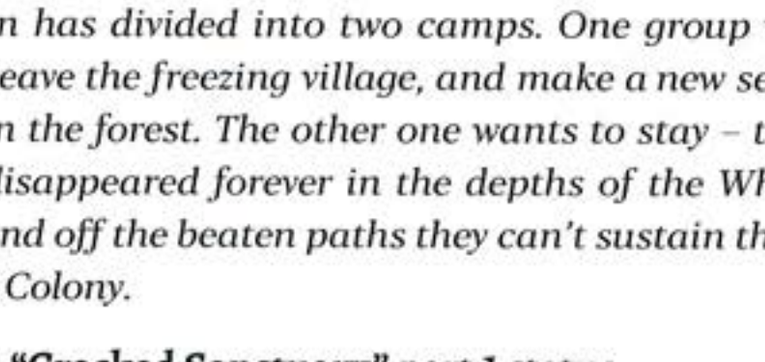
The town has divided into two camps. One group wants to gather, leave the freezing village, and make a new settlement deeper in the forest. The other one wants to stay – too many people disappeared forever in the depths of the Whispering Forest, and off the beaten paths they can't sustain their trade with the Colony.

Gain the **"Cracked Sanctuary"** part **1** status.

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **2** status, go to Verse 22.

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **9** status, go to Verse 23.

Otherwise, go to:



2

The statue in the center of the village is covered with runes describing the story of the Forest Sanctuary and its founder, a priestess of the Allmother. A small altar rests at the feet of the statue.

If you are **Mabd** and you **don't have** the **"Lost Apprentice"** part **2** status, go to Verse 16.

- **Try to sabotage the menhir** (requires the **"Chalk Horse"** part **3** status and Secret card **11**) – go to Verse 6.
- **Absorb the menhir's magic** (requires the **"Leaking Magic"** Secret card (**24**)) – go to Verse 10.
- **Carefully read the runes** (requires all Characters and **Chapter 10**; this will end your Chapter) – go to Verse 24.
- **Start carving** (requires all Characters and **Chapter 14**) – go to Verse 25.
- **Admire it and leave** – Exploration ends.

3

If you **have** the **"Cracked Sanctuary"** part **6** status, you already know everything about this settlement – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

If you **don't have** the **"Cracked Sanctuary"** part **1** status, go to Verse 1.

If you're playing **Chapters 3-4**, go to Verse 7.

If you're playing **Chapters 6-8**, go to Verse 19.

Otherwise, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

4

Hunters have a plethora of meat to sell, uncommon in these times, but their crafted tools and items are rather poor. Also, almost everyone complains about the lack of storytellers and excess of Allfather missionaries.

- **Haggle** (pay 6 Rep reduced by 1 for each point of your ; in a Party use only the highest value) – go to Verse 11.

- **Buy food** – pay 2 Wealth to gain 1 Food (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy equipment** – draw 2 Craftable Items. You can buy any number for 3 Wealth each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Buy magical trinkets** – pay 3 Wealth to gain 1 Magic (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy warming concoctions** – pay 4 Wealth to gain the **"Fiery Brew"** Secret card (**54**) (any number of times, as long as there is one available). Then, make another choice.
- **Sell equipment** – discard any number of non-Craftable Items and gain 1 Wealth for each. Then, make another choice.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

5

The forest feels wonderful. There's almost no snow or ice, the air is warmer, and the smell brings much-needed respite. Some plants even have green leaves, just like the great tree in the Mangrove Huddle – and it is the only tree you know with leaves instead of needles. Before you know it, the sun dips lower, and you must go back.

Each Party member gains 1 Magic and loses 2 .

If you're playing **Chapter 11**, go to:

Otherwise, Exploration ends.

6

If you **have** the **"Chalk Horse"** part **4** status, you already did it; Exploration ends.

Otherwise, read on:

People look at you suspiciously since your actions are quite unusual.

Resolve a blue Encounter. If you win or draw a **"Calm Before the Storm"** Encounter, go to:

Otherwise, Exploration ends.

7

If you **have** the **"Cracked Sanctuary"** part **2** or **3**, you did what you can; Exploration ends.

Otherwise, choose one:

- **Supply the expedition** (pay 2 Food per Character) – go to Verse 8.
- **Supply the people who want to stay** (pay 2 Wealth per Character) – go to Verse 9.
- **Leave them on their own** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

8

You donate some of your supplies. It suffices for sending scouts into the forest.

Each Party member gains 1 Exp and 1 Rep. Gain the **"Cracked Sanctuary"** part **2** status. Exploration ends.

9

You share some of your belongings with those who wish to stay in the Forest Sanctuary. They promise to use them well. First, they plan to negotiate with the Colony and get help warming the town.

Each Party member gains 1 Exp and 1 Rep. Gain the **"Cracked Sanctuary"** part **3** status. Exploration ends.

10

You meditate near the menhir, absorbing its energy. As you do, the shadows deepen, and the wind picks up.

Gain 1 Magic for each marker on the Menhir's base and discard all these markers. You may discard the **"Ritual Chalk"** or **"Wyrdstone Heart"** Items – each of these discarded cards grants you an additional 3 Magic.

Pay 3 Rep per Party member. If you can't, the Party resolves a blue Encounter. Exploration ends.

11

Although news travels slower than ever, the stories of your deeds must have reached the people here. This allows you to get better prices.

- **Buy food** – pay 1 Wealth to gain 1 Food (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy equipment** – draw 3 Craftable Items. You can buy any number for 3 Wealth each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Buy magical trinkets** – pay 3 Wealth to gain 2 Magic (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy warming concoctions** – pay 3 Wealth to gain the **"Fiery Brew"** Secret card (**54**) (any number of times, as long as one is available). Then, make another choice.
- **Sell equipment** – discard any number of non-Craftable Items and gain 3 Wealth for each. Then, make another choice.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

12

The situation is dire, and you look for help in every possible place.

- **Recruit a thief** (only if you don't have the **"Liberation"** part **6** status; pay 4 Rep and 2 Wealth) – go to Verse 13.
- **Pay for useful information** (only if you don't have the **"Clues"** part **3** status, pay 4 Wealth) – go to Verse 14.
- **Listen to gossip (pay 1**) – go to Verse 15.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

13

Finding a thief in a crumbling society isn't a challenge. She brags about her escapades to the Colony, where she stole trinkets and useful devices. She tells you what she knows.

Gain the **"Liberation"** part **6** status. Go back to Verse 12.

14

Your charm and coin encourage some to speak, but only one piece of information seems useful. You speak with the bastard of a Colony sergeant. He tells you in Colony only some are eligible to have children. Those who aren't are severely punished. You should pay this sergeant a visit.

Gain Secret card **9** and the **"Clues"** part **3** status. Go back to Verse 12.

15

Forest Sanctuary is full of rumors. You discard everything that seems irrelevant and are left with only two that sound useful. A strange man changed by the wyrdness lives near the hot springs to the west of town and is infamous for his magical artifacts. He's a hunchback, so you shouldn't have problems recognizing him. Also, in the White Fog, there are invisible advisors under the ice. It is said they tell you everything you want to know, but at a horrible price – your memories.

Gain the **"Clues"** part **2** status. Go back to Verse 12.

16

A youngster approaches you and asks if you are a wandering storyteller. You confirm, and he continues with his questions – do you know a young, beautiful girl also of this profession? And could you tell her that he's waiting? It's now your time to inquire – you find out that the girl was your apprentice, and she went somewhere west.

Mabd gains 1 Exp. Gain the **"Lost Apprentice"** part **2** status. Go back to Verse 2.

17

You are freezing to death – the journey through snow and ice was exhausting. People in the Forest Sanctuary seem to understand your struggle. They feed you and warm you by their hearths.

If there is a **Special Event A** in the Event Deck, replace it with **Special Event D**. Each Character on this Location card gains 2 Food and loses 2 Exposure. Gain the **"Means of Survival"** part **8** status. If you **have** the **"Riding Donkey," "Steadfast Palfrey,"** or **"Lucky Piglet"** Item, go to:

Otherwise, Exploration ends.

18

Because of the uproar in the Colony, no one wants anything to do with you.

Resolve the **"False Accusation"** blue Encounter (Difficulty 3). Don't gain any reward from this Encounter. Then, Exploration ends.

19

Go to:

20

Go to:

21

If you **have** the Secret card **63**, they already joined you – Exploration ends. Otherwise, read on:

You explain why you need help. Your reason isn't trivial – it concerns the fate of the entire island. It will probably be dangerous, and you need anyone willing to aid you. Despite your arguments and the well-being of Forest Sanctuary, its people are reluctant to help. For centuries, each settlement could only count on itself. Giving you their warriors and staying defenseless for the greater good is not an easy decision to make.

- **Pay them** (pay 5 Wealth and 3 Rep per Character) – gain Secret card **63**. Exploration ends.
- **Force them** (requires 4 ; pay 4 Rep per Character) – gain Secret card **63**. Exploration ends.
- **Leave** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

22

Go to:

23

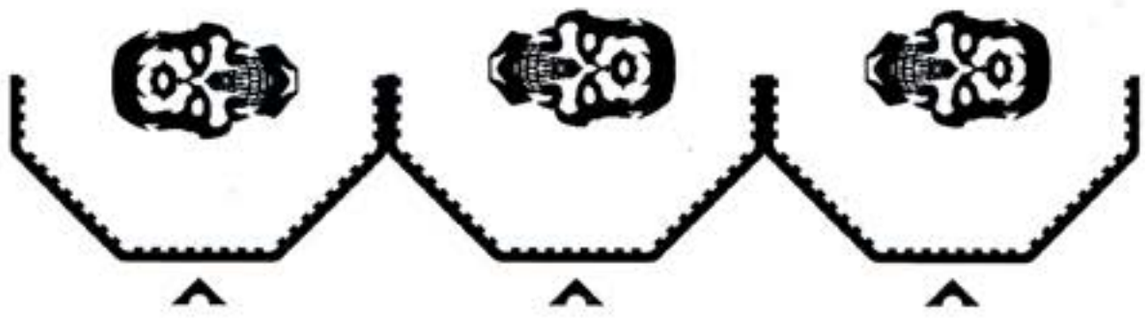
Go to:

24

Go to:

25

Go to:

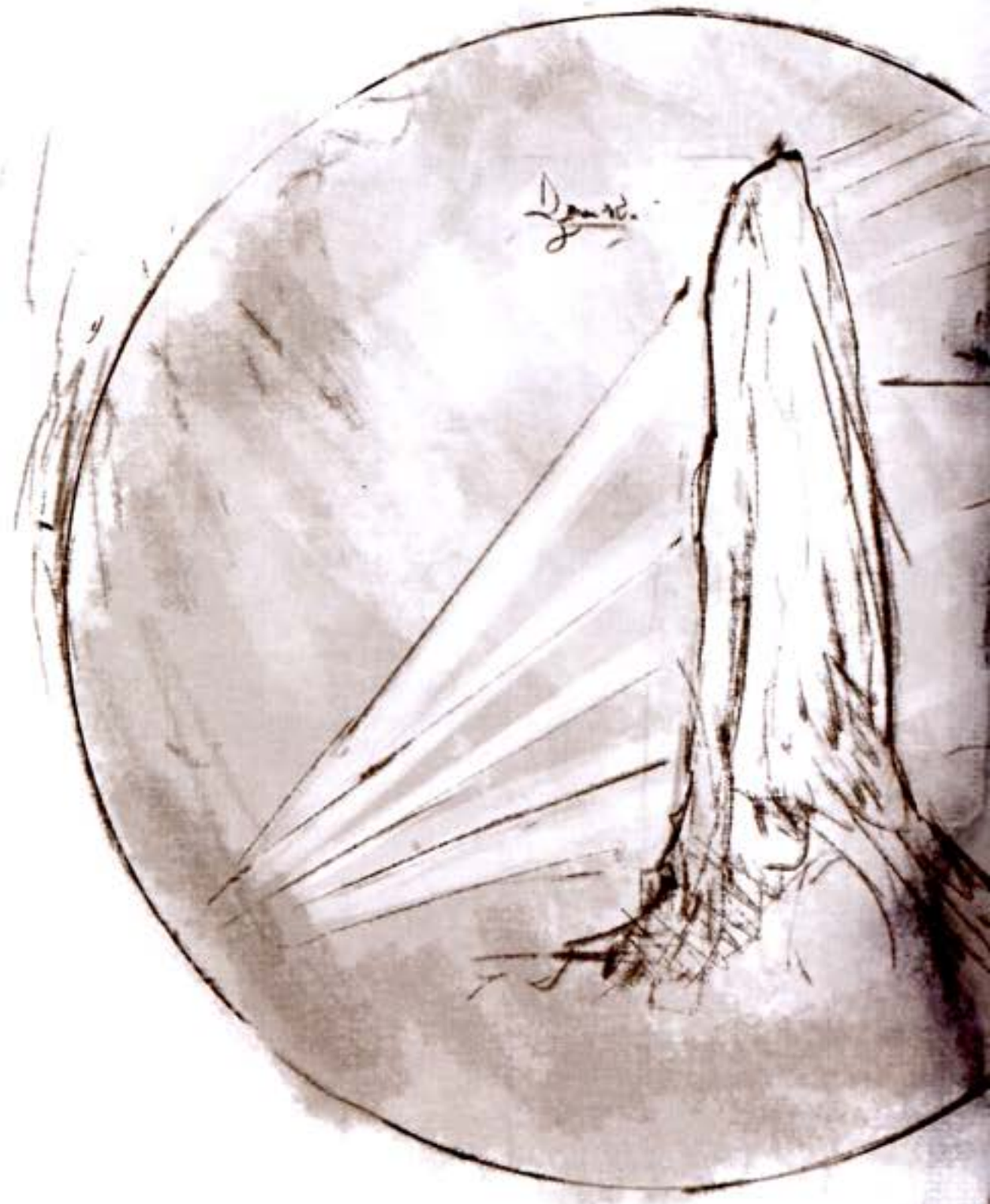


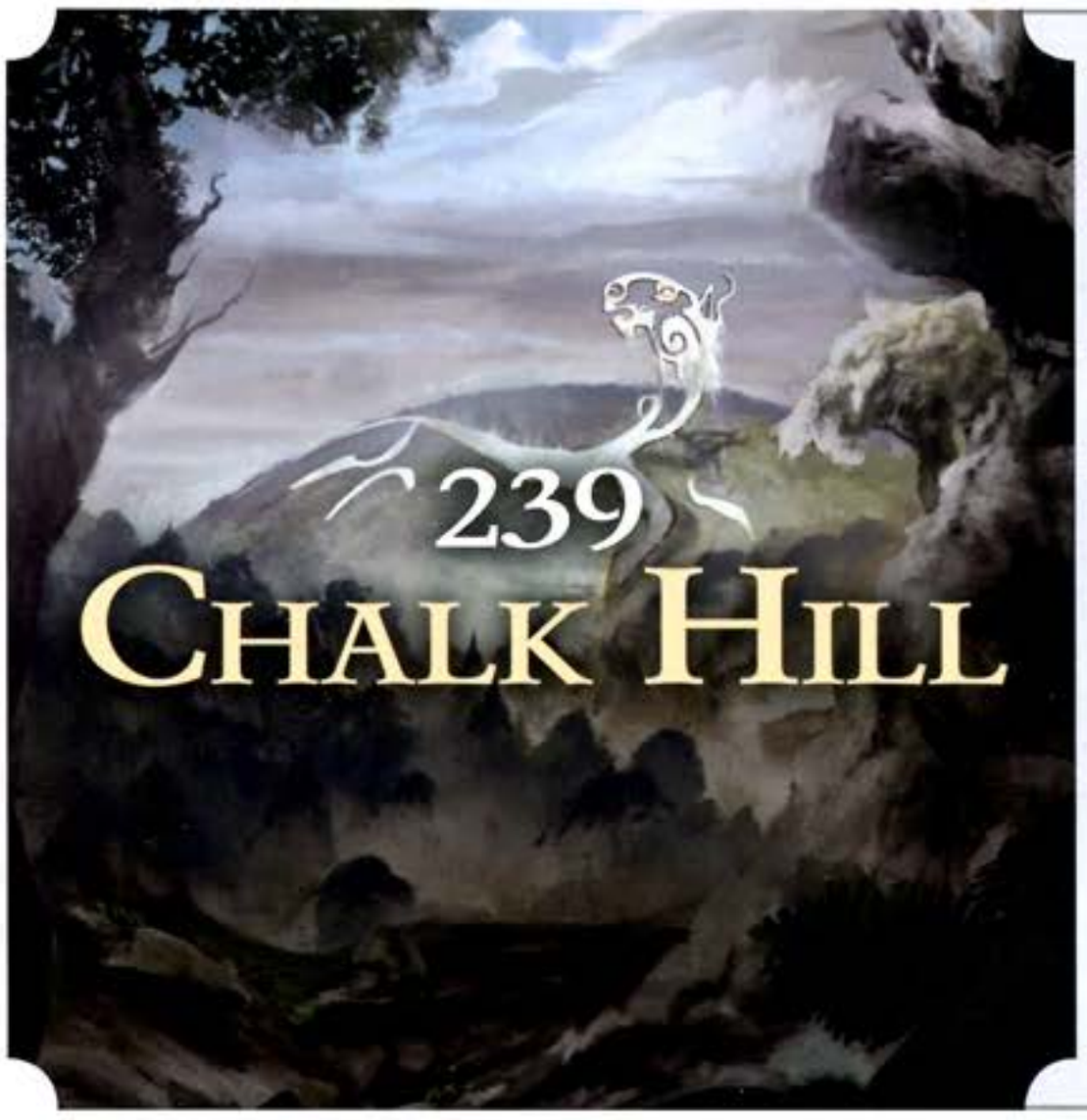
Menhir

Requires **all Characters** and the **Menhir Rites** Secret card (**11**).

Pay 3 , 1 Magic, and 1 (per Character): put a new Menhir model on this Location and set its Dial to **8** (-1 per Character).

If there aren't enough models left, take one from another Location of your choice.





239
Chalk Hill

If you're playing **Chapter 5**, go to Verse 3. Otherwise, read on:

You hear loud rumbling and whickering long before you emerge from the woods and see this barren hill, a place you would rather find in your dreams or nightmares than in reality. A horse silhouette of chalk struggles to emerge from the ground, creating severe tremors. Loud creaks draw your focus to a dilapidated cabin at the forest edge, swaying in the earthquake – and a stoic man drinking from a steaming cup.

- **Approach the horse head** – go to Verse 4.
- **Visit a ramshackle cottage** – go to Verse 9.
- **Search for clues** (requires **Chapter 11**) – go to Verse 1.
- **Visit Grovesoul** (requires all Characters and the **"Secrets of the Forest"** part **4** status) – go to Verse 5.
- **Retreat carefully** – Exploration ends.

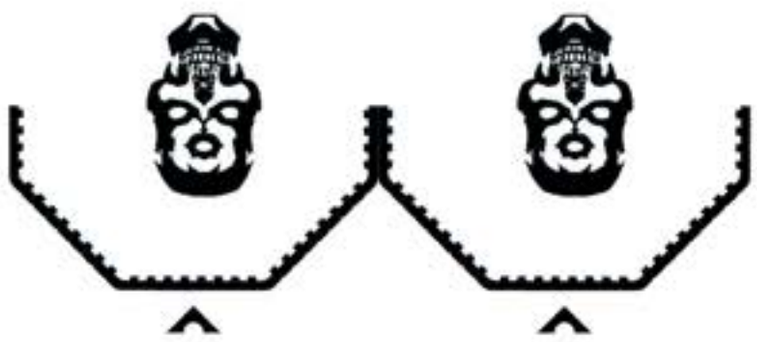
1

Go to:

2

The walk takes time, but you finally reach the horse's rear legs. Both look immovable and bound to earth and stone. The right one exhibits some features of the living flesh, trembling as the horse struggles. You should be able to rip it from the ground with focused magic.

- **Go back to the horse head** – go to Verse 4.
- **Investigate the left leg** (requires 2) – go to Verse 7.
- **Force the right hoof to move** (only if you don't have the **"Chalk Horse"** part **2** status; pay 4 Magic per Character) – go to:



3

There is a search party in the forest under the leadership of a mighty warrior from the Colony.

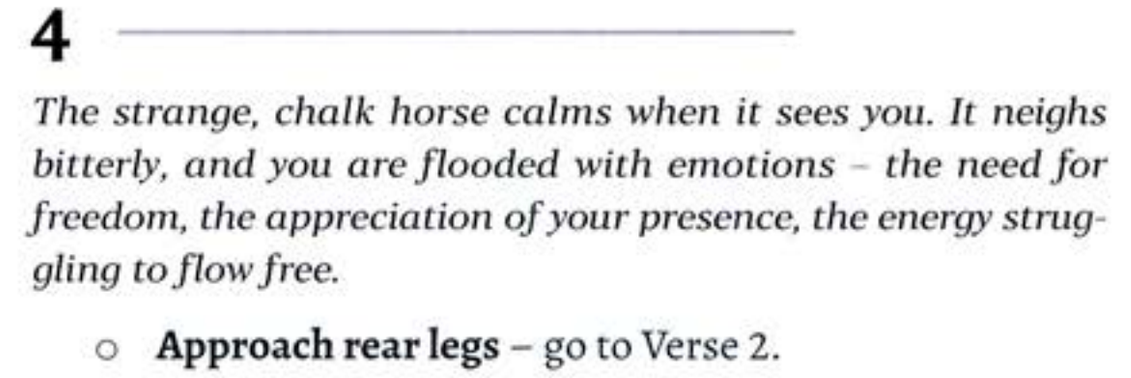
If you **have** 3 or more or , Exploration ends.

Otherwise, the scouting party notices you – resolve the **"Boudi"** gray Encounter (Difficulty 3). Lose 1 at the start of the first Activation in this Encounter. You can't Escape during the first Combat Turn. After the Encounter, Exploration ends.

4

The strange, chalk horse calms when it sees you. It neighs bitterly, and you are flooded with emotions – the need for freedom, the appreciation of your presence, the energy struggling to flow free.

- **Approach rear legs** – go to Verse 2.
- **Check the front leg** – go to Verse 6.
- **Free the chalk horse** (requires all 4 parts of the **"Chalk Horse"** status) – go to:



- **Ask about the priestess** (requires **Chapter 11**) – go to Verse 8.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

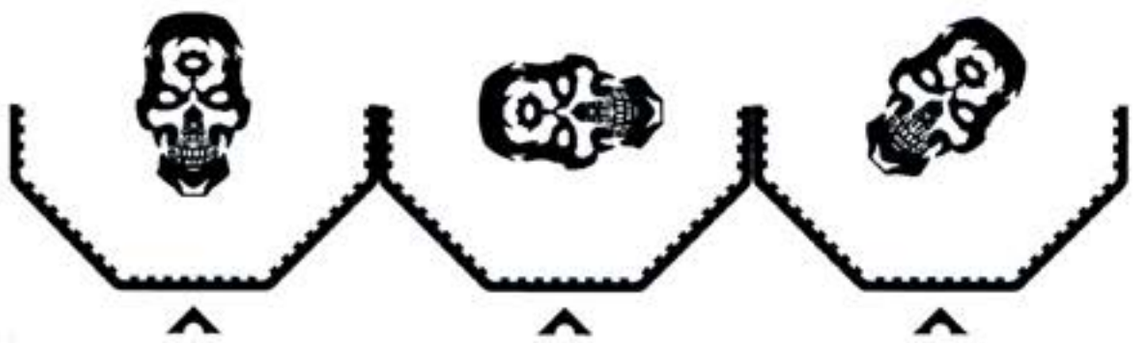
5

Go to:

6

The limb looks almost like a real horse's leg, but it's smaller and younger than the rest of the animal. You feel you could give it some of your life experience to help it grow and reach a fully adult state.

- **Go back to the horse's head** – go to Verse 4.
- **Help the leg grow** (only if you don't have the **"Chalk Horse"** part **1** status; pay 2 **Exp** per Character) – go to:



7

You discover this area is too close to the forest and the menhir in the south – wyrdness can't affect the reality here. You must find a way to let the wyrdness creep in even for a moment, and count on the horse to be able to free its leg during the time when all laws cease to apply.

Gain the **"Chalk Horse"** part **3** status. Exploration ends.

New Task: Gain knowledge about menhirs, then go to the Forest Sanctuary and sabotage its menhir.

8

The horse doesn't remember this woman. You feel that despite the age of its body, its mind is young. Its only desire is to be free.

Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

9

The hut is inhabited by a lunatic herbalist who sometimes speaks with the chalk horse. He's not interested in talking to you, but if you pay him, he treats your wounds.

Each Party member may pay a total of 2 **Wealth** and **Food** to gain 2 . Then, Exploration ends.

241 Sleeping Rocks

Low trees grow over a ruined cromlech. They house many animals, big and small, whose cries lure hunters and vagabonds from the western settlement. As you move toward the center of the stone circle, you notice more ovoid stones covered in worn runes. They lie scattered around randomly, as if fallen from the sky.

- **Enter the stone circle** – go to Verse 6.
- **Pass the mists to the Still River** – go to Verse 1.
- **Hunt** (pay 1) – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

If Location **235** is not attached to this card, you may pay 1 **Magic** (1 Character), 2 **Magic** (2-3 Characters) or 3 **Magic** (4 Characters) to attach Location **235** to the right edge of Location **241**.

If Location **235** is attached to this card, you may pay 1 per Party member to move all Party members to Location **241**. Then, Exploration ends.

If you didn't do the above, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

3

You scout the forest and catch small animals – they hide under the trees, scared by the storm raging to the southwest. Unfortunately, your activity draws the attention of something much bigger...

New Task: Investigate the storm to the southwest.

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-3 – gain 1 **Food**.

4-6 – gain 2 **Food**.

7+ – gain 3 **Food**.

Then, resolve a green Encounter. Exploration ends.

4

Following the ghost's instructions, you check if the elements needed for the ritual are present – they are. Now, you must put everything in order and muster some magic.

- **Rest between the stones** – each Party member loses 1 . Exploration ends.
- **Drag stones to the right places** (pay 5 reduced by each point of your ; in a Party use only the highest value) – gain the **"Missions"** part **5** status, then make another choice.
- **Adjust columns to magical ley lines** (pay 5 reduced by each point of your ; in a Party use only the highest value) – gain the **"Missions"** part **6** status, then make another choice.
- **Infuse the circle with magic** (requires the **"Missions"** part **5** and **6** status; pay 6 **Magic**) – go to:

6

You go through a leaning portal of three stone slabs and approach rocks scattered in the center of a ruined circle. There are many legends about this great druidic circle, as well as the druids themselves – vile warlocks performing bloody rituals for something they called the greater good.

- **Rest between the stones** – each Party member loses 1 . Exploration ends.
- **Prepare the ritual** (requires the **"Missions"** part **3** status) – go to Verse 4.

Dream

You slowly cut the throat of one the vagrants who dared burn your brethren. Magic in his blood drains into the stones, bringing you respite and filling you with power. From pain – strength. From death – life. This is the way of a druid.

Each Character who has this Dream gains 1 .

Nightmare

In the last moments of your life, you imagine the wonderful Moonring with its floating stones. Your body burns slowly, you choke on smoke, and your vision blurs. The hateful shouts of the crowd surrounding the cage ring in your ears. To think you could have escaped to Dark Morass and avoid this horrible end...

Each Character who has this Nightmare loses 1 .

242 Stone of Memories

Charred wooden bars protrude from the snow. You also discern outlines of stone roads beneath the ice. These trails lead toward a black stone surrounded by columns of ice. Writing covers both the stone and the columns – more or less readable. A stone's throw to the west, you spot a fur tent and a dead campfire under a layer of snow.

- **Approach the stone** – go to Verse 1.
- **Inspect the camp** – go to Verse 5.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

If you **don't have** the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **8** status, go to Verse 4.

If you are **Niamh** and **don't have** the **"Past"** part **2** status, go to Verse 11. Otherwise, read on:

Thousands of inscriptions cover the towering stone from its base to its top. You wonder how old they are.

- **Read about Avalon's history** – go to Verse 7.
- **Focus on runes about magic** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 2
- **Leave** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

2

You look for anything connected to the art of magic, but there isn't much information – most of the inscriptions are about trade deals, land disputes, or crimes. But experiencing the day-to-day lives of Avalon's past inhabitants is mystical in its own way.

Each Party member gains 1 Magic. Exploration ends.

3

The girl reluctantly shares her knowledge, which she gained studying the Stone of Memories.

If you **have** the Secret card **48**, go to Verse 13.

Otherwise, gain Secret card **52**. Exploration ends.

4

When you approach the boulder, something moves behind it. The creature, covered in ice and snow, stands and approaches. You ready your weapons, but then it speaks: "Wanderers? Seekers of truth?" You take a good look and discover it might be a human, probably a woman.

Gain the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **8** status.

- **Greet her** – go to Verse 6.
- **Attack!** – She must be a wyrdspawn. Go to Verse 10.

5

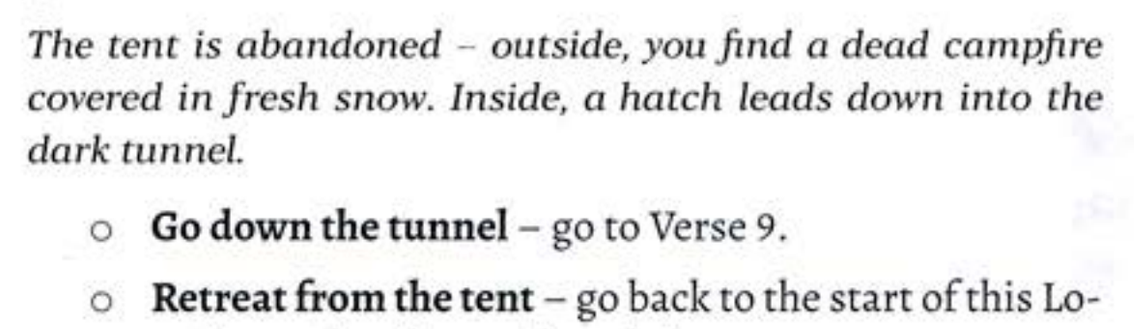
The tent is abandoned – outside, you find a dead campfire covered in fresh snow. Inside, a hatch leads down into the dark tunnel.

- **Go down the tunnel** – go to Verse 9.
- **Retreat from the tent** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

6

You greet the strange creature, feeling an unnatural cold coming from its body. "You're welcome here until you do something to disrespect the knowledge gathered in this place."

Each Party member gains 1 Exposure. If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **14** status, go to:



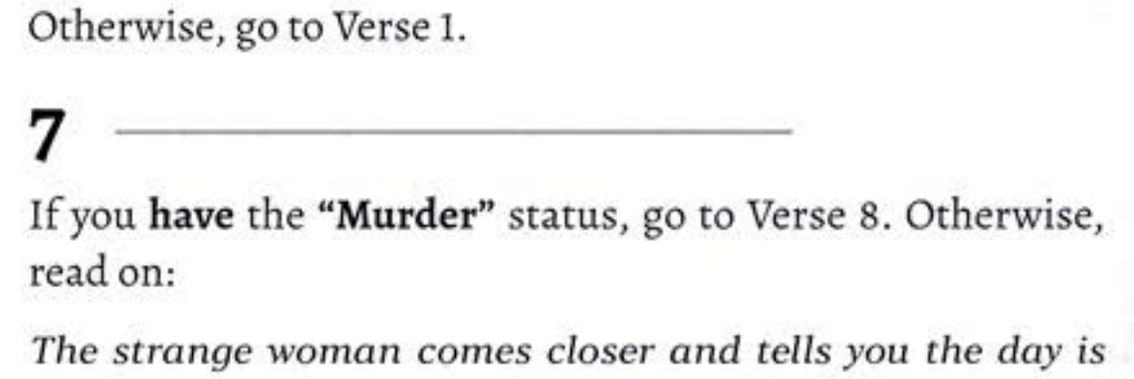
Otherwise, go to Verse 1.

7

If you **have** the **"Murder"** status, go to Verse 8. Otherwise, read on:

The strange woman comes closer and tells you the day is too short for you to find anything meaningful on your own. She studied this rock for years, and she tells you the history of Avalon.

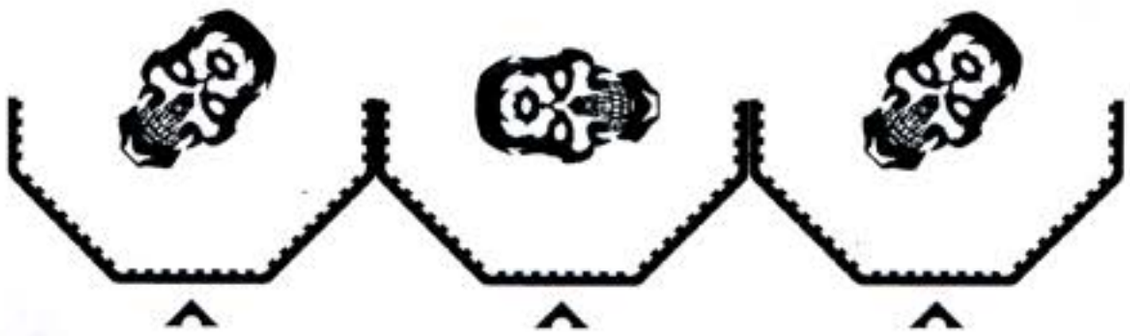
Go to:



8

You don't know where to start. The large boulder? Ice pillars? Some texts are even scribbled on pieces of rough leather.

- **Back down** – go back to Verse 1.
- **Read about Avalon anyway (pay 4)** – go to:



9

As you delve deeper, the air warms. Soon, you enter a pleasant cave covered in glowing runes radiating with heat. A lone, amber-eyed girl sits in the center surrounded by scrolls.

If you are **Mabd** and you **don't have** the **"Lost Apprentice"** part **3** status, go to Verse 12.

Otherwise, choose one:

- **Learn the warming runes** (requires all Characters; pay 2 Exp per Character) – go to Verse 3.
- **Speak for a while and leave** – *She is too immersed in her studies of the past to dedicate time to you.* Exploration ends.

10

You assault the monster, which is slow to react. You heave it back against the rock. With a faint sigh, the creature cracks and falls apart, as if made entirely of ice. Dark, thick blood slowly seeps from its shattered body.

Gain the **"Murder"** status. Go to Verse 1.

11

If you **have** the **"Murder"** status, go to:

Otherwise, go to:

12

Seeing your young apprentice alive and well fills your heart with untold joy. You hug each other, as you tell her the places you have traveled to find her. A moment later, while sharing a warm herbal tea, you learn the girl is content here and doesn't plan to move. She always yearned for stories from the past, and the Stone of Memories provides more than you ever could.

After a long while, the time comes to part ways. The girl looks at your horn and notices it's badly worn. She offers you hers, as she doesn't need it anymore. It is a splendid instrument you found for her a long, long time ago. You accept it with gratitude, hoping it will remind you of her wherever the path might take you.

As you prepare to depart, the girl smiles and says:

"Teacher, one last thing before you leave. There is an inscription I came upon here, from twenty years ago. A tale of a brave storyteller who travelled with her amber-eyed infant daughter."

She leaves the question unasked, and you're grateful for this. Trying hard to stop the tears, you answer:

"You should know it's impossible. The wyrd-covered trails are no good for a child, and the tradition forbids it. Only orphans may become storytellers."

She stands silent for a while before she finally nods and lets you go. You will not forget the warmth of her parting smile until the end of your days.

Mabd gains 2 Exp, Secret card **94**, and loses all . Gain the **"Lost Apprentice"** part **3** status. Go back to Verse 9 and make another choice.

13

Go to:

243 Fractured Tower

A single tower stands against the skyline, its shattered spire resting at the foot of a hill. The tower appears in many legends and paintings – as a meeting place, backdrop to a scene, or as the setting of a battle. No one knows its original purpose, but it must be related to the Tuathan wall looming to the west. Strange beasts prowling the surrounding woods certainly come from this ancient city.

- **Try finding a way up the tower** – go to Verse 5.
- **Explore the woods** (only if you don't have the **"Mysteries and Visions"** part **9** status) – go to Verse 1.
- **Meet the Lady** (requires **Chapter 8**) – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

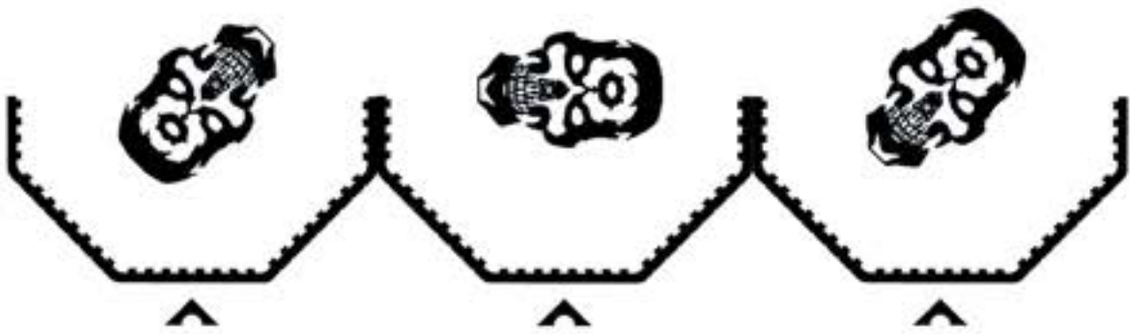
1

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-2 – *Why are you starting to slip...?* Go to Verse 6.

3-6 – *There are no animals nor anything else.* Exploration ends.

7+ – *Something catches your attention.* Go to:



2

You stand at the feet of the broken tower. The main gate barely hangs on rusted hinges – it stands slightly ajar, and you see mostly debris inside.

- **Enter** – go to Verse 7.
- **Walk around the tower** – go to Verse 9.
- **Go down the hill** – Exploration ends.

3

You meet Pale Lady at the foot of the hill. The Fractured Tower is the only witness to your reunion. The Fore-dweller looks at a gap in Tuathan's wall and asks you if you are ready to enter the ancient capital of her race.

- **Not yet** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.
- **Yes** (requires all Characters; this will end your Chapter) – go to:

5

You stand in the hill's shadow, looking for a way to ascend. There is one narrow, dangerous path to the top. You're not sure if you have the courage to follow it.

- **Take the path** (only if the lowest in the Party is 2 or more) – go to Verse 8.
- **Retreat** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

6

Resolve the **"Snow Antlion"** green Encounter (Difficulty 4). Then, Exploration ends.

7

If you **don't have** the **"Horrors"** part **7** status, go to:

Otherwise, read on:

The tower's interior is difficult to navigate, but there is nothing to find here anyway. Detailed wall paintings are the only things left intact, depicting brave knights fighting Fore-dwellers and duelling on the fighting grounds. Their scenes of past glory at least raise your spirits.

Each Party member loses 1 . Then, Exploration ends.

8

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-3 – *Bravery wasn't enough to go up the path – you slipped on ice and hurt yourself.* Each Party member loses 1 and 1 . Go back to Verse 5.

4-6 – *The trail is harsh, but you manage to arrive at the foot of the tower.* Each Party member loses 1 . Go to Verse 2.

7+ – *You notice convenient footholds, and your travel is quite easy.* Go to Verse 2.

9

The view from the hill is beautiful, with the high wall of Tuathan to the west and a giant stone head to the south. Northeast from here, a single island stands against the waves, a ruined city atop it. But the area near the tower is stripped of anything useful.

Go back to Verse 2.

New Task: Search the ruined city in the northeast.

244 Howling Nest

Stone and iron pegs anchor shaky rope bridges connecting the cliff to the ruin-covered island. It looks like a stone nest sitting atop an inaccessible rock, surrounded by raging waters. To make the impression ghastlier, the wind carries howls and shrieks from this direction. You wouldn't be surprised if it was home to the Black Drifter.

- **Go through the bridge** (requires 2) – go to Verse 1.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

The bridge sways as cruel wind lashes your skin, carrying frigid water from below. The island isn't much better – miserable howling echoes from ruined buildings and holes in the ground.

Each Party member gains the 1 Exposure.

- **Explore the ruins** – go to Verse 6.
- **Descend underground** – go to Verse 4.
- **Leave the cursed island** – Exploration ends.

2

Without warning, something strikes you in the back. Struggling to regain balance, you turn to face an intimidating creature.

Resolve the **"Child of Morrigan"** gray Encounter (Difficulty 5). If you win (or the Enemy Runs Away), go to Verse 9. Otherwise, Exploration ends.

4

If you **have** the **"Resentful Goddess"** status, go to Verse 10.

If you **have** the **"Horrors"** part **8** status, go to Verse 7.

Otherwise, go to:

5

The goddess exchanges some words of courtesy with you, but she doesn't have much time, focused on performing some strange rituals.

If you are playing **Chapters 14-15** and **don't have** the Secret card **98**, go to Verse 12.

Otherwise, go back to Verse 7 and make another choice.

6

The life of this city must have revolved around the central building, probably a temple. It looks impressive, but it's as empty as every ruin in this damned place.

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-5 – go to Verse 2.

6+ – go to Verse 8.

7

You enter the underground city without hesitation – you are favored by their goddess, after all. Unsettling residents don't approach – they only track you with their eyes.

- **Meet the goddess** – go to Verse 11.
- **Sell food** – pay 1 Food to gain 1 Wealth (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy inventory** (each Party member gains 1) – *These items belonged to prey of Morrigan's children.* Draw the top 3 Item cards. You can buy any number for 3 Wealth each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

8

You hear a rustling and hide behind the crumbled wall. An intimidating creature with gray skin and broad ears passes with sharp blades in its hands. You wait for a moment and take another route.

Go to Verse 9.

9

After searching the city for a long time, you only find some abandoned baubles.

Each Party member gains 1 Wealth. Exploration ends.

10

You're ambushed as soon as you step foot on the stairs leading down. The fight is out of question – too many of Morrigan's Children spring out of the dark. They drag you to the edge of the island and throw you into the raging waters.

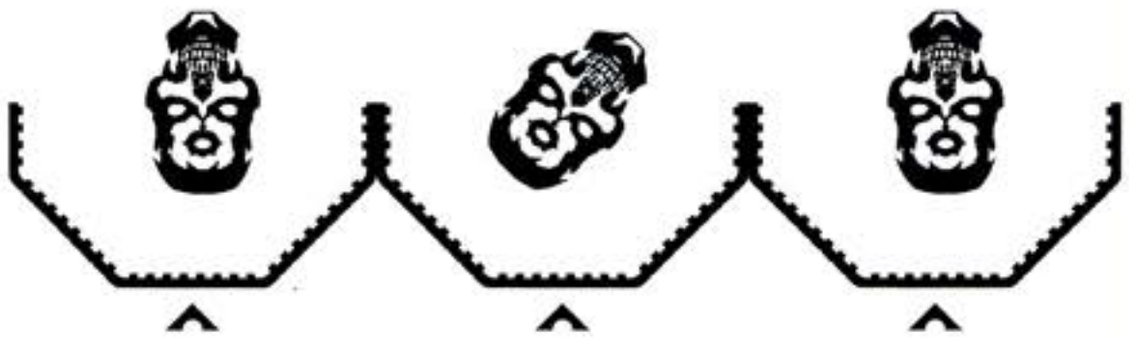
You're not sure how you still live, but you must avoid the ice floes and somehow get back to the mainland.

Each Party member loses 4 , gains 4 and gains 4 Exposure. Then, Exploration ends.

11

If you **have** the **"Missions"** part **9** status, go to Verse 5.

If you **have** the Secret card **16**, go to:



Otherwise, Morrigan doesn't want to speak with you – Exploration ends.

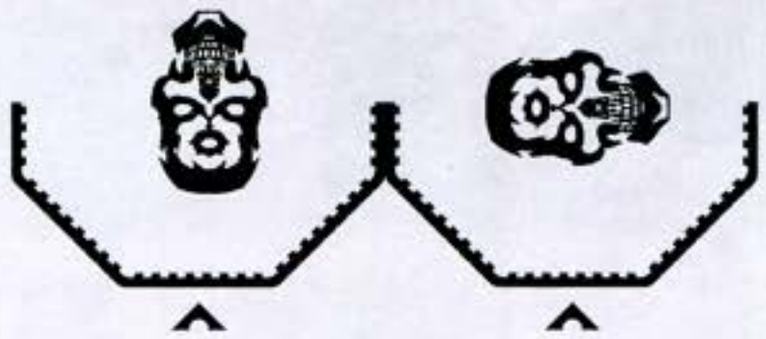
12

Before you open your mouth, Morrigan tells you that she will help you, as you have helped her. She knows that you're doing what you think is best for the island. Although in the past she was bitterly betrayed by humans, she lends you her best warriors, who will help you in upcoming battles.

- **Accept her offer** – gain Secret card **98**. Exploration ends.
- **Refuse** – Exploration ends.

Dream & Nightmare

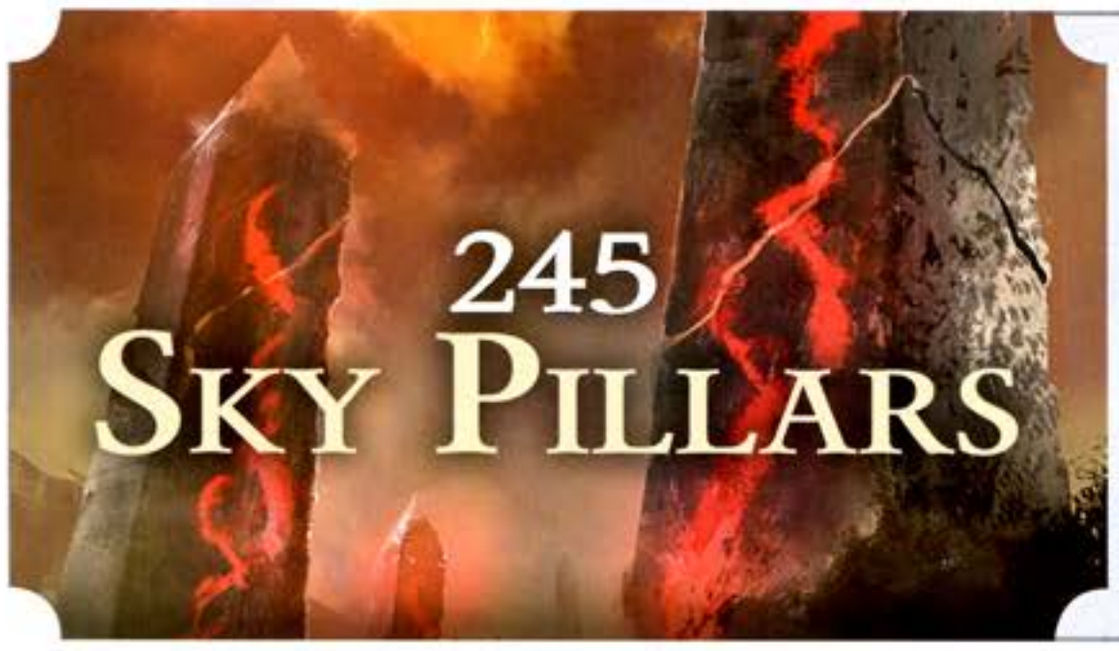
If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **3** status, go to:



Otherwise, read on:

Your life is full of darkness that aches more than it should, since you know there is still a world of light somewhere above. You carry many burdens, but knowing that because of your bitterness, your children have turned into monsters, is the heaviest.

Each Character who has this Dream or Nightmare gains 1 .



245
Sky Pillars

A storm rages above, resounding with thunder and illuminated by lightning. It's the most powerful storm you've ever seen, but no raindrops or snowflakes reach the ground – five dark obelisks hold the dome of the tempest above them like pillars, not allowing it descend below a certain point. There is nothing else here, besides the pillars, and a clearly visible entrance to some den or cave.

- **Investigate obelisks** – go to Verse 4.
- **Go inside the den** – go to Verse 6.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

If you **have** 2 parts of the **"Pillars' Magic"** status, go to Verse 3.

Red runes glow with an ominous light. Powerful magic overwhelms your body and mind.

Gain 4 Magic. Add 1 mark to the **"Pillars' Magic"** status. Then, Exploration ends.

2

You rest in the den, sheltered from the chill wind and other threats. But it's still frigid, so you must move on.

Each Party member loses 1 and gains 1. Exploration ends.

3

Go to:

4

Black, glossy stone carved with red runes peeks out from under the snow. The obelisks are so tall, they pierce the raging storm above.

If you **have** 3 or more , go to Verse 7. Otherwise, you have no idea how the obelisks can be of any use – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

6

You carefully enter the hole. You must stoop so low you almost burn your face with your own torch.

If you **have** the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **9** status, go to Verse 2. Otherwise, go to:

7

You cannot read the runes, but you sense ancient magic slumbering in these stone structures. You're sure it is connected to blood and death, and – somehow – to the storm above. It won't be entirely safe, but you think you can steal some of their power.

- **Extract magic** (pay 1) – go to Verse 1.
- **Leave** – *It's better not to meddle with mysterious powers.* Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

Dream

A funeral procession approaches a grave with a black tombstone. Your small, four-armed masters wait for you, preparing a rite to send your sister's soul into the sky. The fierce giantess fell to the sunwyrm a fortnight ago. You will miss her, but at least she had a good death. And now, her spirit leaves this world — a bright light shooting into the clouds.

Each Character who has this Dream gains 1 Magic.

Nightmare

Three great armies clash on fields between dark obelisks. The ground can't drink any more blood, so it collects in puddles several feet deep. None who fight here see the souls of the fallen rapidly escaping their bodies, drawn into the black monuments overlooking the battle.

Each Character who has this Nightmare loses 1.

246 Weeping Watcher

You approach a monumental stone head, its cheeks, eyes, and mouth marked with ice. Many pale-skinned people bustle around the head, tending small gardens and animal pens full of fat foxes, domesticated boars, and puffins with clipped wings. The entrance is colorfully decorated, and inside you find a silent settlement full of calm people – most have their eyes closed, pursed lips, and small, almost non-visible noses. The place is cozy, if unnerving.

If there is a Fore-dweller model or Time Token on this Location, go to Verse 1.

Otherwise, go to Verse 14.

1

If you're playing **Chapters 14-15**, go to Verse 16.

Otherwise, choose one:

- **Visit the market** – go to Verse 13.
- **Look for work** – go to Verse 7.
- **Use the service of heat mages** (pay 2 Wealth per Party member) – *They will treat your exposure.* Go to Verse 4.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

2

The Weeping Watcher looks permanent, but it needs regular maintenance – wyrdstone changes shapes and flows slowly, producing new crevices in the walls that must be sealed.

Each Party member gains 1 Rep for each point of their . Then, gain the **"Friends"** part **2** status. If you **have** parts **2**, **3**, and **4** of the **"Friends"** status, go to Verse 8. Otherwise, Exploration ends.

3

Go to:

4

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **5** status, go to Verse 9. Otherwise, read on.

You cross a room with a high ceiling and reach a chapel. The murals on its walls depict a four-armed woman leading a group of travelers toward a stylized skull before a sea of wyrdness. The mage who looks after this place performs a short ritual, and the cold leaves your body.

Each Party member discards the Exposure Marker. Exploration ends.

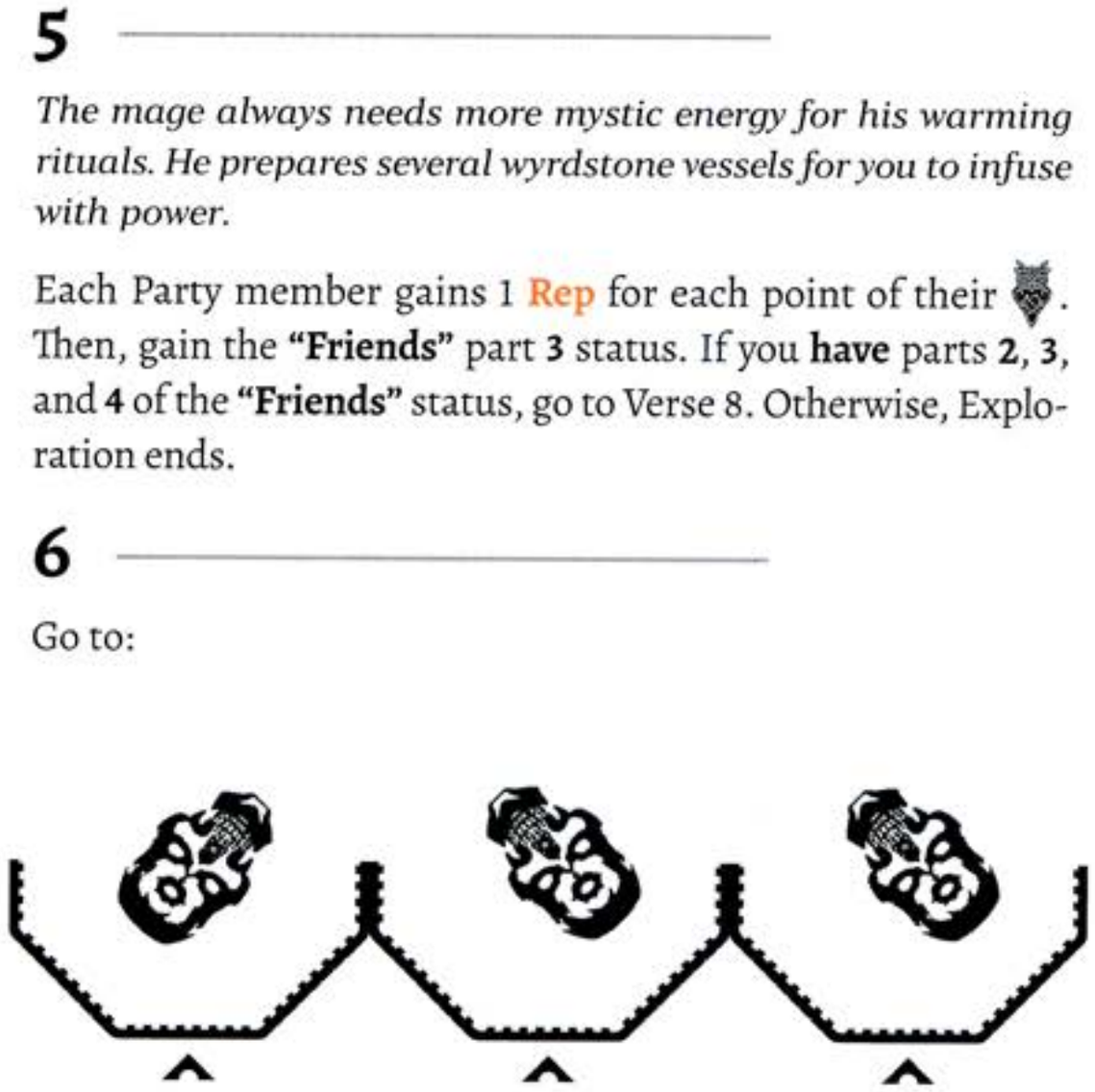
5

The mage always needs more mystic energy for his warming rituals. He prepares several wyrdstone vessels for you to infuse with power.

Each Party member gains 1 Rep for each point of their . Then, gain the **"Friends"** part **3** status. If you **have** parts **2**, **3**, and **4** of the **"Friends"** status, go to Verse 8. Otherwise, Exploration ends.

6

Go to:



7

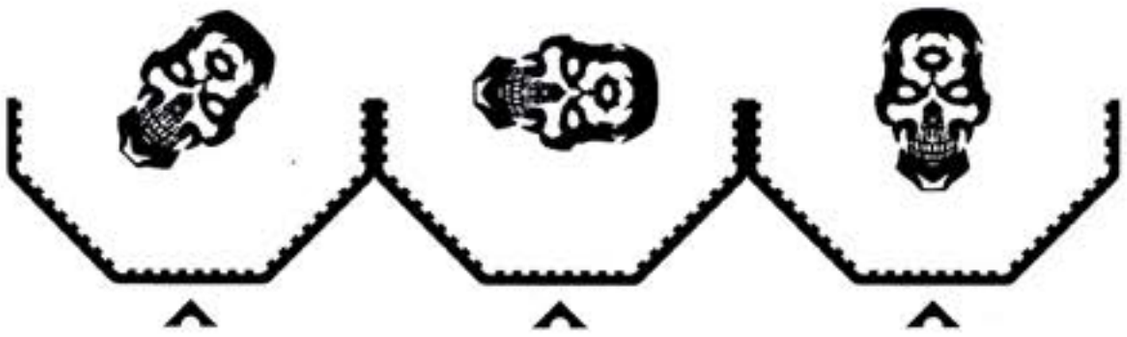
You ask around to see if anyone needs help and is willing to pay for it. There aren't many offers. Weeping Watcher apparently copes well, but still a few people shyly approach.

- **Aid with the settlement maintenance** (only if you don't have the **"Friends"** part **2** status; pay 2) – gain 1 Wealth and go to Verse 2.
- **Supply the mage with power** (only if you don't have the **"Friends"** part **3** status; pay 3 Magic) – gain 1 Wealth and go to Verse 5.
- **Get herbs from the forest** (only if you don't have the **"Friends"** part **4** status; pay 2) – gain 1 Wealth, each Party member gains 1 Exposure. Go to Verse 11.
- **Don't do any of this** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

8

As you prepare to leave, a bald woman stops you. She tells you they owe a debt of gratitude for your many good deeds, and they didn't compensate you fairly. She, together with some others, wants to make it up to you.

Go to:



9

You enter a small chapel with four statues of ancient heroes in the corners. The mage performs a short ritual and gives you a blessing of Avalon's guardians.

Each Party member gains 1, loses 1, and discards the Exposure Marker. Exploration ends.

10

Negotiations are strange – the merchant asks you to stay silent and stares at you intently for a while. Then, he tells you that he will lower his prices.

- **Sell food** – pay 1 **Food** to gain 1 **Wealth** (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy equipment** – draw the top 3 Item cards. You can buy any number of them for 3 **Wealth** each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sell equipment** – discard any number of Item cards and gain 2 **Wealth** for each of them. Then, make another choice.
- **Buy warming mixtures** – pay 3 **Wealth** to gain the **"Fiery Brew"** Secret card (**54**). Then, make another choice.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

11

Remembering the shapes of specific herbs, you wander into the freezing forest. The snow is deep, trees cast dark shadows, and the herbs are hard to spot. You go back, shivering with cold, but with a pouch full of remedies.

Each Party member gains 1 **Rep** for each point of their . Then, gain the **"Friends"** part **4** status. If you **have** parts **2**, **3**, and **4** of the **"Friends"** status, go to Verse 8. Otherwise, Exploration ends.

12

If you **have** the Secret card **57**, they already joined you – Exploration ends. Otherwise, read on:

You explain why you need help – you must finish your quest to save Avalon. It's extremely dangerous, and you need everyone willing to aid you. People here respect you, but they despise violence and are not eager to fight.

- **Pressure them** (pay 4 **Rep** per Character) – gain Secret card **57**. Exploration ends.
- **Accept their decision** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

13

It's the strangest market you've ever seen – everyone exchanges goods without a word, no one shouts or tries to beguile others into buying their wares. However, as soon as you approach the traders, they speak with you eagerly – mainly asking about the situation in other towns, as storytellers don't reach Weeping Watcher anymore.

- **Haggle to get better prices** (pay 8 **Rep** reduced by 1 for each point of your ; in a Party use only the maximum value) – go to Verse 10.
- **Sell food** – pay 1 **Food** to gain 1 **Wealth** (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy equipment** – draw the top 2 Item cards. You can buy any number of them for 4 **Wealth** each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sell equipment** – discard any number of Item cards and gain 1 **Wealth** for each of them. Then, make another choice.
- **Buy warming mixtures** – pay 4 **Wealth** to gain the **"Fiery Brew"** Secret card (**54**), if available. Then, make another choice.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

14

Roll a die and add 3 if there is an Active Menhir in this Location. Subtract the value of your . Check your final result:

1-5 – go to Verse 1.

6+ – place a Time Token on this Location and go to Verse 15.

15

Pale people hide within the marble head as the black beast approaches. According to legend, the Drifter brings wyrdness and plague.

Go to:

16

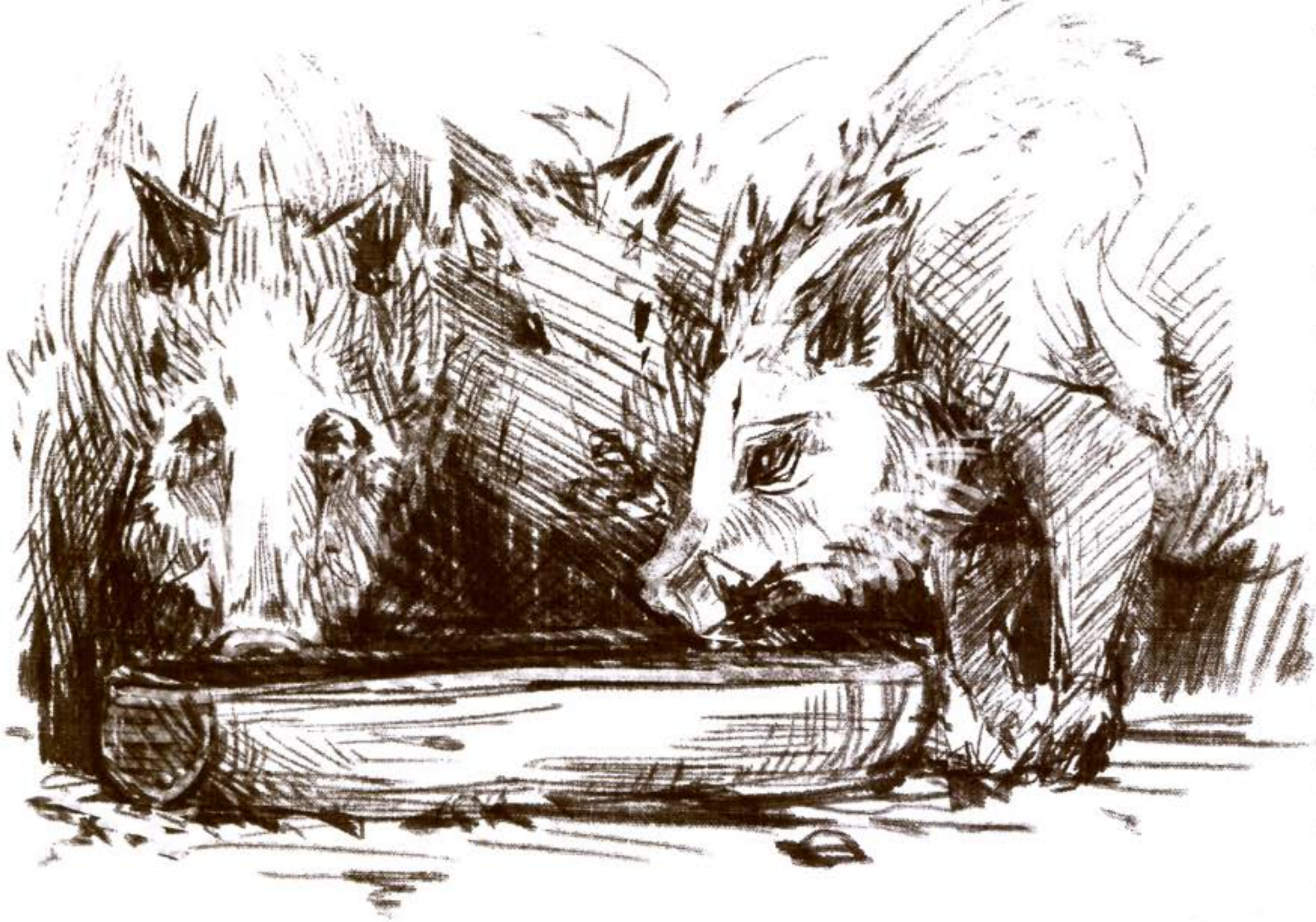
- **Visit the market** – go to Verse 13.
- **Look for work** – go to Verse 7.
- **Use the service of heat mages** (pay 2 Wealth per Party member) – *They will help cure your exposure.* Go to Verse 4.
- **Use your knowledge and tools** (requires all Characters, **Chapter 14**, and the **"Decision"** part **2** or **3** status) – go to Verse 3.
- **Meet the Pale Lady** (requires all Characters, **Chapter 15**, and the **"Decision"** part **1** or **5** status) – go to Verse 6.
- **Ask them to join you** (requires **Chapters 14-15** and the Secret card **96**) – go to Verse 12.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

Menhir

Requires **all Characters** and the **Menhir Rites** Secret card (**11**).

Pay 2, 1, 1 Wealth (per Character): put a new Menhir model on this Location and set its Dial to **8** (-1 per Character).

If there aren't enough models left, take one from another Location of your choice.



251
Gruesome Display

You enter a Fore-dweller city and immediately want to turn back – symmetrical buildings with glass walls brim with motionless people, animals, and even Fore-dwellers. Most look normal, while others don't have skin or even flesh – you see their insides as clearly as the fear in their lidless eyes. As you delve deeper, some of this sick exhibition moves to the outside, forcing you to walk between corpses embalmed in different poses.

If you **have** Secret card **97** and **don't have** the **"Keeper"** part **1** status, go to Verse 1.

If you **don't have** the **"Tuathan"** status, go to Verse 3.

Otherwise, each Party member gains 1. Choose one:

- **Explore the display** – go to Verse 2.
- **Gather food from animal bodies** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 4.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

You hear a grim voice inside your head: "We're almost there. The heart of this necropolis lies south-west from here. Make haste!"

Gain the **"Keeper"** part **1** status. Then, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

2

You look around, absorbing the horrible sights. You feel sick, unprepared for such atrocities. It looks like someone was studying humans and built an entire city of their anatomical displays.

Each Party member gains 1. If you **don't have** the **"Dismay"** part **1** status, each Party member gains 1 Exp; gain the **"Dismay"** part **1** status.

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **6** status, go to Verse 8. Otherwise, Exploration ends.

3

Suddenly, you realize you're inside Tuathan, the infamous Fore-dweller city where monsters dwell, with wyrdness so thick and deadly it kills in a heartbeat. But what you see around you is nothing like the stories. The sights are alien and strange, but not horrific. The wyrdness doesn't seem so threatening – there's barely more of it than around your hometown. Were the legends wrong? Is even the wyrdness fading from Avalon? Or maybe, after centuries, the island has reached some new equilibrium?

You imagine that, as wyrdness flowed out of Tuathan to fill holes torn by humans and their menhirs, eventually everything balanced out, like water in two connected vessels. The island became weirder while Tuathan normalized.

You almost feel disappointed you can't witness Tuathan in its full, warped glory.

Gain the **"Tuathan"** status. Then, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

4

Breaking apart frozen meat and bones is a heinous act. The flesh smells like rotten vegetables.

Each Party member gains 2 Food and 1.

Toss a Dial:

Grail – Exploration ends.

Skull – each Party member loses 1. Then, Exploration ends.

8

You find human skeletons in shining armor atop horses of bleached bone. You recognize symbols on the riders' shields as crests of the Knights of the Round Table. So, this is where the Order disappeared. Were they trying to stop the Fore-dwellers? Were they looking for something? You would have to turn back time to learn...

Each Party member gains 1.

Exploration ends.

252 Sword Plain

Buildings part, and a large, empty field of grass unravels before you. As you approach, you notice it isn't grass, but steel blades protruding from the ground. It would be difficult to move through this thicket of sharp weapons without drawing blood.

- **Search the meadow** – go to Verse 3.
- **Look for a usable weapon** (pay 1) – go to Verse 2.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

Anger flares inside you...

- **Let it burn** (only if you don't have the **"Dismay"** part **2** status) – go to Verse 7.
- **Suppress this feeling** – Exploration ends.

2

Roll a die and add the lowest value in the Party. Check your final result:

1-4 – *You forsake your search after the blades cut into your flesh.* Each Party member loses 1. Exploration ends.

5-7 – *You can't find anything useful.* Exploration ends.

8+ – go to Verse 5.

3

You search for something interesting, but find nothing.

If you **have** 3 or more , go to Verse 1.

If you **have** 3 or more or 4 or more , go to Verse 6.

Otherwise, Exploration ends.

5

After an exhausting hunt punctuated by painful scratches from the steel grass, you finally find an unbroken weapon in good condition.

Each Party member loses 1. Gain 1 **"Weapon"** Item. Exploration ends.

6

You carefully study the distribution of the blades. They appear to grow like plants, with fewer in the shadows and unfertile ground. If this place appears this way without wyrdness, imagine it enveloped by the wyrd.

If you **don't have** the **"Dismay"** part **3** status, each Party member gains 1 Exp; gain the **"Dismay"** part **3** status.

Exploration ends.

7

You let the anger take hold. You strike surrounding blades with your weapon. Razor sharp shards of steel fly in all directions, slicing your exposed skin. One of the larger shards falls to the ground with a curiously hollow noise. You calm yourself and kneel to investigate. Someone buried an eerie wooden mask here!

Each Party member loses 1. Gain Secret card **3** and the **"Dismay"** part **2** status. Exploration ends.

253
Heart of Tuathan

A vast wasteland with one discernable landmark – a high, tilted hill, resting on human-made walls which sink into the ground. Tendrils of wyrdness lazily float above the snow, melting it in their paths, dispersing as they touch snowdrifts. Is this place truly the heart of the ancient city of the Fore-dwellers?

If you **have** the Secret card **97** and **don't have** the **"Keeper"** part **2** status, go to Verse 2.

Otherwise, choose one:

- **Inspect the wall** – go to Verse 7.
- **Wander through the wastes** – go to Verse 4.
- **Speak with the Lady** (requires all Characters, and **Chapter 9**) – go to Verse 3.
- **Use the underground passage** (requires all Characters and **Chapters 10-15**; pay 3 per Party member) – go to Verse 5.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

2

You feel something wriggling in your chest – pain and terror overwhelm you in an instant. You open your mouth to scream, but instead of words, a spurt of greenish liquid emerges and sinks into the ground. Soon, tendrils grow from the stain. The ground trembles. Something is happening below your feet – this thing appears to take roots here. Your head suddenly fills with an unfamiliar presence telling you that your deeds won't be forgotten.

Gain the **"Keeper"** part **2** status. The Character with Secret card **97** gains 3 Exp, and discards Secret card **97**. Other Party members gain 1 Exp. Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

3

If there is no Fore-dweller model on this Location, move it here – Pale Lady knows Tuathan well and comes with haste.

Pale Lady climbs the hilltop, and you follow. She asks you to watch over her and Lancelot while she performs a ritual. While concentrating, she can't defend herself from threats.

Go to:

4

The wastes lie barren – there is nothing here except for cold and dread.

- **Use wyrdness to enhance your body and mind** – *The wyrdness is strong here. Malleable. Waiting to be shaped.* Go to Verse 6.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

5

There is a small crevice at the hill's feet. From there, branching corridors (like those deep beneath Kamelot) lead into the bowels of Avalon.

Go to:

6

You find you can weave and manipulate wyrdness with ease. If you use the right catalysts, you can change everything, including your own past experiences!

Each Party member gains 1 . Each Party member may pay 2 Exp and then pay 3 Food or 3 Wealth or 3 Magic to discard one of their Skill cards and choose a new Skill card with the same Attribute.

Exploration ends.

7

What looks like a wall of natural stone, after closer inspection, turns out to be a single block of wyrdstone. Up high, where the wall touches the hilltop, you see an upside-down gate. It looks like a part of a fortress turned on its top and submerged in the ground.

Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

254 Marble Toes

Townhouses lie on their sides, doors opening to the sky. Edible plants grow between their walls, sheltering wild animals beneath lush leaves. The deeper you explore, the less wyrdness you find – and, finally, you stand before giant white feet emerging from the ground, their soles marked with spiral grooves.

- **Explore the laying buildings** – go to Verse 1.
- **Study spirals on the soles** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 4.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

You comb the buildings, entering through windows. It's hard to move inside – furniture and tools lie scattered and damaged on the wall, which is now your floor. Everything looks unfamiliar, as if made for something like a human yet different at the same time.

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

- **1-3** – *These upturned structures hold perilous traps.* Each Party member loses 2 and gains 1 . Exploration ends.
- **4-6** – *As you search through the rubble, you find something interesting.* Each Party member gains 1 Wealth. Exploration ends.
- **7+** – go to Verse 6.

4

You approach the enormous marble feet. Spirals are carved into their soles – larger shapes formed of smaller ones made of even tinier coils. Your eyes strain, staring at this unending recursion.

If you **have** 2 or more , go to Verse 8.

Otherwise, each Party member gains 1 Magic and 1 . Exploration ends.

6

You find a cache hidden below the former floor that opened under its own weight.

Each Party member gains 1 Wealth. If you **don't have** the **"Hidden Caches"** part **7** status, gain 2 non-Companion Items and the **"Hidden Caches"** part **7** status. Then, Exploration ends.

8

You notice a strange relation between spirals' shape and the wyrdness surrounding them. They somehow seem similar. You feel that manipulating a small part of wyrdness might easily change something bigger.

If you **have** 3 or more and **don't have** the **"Clues"** part **6** status, go to:

Otherwise, each Party member gains 2 Magic and 2 . Exploration ends.

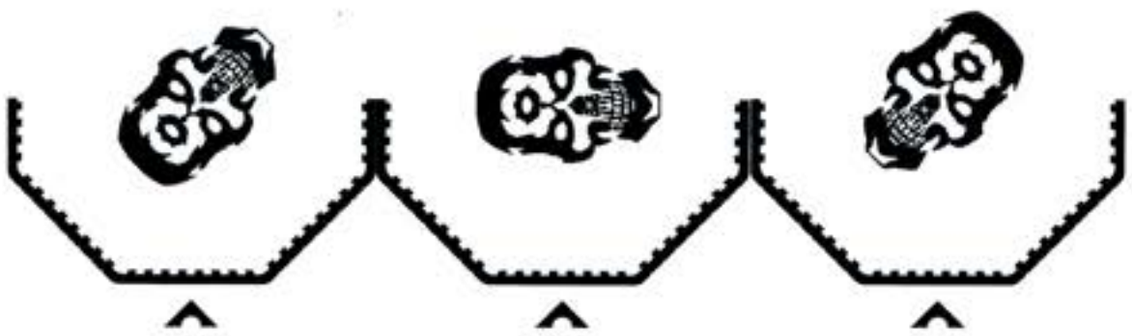
The tempest tosses you around, pulling your clothes and hair painfully. You struggle between the fighting specters of humans and Fore-dwellers. Their ethereal weapons don't cut, but you still feel pain and biting cold with every strike. You must do something – standing here seems like an easy way to lose your life.

Each Party member loses 1 , gains 1 and 1 **Exposure**. Then, choose one:

- **Try to communicate with ghosts** (requires 3 or 4) – go to Verse 1.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

Go to:



258 Still Forest

You wonder what happened to the people who left the settlement and set out toward the heart of the forest. Those still in the village look at you with hostility, blaming you for the schism. What's worse, there are too few left to defend against the Black Drifter assaulting the local menhir.

If there is a Fore-dweller model or Time Token on this Location, go to Verse 2. Otherwise, go to Verse 1.

1

Roll a die, add +3 if there is an Active Menhir in this Location, and subtract your . Check your final result:

1-5 – go to Verse 2.

6+ – place a Time Token on this Location and go to Verse 10.

2

- **Approach the menhir** – go to Verse 3.
- **Buy magical trinkets** – pay 3 Wealth to gain 1 Magic (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Walk in the forest** (pay 2 per Party member) – go to Verse 5.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

3

The statue in the center of the village displays runes describing the story of the Forest Sanctuary, and its founder, a long-forgotten Allmother priestess who found solace here after a quest that claimed the lives of her companions. There are few candles and prayers at the monument's feet.

If you are **Mabd** and you **don't have** the **"Lost Apprentice"** part **2** status, go to Verse 9.

- **Try to sabotage the menhir** (requires the **"Chalk Horse"** part **3** status and the Secret card **11**) – go to Verse 6.
- **Carefully read the runes** (only if the **Chapter 10: Part 3** Quest Card is revealed; requires all Characters; this will end your Chapter) – go to Verse 7.
- **Start carving** (requires all Characters and **Chapter 14**) – go to Verse 8.
- **Admire it and leave** – Exploration ends.

5

The forest is wonderful, despite the situation in Forest Sanctuary. It's still warm and pleasant. And again, you lose yourself in its beauty. Suddenly the sun dips lower, and you must go back.

Each Party member gains 1 Magic and loses 2 . If you're playing **Chapter 11**, go to:

Otherwise, Exploration ends.

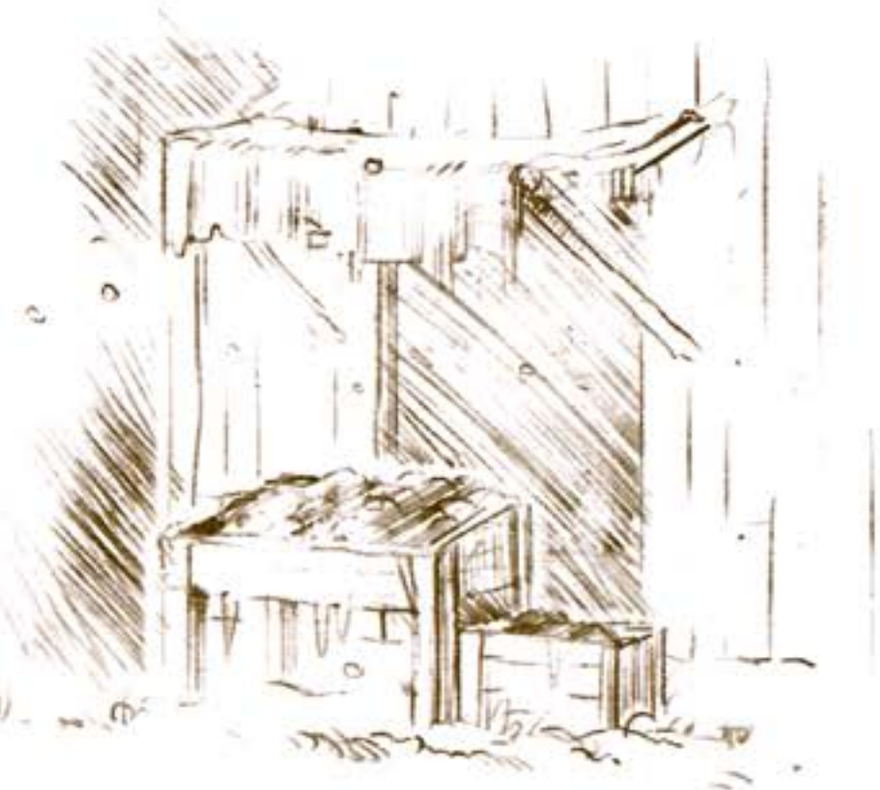
6

If you **have** the **"Chalk Horse"** part **4** status, you already did it; Exploration ends. Otherwise, read on:

People look at you with suspicion as your actions aren't exactly usual.

Resolve a blue Encounter. If you win or draw a **"Calm Before the Storm"** Encounter, go to:

Otherwise, Exploration ends.



7

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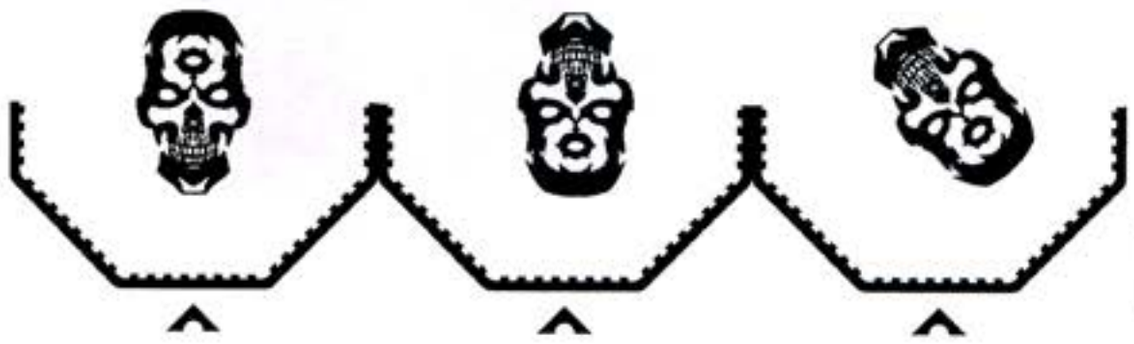

8

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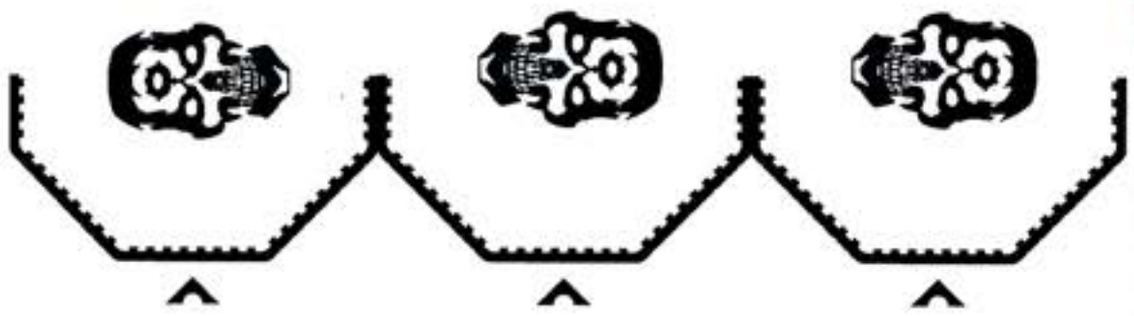


9

A youngster approaches you and asks if you are a wandering storyteller. You confirm, and he continues with his questions – do you know a young, beautiful girl also of this profession? And could you tell her that he's waiting? It's now your time to inquire – you find out that the girl was your apprentice, and she went somewhere west.

Mabd gains 1 Exp. Gain the **"Lost Apprentice"** part **2** status.
Go back to Verse 2.

10

In a weakened state, the settlement can't drive Black Drifter away anymore.

Go to:

Menhir

Requires **all Characters** and the **Menhir Rites** Secret card (**11**).

Pay 3, 1 Magic, and 1 (per Character): put a new Menhir model on this Location and set its Dial to **8** (-1 per Character).

If there aren't enough models left, take one from another Location of your choice.

259 Hollow Hill

It was loud here once, but now the silence rings in your ears, sometimes broken by a distant animal cry. The hill bears the remains of its previous inhabitant – a jagged outline of a horse cut in the ground. The dilapidated cabin is still there, and, before it, stands the man with a steaming cup. This time, his eyes are full of sadness.

- **Visit the ramshackle cottage** – go to Verse 4.
- **Gather detritus of the chalk** (pay 1) – go to Verse 1.
- **Search for clues** (requires **Chapter 11**) – go to Verse 2.
- **Visit Grovesoul** (requires all Characters and the **"Secrets of the Forest"** part **4** status) – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave the site** – Exploration ends.

1

Gain the **"Ritual Chalk"** Item. If it's not available, gain 1 Magic. Exploration ends.

2

Go to:

3

Go to:

4

The lunatic herbalist complains that the horse escaped, and he can no longer spend time with it. He's not interested in talking further with you. However, if you pay him, he treats your wounds.

Each Party member may pay a total of 2 Wealth and Food to gain 2 . Then, Exploration ends.

260 Undercastle

This last stand of humanity was created by Arthur to protect his people should all else fail. To you, it looks anything but safe. Mud and old blood stain the floor, the air smells unpleasant, and unsettling sounds rub your nerves raw. You are confused and don't know exactly where the exit is or what to do here. If you spend too much time in these darkest depths, you'll die of illness or madness.

- **Look for an exit** – go to Verse 1.
- **Explore the Undercastle** (requires all Characters) – go to Verse 4.

1

- **Try to retrace your route** (pay 4 reduced by your) – gain part **1** of the **"Retracing"** status. Then, make another choice.
- **Look for some clues** (pay 4 reduced by your) – gain part **2** of the **"Retracing"** status. Then, make another choice.
- **Feel the atmosphere and the air movement** (pay 4 reduced by your) – gain part **3** of the **"Retracing"** status. Then, make another choice.
- **Explore the darkest places** (pay 4 reduced by your) – gain part **4** of the **"Retracing"** status. Then, make another choice.
- **Leave this place** (requires all Characters and at least 1 part per Character of the **"Retracing"** status) – discard Location **260** and reveal the Location underneath. Then, Explore this Location for free.
- **Abandon this idea** – Exploration ends.

2

Darkness seems to push against the torchlight, as if it wants to devour and imprison you. Finally, you approach a well-crafted portal with an inscription: "Archives." The area appears brighter. The oaken gate is in good condition, unlike its iron lock. If not for the magical barrier pushing you away, entering the Archives would be an easy task.

- **Go inside** (requires the **"Darkness"** part **6** status) – *You have opened the door before.* Go to Verse 14.
- **Use new hex** (requires the **"Darkness"** part **3** status) – go to Verse 16.
- **Force your way using magic** (pay 5 Magic) – go to Verse 13.
- **Force your way using brute strength** (pay 4 per Character) – go to Verse 13.
- **Go back to the camp** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

3

Go to:

4

You leave your camp. The air immediately grows foul, and the darkness deepens.

- **Follow the strange tracks** (only if you don't have the **"Darkness"** part **1** status) – go to Verse 3.
- **Explore the rancid-smelling caverns** – go to Verse 8.
- **Delve deeper into the darkness** – go to Verse 2.
- **Do something else** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

5

The barking dies away, and now you hear only the water trickling down the walls. Suddenly, something growls behind your back.

Toss a Dial:

Grail – resolve a green Encounter.

Skull – resolve a purple Encounter.

Then, Exploration ends.

7

You pass the spore clouds and soon caverns transition into human-made corridors. Most have collapsed, but you can reach two nearby rooms.

Characters with Secret card **66** lose 1 and gain 1 , as spores make their way into the wounds and inflame them.

- **Enter the room on the left** (only if you don't have the **"Darkness"** part **3** status) – go to Verse 9.
- **Explore the room before you** – go to Verse 11.
- **Go back to the camp** – Exploration ends.

8

The caves, smelling of rotten eggs, are overgrown with brown moss and pale weeds you fear to touch. Everything is quiet until hounds start baying in the distance.

- **Go toward the noises** – go to Verse 5.
- **Go in the opposite direction** – go to Verse 10.
- **Go back to the camp** – Exploration ends.

9

Cobwebs fill every inch of the dark chamber. Dust covers most of them, but some look fresh.

If you **have** 3 or more , you may go to Verse 15.

- **Burn the webs** – go to Verse 17.
- **Hack through them** – go to Verse 18.
- **Sneak past them** – go to Verse 19.
- **Go into the other room** – go to Verse 11.
- **Go back to the camp** – Exploration ends.

10

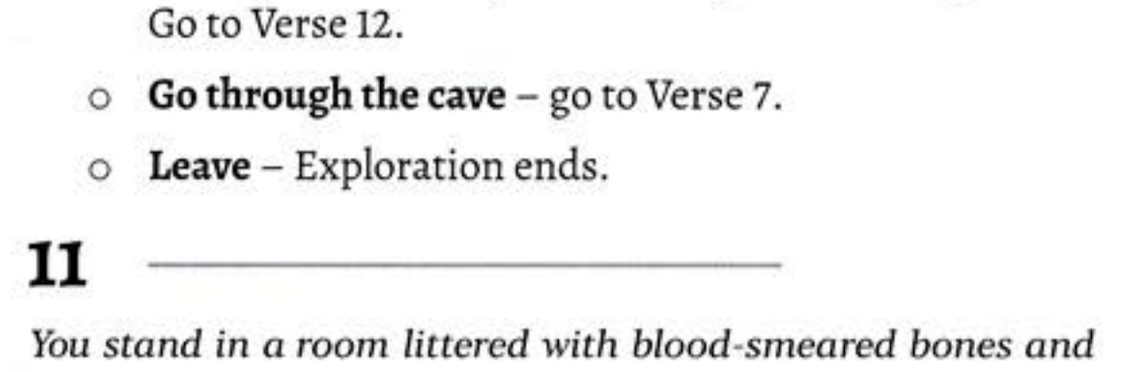
A plethora of fungi covers the area. When you nudge them, they emit puffs of spores that irritate the skin and make you nauseous.

- **Gather mushrooms** (only if you don't have the **"Darkness"** part **2** status) – *You recognize some of them!* Go to Verse 12.
- **Go through the cave** – go to Verse 7.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

11

You stand in a room littered with blood-smeared bones and tattered fur. This must have been the lair of a large beast. You think it might be wise to leave before the beast that lives here – or something worse – returns.

If you **don't have** the **"Darkness"** part **7** status and have at least 3 or 3 , go to:



Otherwise, choose one:

- **Go into the other room** (only if you don't have the **"Darkness"** part **3** status) – go to Verse 9.
- **Go back to the camp** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

12

You gather fungi you recognize as edible. There's not much, but still, it was worth your time for some sustenance.

Gain 2 Food and the **"Darkness"** part **2** status. Exploration ends.

13

You push yourself to the edge, but finally, the gate gives way.

Gain the **"Darkness"** part **6** status. Go to Verse 14.

14

Go to:

15

You consider hacking through the webs – but spiders would react to vibrations, and sticky threads would trap your weapons. It's better to sneak through the area or burn it to the ground.

Go back to Verse 9.

16

You recite the spell and touch the gate. It gives way, allowing you to enter.

Gain the **"Darkness"** part **6** status.

If you **have** 2 or more , the hex worked well – go to Verse 14.

Otherwise, you did something wrong, and the magic hurt you – each Party member loses 2 Magic and 1 . Then, go to Verse 14.

17

Go to:

18 _____

Go to:

19 _____

Go to:

261 Moonring

Ovoid stones float lazily above short trees in the center of a deserted stone circle. A large puddle of melted snow gathers beneath them, steaming as it alternates between freezing and thawing. You still can't believe you're responsible for this...

Animals still dwell here, indifferent to the newfound strangeness of this place, but hunters avoid this land now, letting you rest unperturbed.

- **Go to Still River** – go to Verse 1.
- **Enter the stone circle** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 6.
- **Hunt** (pay 1) – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

If Location **235** is not attached to this card, pay 1 Magic (1 Character), 2 Magic (2-3 Characters), or 3 Magic (4 Characters) to attach Location **235** to the right of Location **261**.

If Location **235** is attached to this card, pay 1 per Party member to move all Party members to Location **261**. Then, Exploration ends.

If you can't or don't want to do this, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

3

You scout the forest and catch some small game. Unfortunately, your activity draws the attention of something bigger...

Roll a die and add your . You result was:

1-4 – gain 1 Food.

5-7 – gain 2 Food.

8+ – gain 3 Food.

Then, resolve a green Encounter. Exploration ends.

6

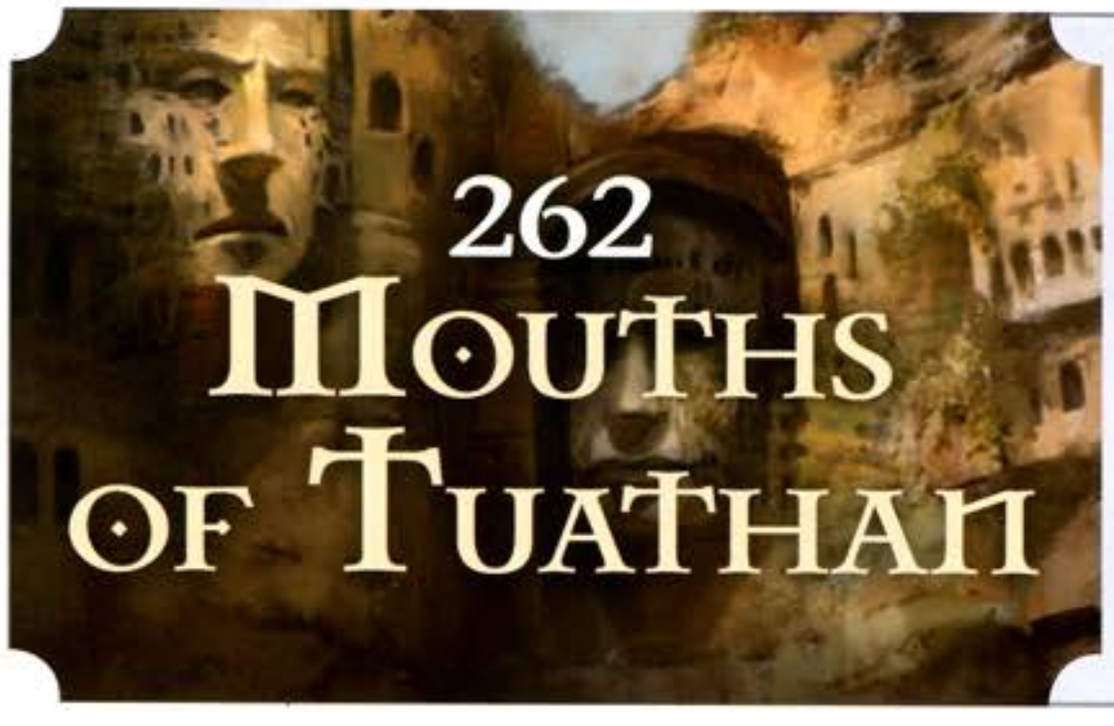
You rest under the floating rocks. Pleasant energy floods your body, making you feel as though you can do anything.

If there is no Time Token on this Location, place a Time Token on this Location and each Party member gains 2 Magic. Exploration ends.

Dream & Nightmare

You dream of foreign lands full of green plants, illuminated with hot and intense sunlight. The sights are strange, but also pleasant.

Each Character who has this Dream or Nightmare discards the Exposure Marker and loses 1 .



262 Mouths of Tuathan

The first thing that draws your attention is a high wave blocking the way to the west – at least thirty feet tall, perpetually crumbling though it's frozen forever. When you manage to avert your eyes from this wonder, you examine your surroundings – you stand on a narrow strip of land between the walls of Tuathan and a cliff leading to the sea. A faint sound seems to come from beyond the cliff's edge.

- **Lean out to see the cliff face** – go to Verse 5.
- **Delve into the crevices of the Tuathan wall** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 4.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

2

Roll a die and add your or (whichever is higher). Check your final result:

1-6 – *Only a moment has passed, but you feel lost. You struggle to find a way out in panic.* Each Party member gains 2 . Exploration ends.

7+ – You emerge in some cave... Go to Verse 8.

3

If you **have** 1 or less , you brush against the substance and it burns your skin – each Party member loses 1 . Read on:

Crystals repel slimy veins – the niche is free of them. Inside, you find tiny mirrors and rusted elements of fragile machinery that crumble under the slightest touch. Torchlight reflects in the mirrors and focuses in many points in the cave. The yellow slime quickly moves away from these points.

If you **don't have** the **"Riches of the Past"** part **6** status, each Party member gains 1 Exp; gain the **"Riches of the Past"** part **6** status. Exploration ends.

4

The wind howls achingly in the bone-like structure of the wall. You hear barking and growling deeper inside.

- **Check the immediate surrounding of the entrance** – go to Verse 7.
- **Go deeper** (requires 2) – go to Verse 2.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

5

You lean over the cliff and see three faces carved in the stone, their eyes the size of a standing human. They stare piercingly back at you. "It's not comfortable to talk like that," the cliff rumbles. "There is a path leading down. Come closer, human."

- **Draw back and leave** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.
- **Go down** (requires all Characters, pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 11.

7

You navigate the interior, trying not to lose sight of the exit. You find frozen feces and scraps of fur and scales. Soon, you spot a mangled human body, its face and stomach torn out.

- **Inspect the dead body** – go to Verse 10.
- **Go deeper into the wall** (requires 2) – go to Verse 2.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

8

Slimy, yellow veins covering the floor and walls of the cave undulate slowly. You're careful not to step on them, worried by their strange smell. As you pass the veins, small feelers rise from them, grasping after you.

The cave is empty, excluding one empty niche surrounded by white-pink crystals.

- **Leave this place** – Exploration ends.
- **Try to reach the niche** – go to Verse 3.

10

The wounds are full of frozen, white maggots. Dried blood covers every surface. Despite the cold, the corpse reeks of decay. It once belonged to a traveler – rusted kettles and climbing equipment are among his ruined belongings.

Each Party member gains 1 .

If you **don't have** the **"Riches of the Past"** part **5** status, you find golden trinkets in good condition – gain the **"Petty Trinkets"** Item (or 1 Wealth if it's not available) and the **"Riches of the Past"** part **5** status.

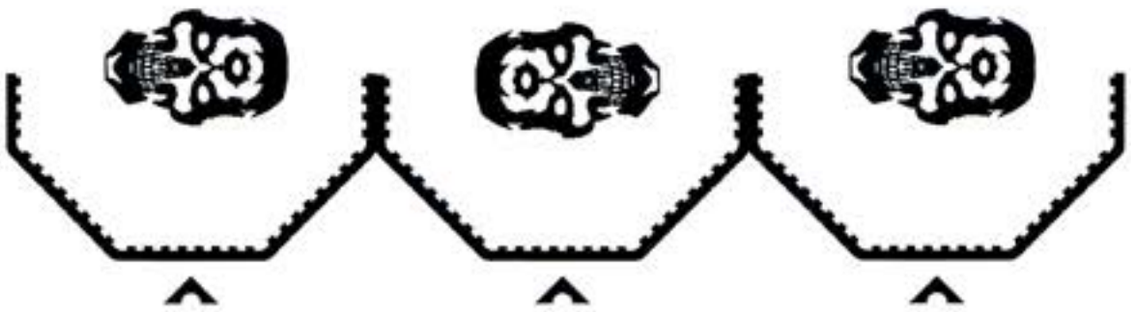
Then, go back to Verse 7.

11

You descend slippery steps carved into the cliffside and emerge onto the frozen sea. Stone sages look down on you from above. "Knowledge comes at a price, but today the order will be reversed," they say. Then, you hear faint rumbling – could it be... laughter?

- **Ask about them** (pay 1 Exp per Character) – go to:

- **Ask where you can get the exemplar of the human laws** (requires **Chapter 10**; pay 2 Wealth per Character) – go to:

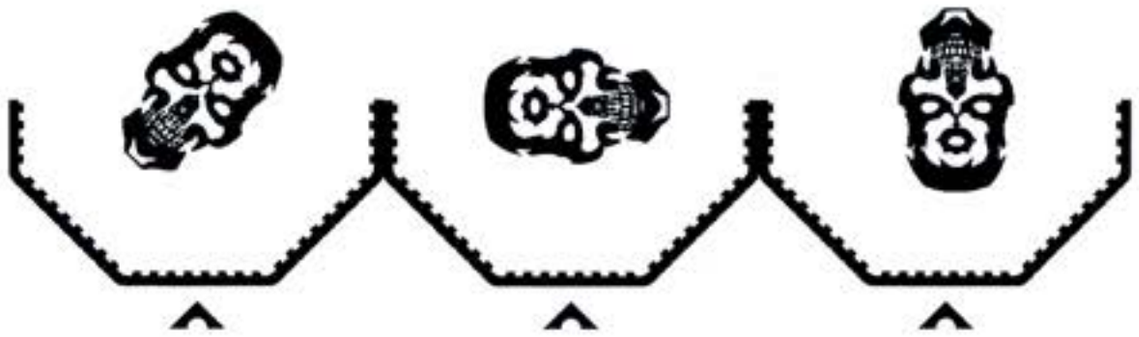


- **Ask about the wyrdness and its origin** (pay 2 Food per Character) – go to:

- **Ask about the current state of the island** (pay 2 Exp per Character) – go to:

- **Ask what you should do** (requires **Chapter 10** and the **"Clues"** part **9** status; pay 1 Wealth per Character) – go to:

- **Ask them to help you with making a decision** (only if the **Chapter 13: Part 5** Quest Card is revealed; pay 4 Magic per Character) – go to:



- **Climb back** – Exploration ends.

263
Devastation

The ground is rippled, and trees grow upside down, their roots burst open by frozen sap. An ice river meanders between unnatural hills and ends in a tiny hot spring, producing thick fog that mingles with wyrdness. The wyrdness is thick here, as if something pushes it from the south.

- **Explore the area** – go to Verse 3.
- **Rest by the hot spring** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 4.
- **Descend into the tunnels beneath the island** (requires all Characters; pay 3 per Party member) – go to Verse 1.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

You thought traversing these dark corridors would be less frightening. You were wrong.

Go to:

3

The strange landscape clinging to Tuathan's wall is fascinating, but you see nothing useful here.

If you **have** 3 or more , go to Verse 6.

Otherwise, Exploration ends.

4

Warm waters pull the cold from your body. You find a moment of respite and sweet oblivion.

Each Party member loses 2 Exposure. Exploration ends.

6

You notice patterns in the area – trees grow in similarly shaped groves on similarly shaped hills, and even fissures form repetitive shapes. As you inspect the surroundings, it becomes obvious this landscape was crafted with some purpose in mind.

If you **have** 4 or more , go to Verse 11.

Otherwise, Exploration ends.

11

You devote time to studying the regularities. Together they form a larger picture in the shape of each of each smaller element, with minor differences. You have the notion these might be Fore-dweller runes, or some other esoteric way of recording information.

If there is a Fore-dweller model on this Location, go to:

Otherwise, Exploration ends.

264 Lonely Hill

A single hill rises from otherwise flat terrain, standing proudly between deep chasms and the high walls of Tuathan. Its slopes are free of wyrdness, which slides off them like snow, making this place a windy but safe spot to rest. You also notice a few tunnel entrances at the foot of the hill.

- **Explore the tunnels** – go to Verse 2.
- **Climb the hill** – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

Go to:

2

The tunnels channel through ice, rock, and frozen soil. They look like they might collapse at any moment.

- **Scout the entrance** – go to Verse 4.
- **Delve deeper** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 5.
- **Spend the entire day exploring the tunnels** (pay 4 per Party member; this will end your day) – go to Verse 1.

3

Climbing the hill isn't a challenge – it's not that steep, and there are many footholds. Soon, you stand atop it and look around. To the north, you see Tuathan's wall of bone-like stone – you still remember the strangeness you've encountered on the other side of it. To the south lie snowy plains marked with black symbols from which plumes of steam rise. A clear lake shimmers in the south-west, a strange wooden structure floating in its center.

Exploration ends.

4

You notice evidence of scavengers and signs of mining activity all around – broken containers and tools, burnt torches, and frozen food. On your way out, you come upon a half-buried entrance to a strange cave – rectangular, almost like the interior of a house. It seems it was spared scavengers, and valuables might remain.

If you **don't have** the **"Hidden Caches"** part **9** status, gain 3 Wealth and 1 non-Companion Item; gain the **"Hidden Caches"** part **9** status. Exploration ends.

5

The deeper you delve, the more these tunnels resemble the ruins of a city, buried beneath the hill. Someone made a mine of this mound, given that everything is picked clean with such diligence. Fortunately, the underground is so vast that there are still some valuables to be found.

Each Party member gains 2 Wealth. Exploration ends.

Dream

You dream of bright sun and lush green grassland. A group places a boulder in the ground alongside others and goes to fetch another rock. Then, it strikes you – the people stand as tall as the trees of the nearby forest.

Each Character who has this Dream gains 1.

Nightmare

You sit at the table with your family, enjoying mead and flatbread. The warmth of the fireplace is made even more pleasant by the raging storm outside. Then, you hear a thunderous noise, as if the whole island has broken in half. Your children look to you with terror in their eyes, and you nod, overflowing with sadness. Then, the world collapses, burying you.

Each Character who has this Nightmare loses 1.

265
Tranquil Lake

As you move forward, it grows warmer and warmer. First, the wet snow sticks to your boots, then white and violet flowers appear. Finally, at the edge of a lake, you spot green grass. The lake isn't frozen! It looks like an enormous bucket of melted snow or a tiny sea without the ice floats. Dilapidated huts stand by the shore – something clearly destroyed the settlement. A giant construction made of wood and stone floats in the center of the lake.

- **Fish the lake** (pay 1) – go to Verse 3.
- **Swim toward the structure** (pay 1 per Party member) – *There's a boat on the shore, but it doesn't look seaworthy.* Go to Verse 4.
- **Investigate the anomaly** (requires all Characters, **Chapter 15**, and the **"Decision"** part **3** status) – go to Verse 5.
- **Begin the hunt** (requires all Characters, **Chapter 15**, and the **"Decision"** part **2** status) – go to Verse 1.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

Go to:

2

You decide to swim toward it, anyway. This structure is definitely a nest, made mostly of wood, but there are also human and animal bones, stones, and other curios inside. You even see a grim pantry full of mangled corpses and a treasury – with some magical trinkets.

Toss a Dial:

Grail – *You notice black wings far away – you snatch some of the trinkets and swim back to the shore.* Each Party member gains 1 Magic. Exploration ends.

Skull – *A black shadow obscures the sun...* Go to:

3

You've heard about fishing in the ocean, but never in a water like this. It appears to be an easy task, and soon your makeshift net is swarming with glistering creatures.

Gain 2 Food. Exploration ends.

4

If you are **Fyul**, go to Verse 7. Otherwise, read on:

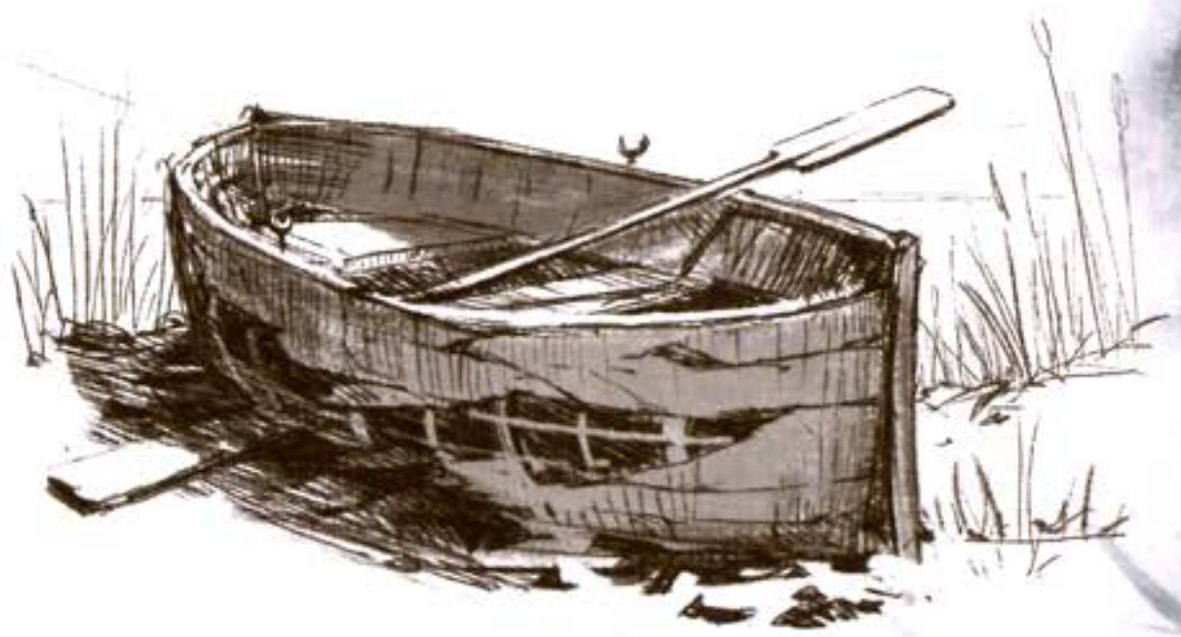
You row toward the structure, which appears to be a nest. You're sure the only creature that could build it is a Black Drifter. Maybe it would be safer to retreat?

- **Retreat** – Exploration ends.
- **Press on** – go to Verse 2.

5

The bright sun reveals something large in the water, beneath the structure in the middle of the lake. Unfortunately, the Black Drifter may appear at the moment of your utmost concentration. You must kill it before you can investigate the anomaly.

- **Begin the hunt** – go to Verse 1.
- **Leave for now** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.



265

7

As you approach the structure, your insides twist with pain, and something in your head screams with fear. The sunlight blinds you, the wind roars in your ears. You must go back!

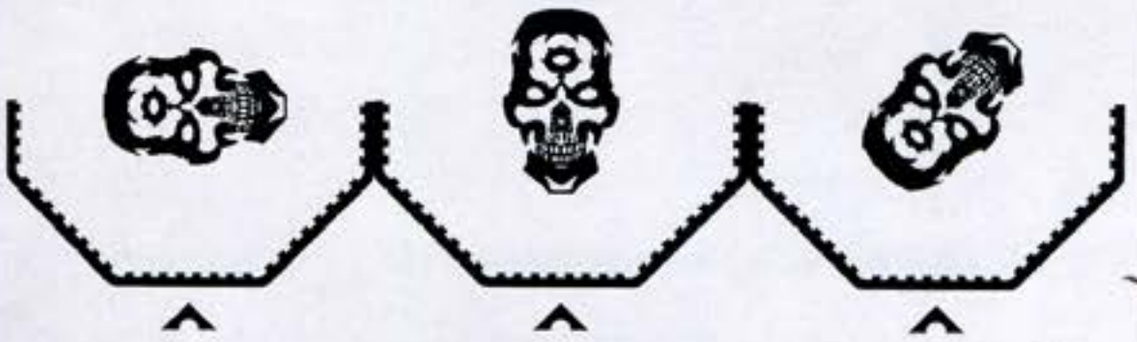
If **Fyul** has 4 or more , go to Verse 2. Otherwise, **Fyul** gains 1 , and Exploration ends.

Dream & Nightmare

Toss a Dial:

- **Skull** – go to:

- **Grail** – If **Fyul** reads this Dream or Nightmare, go to:



Other Characters read on:

The warmth, pleasant smells, and calm atmosphere allow you to rest better than ever.

Each Character who reads this Dream or Nightmare discards the Exposure Marker, gains 2 , and loses 2 .

266 Caustic Meadow

Trenches brimming with black sludge taint the meadow's purity. Snow melts with a loud hiss as it touches the liquid – you shudder each time you hear it. A lone, worn menhir stands between the ditches, bearing marks of frequent Black Drifter visits. The creature must nest nearby, most likely to the west, where you saw its shadow recently.

If there is a Fore-dweller model or Time Token on this Location, go to Verse 11.

Otherwise, go to Verse 17.

1

The man says he saw them. And if that's all that remains of humanity, then everything's lost.

Go back to Verse 6 and make another choice.

2

You've heard legends about the symbols on these plains – that Merlin made them for the gods to read from above. It may be absurd, but maybe this man followed the glyphs?

Go back to Verse 6 and make another choice.

3

You say farewell and walk away.

If there is a Time Token on this Location, the man keeps looking at you, but does nothing – Exploration ends.

Otherwise, he stops you and asks about your purpose. You answer that you're trying to help the island – go to Verse 5.

4

A clay bottle seems sufficient for this task. But you must be careful not to hurt yourself.

Gain the **"Witches' Bile"** Item (or 1 Magic if it's not available). If you **don't have** at least 3 or , each Party member loses 2 .

Exploration ends.

5

The man looks at you again, more carefully. He notices your equipment, scars, and exhaustion.

If you **have** the **"Allfather's Blessing"** status, go to Verse 10.

Otherwise, go to Verse 8.

6

The figure, a man, stands much taller than you thought – when you approach, it appears you barely reach the height of his arm. He boasts a long beard the same color as the ram fur he wears. Despite his impressive stature, he seems confused and lost. He inquires where all the people are. He says he came here, as he was asked, but he seems to be a little late. He's found no one, only several pathetic villages.

Gain the **"Friends"** part **5** status.

If you **have** at least 4 or the **"Clues"** part **5** status, you may go to Verse 2. Otherwise, choose one:

- **Tell him about towns to the east** – go to Verse 1.
- **Ask who he is** – go to Verse 9.
- **Explain that humanity is dying** – go to Verse 7.
- **Tell him you're trying to save Avalon** – go to Verse 5.
- **Bid him farewell** – go to Verse 3.

7

He has noticed it already. He asks whether humanity will find a way to stop dying? Will it regrow?

Go back to Verse 6 and make another choice.

8

He murmurs to himself that maybe you do need his help. Then he asks if you truly deserve it.

- **You're sure that it is he who needs your help** – go to Verse 12.
- **You deserve his help** – go to Verse 13.
- **You don't need his help** – go to Verse 14.

9

He is outraged that you don't know him. "I'm Cisonus, the patron of the path, revels, and courage! The mightiest of adventurers, the defender of humanity. If you don't remember me, then perhaps this island doesn't deserve my attention."

Place a Time Token on this Location. Go back to Verse 6 and make another choice.

10

"You have a patron, I see. I don't know him, but I won't interfere with him. Be safe on your path," says the man. He leaves as if he has forgotten about you already.

Exploration ends.

11

- **Gather the corrosive substance** – go to Verse 4.
- **Talk to the tall figure** (only if you don't have the **"Friends"** part **5** status) – *You haven't noticed him before. He looks lost.* Go to Verse 6.
- **Admire the menhir** – go to Verse 16.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

12

If you **have** 2 or less , the man feels insulted and leaves you without a word – Exploration ends. Otherwise, read on:

"A true spirit of an adventurer," says the man. "But don't push it too far."

Go to:

13

If you **have** 8 or more Rep, go to:

Otherwise, the man shakes his head and leaves you without a word – Exploration ends.

14

If you **have** 2 or less , the man laughs and leaves you without a word – Exploration ends. Otherwise, read on:

"Spoken like a true hero! I like it. But remember – you're only human."

Go to:

15

A black shadow looms on the western horizon, rising up from a nearby lake.

Go to:

16

You step over countless caustic streams and finally approach the menhir. It looks weathered and sad, but still stands as the only guardian of this place.

- **Leave** – go back to Verse 11.
- **Start carving** (requires all Characters and **Chapter 14**) – go to:

17

Roll a die and add +4 if there is an Active Menhir in this Location. Subtract the value of your .

Check your final result:

1-5 – go to Verse 11.

6+ – place a Time Token on this Location and go to Verse 15.

Dream & Nightmare

Before you fall asleep, you think of others. These white wastelands, stretching wide under a bleak sky, remind you of the loneliness lurking in every corner of this desolate island. In the middle of the night, human voices wake you. Malformed silhouettes born of your wishes, snow, and wyrdness surround you, demanding your attention.

All Characters who have this Dream resolve one blue Encounter, as a Party.

Menhir

Requires **all Characters** and the **Menhir Rites** Secret card (**11**).

Pay 1 , 1 , and 2 Magic (per Character): put a new Menhir model on this Location and set its Dial to **7** (-1 per Character).

If there aren't enough models left, take one from another Location of your choice.

266 Caustic Meadow

Trenches brimming with black sludge taint the meadow's purity. Snow melts with a loud hiss as it touches the liquid – you shudder each time you hear it. A lone, worn menhir stands between the ditches, bearing marks of frequent Black Drifter visits. The creature must nest nearby, most likely to the west, where you saw its shadow recently.

If there is a Fore-dweller model or Time Token on this Location, go to Verse 11.

Otherwise, go to Verse 17.

1

The man says he saw them. And if that's all that remains of humanity, then everything's lost.

Go back to Verse 6 and make another choice.

2

You've heard legends about the symbols on these plains – that Merlin made them for the gods to read from above. It may be absurd, but maybe this man followed the glyphs?

Go back to Verse 6 and make another choice.

3

You say farewell and walk away.

If there is a Time Token on this Location, the man keeps looking at you, but does nothing – Exploration ends.

Otherwise, he stops you and asks about your purpose. You answer that you're trying to help the island – go to Verse 5.

4

A clay bottle seems sufficient for this task. But you must be careful not to hurt yourself.

Gain the **"Witches' Bile"** Item (or 1 Magic if it's not available). If you **don't have** at least 3 or , each Party member loses 2 .

Exploration ends.

5

The man looks at you again, more carefully. He notices your equipment, scars, and exhaustion.

If you **have** the **"Allfather's Blessing"** status, go to Verse 10.

Otherwise, go to Verse 8.

6

The figure, a man, stands much taller than you thought – when you approach, it appears you barely reach the height of his arm. He boasts a long beard the same color as the ram fur he wears. Despite his impressive stature, he seems confused and lost. He inquires where all the people are. He says he came here, as he was asked, but he seems to be a little late. He's found no one, only several pathetic villages.

Gain the **"Friends"** part **5** status.

If you **have** at least 4 or the **"Clues"** part **5** status, you may go to Verse 2. Otherwise, choose one:

- **Tell him about towns to the east** – go to Verse 1.
- **Ask who he is** – go to Verse 9.
- **Explain that humanity is dying** – go to Verse 7.
- **Tell him you're trying to save Avalon** – go to Verse 5.
- **Bid him farewell** – go to Verse 3.

7

He has noticed it already. He asks whether humanity will find a way to stop dying? Will it regrow?

Go back to Verse 6 and make another choice.

8

He murmurs to himself that maybe you do need his help. Then he asks if you truly deserve it.

- **You're sure that it is he who needs your help** – go to Verse 12.
- **You deserve his help** – go to Verse 13.
- **You don't need his help** – go to Verse 14.

9

He is outraged that you don't know him. "I'm Cisonus, the patron of the path, revels, and courage! The mightiest of adventurers, the defender of humanity. If you don't remember me, then perhaps this island doesn't deserve my attention."

Place a Time Token on this Location. Go back to Verse 6 and make another choice.

10

"You have a patron, I see. I don't know him, but I won't interfere with him. Be safe on your path," says the man. He leaves as if he has forgotten about you already.

Exploration ends.

11

- **Gather the corrosive substance** – go to Verse 4.
- **Talk to the tall figure** (only if you don't have the **"Friends"** part **5** status) – *You haven't noticed him before. He looks lost.* Go to Verse 6.
- **Admire the menhir** – go to Verse 16.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

12

If you **have** 2 or less , the man feels insulted and leaves you without a word – Exploration ends. Otherwise, read on:

"A true spirit of an adventurer," says the man. "But don't push it too far."

Go to:

13

If you **have** 8 or more Rep, go to:

Otherwise, the man shakes his head and leaves you without a word – Exploration ends.

14

If you **have** 2 or less , the man laughs and leaves you without a word – Exploration ends. Otherwise, read on:

"Spoken like a true hero! I like it. But remember – you're only human."

Go to:

15

A black shadow looms on the western horizon, rising up from a nearby lake.

Go to:

16

You step over countless caustic streams and finally approach the menhir. It looks weathered and sad, but still stands as the only guardian of this place.

- **Leave** – go back to Verse 11.
- **Start carving** (requires all Characters and **Chapter 14**) – go to:

17

Roll a die and add +4 if there is an Active Menhir in this Location. Subtract the value of your .

Check your final result:

1-5 – go to Verse 11.

6+ – place a Time Token on this Location and go to Verse 15.

Dream & Nightmare

Before you fall asleep, you think of others. These white wastelands, stretching wide under a bleak sky, remind you of the loneliness lurking in every corner of this desolate island. In the middle of the night, human voices wake you. Malformed silhouettes born of your wishes, snow, and wyrdness surround you, demanding your attention.

All Characters who have this Dream resolve one blue Encounter, as a Party.

Menhir

Requires **all Characters** and the **Menhir Rites** Secret card (**11**).

Pay 1, 1, and 2 Magic (per Character): put a new Menhir model on this Location and set its Dial to **7** (-1 per Character).

If there aren't enough models left, take one from another Location of your choice.

267 Horn of South

Churning waves crash against the cliff, breaking the ice crust lining the shore. Two rocks protrude from this frigid hell – a single tower stands guard atop one of them, while ruins adorn the other. Anyone wishing to visit any of these rocks must cross the sea, using a single rope swinging several feet above the waters.

- **Cross the water using the rope** – *It doesn't look safe.* Go to Verse 5.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

You must cross the perilous sea again...

You may pay 1 per Party member – if you do, add 1 to the following roll. Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-3 – *You don't want to cross this path twice. And you won't have to, because you lose your footing and fall into the sea.* Go to Verse 2.

4+ – *Feeling solid ground under your feet, you breathe a sigh of relief. Now, you hate the wind even more.* Each Party member gains 1 Exposure. Exploration ends.

2

You manage to crawl onto solid land, but you can't feel your limbs or think straight. You're not sure you will survive.

Each Party member loses 1 , and gains 4 and 4 Exposure. Exploration ends.

3

The floor crunches unpleasantly under your feet – it's covered in frozen mud and fishbones. The tower is empty, save for a strange chair resembling a throne of some ominous ocean god – a corpse sits upon it, covered in seaweed, shells, and starfish.

If you **don't have** the **"Riches of the Past"** part **2** status, go to Verse 9.

Otherwise, there isn't anything of use. Go back to Verse 7.

4

Your strike is clean, piercing the place where the corpse should have its heart. It doesn't open its eyes; it doesn't give out a last breath. It just stops existing, as it should have a long time ago. You can almost feel the relief of the escaping soul.

Each Party member loses 1 for each point of their and gains 1 Exp. Go back to Verse 7.

5

You grab the rope with your hands and hook your feet around it. Slowly, you move toward the tower.

You may pay 1 per Party member – if you do, add 1 to the following roll. Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-3 – *You are too afraid of falling. And, in the end, you plummet into the roaring, frigid sea.* Go to Verse 2.

4-7 – *The road is long, but safe, even though the wind freezes you to the bone.* Each Party member gains 3 Exposure. Go to Verse 7.

8+ – *You edge toward the tower with determination until, finally, you arrive at its base.* Each Party member gains 1 Exposure. Go to Verse 7.

7

You stand at the feet of a tower reeking of decaying kelp, fish, and musty water. Where once stood a gate, now only a gaping hole and rusted hinges remain. The interior is dark and quiet, its silence disturbed only by the wind whistling between loose stones.

- **Enter the tower** – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave** – go to Verse 1.

8

You speak to the corpse, but it doesn't react.

If you **have** at least 3 or , go to Verse 10. Otherwise, you can't do anything to make it speak – go back to Verse 7.

9

The corpse raises its head and asks with a raspy voice: "Is it you, Arev? You, here, after all these years, son of an ox!" The corpse looks at you intently, though it has no eyes, only two dark hollows. A small crab resides in one.

The corpse extends its hand above a burnt-out candle, grabs a flint, and sprays the table with bright sparks. The face looks more resigned, and the corpse falls asleep, or at least stops moving. You notice a weapon leaning against the chair.

Each Character with 1 or less gains 1 . Gain the **"Riches of the Past"** part **2** status. Then, choose one:

- **Kill the miserable creature** – go to Verse 4.
- **Try speaking to it** – go to Verse 8.
- **Take the weapon** – gain 1 **"Weapon"** Item. Then, make another choice.
- **Leave it to its misery** – go back to Verse 7.

10

You light the candle, the same the corpse tried to ignite. "Warm," the corpse says. "There is a fire in the Horns of South again. Whoever you are, thank you." Then, it closes its eyes, its face bearing a faint shadow of a smile.

Each Party member gains 2 Exp and loses 3 . Go back to Verse 7.

268 Bleeding Land

Oily waters flow lazily between tree husks surrounding the road leading east, where swords taller than mountains loom in the distance. The marsh doesn't freeze – strange considering the frigid air. You hear a far-off, dying wail.

- **Step off the path** – go to Verse 1.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

Black mud splashes under your feet, tugging at your boots.

- **Explore the dead woods** – go to Verse 4.
- **Wander into the heart of the bog** (only if you don't have the **"Gifts"** part **2** status; pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 7.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

2

You spot a four-eyed owl observing you from a high branch. It slowly turns its head upside down.

- **Approach the owl** – go to Verse 6.
- **Look around** – go to Verse 8.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

4

You delve between trees adorned with rusted chains. Many trunks have fallen and cracked open, revealing their disgusting secret – inside is not wood but thousands of maggot husks.

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-6 – *You didn't notice the predator before it jumps at you.* Resolve a purple Encounter. Then, Exploration ends.

7+ – *You hide, and the monster passes.* Go to Verse 2.

6

The owl takes wing from the branch, spraying drops of caustic liquid, and flies off. You want to go back but notice trails left by small animals. Maybe you can hunt here?

Each Party member with 1 or less loses 1 . You may pay 1 to gain 2 Food. Then, Exploration ends.

7

You walk through the swamp, trying not to lose yourself in this twisted labyrinth. Choking fumes rise from the ground, and ominous sounds echo in the distance.

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-3 – *You fall into the black, oily water. It's freezing and disgusting.* Each Party member loses 1 , gains 1 , and gains 1 Exposure. Exploration ends.

4-7 – *The way is perilous, but you manage to get through unscathed.* Go to Verse 9.

8+ – *Something breaks under your feet, so you jump back. It was only a branch. You end up in a puddle of oily substance.* Each Party member gains 1 and 1 Exposure. Go to Verse 9.

8

The area is certainly interesting – with hollow trees and black, oily waters, but there is nothing relevant to your quest.

If you **have** at least 4 and don't have the **"Riches of the Past"** part **3** status, go to:

Otherwise, go back to Verse 2 and make another choice.

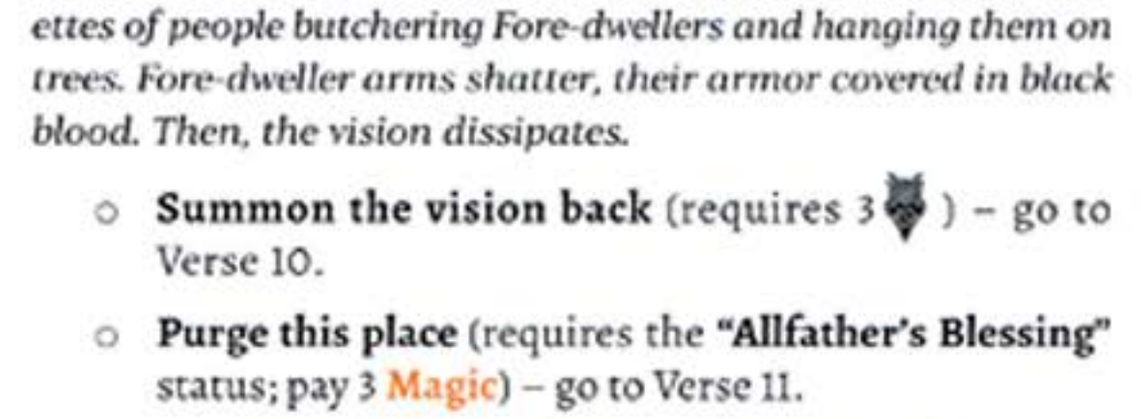
9

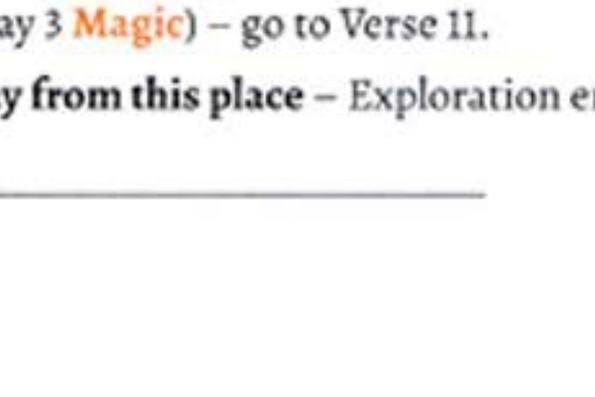
You find a place where a black, oily liquid flows out from the ground. You feel sick from its fumes, and see ethereal silhouettes of people butchering Fore-dwellers and hanging them on trees. Fore-dweller arms shatter, their armor covered in black blood. Then, the vision dissipates.

- **Summon the vision back** (requires 3) – go to Verse 10.
- **Purge this place** (requires the **"Allfather's Blessing"** status; pay 3 Magic) – go to Verse 11.
- **Run away from this place** – Exploration ends.

10

Go to:





11

Go to:

Dream

You don't remember your dream, but after waking, you feel the lancing pain in your arms, as if torn from your body.

Each Character who has this Dream loses 1 .

Nightmare

You wake by the fading campfire. You want to get up, but you can't move. You notice dark silhouettes out of the corner of your eye – they gather around your camp and chant in a language you don't understand. Opalescent tendrils drift forward, and when they touch you, your body flares with agonizing pain. Then, you wake again, looking at the fading campfire. Your eyes and ears bleed.

Each Character who has this Dream loses 1 and gains 1 .

269
Iron Gate

The northern wind carries ominous whispers along with the smell of burned flesh, stirring unpleasant feelings. You approach a massive iron gate leading into a fortress or, as the legends say, a necropolis full of undead monsters. Other stories blame this place for every disease in Avalon, from simple colds to the formidable Red Death.

If you **have** part **7** and **don't have** part **8** of the **"Clues"** status, go to Verse 3. Otherwise, choose one:

- **Inspect the iron gate** – go to Verse 4.
- **Cross the frozen sea** (requires the **"Clues"** part **8** status) – *The path to the north is now visible.* Go to Verse 6.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

2

You finally reach the top of the wall and discover that its other side is smooth and tilted to the inside, preventing anything from escaping. Countless monsters teem at its feet, shedding contaminated blood. You see many buildings, but they are all full of these beasts – you can't figure out how to enter this place without being torn to shreds. Reluctantly, you climb back down.

Exploration ends.

3

You notice a bloody trail on the snow, leading north through the frozen sea. It seems that whoever left it, has known how to cross the perilous field of floating ice. If you follow it, you should be able to traverse it too.

Gain the **"Clues"** part **8** status. Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

Hint: The path to the north is now open.

4

As you approach the iron gate, you notice that someone tried to break it from the outside without success. You can hear unsettling groans and bloodcurdling cries from beyond. Then, everything goes silent, only to burst into loud banging, as if dozens of beasts try to tear down the gate.

- **Climb the wall** (pay 1 per Party member) – *Taking a peek at the other side wouldn't hurt.* Go to Verse 7.
- **Leave** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

6

The blood still marks the ice and snow, showing you the safe path north.

If Location **215** is not attached to this card, you may pay 1 Magic (1 Character), 2 Magic (2–3 Characters), or 3 Magic (4 Characters) to attach Location **215** to the upper edge of Location **269**.

If Location **215** is attached to this card, you may pay 1 per Party member to move all Party members to Location **215**. Then, Exploration ends.

If you didn't do the above, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

7

The wall is tall and covered in ice...

Roll a die and add your . Add 2 if you have the **"Adventurer's Kit"** Item.

1-2 – *You fall on the sharp rocks.* Each Party member loses 3 and 2 . Exploration ends.

3-6 – *Climbing this wall is harder than expected.* Each Party member loses 1 . Go to Verse 2.

7+ – *The wall is high, but you find some convenient handholds.* Go to Verse 2.

Dream

You're imprisoned in a tiny cell. Your skin itches, but you can't scratch it, as it flakes off with the slightest touch. Countless cracks in your flesh bleed intensely, yet you still live, supporting your pathetic body with magic. You're alone in your struggle – other patients have long died or transformed into horrible beasts, killing the last of the monks. So, you wait.

Each Character who has this Dream gains 1 .

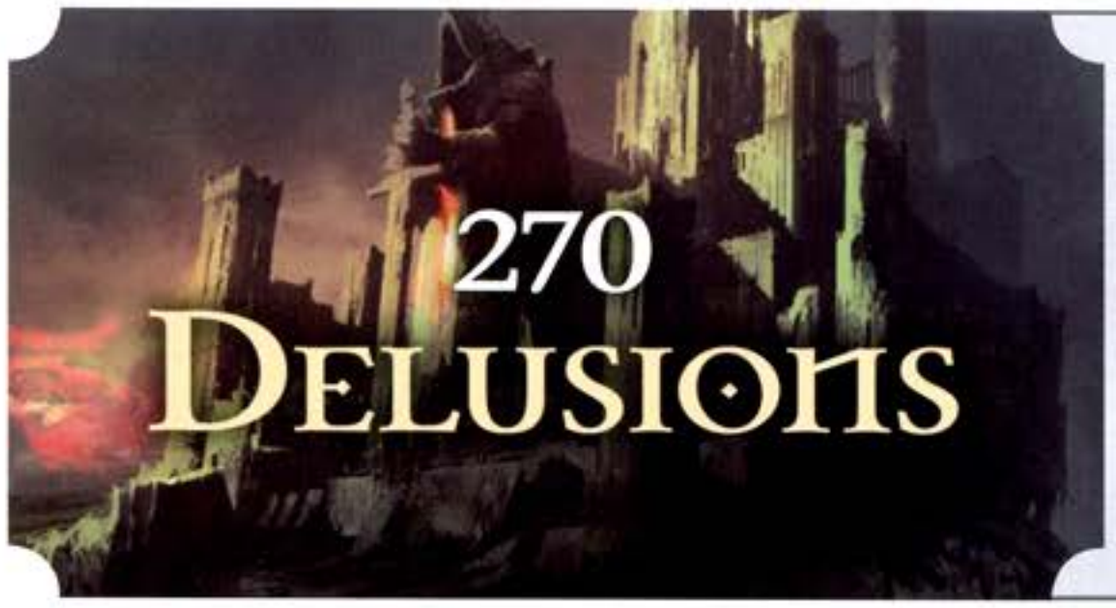
Nightmare

You're the keeper of this place. You can't remember your previous life, only your name: Wyrmtoe. But this puny title isn't yours anymore – you're Dá Derga now, and your red servants await your orders. You can do whatever you want, but you don't have time for... fun. You must reach the continent, where the gods dwell, and raise your palace of blood there.

Each Character who has this Nightmare tosses a Dial:

Skull – the Character gains the Secret card **66**.

Grail – nothing happens.



270 Delusions

If you are in Location **115**, go to Verse 4.

If you are in Location **117**, go to Verse 1.

If you are in Location **119**, go to Verse 11.

If you are in Location **140**, go to Verse 8.

If you are in Location **142**, go to Verse 9.

If you are in Location **157**, go to Verse 13.

If you are in Location **190**, go to Verse 16.

1

If you **have** replaced Location **202** with **282**, go to Verse 7. Otherwise, go to Verse 12.

2

It seems you're not the only hunter here...

Gain 3 Food and toss a Dial:

Grail – resolve the **"Wyrdbear"** green Encounter (Difficulty 1 or 2).

Skull – resolve the **"Trapdoor Hunter"** green Encounter (Difficulty 2).

Then, Exploration ends.

3

The wind rises as you approach the shore. You close your eyes, sheltering them from sand and icy water. When you open them, a raging wave of spirits comes your way.

Resolve the **"Slaugh"** purple Encounter (Difficulty 4). You don't get any Reward or Loot from this Encounter. Then, Exploration ends.

4

These terraces don't look exactly like the steep cliffs you've seen north of Mangrove Huddle, but the resemblance is uncanny.

If you **have** replaced Location **203** with **283**, go to Verse 19. Otherwise, go to Verse 6.

5

It's hard to find something useful – the area is vast, and you're not the first who wants to loot it.

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-4 – *You find nothing but some worthless clay vessels. Your boots are now sodden.* Exploration ends.

5+ – *Oisin was right! You find some magic-infused jewels.* Gain 2 Magic. Exploration ends.

6

A small shrine stands here, guarded by a man with a battle axe. You ready yourself, but he waves and asks if you want to hear about Allfather, the true religion of the Homelands.

- **Speak with the man** – go to Verse 25.
- **Explore nearby caves** – go to Verse 15.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

7

A town surrounded by a high wall sits in the center of the sea of tents. To the north, you see a path leading up the hill. Vagabonds from the camp stare at you with unpleasant eyes, and the town itself is closed to visitors. It's not a welcoming place.

If there is a Quest Token on this Location, go to Verse 30. Otherwise, read on:

Place a Quest Token on this Location. Resolve the **"Confiscation"** blue Encounter (Difficulty 3). You can't Avoid this Encounter. If you fail, people will take your food and provide it to their starving folks. If you win, people praise you as a strong-willed hero. Then, go to Verse 30.

8

A damp meadow unfolds between an ocean, cliffs, and devastated area in the west. It's full of wooden ruins that, according to Oisin's words, hide the magic of the past. Also, local forests abound with game.

- **Hunt** – go to Verse 2.
- **Look for relics** – go to Verse 5.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

9

You wonder how city this big can fit on such a narrow highland. And you miss the cold – in this warm weather, the stench coming from the confined streets is unbearable.

If there is a Quest Token on this Location, go to Verse 14. Otherwise, go to Verse 28.

10

You leave some money in a clay pot held by a young boy and enter the shrine. Everything lies in disarray – dust hangs in the air, workers knock out holes in the walls, painters sketch future frescos. An acolyte leads you to a place where you can pray in relative peace.

Each Party member loses 2. Exploration ends.

11

An enormous tree looms over the troubled sea. It's the same one overlooking Mangrove Huddle, but there is no settlement under its protective roots. It also looks much healthier – its leaves are lush green, and the runes glow brighter than you remember.

Each Party member may pay 2 to rest by the tree – if they do, they lose 1. Then, Exploration ends.

12

It is a corpse of a farmhold – cracked walls, unstable ground riddled with crevices, and a shattered menhir. You have a feeling that something dwells in the soil under your feet. Oisin has told you that you shouldn't linger here – a monstrous beast frequents this place.

- **Ignore the warnings and explore this area** – go to Verse 20.
- **Quickly go past this area** – Exploration ends.

13

The beach is a place of both beauty and horror – waves shimmer in the autumn light, forcing you to squint your eyes, while the sand is full of bones and corpses washed ashore, shrouded with ominous mist. The stench of rotting kelp permeates the air.

- **Admire the view** – go to Verse 17.
- **Search the shore** – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave this unsettling place** – Exploration ends.

14

You navigate busy streets with difficulty.

- **Visit the market square** – go to Verse 24.
- **Find a healer** – go to Verse 21.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

15

Allfather's priests established a small asylum for paupers and travelers. You're welcomed with open arms and offered food and accommodation.

If you **don't have** the **"Darkness"** part **5** status, you may accept their invitation – go to Verse 18.

Otherwise, Exploration ends.

16

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **8** status, go to Verse 23. If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **9** status, go to 27. Otherwise, go to 29.

17

It's hard to admire this cemetery, despite its beauty. Additionally, you start hearing discordant music played by the wind on the bones. Your muscles tense up. Visions of death grip your imagination.

Each Party member gains 1. Exploration ends.

18

The meal was filling, and now priests tend your wounds.

Gain the **"Darkness"** part **5** status. Each Party member gains 1 Food and 2. Then, Exploration ends.

19

A small Allmother shrine is surrounded with scaffolding. Dozens of white-clad acolytes carry orders and water between workers. Several guards stand near the entrance to the caves.

- **Visit the temple** (pay 1 Wealth per Party member) – *They want a donation for the roof repairs.* Go to Verse 10.
- **Speak with the guards** – go to Verse 22.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

20

You scout the terrain when the ground beneath you suddenly collapses, accompanied by a deafening roar. You try to jump away and escape, but then something emerges from the soil, tossing you away like a rag doll. Everything goes dark.

You regain consciousness a little later, with pain in your chest and countless scratches. There is a large hole, at least as wide as the tree in the Mangrove Huddle, several paces from you.

Each Party member loses 6 reduced by their and . Exploration ends.

21

A local healer is beleaguered – an unending queue of patients snakes through narrow alleys.

- **Wait for your turn** (pay 2 and 1 Wealth per Party member) – go to Verse 26.
- **Use your charm** (requires 3 , pay 1 Wealth per Party member) – go to Verse 26.
- **Leave** – *You don't have time for this!* Go back to Verse 9 and make another choice.

22

Guards tell you that heretics and bandits are kept there, and no one can enter. They are fed, of course, but remain too dangerous to be let free.

Go back to Verse 19 and make another choice.

23

You pass the castle gates under the piercing gaze of two wardens. Their primitive leather armor and simple spears don't match the grandeur of this fortress. The next sight is also unusual – instead of noble people, knights, or servants, you see an unorganized camp of smallfolk. There are also some well-maintained statues, depicting unknown heroes – looking at them brings strange warmth to your heart. Oisin thanks for your aid and goes toward the archive, where he has something to do, as he says.

Go to:

24

The market square is impressive, and you can acquire a plethora of items there. But be careful – there are also many fraudsters looking for easy prey.

- **Sell food** – pay 2 Food to gain 1 Wealth (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy equipment** (only if there is no Time Token on this Location) – place a Time Token on this Location. Draw top 2 Item cards. You can buy any number of them for 3 Wealth each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sell equipment** – discard any number of non-Craftable Item cards and gain 2 Wealth for each of them. Then, make another choice.
- **Leave the square** – Exploration ends.

25

The man tells you that Allmother's cult is a religion made up single-handedly by Morgaine who wanted to take control over the Round Table and the entire Avalon. According to him, before Morgaine's manipulations, the prime deity was always the Allfather. The man and his comrades found tomes describing this true religion that date back to the Homelands. And he will be preaching it, with peace and rightfulness, helping those in need, showing that priests and faith should be for people, not the other way around.

Go back to Verse 6.

26

The healer doesn't look concerned with your ailments, gives you a small flask, and pushes you out the door. You drink, hoping it will help. It doesn't, but you feel invigorated.

Each Party member gains 1 . Exploration ends.

27

Two knights stop you at the gate, but when they spot Oisin, they let you through. Then, Oisin thanks for your help and tells you that he must visit the archive in haste. Before he departs, he asks some servants to entertain you.

Go to:

28

A woman in a simple tunic pulls you away. She explains that she was once an influential noble, but the vile schemes of her enemies cost her everything. She begs you to help her and promises she will return the favor soon – you just have to trust her and wait. When you think about her words, a group of youngsters surrounds you, asking about your weapons and tugging at your clothes. When you drive them away, you notice the woman also disappeared, along with one of your bags.

Place a Quest Token on this Location. A Party member with the lowest (in case of a tie use the highest Character Number) loses all Food and all Wealth. If there is only 1 Character in play, they lose half of their Food and Wealth rounded up instead. Then, go to Verse 14.

29

The castle is dilapidated – the gate hangs on one hinge, the walls are rubble, and the lone guard, looking like another permanent element of the fortress, is old and wears a dented breastplate. He looks at you lazily and lets you in. There are some ragged "knights" skirmishing with axes and shields, and one groom tending an overfed horse. You have a feeling that this place will look like your Kamelot in not so many years. Oisin interrupts your grim observation, and thanks you for your help. Then he departs, explaining that he must go to the archive.

Go to:

30

The camp huddled under the town walls bustles with energy and anger. Your appearance pushed them to do something about their pathetic situation, and they yell that if they aren't allowed into First Farmhold, they will take this place by force.

- **Buy makeshift items** – draw 2 Craftable Item cards. You can buy any number of them for 2 Wealth each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sell food** – pay 1 Food to gain 1 Wealth (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Leave the village** – Exploration ends.

Dream & Nightmare

You look through eight eyes at your sleeping body – curled beneath the wall of Kamelot's underground archive. A thin layer of dust covers your face, your clothes, your hair. Everything is still, nothing interrupts the disturbing tranquility. Are you dead?

Each Character who reads this Dream or Nightmare gains 1.

Menhir

You can't Activate a Menhir in this Location.

270

271 Sanctum

The temple is awe-inspiring, rising to the sky and surrounded by stoic priests, their snow-white robes contrasting with the lush vegetation. The sun scorches you with its light, adding almost pleasant discomfort to the scene. You don't like this place – it's not of your world, and you're not a part of this story.

- **Enter the sanctum** – go to Verse 7.
- **Speak with priests** (only if you don't have the Secret card **1** or **8**) – go to Verse 4.
- **Show your inflamed wounds to a priest** (requires the Secret card **66**) – go to Verse 11.
- **Concoct a plan to steal the exemplar** (only if you **have** the **"Friends"** part **7** status and **don't have** the Secret card **1** or **8**) – go to Verse 10.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

"May the Allmother bless you! You have the luck of visiting the first Allmother temple across all times and places," an old priestess says. You ask what it means, but she doesn't elaborate – she just keeps looking at you with a kind, warm smile.

Gain the **"Strangeness"** part **2** status.

Exploration ends.

4

If you **have** the **"Gifts"** part **4** status, go to Verse 6.

If you **have** the **"Friends"** part **7** status, go to Verse 8.

Otherwise, go to Verse 1.

6

A priest and priestess welcome you warmly – they know your purpose here and will help you in any way possible. They lead you into the magnificent temple. You can't help but stare at the colorful stained glass, high, ribbed vault, golden ornaments, and vivid frescos. You enter a smaller room with a single pedestal inside, with a goblet on it. It radiates with glory so imposing you don't know if you should cry or kneel. The priests kindly pretend they haven't noticed your reaction – they take the cup. They place it in your hands, warm and glowing.

"Do not be afraid to hold it. You are unable to taint it, and it will find its way back home, once it's no longer needed," the priestess says, and they both bid you farewell.

Gain the Secret card **1**. Discard the Active Quest Pile. Find and resolve the **Chapter 12**: **Part 3** Event card. Exploration ends.

7

A guard clad in shiny armor and snow-white surcoat stops you. He says you cannot enter without priests' consent.

Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

8

You feel judging gazes on your back as you approach the gate. Two young men and an older priestess block your way. "I have to ask you to leave," says the woman. "I don't know about your intentions, but I can feel the evil lurking near you. I cannot let it taint the sanctity of this temple."

Exploration ends.

10

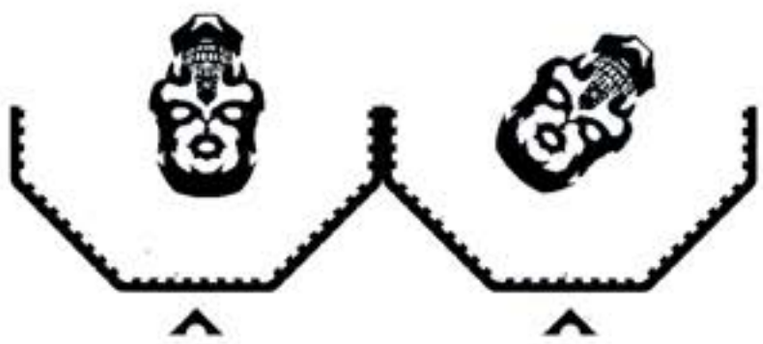
You look around and discover that the temple's only entrance is the main gate watched by a guard. He doesn't even look at incoming priests and lets them in without a word, though. If you manage to get white robes, you could sneak in without any problem.

- **Leave** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.
- **Assault a lone priest and steal his robe** – go to:

11

The man to whom you show your wounds is visibly scared by them. He leads you to a room with a sparkling fountain and asks you to stay there. You are left unsupervised, as you wait for "powerful priestesses" – only they can do something about your ailment.

- **Wait for priestesses** – go to Verse 12.
- **Slip away and try to steal the exemplar** (only if you don't have the Secret card **1** or **8**, AND have the **"Friends"** part **7** status) – go to:



12

Go to:

Dream & Nightmare

You wander around the temple. The cathedral looks increasingly like a tree – stained glass turns into hollows; towers branch off the main building. Soon, you circle the giant tree growing in Mangrove Huddle, but the entrance to the temple is still visible in its thick trunk.

Gain the **"Strangeness"** part **3** status.

272
CORBENIC

A pleasant smell of fruits and pastry fills the air. Merry music echoes from within the castle with walls blindingly white, rising from a clear lake. Everything feels so serene... you could stare for hours and soak up the sights, but the temperature makes you sweat, and the vibrant colors unnerve.

- **Return to Avalon** – go to Verse 4.
- **Enter the castle** – go to Verse 1.
- **Explore the castle's surroundings** – go to Verse 7.
- **Meet the old man** (requires the **"Friends"** part **7** status and the Secret card **1**) – go to Verse 6.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

If you **have** the **"Friends"** part **7** status, go to Verse 10. Otherwise, go to Verse 2.

2

You cross the bridge and the gate breathes cool, fragrant air in your face. Before you know it, you find yourself inside the magnificent castle.

- **Visit the king** – go to Verse 5.
- **Speak with servants** – go to Verse 8.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

3

Fisher King, as you name him in your mind, looks away and tells you that there is a relic in the temple beyond the splendorous fields to the east. "This relic – I desired it once, so much so that I was ready to do anything to have it. But there was a grim lesson I was yet to learn. Some things can only be claimed by those who do not seek them..."

The king goes silent for a while, and then continues:

"I decided to move the cup from the castle, for – despite all its beauty – its sight pained me greatly," the king says. "Go to the temple and take it. It will be reborn here anyway, made whole by the memories of countless worlds that help it exist. Take it and do whatever you want in your world. I'm not a part of it, not anymore."

Gain the **"Gifts"** part **4** status. Go back to Verse 5.

4

You wander the forest, but after a while, you inevitably end up near the glorious, shimmering lake. Even if you try going in a straight line, you eventually return to the castle.

Gain the **"Strangeness"** part **6** status.

Each Party member loses 2. Exploration ends.

5

A middle-aged man in livery leads you through the throne room and long corridors to the small door in the castle wall. You emerge at the hidden shore where a man in simple clothes sits with a fishing rod in his hands. He looks at you with anticipation.

If you **have** the **"Friends"** part **7** status, his stare is intimidating – each Party member gains 1. Then, read on:

"Do you have it? Have you learned the question?" the king finally says.

He notices your confusion, smiles warmly, and says:

"I apologize. I see you came here with different purpose. What is it you seek?"

- **Leave the king in peace** – Exploration ends.
- **Ask him about the exemplar of the human reality** (only if you don't have the **"Gifts"** part **4** status) – go to Verse 3.
- **Ask him about the secret of this place** (only if you don't have the Secret card **91**) – go to:

6

Go to:

7

The castle's surroundings are plain, but something happens to the east, where sounds of battle and revelry emanate. The lake, the forest on its edges, and meadows look more like a poetic idea rather than a real place – the atmosphere is peaceful, but also filled with ominous tension, a fear of beyond. Just like lands of legends and myths, where every forest hides treasures and monsters, and where every rock has a meaning and a mystery behind it. You feel awful when you look at the perfection surrounding you – you're from the opposite of this realm; a land of flaws, distorted by wyrdness. You don't like this place.

Gain the **"Strangeness"** part **5** status.

Exploration ends.

8

Servants are eager to answer questions related to the castle, but they don't know anything else. It seems that they don't even have the basic knowledge about this strange, summer world.

Gain the **"Strangeness"** part **4** status.

Go back to Verse 2.

10

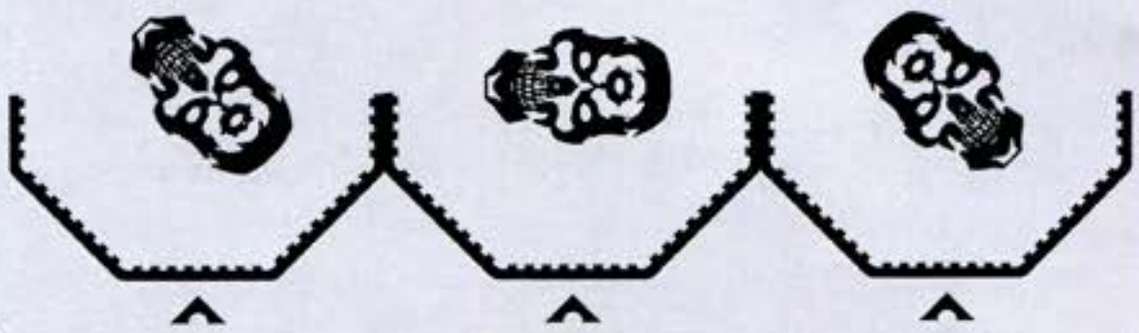
Knights at the gate tell you that you didn't have to escape – the king had decided to free you. But now he is angry.

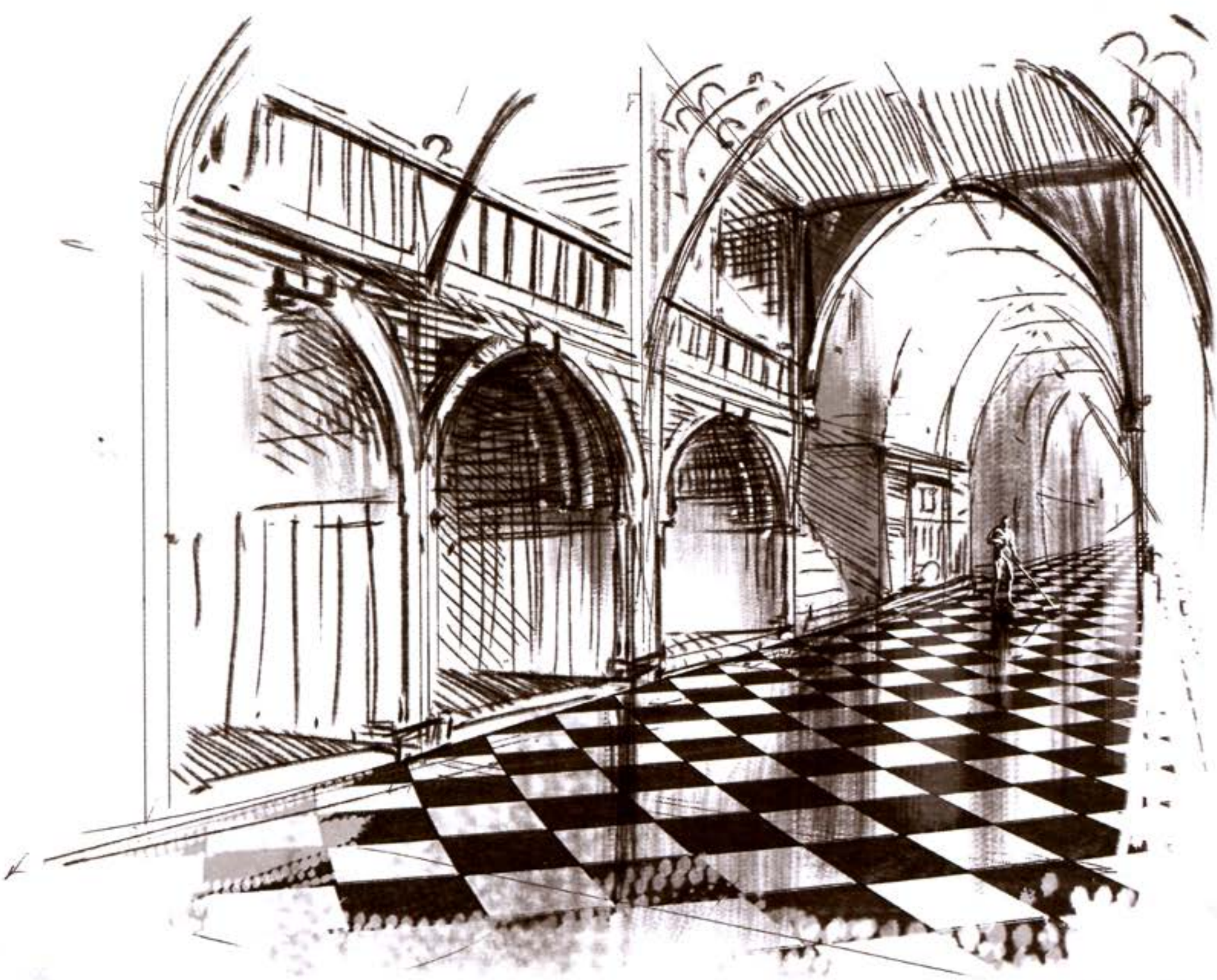
Go to Verse 2.

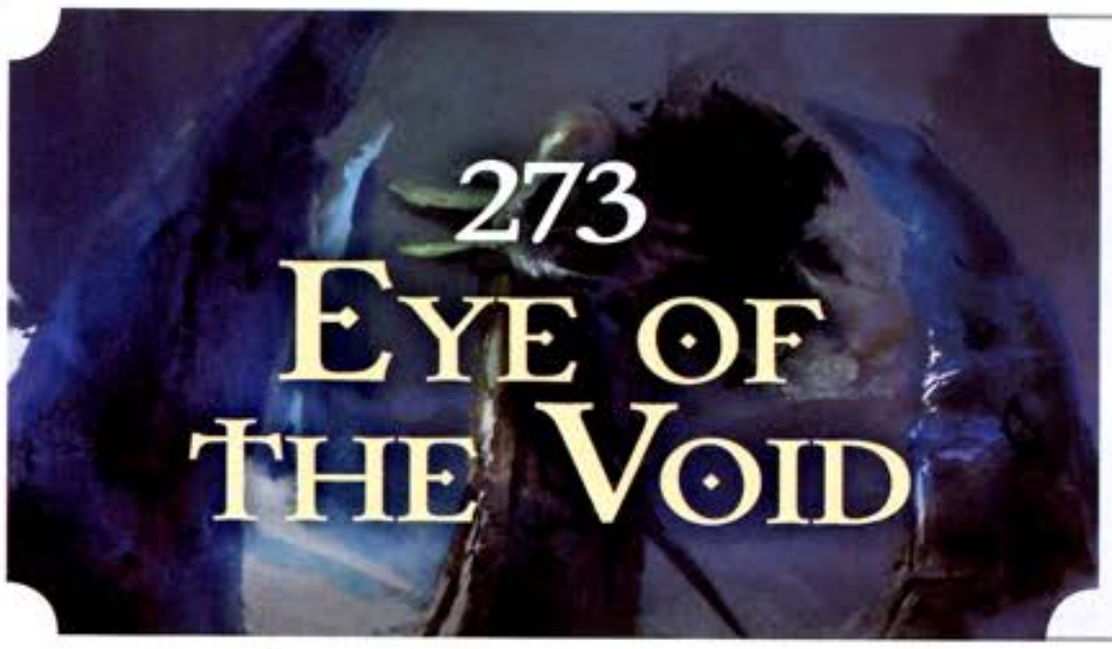
Dream & Nightmare

When the night comes, you lie on the lush green grass, drenched in sweat. It's too warm and humid. Falling asleep here will be a challenge. You try to relax and look at the sky. It's... wrong. The stars that you know are gone. Shieldmaidens are gone. The Walrus and its Prey are gone. Even the reddish Cauldron. This place is not your world. Could the key to repairing Avalon lie so far from Avalon?

If the **Chapter 12: Part 3** Quest Card is revealed and you have at least 4 parts of the **"Strangeness"** status, go to:







273
Eye of the Void

Dried blood blemishes the menhir standing in the circle of ice claws, which rise like a maw about to clamp shut. Runes etch the surface of these claws, all bloodied. The portal to the nothingness is larger than before – it swallowed the building, and is starting to devour the next one. But it flickers, as if it might disappear at any moment. For now, this is not a safe place.

If there is a Fore-dweller model or Time Token on this Location, go to Verse 1.

Otherwise, go to Verse 5.

1

Choose one:

- **Approach the menhir** – go to Verse 3.
- **Search through the ruins** – *Because of the portal, this can be dangerous.* Go to Verse 7.
- **Leave the deserted village** – Exploration ends.

2

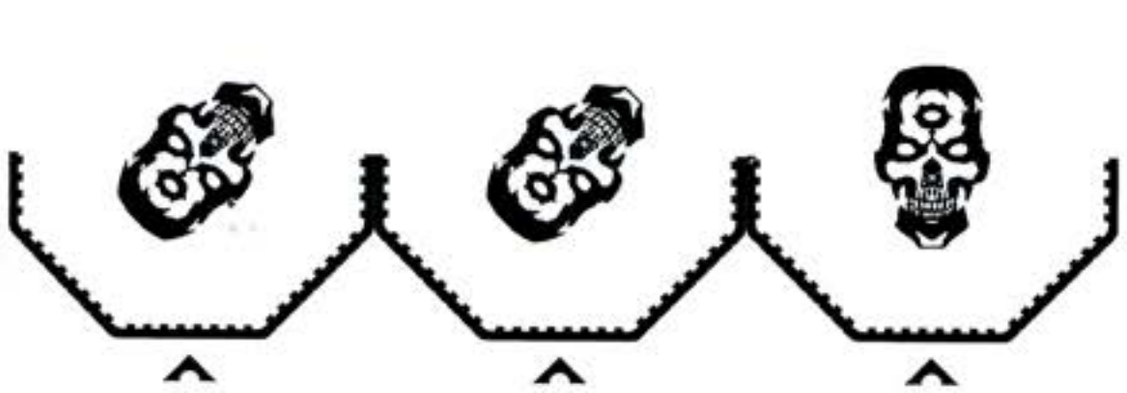
Frigid air flows from the portal like a swift river. Your hands tremble, your body shivers. You move as cautious as you can, but you accidentally hit the wall. The building collapses. Wounded and freezing, you crawl from the rubble.

Each Party member loses 2 and gains 1 Exposure. Exploration ends.

3

Tainted by the madman's blood, the menhir looks terrifying – a harbinger of humanity's end.

- **Focus on something else** – go back to Verse 1.
- **Start carving** (requires all Characters and **Chapter 14**) – go to:

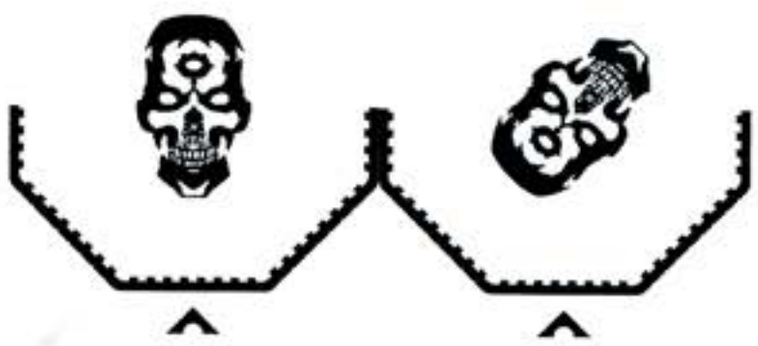


4

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-7 – go to Verse 2.

8+ – go to:



5

Roll a die and add +3 if there is an Active Menhir in this Location. Subtract the value of your . Then, check your final result:

1-5 – go to Verse 1.

6+ – place a Time Token on this Location and go to Verse 10.

7

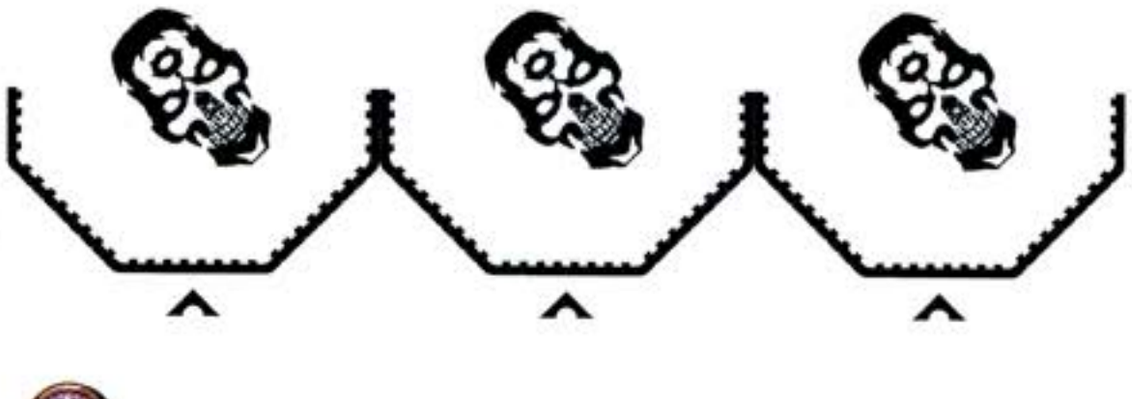
There's not much here. When the menhirs started working again, people from Mangrove Huddle became braver and scavenged everything from this place. The only place that may still hold anything worth taking is the half-devoured building near the portal. It looks dangerous.

- **Search it anyway** (pay 2 per Party member) – go to Verse 4.
- **Leave** – go back to Verse 1.

10

"When you see black wings, put out your light and hide in the darkness," goes the saying. It hints at a truth.

Go to:



Menhir

Requires **all Characters** and the **Menhir Rites** Secret card (**11**).

Pay 3 and 2 Magic (per Character): put a new Menhir model on this Location and set its Dial to **8** (-1 per Character).

If there aren't enough models left, take one from another Location of your choice.

274 SPLENDOR

Dozens of knights duel in tiltyards, while mages show off their magic, ogled by well-dressed spectators. The sky bursts with blazes of bright spells, and the laughter and cheers deafen you. Before you know it, you are a part of this loud crowd.

- **Challenge a knight** – go to Verse 3.
- **Push through the crowd** – go to Verse 6.
- **Watch the tournament** – go to Verse 2.
- **Challenge a mage** (pay 1 Magic per Party member) – go to Verse 8.

1

You leave, exhausted and full of contempt. Your pride will hurt for a while.

Each Party member loses 1 and gains 1.

2

The tournament is addictive, and the day passes in no time. But you don't regret spending time here – it was a wonderful experience that would be impossible to find in the frozen Avalon.

Each Party member gains 1 Exp and loses all . Exploration ends.

3

The knight, perfect in every way, looks at you with disdain. "You're filled with darkness so deep that even my sword is not able to cleanse it. I won't fight you – you would only taint my weapon."

- **Persuade him to fight** (requires 3 or 4) – go to Verse 10.
- **Leave in shame** – go to Verse 1.

6

Every step forward is a struggle with so many people around, and so much ruckus. Everyone tries to be kind and to let you through, but still, navigating the crowd takes a long, long time.

Each Party member loses 2. Exploration ends.

8

You approach the sorceress whose spell shimmered in the sky a moment ago. She greets you with a broad smile and accepts your challenge. Your most powerful rituals and spells look like cantrips compared to her miracles. But she doesn't disdain you – she tells you that you have the potential, but need more training.

Each Party member loses 1. Exploration ends.

10

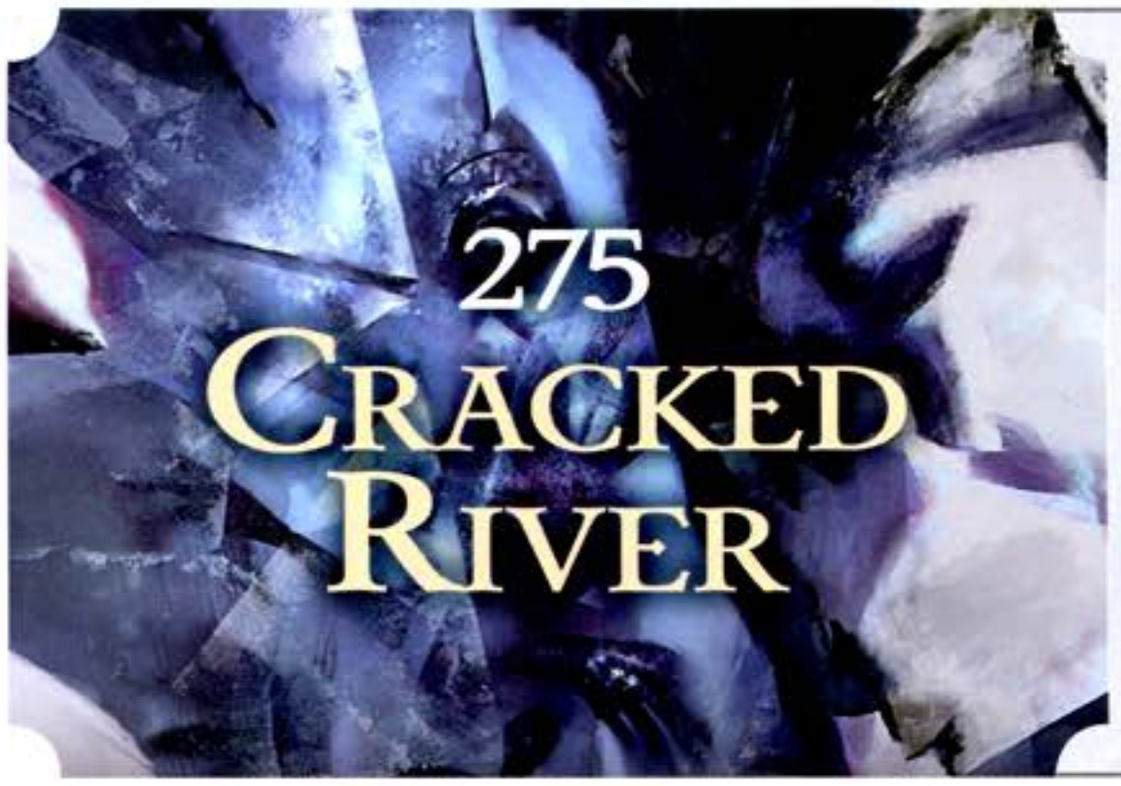
You convince the knight that it's not evil, but strangeness – you're from a land so far away it's no wonder you're different. He apologizes for his prejudice and agrees to fight you. It's a one-sided duel – he makes no mistakes; his movements are precise and speak of a lifetime spend under a watchful eye of the best teachers. After his victory, he congratulates you on your courage and effort, and asks you to accept a gift for his earlier, unacceptable behavior.

If you **don't have** the **"Gifts"** part **5** status, gain 1 Wealth and the **"Gifts"** part **5** status; each Party member gains 1 Exp. Exploration ends.

Dream & Nightmare

The night falls, and everyone leaves the tournament site. Where are they going? They were so many people here they won't fit into the castle or the temple, and you didn't see any other buildings nearby. You fall asleep, troubled by these thoughts.

Gain the **"Strangeness"** part **1** status.



275 CRACKED RIVER

You move past loose ice shards on your way to the Still River. As you approach, you find the surface cracked, as if something heavy fell on it – or something tried to escape from below. Whatever happened, it flung the shattered ice, damaging trees and collapsing the ruined cottage. Only the strange structure stands unharmed.

- **Check the menhir** – go to Verse 3.
- **Go to the west** – go to Verse 6.
- **Pass the southern forest** – go to Verse 7.
- **Visit the strange ice structure** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 2.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

2

The structure is ominous, as it has always been. It still is made of spirals similar to shapes that travelers sometimes find imprinted on large boulders in northern hills and caverns.

Each Party member gains 1 Magic and 1 . Exploration ends.

3

You carefully step onto the ice, avoiding the largest fractures, and move toward the place where the menhir was submerged. The closer you are, the more destruction you see – it looks like the menhir was the epicenter of this incident. The ice lost its transparency, but as you look through it, you can discern the menhir's outline – it stands cracked and broken. You don't feel even the slightest trace of its magic.

Each Party member gains 1 . Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

6

The mist was dispersed, probably by the same event that fractured the ice river. Going west isn't a problem anymore.

If Location **241** is not attached to this card, you may pay 1 Magic (1 Character), 2 Magic (2-3 Characters), or 3 Magic (4 Characters) to attach Location **241** to the left of Location **275**.

If Location **241** is attached to this card, you may pay 1 per Party member to move all Party members to Location **241**. Then, Exploration ends.

If you didn't do the above, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

7

You delve into the impassable forest. However, finding the route shown to you by the ironclad warrior proves easy, and soon you stand on the other side of the root maze.

If Location **225** (or **276**, or **277**) is not attached to this card, you may pay 1 Magic (1 Character), 2 Magic (2-3 Characters), or 3 Magic (4 Characters) to attach Location **225** (or **276**, or **277**) to the bottom of Location **275**.

If Location **225** (or **276**, or **277**) is attached to this card, you may pay 1 per Party member to move all Party members to Location **225** (or **276**, or **277**). Then, Exploration ends.

If you didn't do the above, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

276
Glorious Tree

Nature sprouts, sticking shy stems out of the snow. Roots of the tree seem less dry. It's also warmer – you shiver only when the wind blows, and the snow is wet and sticks to your boots. When you look up, you see a lush tree crown shimmering with gold. The tree lies just beyond a broken bridge.

- **Go north, toward the frozen river** – go to Verse 3.
- **Cross the damaged bridge** (pay 1 per Party member) – *There is a magnificent tree on the other side.* Go to Verse 4.
- **Visit the marvelous site** (requires the **"Means of Survival"** part **5** status; pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 5.
- **Find a place you've seen from the tower** (only if you have the **"Mysteries and Visions"** part **5** and **don't have** the **"Means of Survival"** part **5** status; pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 6.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

3

Melting snow sticks to your boots as you walk through the flourishing forest.

If Location **235** (or **275**) is not attached to this card, you may pay 1 **Magic** (1 Character), 2 **Magic** (2-3 Characters), or 3 **Magic** (4 Characters) to attach Location **235** (or **275**) to the top of Location **276**.

If Location **235** (or **275**) is attached to this card, you may pay 1 per Party member to move all Party members to Location **235** (or **275**). Then, Exploration ends.

If you didn't do the above, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

4

You smell the tree long before you can see it – a pleasant, sweet scent wafts toward you. Under the tree, blooming flowers surround a small grave, slowly engulfing the majestic, immovable spear stuck deep into the ground. Golden fruit hangs from sagging branches, inviting you to taste.

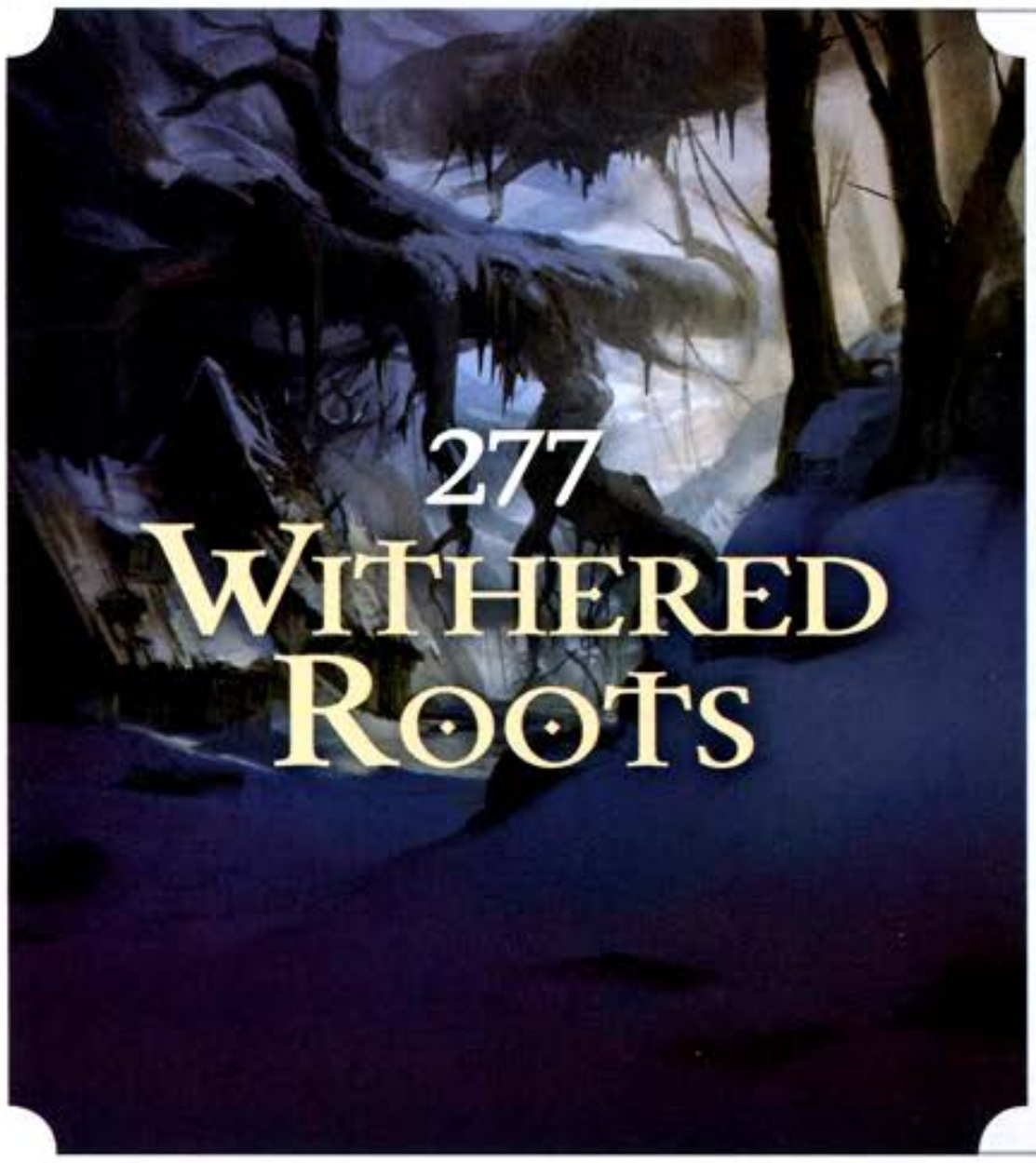
- **Leave** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.
- **Rest by the tree** – each Party member gains 2 and loses 2 . Exploration ends.
- **Eat a fruit** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to:

5

Go to:

6

Go to:



277 Withered Roots

Can it be the roots are more tangled than before? Many drip with disgusting sap, leaving greasy and pungent stains on your clothes. You feel something staring at you from every shadow, but you can't hear anything other than wind whistling between dried branches. You're not sure if this place has any chance of becoming a path to the north once again.

Each Party member gains 1 **Exposure**. Then, choose one:

- **Go north, toward the frozen river** – go to Verse 3.
- **Cross the damaged bridge** (pay 1 per Party member) – *The tree on the other side looks sick.* Go to Verse 4.
- **Visit the marvelous site** (requires the **"Means of Survival"** part **5** status; pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 5.
- **Find a place you've seen from the tower** (only if you **have** the **"Mysteries and Visions"** part **5** and **don't have** the **"Means of Survival"** part **5** status; pay 2 per Party member) – go to Verse 6.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

3

The yellowish, fetid liquid drips on your shoulders as you travel north.

If Location **235** (or **275**) is not attached to this card, you may pay 1 **Magic** (1 Character), 2 **Magic** (2-3 Characters), or 3 **Magic** (4 Characters) to attach Location **235** (or **275**) to the top of Location **277**.

If Location **235** (or **275**) is attached to this card, you may pay 1 per Party member to move all Party members to Location **235** (or **275**). Then, Exploration ends.

If you didn't do the above, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

4

The tree casts a deep shadow on the grave, rimmed with dried flowers. A spear impaled into the grave announces the triumph of something sinister. Tree branches sag under the weight of brown, slimy fruits oozing reeking juice.

- **Leave** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.
- **Eat a fruit** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to:

5

The hot spring stinks like rotten puffin eggs. You must warm up – despite the smell, you immerse yourself in the waters.

Each Party member discards the Exposure Marker and gains 1 . Exploration ends.

6

You search the dark thicket and find that it hides a hot spring.

Each Party member gains 1 . Gain the **"Means of Survival"** part **5** status. Go to Verse 5.

280 Forlorn Swords

The enormous swords dwarf even the mountains – one lies on its side, concealing a ruined building beneath its blade; the second lies broken in half; the third reaches to the sky, its pommel obscured by clouds. For a moment, you think these must be the swords of giants who yielded to Arthur, but they are simply too large. They also couldn't be made by humans. Is it a work of wyrdness?

- **Investigate the old ruin** – go to Verse 1.
- **Check the broken blade** – go to Verse 8.
- **Go on a hunt** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

You approach the ruins resembling a massive version of Mangrove Huddle's forge. Huge bellows, their leather bags long rotted away, wait near furnaces that haven't seen fire for ages. Most tools lie on workbenches in order, but rusted and decayed beyond repair. You note one empty spot, marked with dark, frozen blood – someone has taken one of the items. You follow the barely visible track and discover it leads east.

Gain the **"Clues"** part **7** status. Exploration ends.

Hint: You should travel east to progress your quest.

2

You search the place – closer inspection reveals the extent of the incomprehensible catastrophe. It appears an entire settlement perished in a moment. It's terrible, but you can't do anything about it – you're here for loot. It seems there might be some things worth your attention.

Each Party member gains 1 Wealth and 1 . If you **don't have** the **"Riches of the Past"** part **4** status, gain 1 non-Companion Item, then gain the **"Riches of the Past"** part **4** status. Exploration ends.

3

Mountains abound with animals.

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-3 – *You catch a small fox, but something much larger attacks you.* Gain 1 Food. Draw 2 green Encounters and resolve one with the higher value.

4-7 – *You find a nest of delicious eggs. But a mountain predator looking for an easy meal comes upon the nest at the same time.* Gain 2 Food. Resolve a green Encounter.

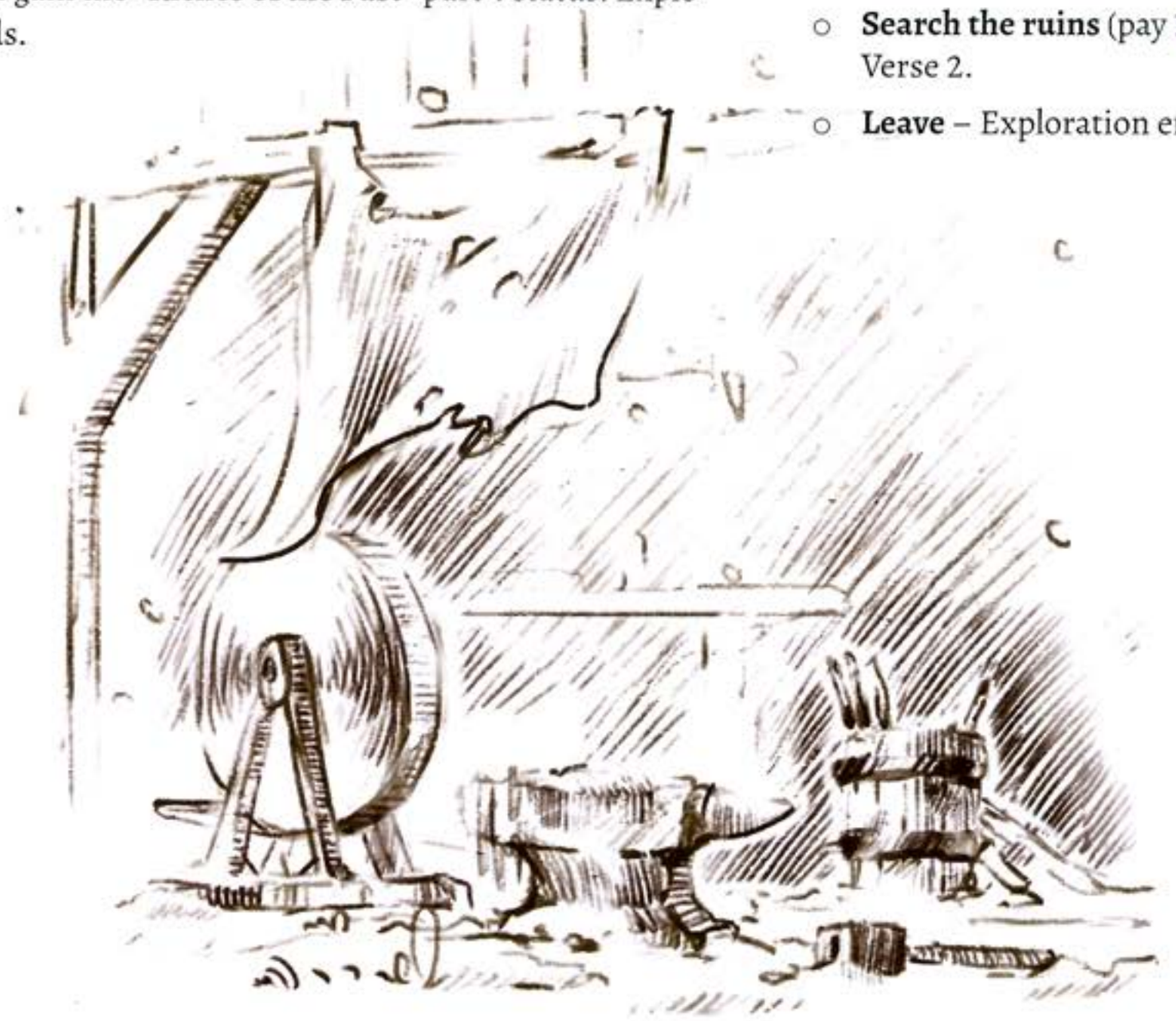
8+ – *You find a family of puffins on a cliff. You catch some before they take flight.* Gain 2 Food. Resolve the **"Glacial Puffin"** green Encounter (Difficulty 1).

Then, Exploration ends.

8

Ropes, thick as your forearm, entwine the giant sword handle. The dangling lines lead to the valley where you find crushed wooden houses, furniture, and dozens of frozen corpses, all entangled in the ropes.

- **Search the ruins** (pay 1 per Party member) – go to Verse 2.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.



282 Round Farmhold

A town-sized rotunda with stone walls and a dome covered in black sand stands watch over a meadow north of the Mangrove Huddle. This farmhold stands isolated from the outside world – to gain entrance, you must prove yourself a merchant or person of great renown. Even then, the guards must hoist you up to the gate in the dome at the top of the wall.

- **Gain access to the city** – go to Verse 2.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

One scene in particular attracts your attention. The founders of the city stand around the lake with a wooden house in the center. They perform a ritual of some sort. In the next scene, the water is clear, and many people rest by its shore.

Each Party member loses 1 . Exploration ends.

2

You approach the high wall from where a guard shouts: "Halt!" You see she holds a bow at the ready with an arrow nocked. She declares none enter the city without good reason.

- **You look trustworthy** (requires 6 Rep or 3) – go to Verse 5.
- **You have goods to trade** (pay 1 Food per Party member) – *You also have a gift for the guard.* Go to Verse 5.
- **Otherwise, they turn you away** – Exploration ends.

3

The tavern, run by a retired storyteller, is small and comfortable. You relish the subtle aroma of birch wine as you sit near an ornamental fireplace. After the drink, you warm yourself in a fragrant sauna.

Each Party member discards the Exposure Marker, gains 1 , and loses 1 . Then, each Party member Passes for the rest of the Day. Exploration ends.

4

Each shop is distinct – no one offers the same goods. Their owners have two apprentices each, to ensure their knowledge and skill pass to the next generation.

- **Haggle for better prices** (pay 6 Rep reduced by 1 for each point of your ; in a Party use only the maximum value) – go to Verse 10.
- **Rent a workstation** (pay 1 Wealth and 3) – draw 2 random Craftable Items and pick one. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Then, make another choice.
- **Buy equipment** – draw 2 Item cards. You can buy any number for 4 Wealth each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sell equipment** – discard any number of Item cards and gain 1 Wealth for each. Then, make another choice.
- **Go somewhere else** – go to Verse 5.

5

The city is full of convoluted laws and customs following old traditions and the Allfather's commandments. One's social status regulates access to the warmth, but no one can explain how exactly to gain (or lose) this status. Taverns brim with alcohol, but no food. At least they have a nice artisan district.

- **Visit a tavern** (pay 2 Wealth per Party member, this will end your day) – go to Verse 3.
- **Pay for the entry to the underground** (pay 1 Wealth per Party member) – go to Verse 9.
- **Enter the artisan district** – go to Verse 4.
- **Leave the city** – Exploration ends.

8

Tradition does not bind you, so you don't take the strange laws of these people for granted. Instead, you find a way to twist them to your benefit.

- **Rent a workstation** (pay 3) – draw 3 random Craftable Items and pick one. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Then, make another choice.
- **Buy equipment** – draw 3 Item cards. You can buy any number for 4 Wealth each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sell equipment** – discard any number of Item cards and gain 2 Wealth for each. Then, make another choice.
- **Go somewhere else** – go to Verse 5.

9

The underground is impressive – vast caves filled with enormous wyrm bones, and walls decorated with frescoes depicting the founders of the city and their combat with the beast. Some paintings show a great battle with the rebels first trying to breach the walls and, failing that, to burn the city.

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **1** status, go to Verse 1.

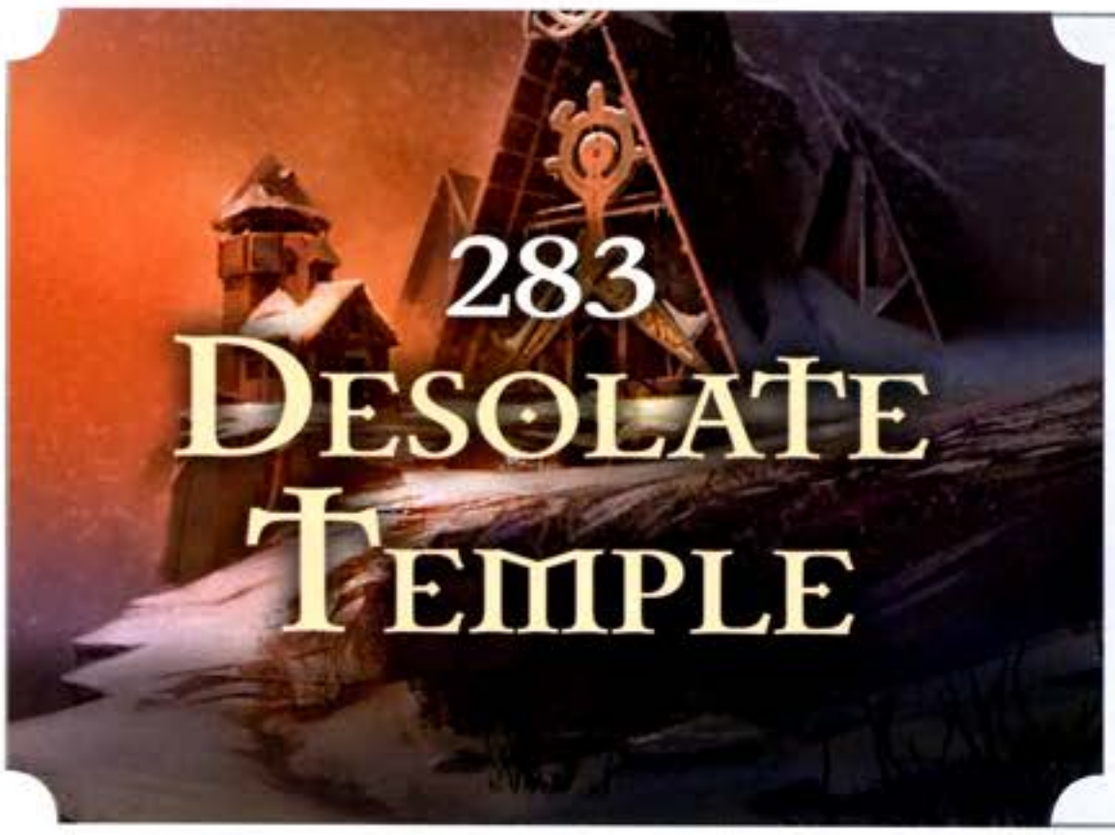
Otherwise, Exploration ends.

10

When you mention a discount, the merchant immediately calls a guard who approaches and explains that you are breaking the law – all prices are regulated by decrees.

Resolve the **"Convoluted Laws"** blue Encounter (Difficulty 1). You don't get any Reward and don't apply any Failure in this Encounter.

If you win, go to Verse 8. Otherwise, Exploration ends.



283
Desolate Temple

A small cottage sits on the cliff in the shade of a great temple bearing symbols of the Allmother. Even with the Allfather's religion rooting out any sign of older faith, this still stands. As you look south, a scenic vista unfolds: woods, glimmering snow, and beyond them – ocean. You turn west, looking at a steep slope too dangerous to descend, and wonder about the path that once led down toward Twisted Pathways.

- **Go inside the temple** – go to Verse 1.
- **Observe the lands to the west** – go to Verse 6.
- **Visit the cottage** (only if you don't have the **"Wilderness Encounters"** part **7** status) – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

You enter the grand temple – and find only destruction. Tall Allmother statues lie toppled, tar smears paintings, and fragments of furniture litter the floor. Allfather's inquisition has been here.

- **Search the ruins** – go to Verse 5.
- **Pray to the Allfather** – *You feel his powerful presence.* Go to Verse 9.
- **Pray to the Allmother** – go to Verse 7.
- **Exit** – Exploration ends.

3

Go to:

5

You walk between the devastated statues...

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

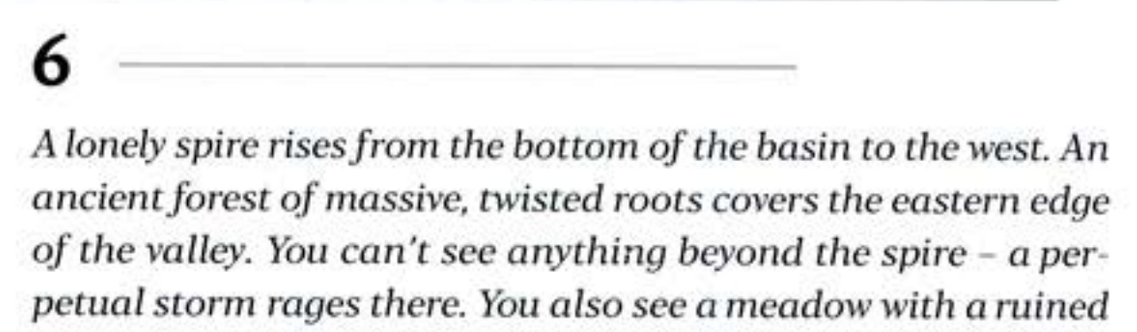
1-6 – *You find only rubble here. The pillagers must have taken everything.* Exploration ends.

7+ – go to:

6

A lonely spire rises from the bottom of the basin to the west. An ancient forest of massive, twisted roots covers the eastern edge of the valley. You can't see anything beyond the spire – a perpetual storm rages there. You also see a meadow with a ruined village and a menhir at its center, and woods frosted with ice.

If you're playing **Fyul**, **have** the **"Fallen Wyrdhunters"** part **1** status, and **don't have** the **"Fallen Wyrdhunters"** part **2** status, go to:



Otherwise, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

7

You close your eyes, muttering old prayers. You feel a calming presence, as if nothing terrible happened here.

If you **have** the **"Allfather's Blessing"** status, your head suddenly bursts with pain – each Party member gains 1 and Exploration ends.

Otherwise, the prayer soothes your nerves – each Party member loses 1 and Exploration ends.

9

You find a secluded corner sheltered from the Allmother's stone eyes.

If you **have** the **"Saved by the Goddess"** status, you can't remember any prayers and you feel an overwhelming drowsiness – each Party member loses 1 and Exploration ends.

Otherwise, you feel an omnipotent presence – if you **don't have** the **"Allfather Blessing"** status, gain this status and each Character gains 3 Exp; Exploration ends.

284 Dread Brochs

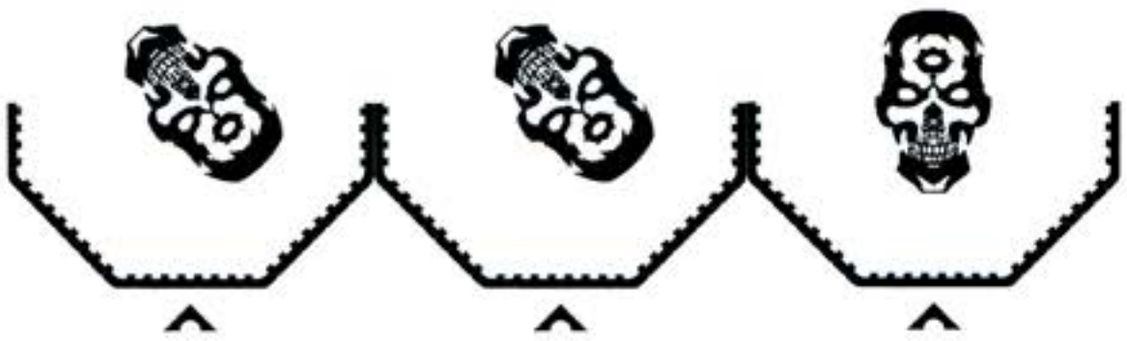
If you are playing **Chapters 1-5**, go to Verse 1. Otherwise, read on:

You watch the traveler stalking through your land. While you stare at their radiant soul, they gaze upon your mighty tendrils against the dark sky sharply contrasting the icy wasteland. The balance is long gone, the wyrdness dispersed – you can no longer use it to shape reality, forcing you to rely on your fallible minions.

- **The traveler goes toward your brochs** – go to Verse 4.
- **The traveler looks upon your might and flees** – Exploration ends.

1

Go to:



2

What an insult! You throw this ungrateful mongrel to the frozen ground.

Each Party member loses 1 . Exploration ends.

3

You speak into the traveler's open mind. Their primal fear pushes them to flee, but they can't stop listening. Once yours, always yours. But you don't want to imprison them. You communicate that you recognize them. You thank the traveler for their help in the past and ask for a new favor.

Each Party member gains 1 . Choose one:

- **The traveler accepts your acknowledgment** (only if you don't have the **"Horrors"** part **6** status, requires all Characters) – go to Verse 9.
- **The traveler wants to hear your request** (only if you don't have the **"Missions"** part **4** status) – go to Verse 8.
- **The traveler demands compensation for their help** (only if you **have** the **"Keeper"** part **2** status and **don't have** the **"Keeper"** part **3** status) – go to Verse 6.
- **The traveler leaves** – Exploration ends.

4

You send cultists to the traveler, your ethereal tendrils tapping into their minds. Many mouths speaking with the same voice dumbfound the traveler. You leverage this moment of confusion, trying to make a more direct contact.

If you **have** 2 or more , go to Verse 7.

Otherwise, choose one:

- **The traveler lets your whispers into their mind** – each Party member gains 1 . Go to Verse 7.
- **The traveler is disturbed and leaves** – Exploration ends.

5

You dismember yourself, ripping free a portion of your will – it burns your very essence as you force it into the traveler's mind.

Gain the **"Missions"** part **4** status.

Choose Party member with at least 3 or 3 . This Character gains Secret card **97**.

Exploration ends.

New Task: Go to Tuathan. Keeper of Secrets will tell you what to do next.

6

Humans... they always want more. You don't need the traveler anymore, and, what's more, you're focused on exploring Tuathan. But you keep your word. Cultists bring armfuls of gold and artifacts. Let the traveler experience your generosity!

Gain 6 Wealth, 10 Magic, and the **"Keeper"** part **3** status. Each Party member gains 1 Exp. Exploration ends.

7

At last, the traveler understands you. Your mouths lure them to one of your priests with a promise of warmth and knowledge. Finally, your mouths reach the priest – a man with a shaggy beard and unkempt hair – who greets the traveler with strange sound: "Czaaary," and presents your will.

- **The traveler offers their sanity in exchange for warmth** – each Party member gains 1 and loses 2 Exposure. Then, make another choice.
- **The traveler offers their power in exchange for mere gold** – pay 2 Magic for 1 Wealth (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **The traveler offers their blood in exchange for carrion** – pay 2 for 1 Food (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **The traveler wishes to speak to you directly** – go to Verse 3.
- **The traveler leaves** – Exploration ends.

8

You need a vessel to carry a fragment of your soul to Tuathan. You've spent enough time in these prisons at the edge of the world. You desire to return to your cradle, a place wrongly taken from you. You know it's empty, waiting to be seeded. All you need is a creature strong enough to bear your presence and take you there – the traveler.

- **The traveler accepts your mission** (requires 3 or 3) – go to Verse 5.
- **The traveler refuses** – go to Verse 2.

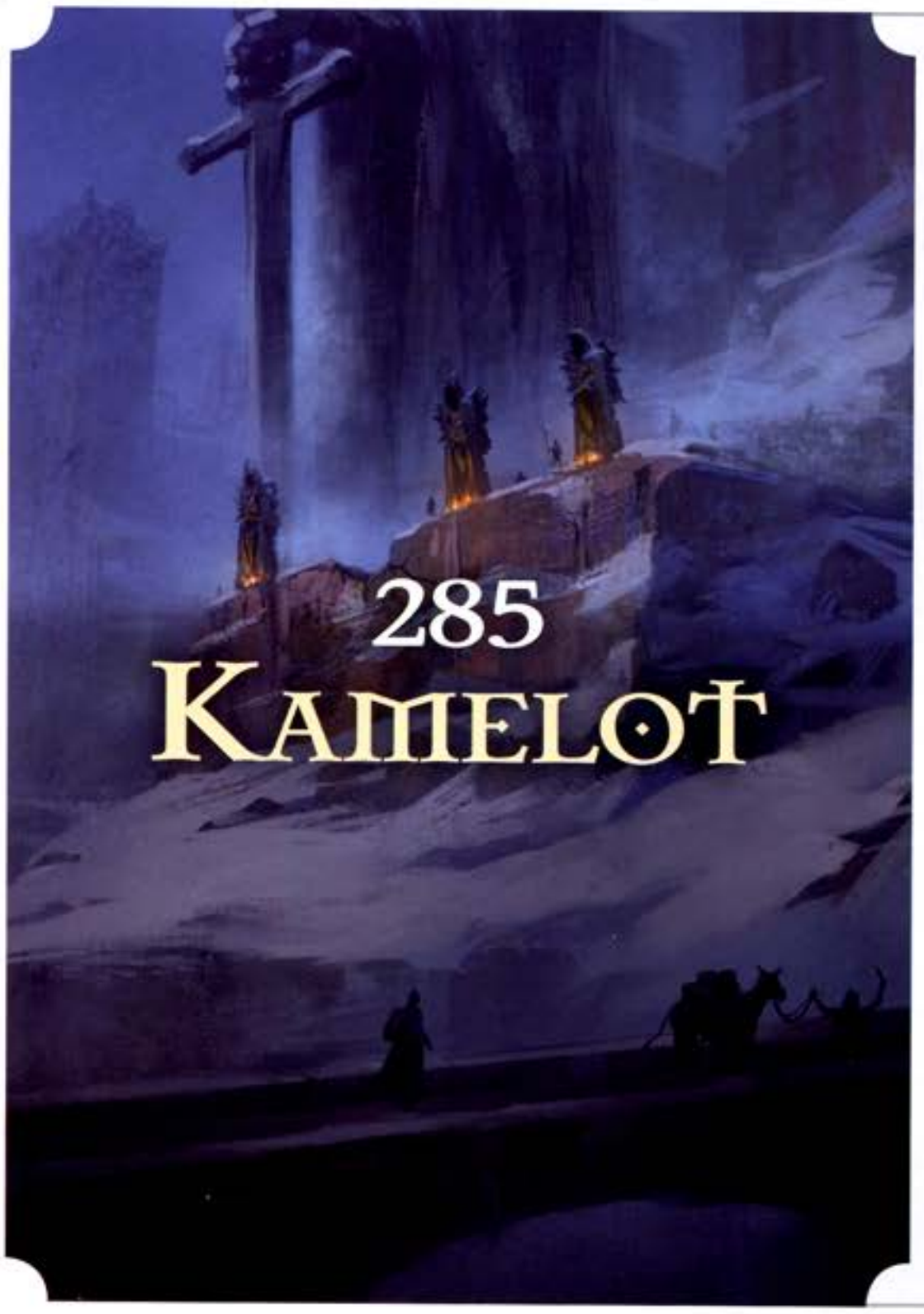
9

Go to:

Dream & Nightmare

You dream of your youth, thousands of years ago, when you prowled the Fore-dweller libraries. Free and full of curiosity, you greedily devoured your first secrets, and sometimes even four-armed scholars, as you tried to communicate with them. The taste... it brings so many childhood memories!

Each Character who has this Dream or Nightmare gains 1 .



285
Kamelot

If you **have** the **"Time"** status, go to Verse 15. Otherwise, read on:

Three menhirs guarded by armed soldiers stand side by side before Kamelot's walls. It looks like four once stood here, but something ripped one from the ground. The castle itself appears run-down, with bastions and wall sections crumbling and toppled from the cliff. Nearby stands a grove, also overlooked by one warden.

If the **Chapter 6**: **Part 1** or **Part 2** Quest Card is revealed, go to Verse 3.

If the **Chapter 8**: **Part 1** Quest Card is revealed, go to Verse 13.

Otherwise, choose one:

- **Speak with the gate guards** – go to Verse 1.
- **Approach menhirs** – go to Verse 2.
- **Hunt in the forest** (pay 1 and 1 **Wealth**) – *You need to pay for a privilege of hunting in these woods.* Go to Verse 4.
- **Go into the cellars** (requires the **"Clues"** part **4** status) – go to Verse 6.
- **Descend into the tunnels beneath the island** (requires **Chapters 10-15** and all Characters; pay 3 per Party member) – go to Verse 14.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

Your appearance causes a ruckus – everyone is surprised to see someone approaching the gates in these dangerous times. The only guests frequenting this place are the Allfather's inquisitors, roving mad folk, or wyrdspawn – as only they travel through thickening wyrdness.

If you **have** the **"Legacy"** part **9** status, go to Verse 5. Otherwise, go to Verse 7.

2

Guards block your way and order you to step back. This is sacred ground! Besides, a black-winged beast often visits these statues, so it's unsafe to linger. One guard points you toward the castle gate.

You may meditate for a moment between the menhirs – each Party member gains 1 **Exposure** and 1 **Magic**. Then, go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

3

Go to:

4

Few people dwell in Kamelot, hence the forest brimming with game.

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-4 – gain 1 **Food**.

5-7 – gain 2 **Food**.

8+ – gain 3 **Food**.

Then, resolve a green Encounter. Exploration ends.

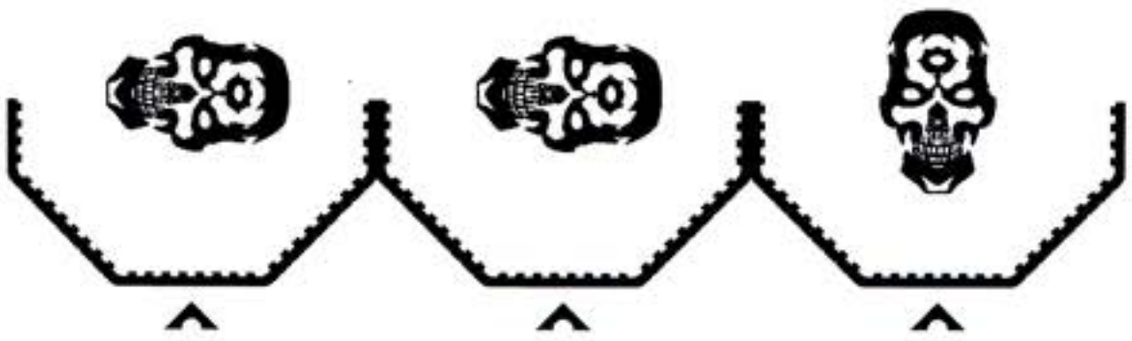
5

The plaza is well kept and the castle seems to be in order. There are few residents, but the relative peace and order make Kamelot a good place to live. You hear that the sole ruler is Morgaine, and she will be glad to speak with you. Also, some craftsmen would like to sell you their crafts for food. They don't get many visitors here.

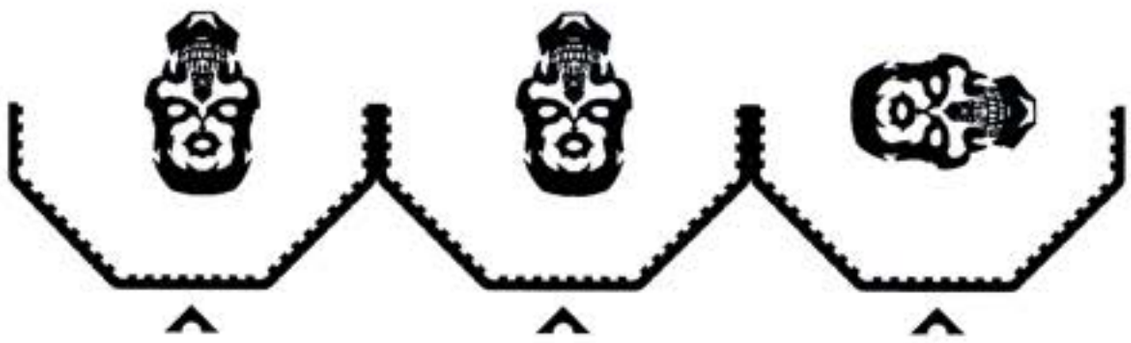
- **Pay Morgaine a visit** – go to Verse 10.
- **Browse the wares** – go to Verse 9.
- **Leave the castle** – Exploration ends.

6

If you are playing **Chapter 6**, go to:



Otherwise, go to:



7

Coughing and shivering people fill the plaza. They look to you with hope and excitement that contrasts their otherwise poor appearance. Guards tell you you should avoid the red district, as it's under quarantine. You also learn that the ruler of this place is Morgaine, but even her smallest decisions must be approved by the Free People Council.

- **Pay Morgaine a visit** – go to Verse 10.
- **Leave the castle** – Exploration ends.

8

Morgaine is sorry, but she can't help you – the knowledge you're looking for is long forgotten. It is said to be hidden somewhere beneath Kamelot, but even if the rumors are true, no one can enter the tunnels – most of them have collapsed, and others are sealed with powerful magic. If you want to inspect them regardless, you have her consent. But don't expect much.

When asked about the menhirs surrounding the castle, she reveals they still have a sliver of power, but only because soldiers protect them from the Black Drifter, the flying monster that feeds on their magic.

Gain the **"Clues"** part **4** status. Exploration ends.

9

Kamelot's artisans mostly make tools – nails, candles, arrowheads. But each also hawks antiques and relics of the past for a bargain price. In the past, when storytellers and travelers visited Kamelot, they had more customers...

- **Haggle for better prices** (pay 5 **Rep** reduced by 1 for each point of your) – go to Verse 11.
- **Sell food** – pay 2 **Food** to gain 1 **Wealth** (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy equipment** – draw the top 2 Item cards. You can buy any number for 4 **Wealth** each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sell equipment** – discard any number of Item cards and gain 1 **Wealth** for each. Then, make another choice.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

10

Morgaine is a young, raven-haired woman – you didn't expect that of a thousand-year-old witch. She greets you warmly and offers a cup of some herbal infusion. In the pleasant atmosphere, she asks about news from the wide world, and for the account of your journeys.

- **Inquire about Menhir Rites** – go to Verse 8.
- **Ask about Morgaine** – go to Verse 12.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

11

It looks like they want to sell you their wares at a better price.

- **Sell food** – pay 1 **Food** to gain 1 **Wealth** (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy equipment** – draw the top 2 Item cards. You can buy any number for 3 **Wealth** each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sell equipment** – discard any number of Item cards and gain 2 **Wealth** for each. Then, make another choice.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

12

She tells you the short and dull story of her life – she was raised and trained as an heir to the previous Morgaine. She assumed power of Kamelot, diminished as it is, and has had little to do since. She tried to pay wandering storytellers to come here more often, when they were still traversing the wyrdness-covered lands, but they didn't want to waste their time here. And yes – despite the legends, "Morgaine" is just a title, and not the name of an immortal, omnipotent witch.

Go back to Verse 10 and make another choice.

13

Go to:

14

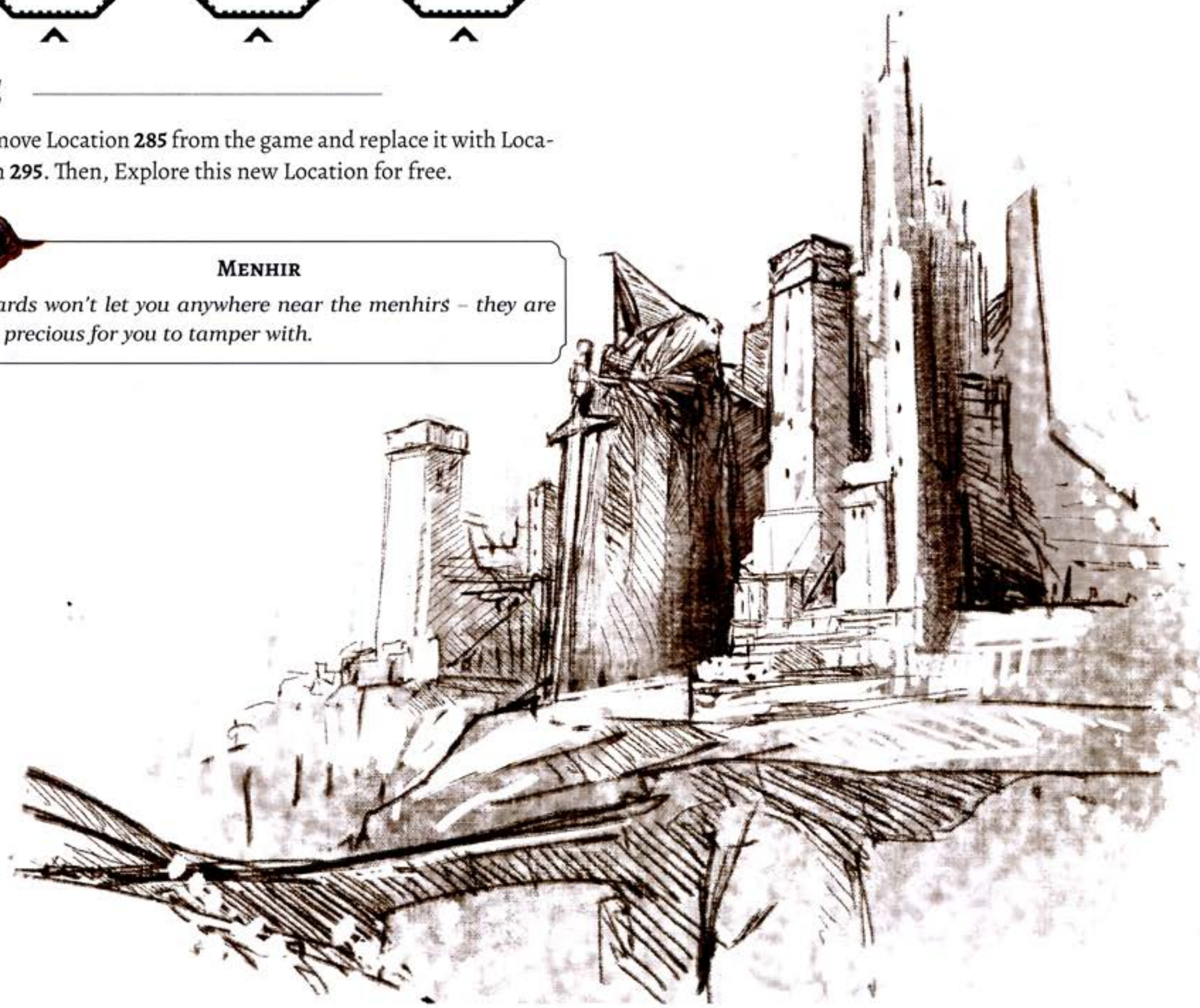
Go to:

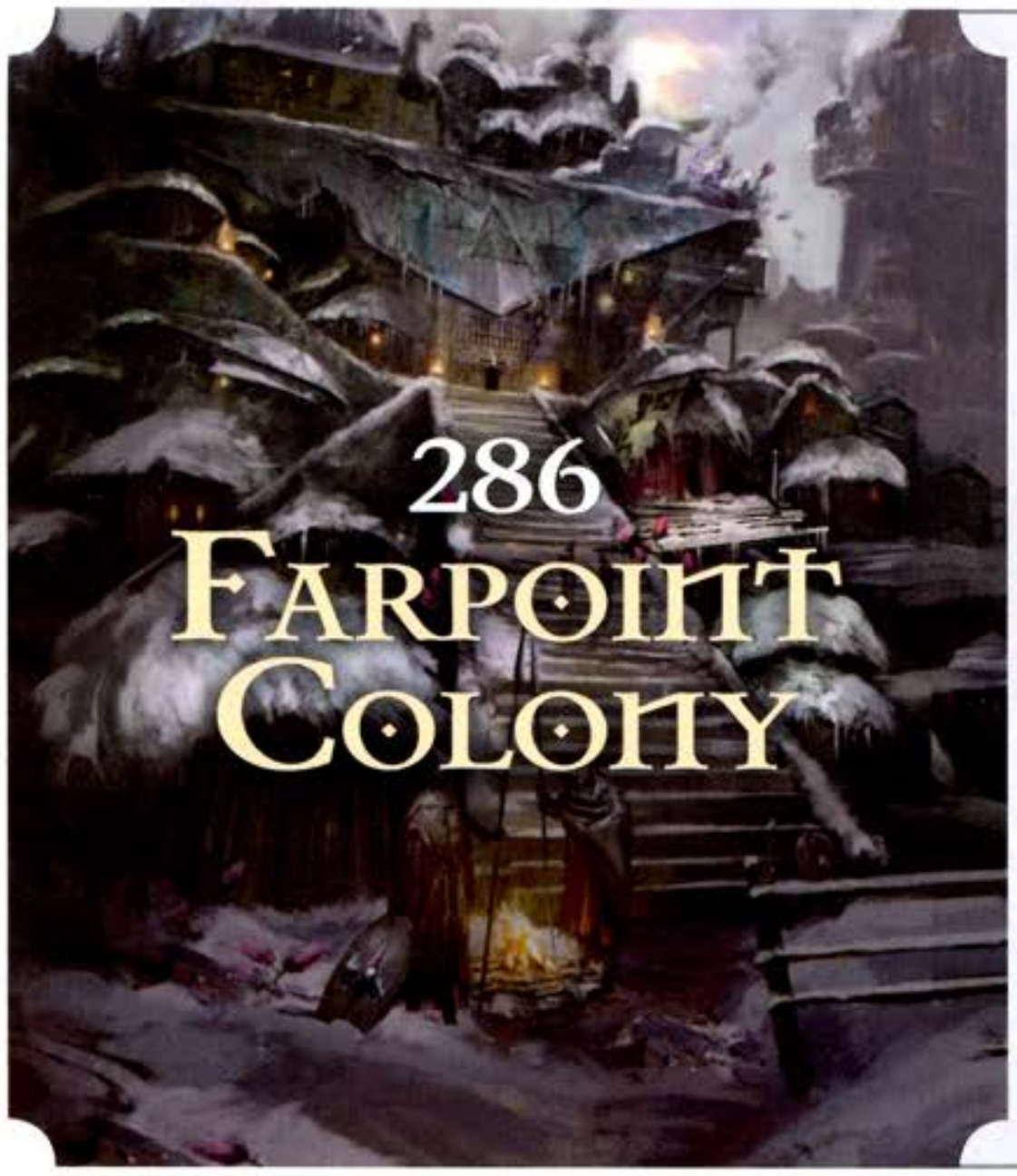
15

Remove Location **285** from the game and replace it with Location **295**. Then, Explore this new Location for free.

MENHIR

Guards won't let you anywhere near the menhirs – they are too precious for you to tamper with.





286
Farpoint Colony

If you're playing **Chapter 3**, go to Verse 10.

If you're playing **Chapter 5**, go to Verse 3.

Otherwise, read on:

Guards shiver in the cold, almost hugging the campfire. They greet and allow you inside, and the gate closes, preventing warm air from escaping. Oil lamps light corridors full of people who stop to exchange friendly words with you. You wander, feeling anxious in the cramped space with the continuous sound of hissing and clattering.

- **Visit a market** – go to Verse 2.
- **Look around the Colony** – go to Verse 5.
- **Ask about the device** (requires 6 Rep) – *It glints temptingly atop the colony.* Go to Verse 1.
- **Ask about the plants** (only if you are **Dagan** and you don't have the **"Needed Supplies"** part **2** status) – go to Verse 6.
- **Prepare to free the knight** (requires **Chapter 4**) – go to Verse 4.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

You climb to the top of Colony, under the watchful eye of one of the guards. There is a strange device there, full of glass shards, tiny metal wires, and tubes. The guard explains that it is used for observing distant places, and shows you how to use it. Dense mists obscure the south, but you can look at the ruined city on the island to the west as if it's right before your eyes. However, there's nothing unusual there.

Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

2

Merchants show their wares in many corridors near the Colony's entrance. Unfortunately, the selection of goods leaves much to be desired.

- **Sell food** – pay 2 Food to gain 1 Wealth (any number of times). Then, make another choice.
- **Buy equipment** – draw top 3 Item cards. You can buy any number for 5 Wealth each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sleep in heated room** (pay 3 Wealth per Party member) – go to Verse 7.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

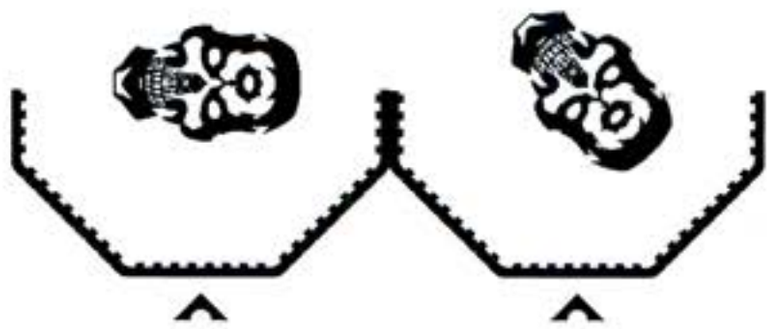
3

If you **have** the **"Liberation"** part **7** status, you rest for a while in unfrequented corridors discovered in a vision in White Fog – gain 1 and Exploration ends.

Otherwise, go to:

4

Go to:



5

Wide pipes run through each corridor – they're warm to the touch, and you hear water flowing through them. Everything is simple but efficient, including the people rushing past you with armfuls of tools and papers. There is nothing more to see here.

Go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

6

Go to:

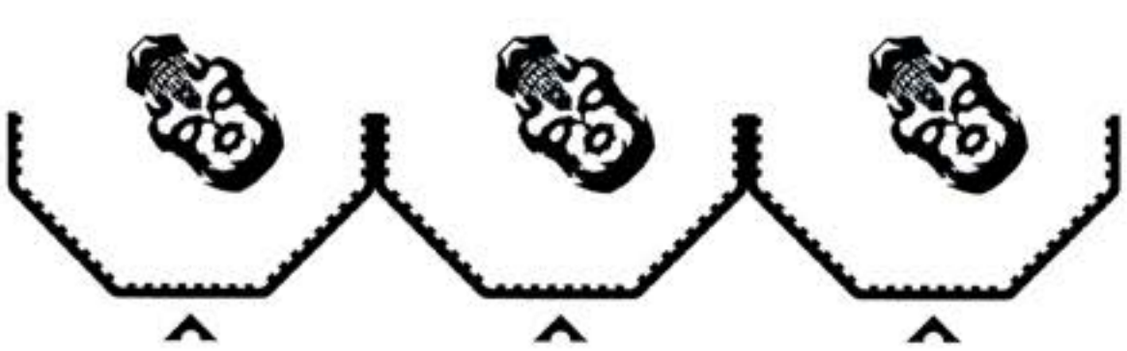
7

You rest in a warm cell, along with two scouts who recently came back from their mission. They grumble about their exhausting work, saying it's not surprising that the wandering storytellers don't want to traverse the thickening wyrdness. But, with the Allfather's help, it will be better soon.

Each Party member gains 3 , loses 1 , discards the Exposure Marker and Passes for the rest of the day. Exploration ends.

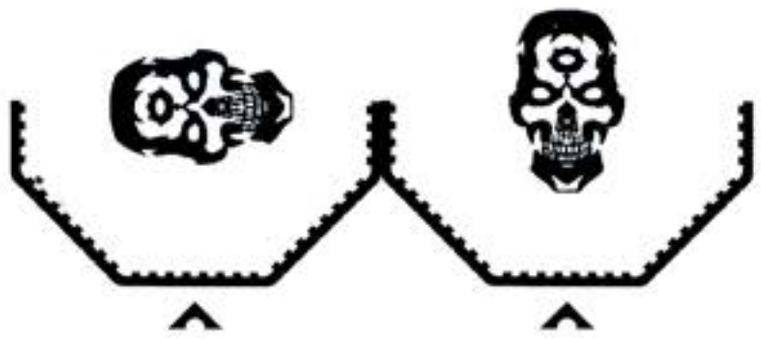
8

Go to:



9

Go to:



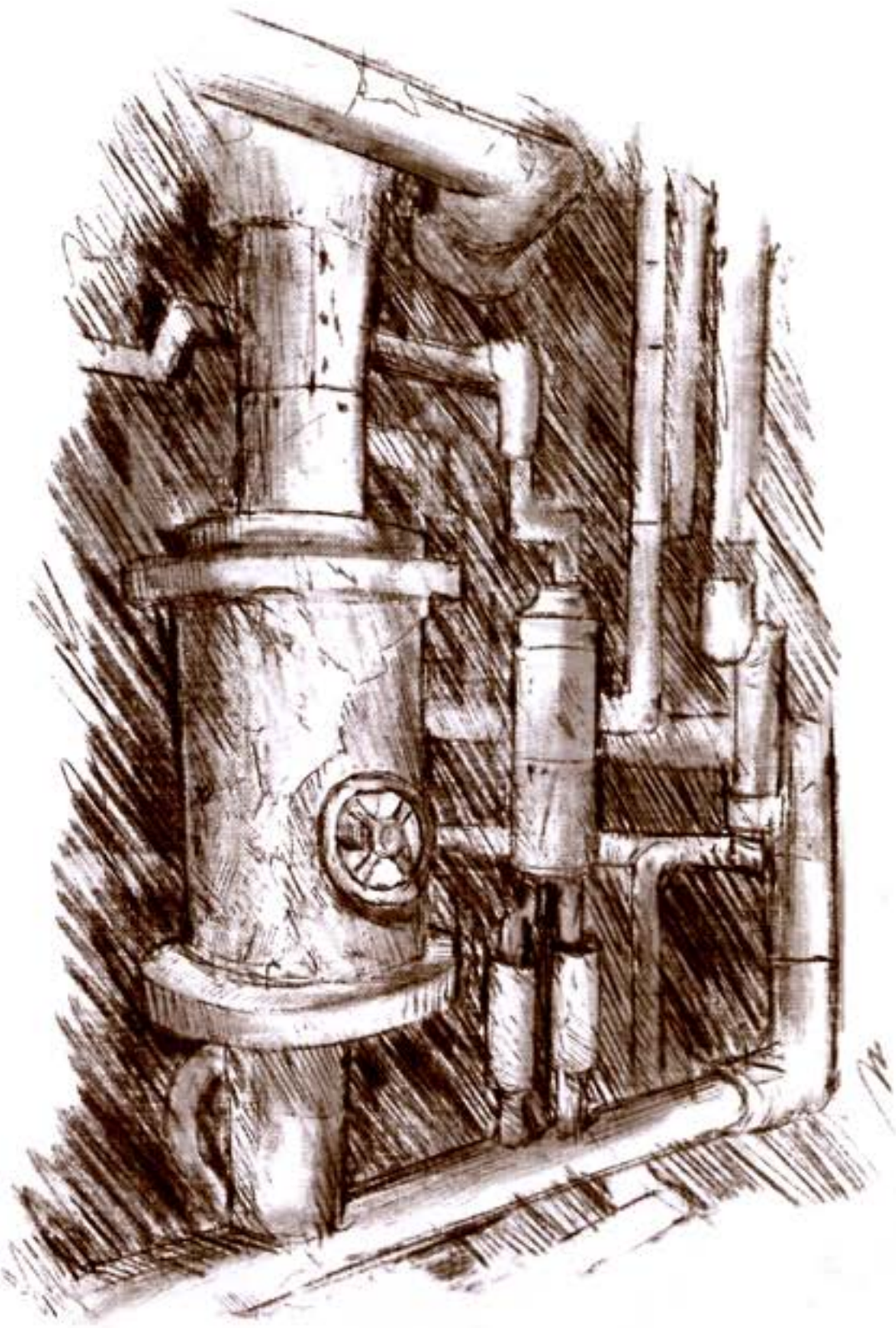
10

Three freezing guards huddle around a steel barrel full of burning wood. One approaches you. "Sorry, but you can't enter the Colony. We'll gladly invite you in, as we don't have many guests, but the disturbance in the Forest Sanctuary made our leaders suspicious of visitors. Until the problem is solved, no one can enter."

- **Ask for help** (only if you don't have the **"Means of Survival"** part **8** status) – go to Verse 8.
- **Ask if you can aid them somehow** – go to Verse 9.
- **Report your actions** (requires all Characters AND the **"Cracked Sanctuary"** part **1** status; this will end your Chapter) – go to Verse 11.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

11

Go to:



288
Red Valley

If you are playing **Chapter 8**, go to Verse 1. Otherwise, read on:

Wind, blowing through the valley brings metallic smells and screams of agony. Statues watching over this place cry with blood – their grim faces stained red evoke dread. You step into the valley, choking on the fetid smell of rotting flesh.

If any of the Party members have Secret card **66**, go to Verse 4.

Otherwise, go to Verse 2.

1

You must meet Pale Lady before entering Tuathan – you don't know what horrors await you there. She should be waiting for you at the feet of Fractured Tower.

Each Party member gains 1 . Move all Party member to Location **243**. Exploration ends.

2

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-3 – *Your journey through the valley is filled with strange sounds and smells, but nothing happens.* Exploration ends.

4-5 – *Something awful attacks you from one of the wall crevices!* Resolve a purple Encounter. You don't gain any Reward or Loot after the Encounter. Then, Exploration ends.

6+ – *You have a bad feeling...* Go to Verse 5.

4

A swarm of beasts falls from countless crevices marking the walls. There are so many that you don't have the slightest chance of defeating them in combat – you flee.

Each Party member rolls a die and may pay up to 3 to add 1 per each point of to the result.

Each Party member with result 4 or higher ends this Exploration. The rest go to:

5

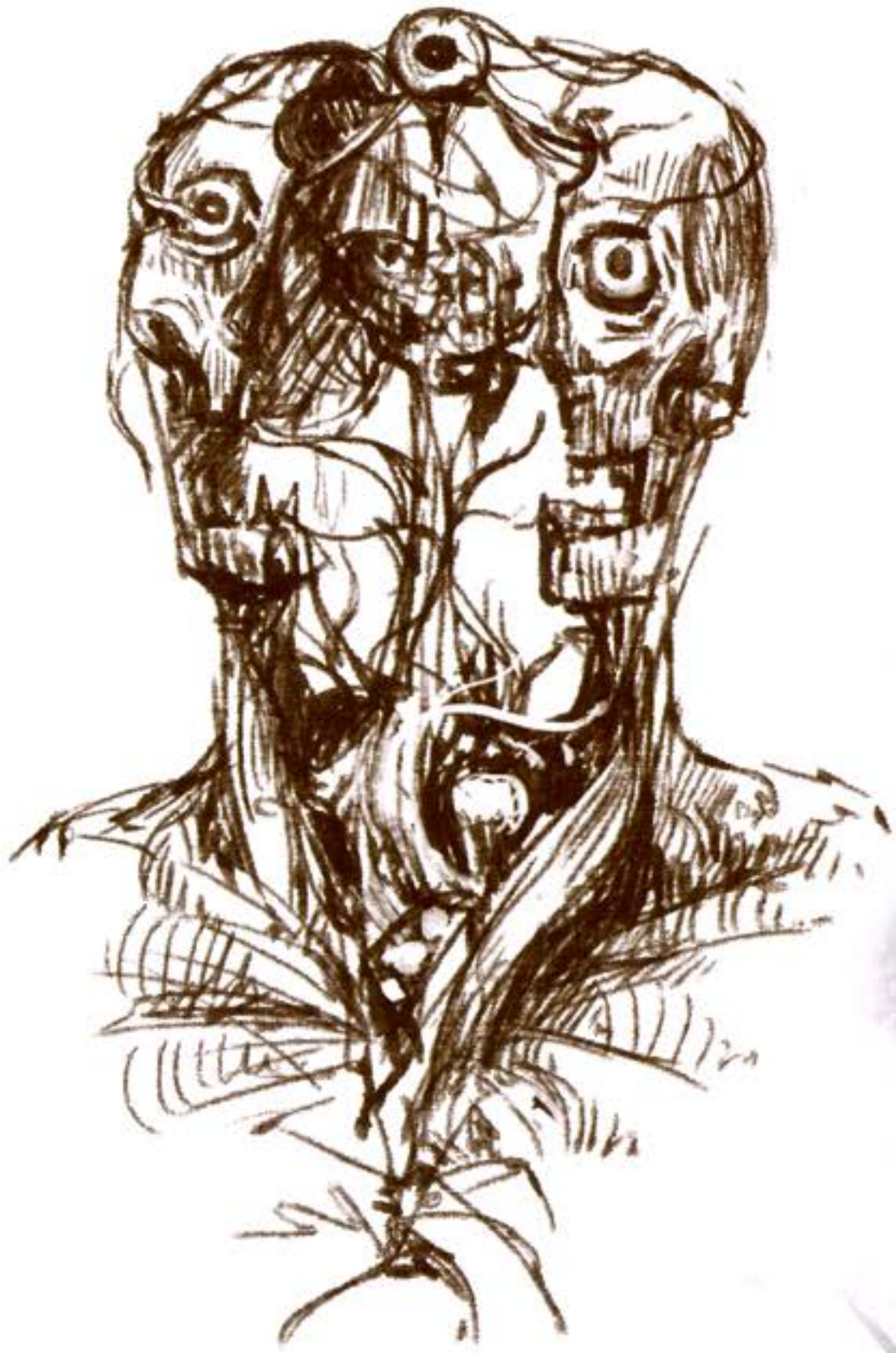
Roll a die. Check your final result:

1 – resolve the **"Red Beast"** green Encounter (Difficulty 4). You don't gain any Reward or Loot after the Encounter. Then, Exploration ends.

2 – resolve the **"Plague Embodiment"** purple Encounter (Difficulty 4). You don't gain any Reward or Loot after the Encounter. Then, Exploration ends.

3-5 – resolve the **"Bog Maiden"** green Encounter (Difficulty 3). You don't gain any Reward or Loot after the Encounter. Then, Exploration ends.

6 – *It was only a feeling.* Exploration ends.



289
Last Ruin

You cross the breach and emerge in a city surrounded by the high walls of Tuathan. Wyrdness swirls between tall buildings and gathers around a shifting statue in the central plaza. The sculpture roughly resembles a menhir, save for countless eyes forming and disappearing around its head, and a variable number of constantly growing and fading arms. Its body glimmers, changes. For the Fore-dwellers, it must be something like a Fore-dweller is to humans. The city around the statue is abandoned and in ruin.

- **Investigate the statue** – go to Verse 1.
- **Ransack the city** – go to Verse 3.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

Wyrdness is so thick around the statue that you can't go any closer than several steps before it.

- **Study the statue** – go to Verse 4.
- **Back out** – go back to the start of this Location and make another choice.

3

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1-5 – *There is nothing you could possibly use. Only incomprehensible rubbish.* Exploration ends.

6-8 – *Crystallized wyrdness... or at least you think so.* Each Party member may gain 1 to gain 2 Magic. Then, Exploration ends.

9+ – if you don't have the **"Hidden Caches"** part **8** status, go to Verse 6. Otherwise, each Party member may gain 1 to gain 2 Magic. Then, Exploration ends.

4

Go to:

6

You find a gold brooch still attached to a shred of a quality fabric.

Each Party member gains 1 Exp. Gain 3 Wealth and the **"Hidden Caches"** part **8** status. Exploration ends.

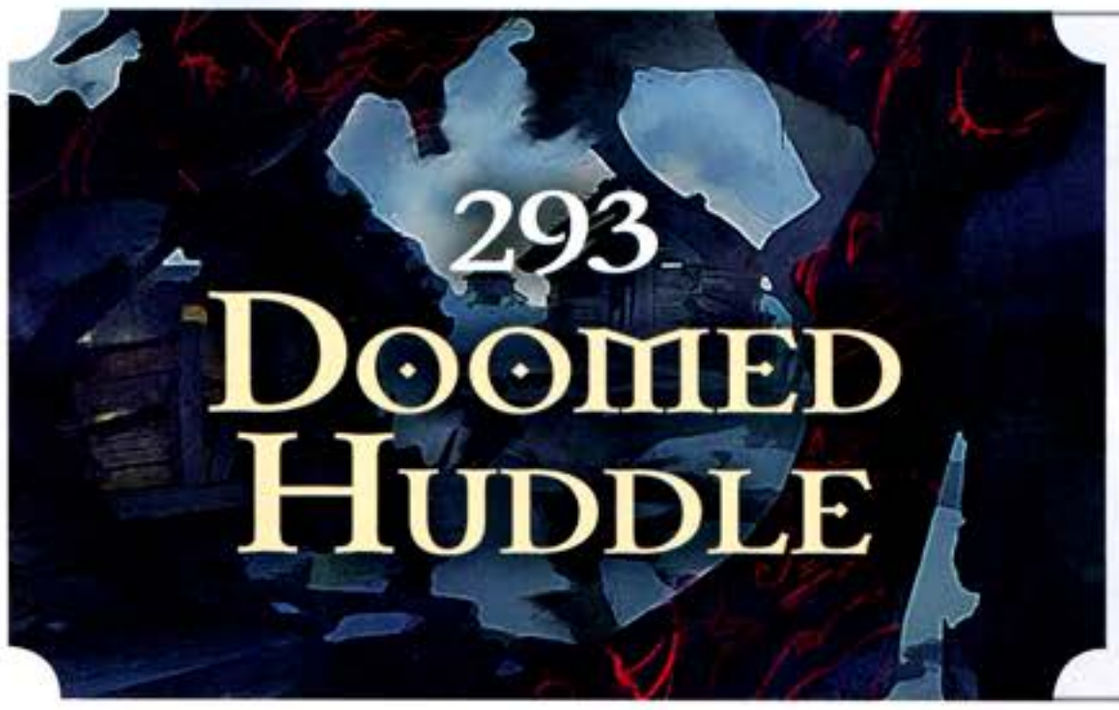
Dream & Nightmare

In your dream, you huddle next to the flickering statue, trying to warm your four hands in the comforting cloud surrounding it. All around you, the cold creeps in. Throughout Avalon, your familiar world yielded before another, alien one. A dreary, deterministic reality, where one flap of butterfly wings today always brings the same results one hundred years later. A hell, devoid of the tantalizing potential for change and greatness.

The cold is now so close it touches your body. You shrivel, instinctively covering yourself with this carapace intended to keep your precious energy inside. But it won't be enough. It can only sustain you for so long.

Finally, the cold enters your body in an unbearable wave of pain.

Each Character who has this Dream or Nightmare loses 1 and gains 1.



293 Doomed Huddle

Runes on the tree glow dimmer than the last time you visited this place. Wyrdness creeps into the outer parts of the settlement, and people burn extra wood in a futile attempt to keep themselves warm. You feel judging eyes following your movement as if you brought misfortune upon this place.

- **Go to the warmth healer** – go to Verse 1.
- **Buy some equipment** – go to Verse 6.
- **Find the singer** (only if you **have** part **7** and **don't have** part **8** of the **"Missions"** status) – go to Verse 7.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

The warmth healer looks at you suspiciously and asks if you have food – it's more needed here than worthless gold.

Each Party member may pay 3 Wealth or 1 Food to discard the Exposure Marker.

Each Party member may pay 4 Wealth or 2 Food to gain **"Fiery Brew"** Secret card (**54**).

Then, Exploration ends.

6

The market is abandoned, its stalls chopped up for firewood. But starving, freezing people will give you their equipment if they can satiate their hunger this way.

- **Shake them down to get better prices** (pay 8 Rep reduced by 1 for each point of your ; in a Party use only the maximum value) – go to Verse 11.
- **Buy equipment** – draw the top 3 Item cards. You can buy any number for 6 Wealth or 4 Food each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

7

Go to:

11

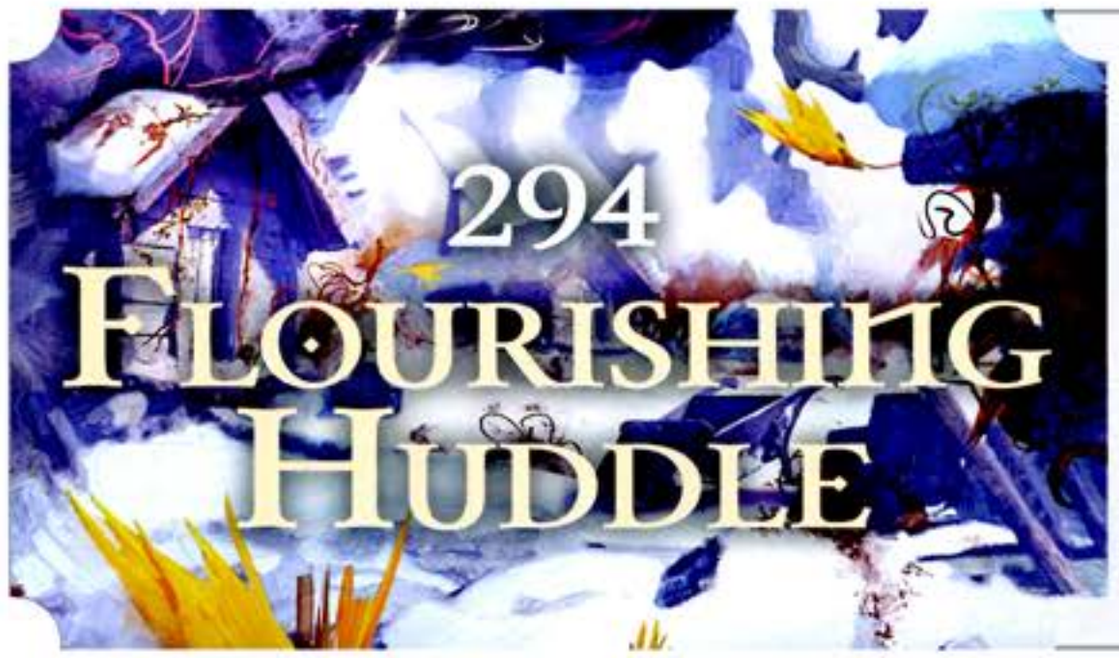
They don't have much choice – they'll sell the items for next to nothing, or they get nothing.

- **Buy equipment** – draw the top 3 Item cards. You can buy any number for 3 Wealth or 3 Food each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

Dream & Nightmare

You can't bear it anymore. These parasites feed you only their wyrdness-infused corpses – without proper fertilizer, you will dwindle and perish. At least these pathetic maggots will die with you.

Each Character who has this Dream or Nightmare loses 1 and gains 1 Exposure.



294 Flourishing Huddle

Mangrove Huddle has flourished since people gained access to more distant hunting grounds and cold-resistant plants. The tree sheltering the settlement also looks healthier – the runes glow brighter, leaves sprout on the branches, the roots grow longer. It's good to be home.

- **Visit the market** – go to Verse 6.
- **Go to the warmth healer** – go to Verse 3.
- **Find the singer** (only if you **have** part **7** and **don't have** part **8** of the **"Missions"** status) – go to Verse 1.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

Go to:

2

Merchants are almost grateful to give you better prices.

- **Buy equipment** – draw the top 5 Item cards. You can buy any number for 3 Wealth each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sell equipment** – discard any number of Item cards and gain 2 Wealth for each. Then, make another choice.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

3

Sacred symbols in the healer's hut are replaced with a tapestry depicting a tree with a shining crown. The healer will take only a small donation for exposing you to Tree's warm blessing.

Each Party member may pay 1 Wealth to discard the Exposure Marker.

Each Party member may pay 3 Wealth to gain **"Fiery Brew"** Secret card (**54**).

Then, Exploration ends.

6

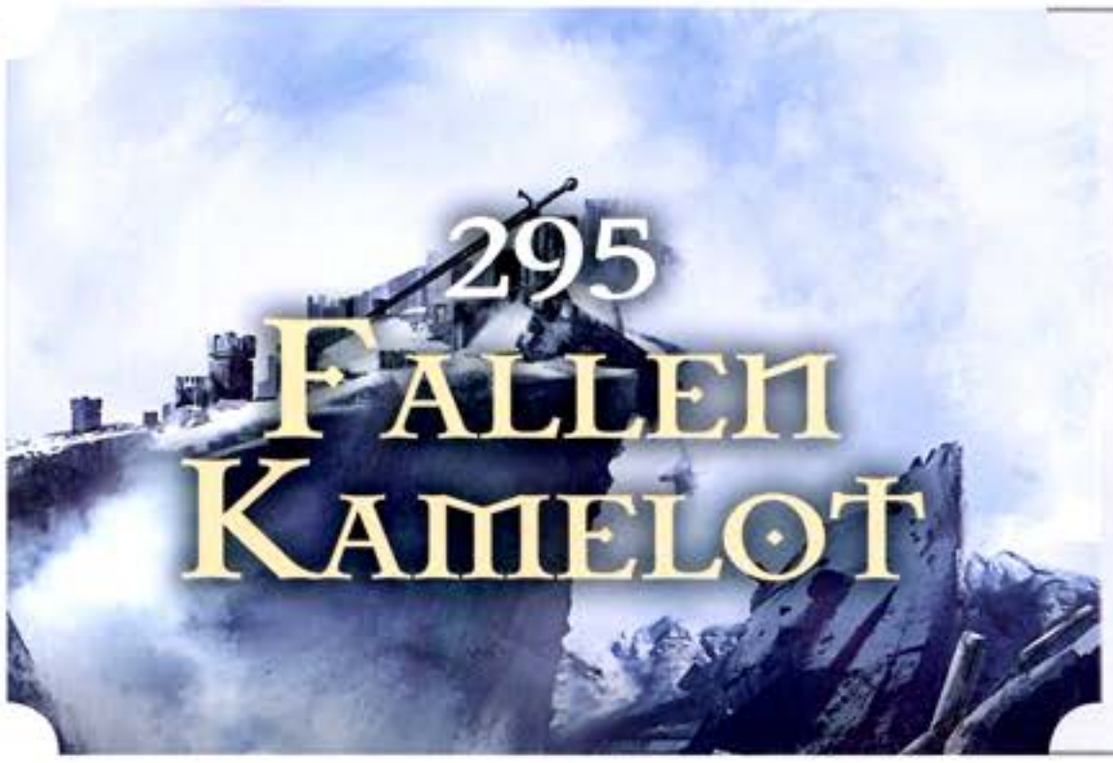
The small market flourishes with new handicrafts, and people shout and haggle eagerly.

- **Haggle** (pay 4 Rep reduced by 1 for each point of your ; in a Party use only the maximum value) – go to Verse 2.
- **Buy equipment** – draw the top 3 Item cards. You can buy any number for 4 Wealth each. Shuffle the rest back into the deck. Exploration ends.
- **Sell equipment** – discard any number of Item cards and gain 1 Wealth for each. Then, make another choice.
- **Leave the market** – Exploration ends.

Dream & Nightmare

It's better now. Your roots mingle with the roots of other, pleasant plants. Your parasites feed you generous amounts of compost, and you finally have enough strength to heat yourself fully in this eternal winter.

Each Character who has this Dream or Nightmare loses 1 Exposure and gains 1 .



295
Fallen Kamelot

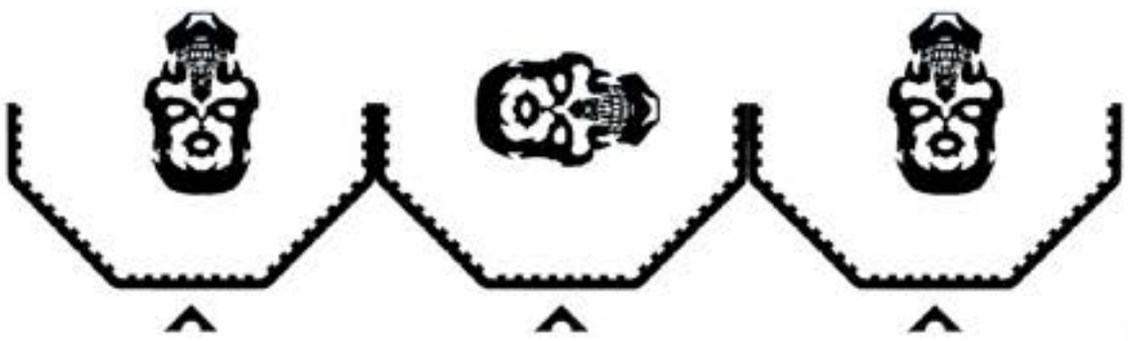
For a moment, you think you've gone the wrong way. But it's not possible to lose your way on this narrow highland – you should be standing before Kamelot. The castle is gone. The entire cliff yielded under the weight of the walls and fell into the sea. Now, the way to the Undercastle is open, as the disaster also damaged the foundations.

- **Descend into the Undercastle** – go to Verse 1.
- **Hunt in the forest** (pay 1) – go to Verse 4.
- **Use the underground passageways** (requires all Characters; pay 3 per Party member) – go to Verse 2.
- **Leave** – Exploration ends.

1

You pass the furrowed land and descend the rubble into the depths of Kamelot.

Go to:



2

Go to:

4

The forest didn't suffer much damage from the cliff's collapse, but animals behave differently now. They are skittish, and sometimes aggressive.

Roll a die and add your . Check your final result:

1–4 – gain 1 Food.

5–7 – gain 2 Food.

8+ – gain 3 Food.

Then, resolve a green Encounter. Exploration ends.

Dream & Nightmare

When you saw the cliff for the first time, it seemed like a perfect place for a castle. It was tall, isolated, beautiful. But when all these stones and people were dragged here from all over the island, it lost its charm. Not to mention you had a haunting feeling it was only a matter of time before the rock broke beneath the weight.

Each Character who has this Dream or Nightmare gains 1 .

296 Husk Colony

The Colony was murdered because of your incompetence. Survivors of the slaughter fight one another to survive, and many lost their minds or perished in the cold that overcame this place after the hot water pipes were damaged. Entering the Colony is like entering a nightmare full of rotting bodies and cold-blooded mad men.

- **Scavenge what remains of the Colony** (pay 2 per Party member) – go to Verse 1.
- **Gather plants growing outside of the Colony** (only if you are **Dagan** and you don't have the **"Needed Supplies"** part **2** status) – go to Verse 2.
- **Leave this horrible place** – Exploration ends.

1

The corridors are filled with stacks of bodies, their limbs crushed, their heads ripped off. You become aware of the power of the four-armed warrior that was traveling with you, and you don't like it. The journey into the bowels of the Colony allows you to gather some abandoned wealth, but it also makes you feel sick.

Each Party member gains 2 Wealth and 2 . Exploration ends.

2

You pluck the plants growing on the sides of the Colony. They resemble radishes, but are resistant to cold. Maybe they will feed your people?

Gain the **"Needed Supplies"** part **2** status. Exploration ends.

Dream

You dream of escaping the slaughter – stumbling over limbless corpses, slipping on urine and blood, while tears slide down your cheeks, burned with scorching magic. You live, but you don't know if you want to.

Each Character who has this Dream gains 1 .

Nightmare

Spinning arms wielding sharp steel kill you. Then, you perish again, immolated by deadly magic from under an otherworldly, three-eyed helmet. Then, you're running through another corridor, and you're killed again. You lose your head. You bleed out. You burn to death. Your mind implodes in excruciating pain. You die. Die again. Die, die, die – each time slain by the same hands.

Each Character who has this Nightmare loses 2 .